

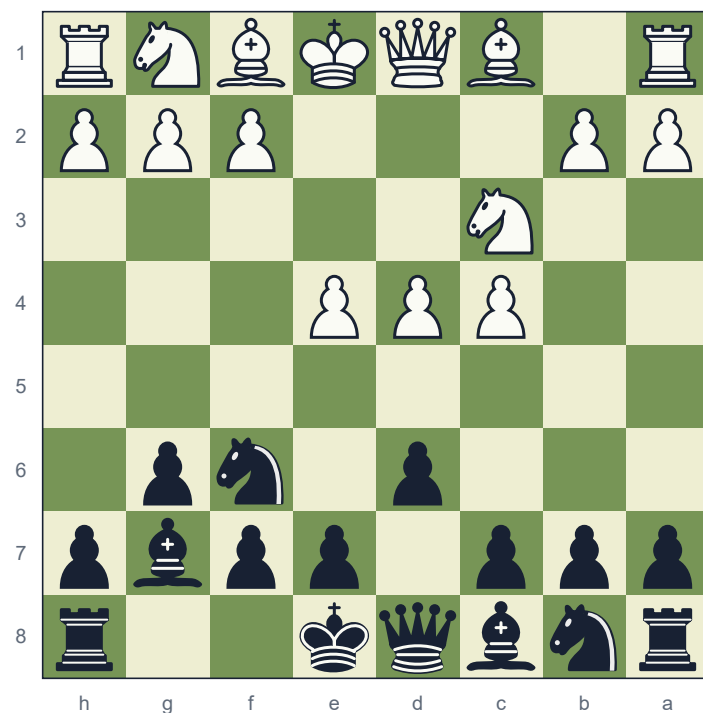
Your King's Indian Defense course

A practical Black repertoire, from move one to the middlegame

Built for a club player who wants to study seriously. Learn a consistent answer to White's common systems, understand the pawn breaks, and practice the decisions that make the opening work.

WHAT IS INCLUDED

27 study booklets plus this material in one combined volume; 83 opening branches; ten illustrative middlegame laboratories; 72 exercises with explained answers; a 12-week plan; and PGN companions.



The starting family - White to move

A VISIBLE IMPROVEMENT

The SVG drawing scale is corrected so pieces are larger and centered accurately within the squares. Every board is oriented with Black at the bottom, with explicit coordinates.

BEGIN WITH UNDERSTANDING

Read 00 and 01, then follow the study order in 25. Use 24 for retrieval practice and 21-23 to connect the opening with plans.

THE MAIN RULE

Choose your plan from the actual center and king positions. A King's Indian setup does not mean that every game calls for ...f5 and a kingside pawn storm.

The bargain you are making

SPACE FOR COUNTERPLAY

In the King's Indian, White often builds the larger center while Black develops behind it. Your compensation is the ability to challenge that center with pieces and pawn breaks. The opening fails as a passive shell: you need a concrete route to activity.

THE BASIC POSITION

After 1.d4 Nf6 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4 d6, the g7 bishop influences d4 through f6 and e5 once those squares clear. Black usually castles and then chooses the central challenge according to White's system.

A REPERTOIRE, NOT EVERY POSSIBLE MOVE

This course selects a coherent answer to the common systems and important deviations. It does not enumerate every legal reply or settle all opening theory. The optional Fianchetto Panno is separated from the core ...Nbd7 repertoire so you can learn one answer first.

WHAT A GOOD OPENING RESULT MEANS

A playable position with active pieces, a defensible king and a plan you understand is a useful outcome. Black does not have to force an advantage. Some sound KID positions retain a modest White space advantage; learning to handle it is part of the opening.

Read the board from Black's side

ORIENTATION

Every board in this course has Black at the bottom. The bottom files run h through a from left to right. The bottom rank is 8. Pieces remain upright. Coordinates retain their normal names: g7 is always g7, regardless of your viewpoint.

MOVE NOTATION

N is knight, B bishop, R rook, Q queen and K king. A pawn move has no letter. x means capture; + is check; # is mate. O-O is kingside castling; O-O-O is queenside castling. Nbd7 identifies the knight from the b-file. A move such as 9...Nh5 is Black's ninth move.

TWO KINDS OF CONTINUATION

Each opening page identifies a selected study anchor. If extra moves were added to reach roughly move ten, they are marked as an illustrative engine-checked continuation. They show one plausible branch, not the only way the opponent can play.

USE A PHYSICAL OR DIGITAL BOARD

Play the sequence with both colors. Before each Black move, name White's threat and two candidate replies. If you cannot explain the chosen move, return to the diagram and the reason rather than memorizing another five moves.

A decision process for every Black move

1. FORCING MOVES

Check whether either king is in check. List captures, checks, direct threats, loose pieces and pawn forks. A threat to your c6 knight after d5 takes priority over finishing an ...a6/...Rb8 formation.

2. THE CENTER

Is the center locked, fluid, or open? Which pawn contact can change it immediately? Compare ...e5, ...c5 and sometimes ...d5 by calculation. A locked center can support a flank attack; an open center usually demands development and king safety first.

3. THE WORST PIECE

Name your least useful piece and a realistic route. The f6 knight may need d7 or e8 to allow ...f5; the b8 knight may belong on c6, d7 or a6 depending on White's setup. The c8 bishop needs a job too.

4. OPPONENT'S BEST REPLY

After selecting a move, calculate White's strongest forcing answer. Do not test your plan only against cooperative moves. If a pawn break loses a piece to a pin, improve the position until the break works.

How this course fits your White repertoire

STUDY BOTH VIEWPOINTS

Your earlier 1.d4 course chose a Fianchetto system against the King's Indian. Booklet 14 here gives Black's response to that family. Compare what each side wants: a secure white king and central control versus active black central pressure.

KEEP SEPARATE NOTEBOOKS

Maintain one page for White's choices and one for Black's choices. A move you recommended as White may be a serious test for Black, without either recommendation being a forced win.

DO NOT CONFUSE THE INDIAN DEFENSES

The Queen's Indian normally uses ...e6 and ...b6. The Nimzo-Indian uses ...Bb4 against Nc3. A Grunfeld uses an early ...d5 challenge. This course centers on ...g6, ...Bg7 and ...d6, with explicit companion defenses when White avoids it.

DO NOT CONFUSE THE KING'S INDIAN ATTACK

The King's Indian Attack is a White setup. Similar piece arrangements with colors reversed can have different tempo counts and pawn structures. This course teaches the King's Indian Defense as Black.

Course directory

- 00 Start here and foundations**
- 01 Move orders and repertoire boundaries**
- 02 Classical gateway - meet White before the center closes**
- 03 Mar del Plata - the 9.Ne1 main line**
- 04 Bayonet Attack - meet 9.b4 with ...Nh5**
- 05 Other ninth moves in the closed Classical**
- 06 Exchange Variation - play the queenless middlegame**
- 07 Petrosian Variation - 7.d5 before castling**
- 08 Gligoric System - 7.Be3 before castling**
- 09 Samisch - the Panno main repertoire**
- 10 Samisch deviations - Bg5 and early pawn attacks**
- 11 Four Pawns Attack - strike with ...c5 and ...e6**
- 12 Averbakh - meet 6.Bg5 with a central break**
- 13 Makogonov and h3 systems**

Course directory / continued

- 14 Fianchetto - a classical ...Nbd7 repertoire
- 15 Optional Fianchetto expansion - the Panno
- 16 Early bishops and unusual central systems
- 17 White omits e4 - e3 and quiet c4 systems
- 18 English and Reti move orders
- 19 London Torre and Colle - when White omits c4
- 20 Trompowsky Veresov and early deviations
- 21 Pawn structures and strategic decisions
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- 23 Ten middlegame laboratories
- 24 72 exercises and explained answers
- 25 12-week study plan and reference cards
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White's choice -> your course reply

This is a repertoire map. An alternative is not labelled bad merely because the course chooses a different move.

NF3, BE2, O-O, D5

...e5, ...Nc6, ...Ne7; distinguish move nine | Booklet 02-05

7.DXE5 AGAINST ...E5

...dxe5; active queenless or open play | Booklet 06

7.D5 BEFORE O-O

...a5 and flexible ...Na6 development | Booklet 07

7.BE3 AGAINST ...E5

...Ng4 and a concrete bishop decision | Booklet 08

F3: SAMISCH

Panno ...Nc6/...a6/...Rb8; react to d5 | Booklet 09-10

F4: FOUR PAWNS

...c5 and ...e6; know the Benoni transition | Booklet 11

BE2 AND BG5: AVERBAKH

...c5 and ...e6 against the center | Booklet 12

H3: MAKOGONOV

...O-O, ...e5 and ...Na6 after d5 | Booklet 13

White's choice -> your course reply

This is a repertoire map. An alternative is not labelled bad merely because the course chooses a different move.

G3 AND BG2: FIANCHETTO

Core ...Nbd7/...e5/...c6 | Booklet 14

OPTIONAL SECOND FIANCHETTO REPERTOIRE

Panno ...Nc6/...a6/...Rb8 | Booklet 15

EARLY BISHOPS, NGE2 OR H4

Respond to the exact threat and center | Booklet 16

E3 RATHER THAN E4

Develop, then challenge with ...e5 | Booklet 17

1.C4 OR 1.NF3

Transpose only when the pawn center matches | Booklet 18

LONDON, TORRE, COLLE

Companion central defenses; no automatic KID | Booklet 19

2.BG5 OR 2.NC3

...Ne4 or ...d5 companion repertoire | Booklet 20

Where the standard setup is appropriate

START WITH 1...Nf6

Against 1.d4, the course begins 1...Nf6. After 2.c4 g6 3.Nc3 Bg7 4.e4, play ...d6 to support the center. Against 3.Nf3 or 3.g3, develop the bishop and wait to see whether White builds e4 or a Fianchetto.

DO NOT CONFUSE A DELAY WITH A REFUSAL

White can postpone Nc3, e4 or d4 and transpose later. Keep a record of the actual piece squares. If White reaches the same position with the same side to move and rights, use the relevant chapter.

THE C6 KNIGHT CREATES A COMMITMENT

...Nc6 is excellent in the Classical and Panno plans, but d5 attacks it. Before choosing ...Nc6, know the retreat: often e7 in the closed Classical, sometimes e5 in a Samisch, and a5 in the Fianchetto Panno.

THE D7 KNIGHT CREATES A DIFFERENT COMMITMENT

...Nbd7 supports e5 and keeps c6 available for a pawn. It can obstruct the c8 bishop and occupy a square wanted by Nf6. You must arrange the pieces accordingly; the same knight maneuver cannot be copied blindly.

When to leave the King's Indian script

2.BG5: TROMPOWSKY

The early bishop attacks or threatens to exchange Nf6 before the normal c4 center appears. The course answers ...Ne4 and then develops centrally. Playing ...g6 is not declared universally bad; it is simply not the selected answer to this different opening.

2.NC3: THE PIRC BOUNDARY

After 1.d4 Nf6 2.Nc3 g6 3.e4 d6, you have a Pirc-type position, not a King's Indian with c4. This course chooses 2...d5 and gives Veresov and Jobava companion lines, so you do not need a full Pirc repertoire here.

1.E4: OUTSIDE THIS COURSE

You need a separate answer to 1.e4. The King's Indian Defense is not a universal system that can be played unchanged against every first move. A Pirc or Modern repertoire would be a separate project with its own theory.

LONDON AND ENGLISH

White can refuse the broad d4/c4/e4 center without doing anything wrong. Your task is to choose an appropriate central challenge. Booklets 18-20 give practical companion lines for these branches.

Choose the central break deliberately

...E5

This directly challenges d4. If White plays d5, you may get the familiar locked chain. If White exchanges, prioritize piece activity. Ensure the pawn and resulting recaptures survive pins and queen exchanges.

...C5

This attacks d4 from the flank and often creates a Benoni structure after d5 and ...e6. It is the main course answer to the Four Pawns Attack and Averbakh. It can also create an open bind if White exchanges the d-pawn.

...D5

This can equalize or free Black when fully prepared, particularly in open or Fianchetto structures. It is not the defining early move of the standard KID repertoire; an early ...d5 against Nc3 can instead enter a Grunfeld.

...F5

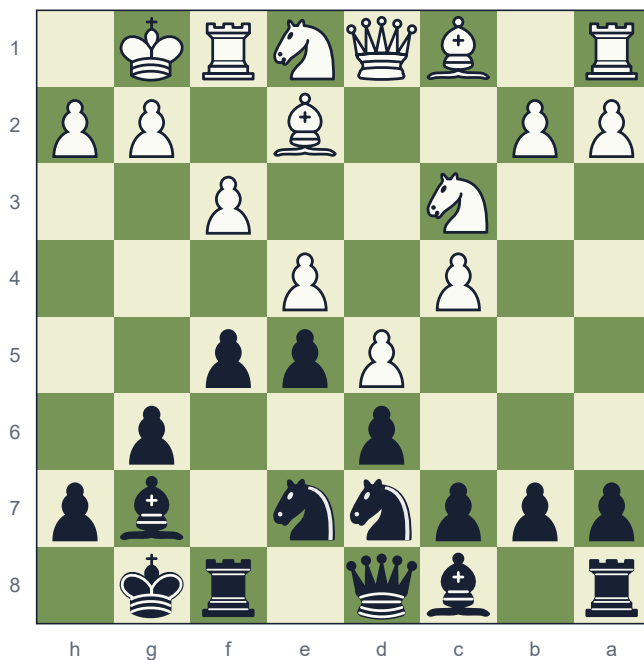
This attacks e4 and can start a kingside initiative. First clear f6, support the center and check White's king position. Against the Fianchetto or a fluid center, the same move may create weaknesses without a useful attack.

Classical gateway - meet White before the center closes

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...e5, then ...Nc6 against 7.O-O. You invite d5, but White can exchange or keep the central tension. Identify that choice before beginning a pawn attack.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The defining choice is whether d4 meets e5 by advancing, exchanging, or remaining in contact. Only the advance creates the familiar locked chain.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Check whether the center is actually closed.
2. Do not capture e4 just because it is attacked.
3. After 8.d5 Ne7, identify White's ninth move.

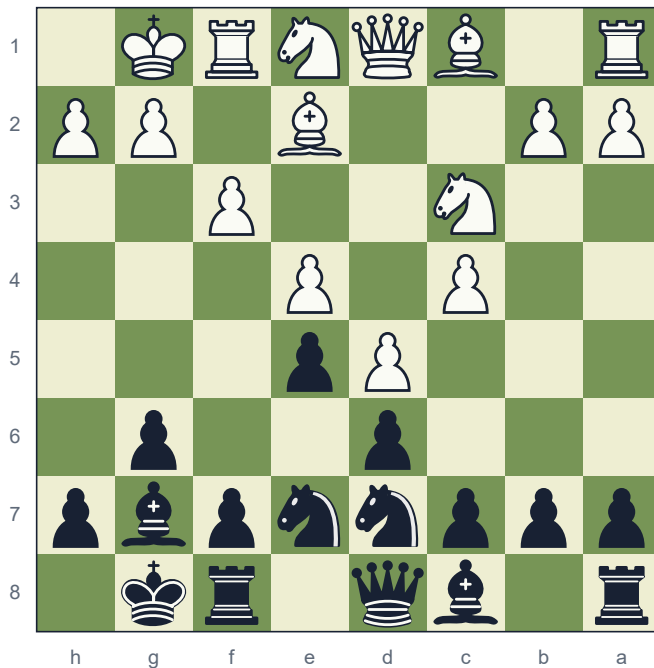
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main entry: the center locks

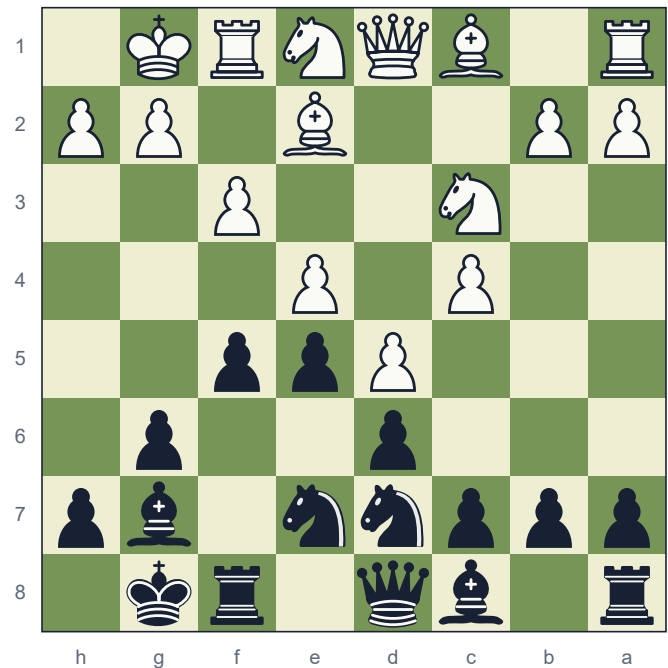
STUDY LINE 02-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. f3 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The c6 knight attacks d4 and is driven to e7. The f6 knight then goes to d7, vacating f6 for the f-pawn. White uses Ne1 and f3 to secure e4.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Meet White's queenside expansion with active kingside play. Decide between ...f4 and maintaining tension; first count White's captures on e5 and f5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The two knights have different jobs. ...f5 is illegal while your own knight remains on f6.

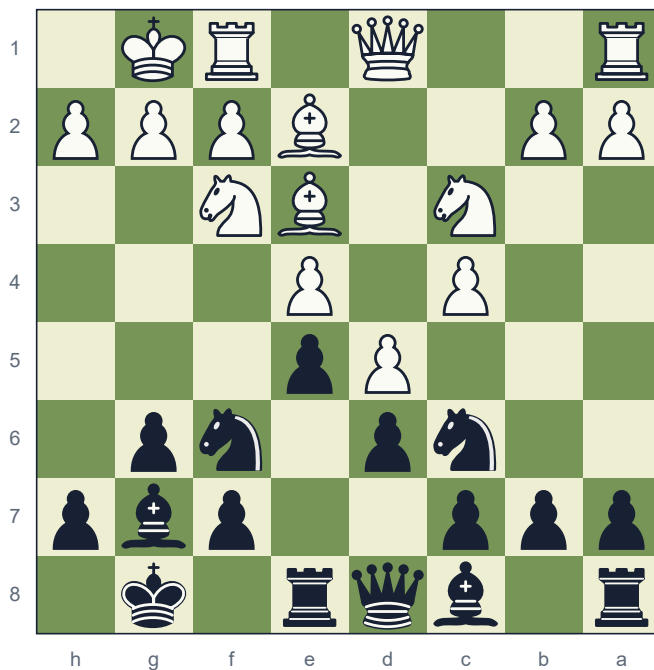
REMEMBER Close the center, reroute the knight, then choose the pawn break.

02 Be3 and the active ...Nd4 response

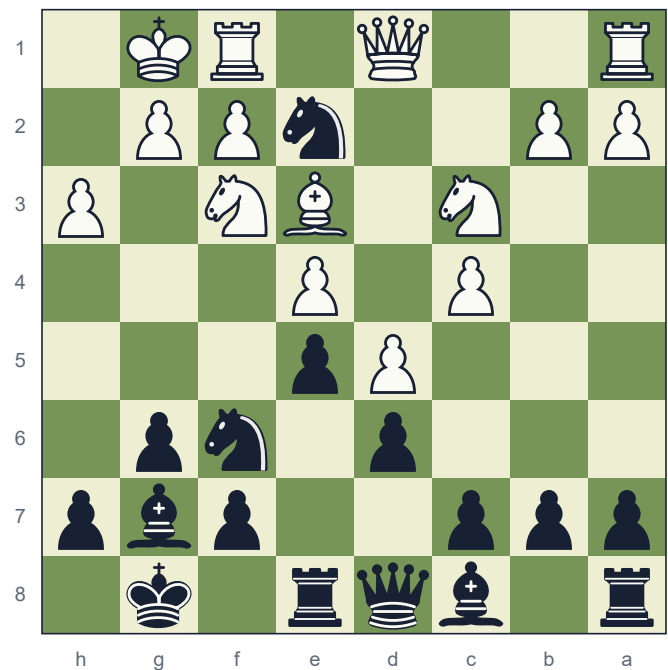
STUDY LINE 02-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Be3 Re8 9. d5 Nd4 10. h3 Nxe2+

Selected anchor ends with 9... Nd4. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move - in check

WHY THESE MOVES

Be3 supports d4 but allows a central knight contact after d5. The e5 pawn supports ...Nd4, and exchanges on d4 must account for the e-file pressure from Re8.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Calculate Bxd4 and Nxd4 before choosing a recapture. Finish development while using the active knight and the central files.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A routine retreat to e7 misses the more active resource in this exact position. Check which pawn and rook support the central knight.

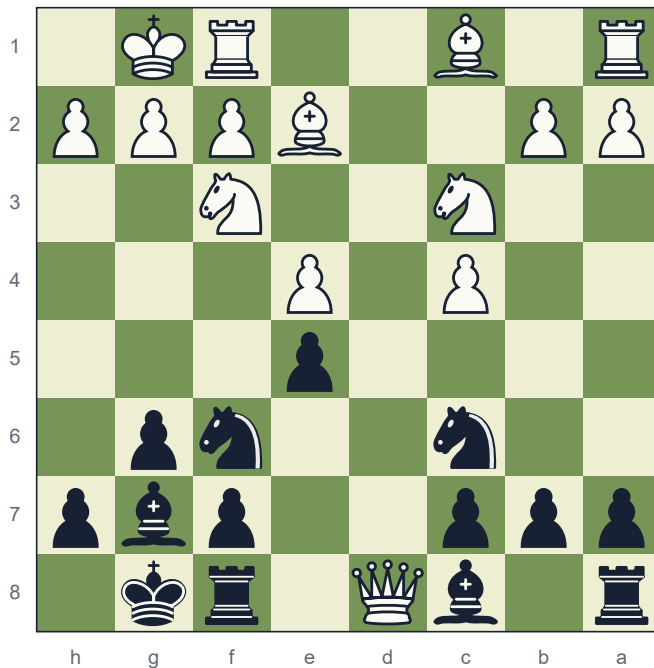
REMEMBER An attacked knight may have an active forward square.

03 White exchanges after ...Nc6

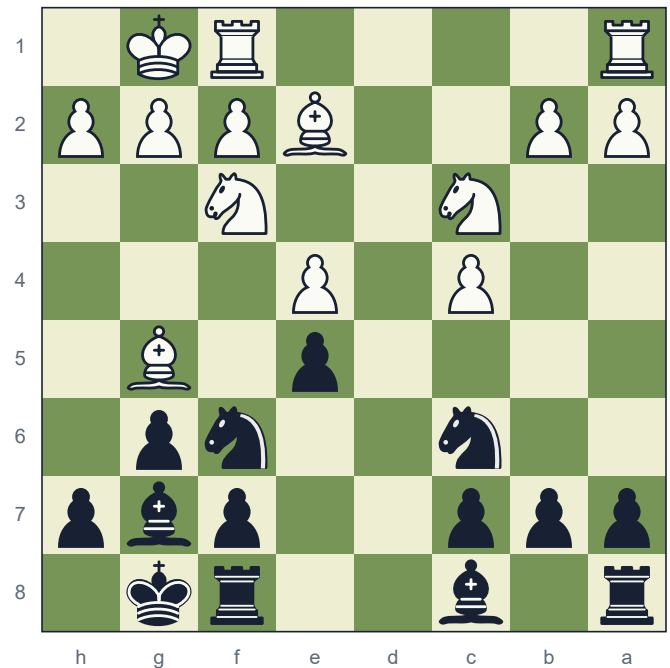
STUDY LINE 02-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. dxe5 dxe5 9. Qxd8 Rxd8 10. Bg5 Rf8

Selected anchor ends with 10. Bg5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The queen exchange removes much of the immediate mating play. The rook recaptures on d8 because Black has already castled.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the c8 bishop, contest d4, and coordinate rooks on open files. Active pieces are more valuable than an automatic pawn storm.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The d6 pawn has left d6. Reassess the center instead of continuing a closed-chain plan.

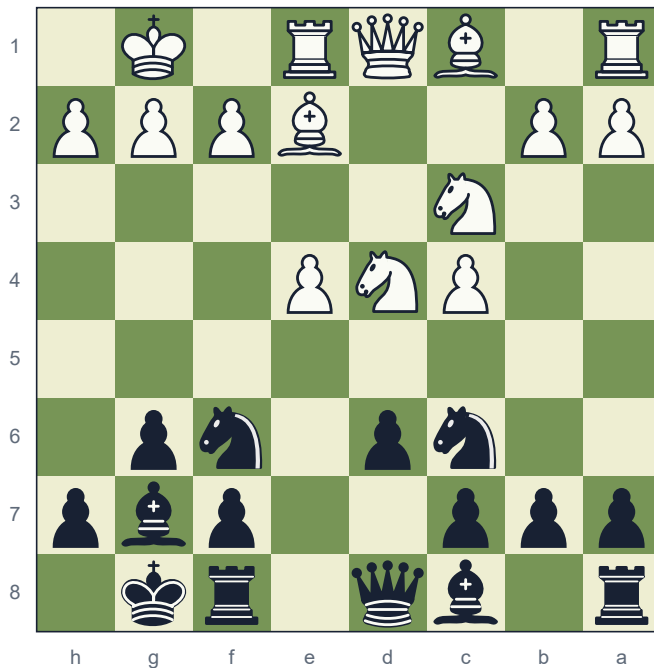
REMEMBER An open center needs active pieces.

04 Re1: release the tension with ...exd4

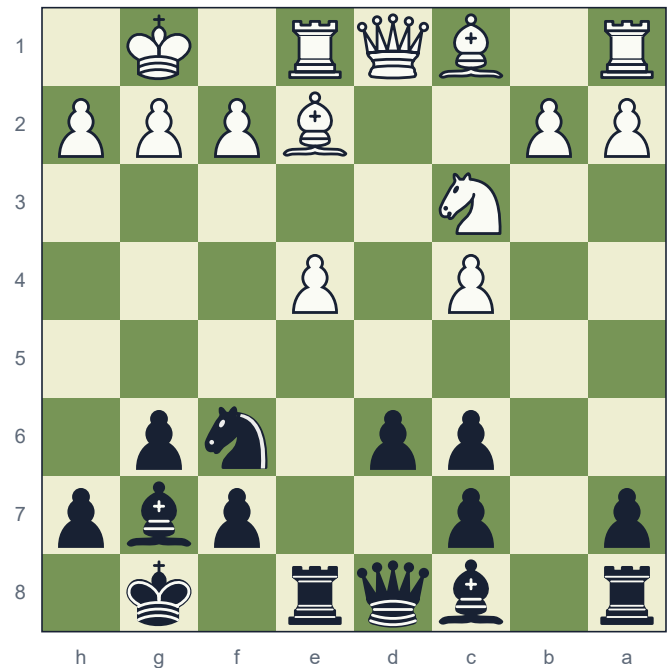
STUDY LINE 02-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. Re1 exd4 9. Nxd4 Re8 10. Nxc6 bxc6

Selected anchor ends with 9... Re8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Re1 supports e4, but the pawn exchange gives Black active pressure on the e-file and d4. ...Re8 is more purposeful after the exchange than before it here.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the c8 bishop and examine ...Nxd4 when it improves the pieces. White may reinforce e4 or bring the bishop to f1.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

There is no locked d5 chain. A kingside pawn storm would ignore the open center.

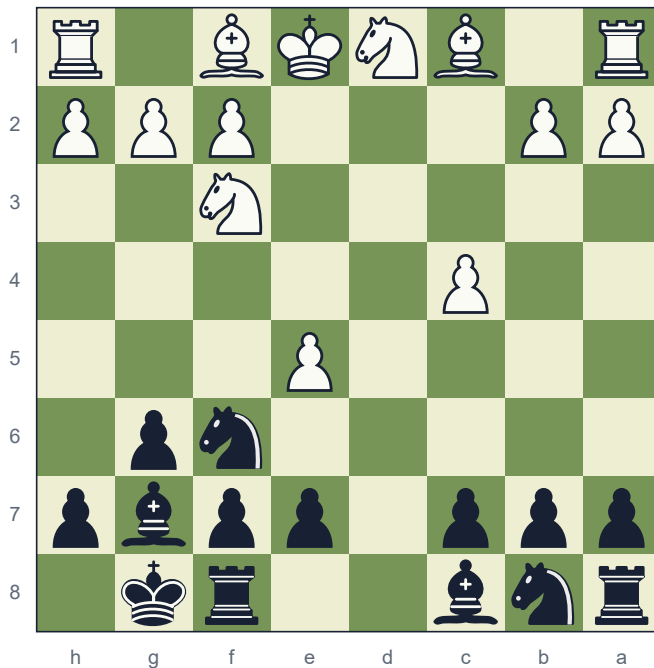
REMEMBER Exchange when it creates useful activity.

05 A premature central lunge

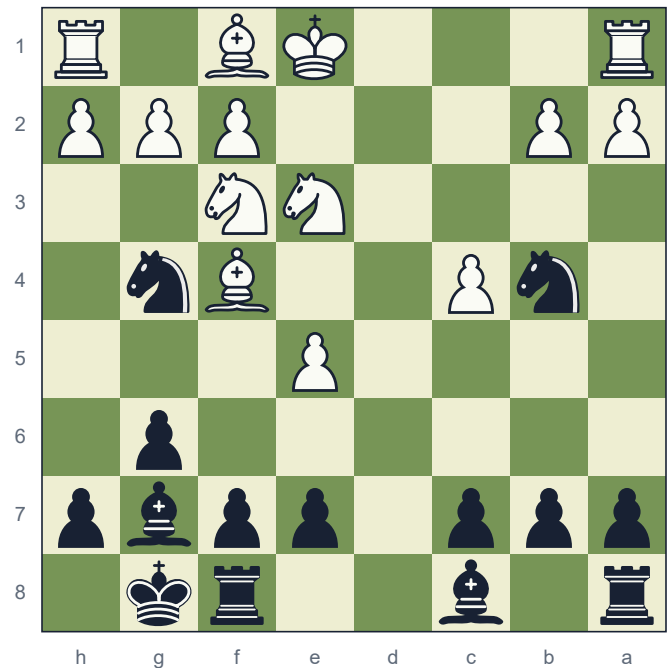
STUDY LINE 02-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. e5 dxe5 7. dxe5 Qxd1+ 8. Nxd1 Ng4 9. Bf4 Nc6 10. Ne3 Nb4

Selected anchor ends with 8... Ng4. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The d-pawn removes e5, and the queen exchange leaves e5 exposed. ...Ng4 develops with pressure on that pawn.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

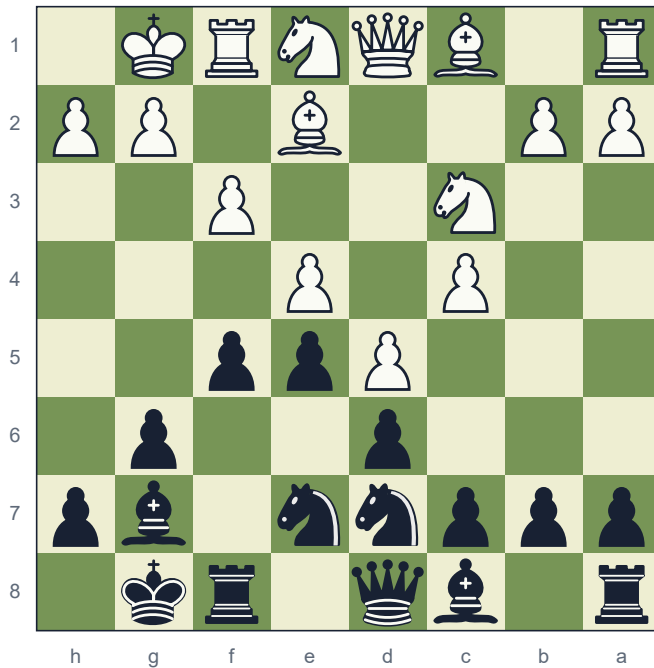
Recover or restrain e5 while completing queenside development. Keep the g7 bishop's diagonal in view.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Calculate the exchanges in their exact order. This is a concrete response to early e5, not permission to leave central threats unanswered.

REMEMBER Challenge the advanced center with captures and tempo.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The defining choice is whether d4 meets e5 by advancing, exchanging, or remaining in contact. Only the advance creates the familiar locked chain.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Meet White's queenside expansion with active kingside play. Decide between ...f4 and maintaining tension; first count White's captures on e5 and f5.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

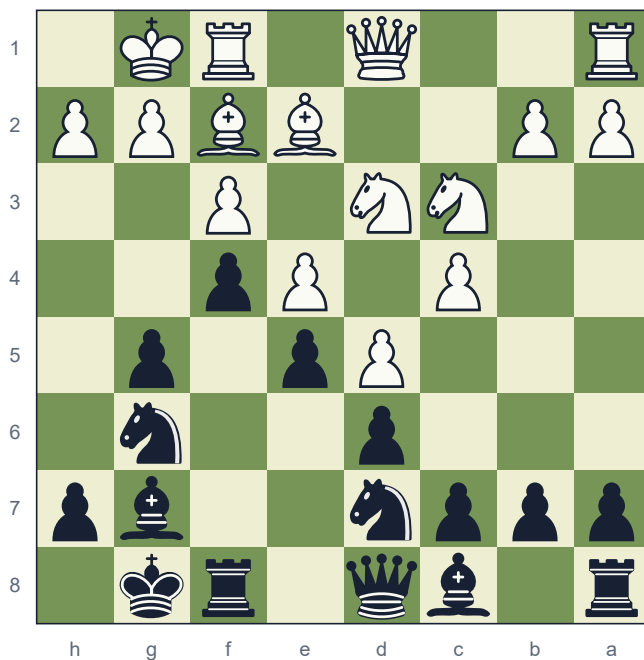
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Mar del Plata - the 9.Ne1 main line

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Answer 9.Ne1 with ...Nd7. The main study spine continues f3, ...f5, Be3, ...f4, Bf2, ...g5. Learn the conditions for the attack as well as the moves.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White has d5 and e4 against d6 and e5. After ...f4 the center and kingside gain a second chain, giving Black space but fixing targets.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Count tempi on both wings.
2. Know which piece will use g6, f6 and h5.
3. An exchange sacrifice needs concrete compensation.

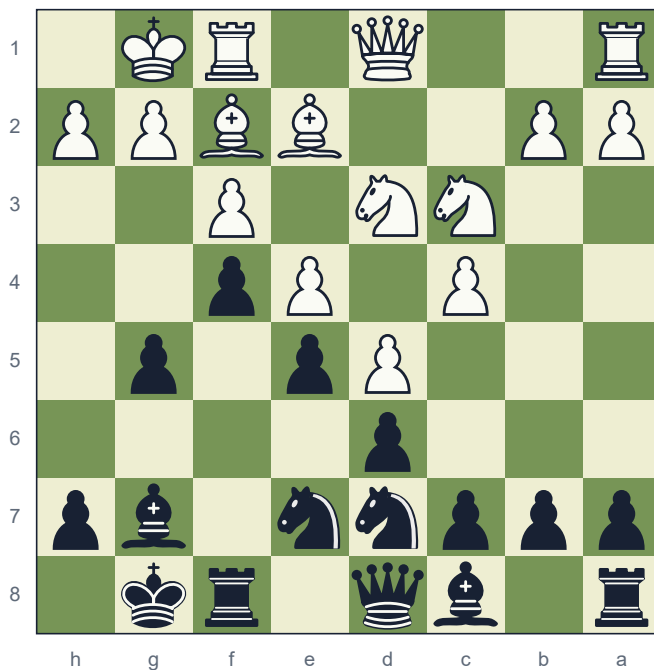
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Traditional attack: f3 and Be3

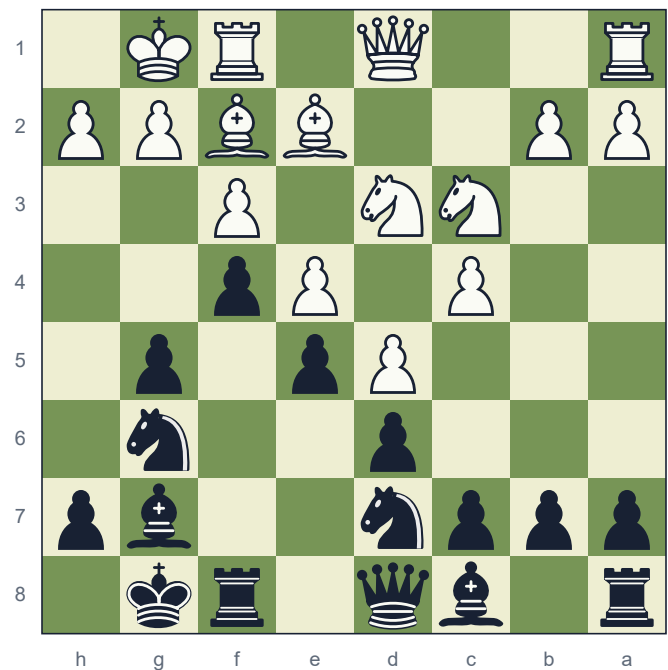
STUDY LINE 03-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. f3 f5 11. Be3 f4 12. Bf2 g5 13. Nd3 Ng6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 13... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...f4 gains space and dislodges Be3. ...g5 supports the advanced pawn; ...Ng6 brings the e7 knight toward the king. These moves make sense because the center is locked.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Coordinate ...Nf6, ...h5 and queen or rook access before sacrificing. White will often play c5, so estimate whether you can tolerate a queenside file opening.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Pawns alone do not mate. If the pieces cannot join, ...g4 may merely open lines against your own king.

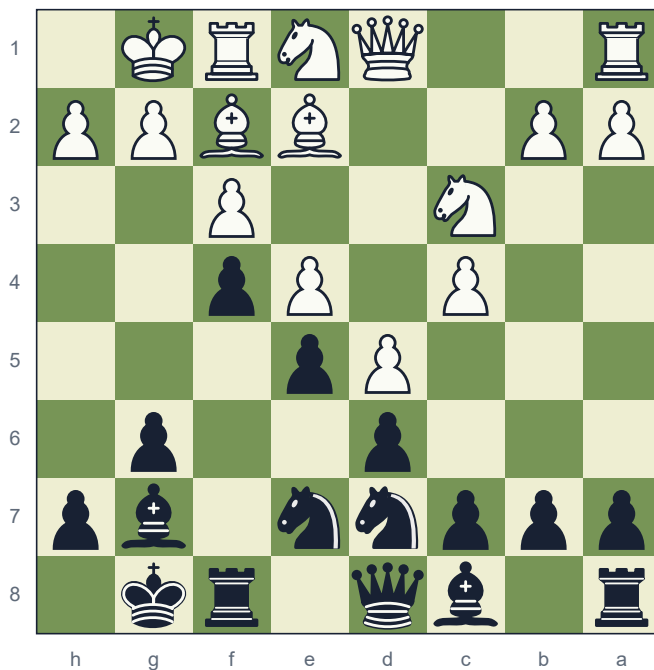
REMEMBER The pawn wave creates entry squares for pieces.

02 Be3 before f3

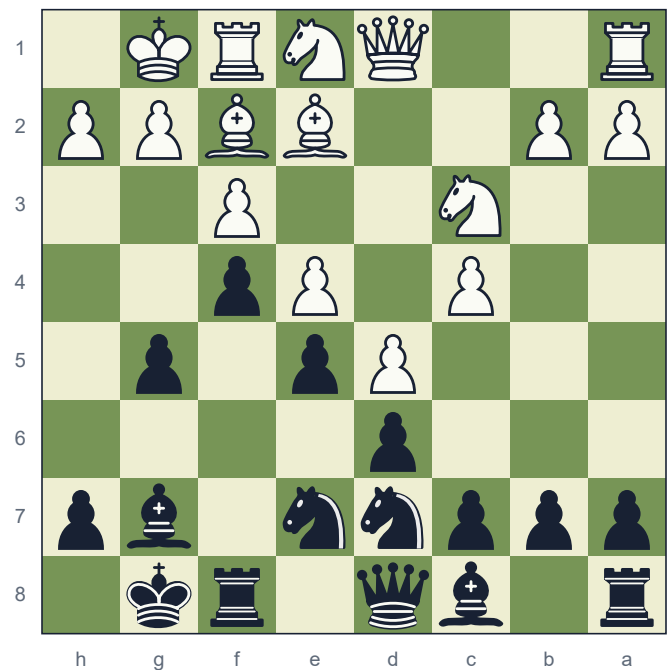
STUDY LINE 03-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. Be3 f5 11. f3 f4 12. Bf2 g5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 12... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White develops the bishop first. Once f3 is played, this reaches the same attacking family as the traditional line.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Bring the e7 knight to g6 and compare White's c5 timing with your own kingside break. Keep d6 defended.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not move by move number alone: the same position can appear through a different order.

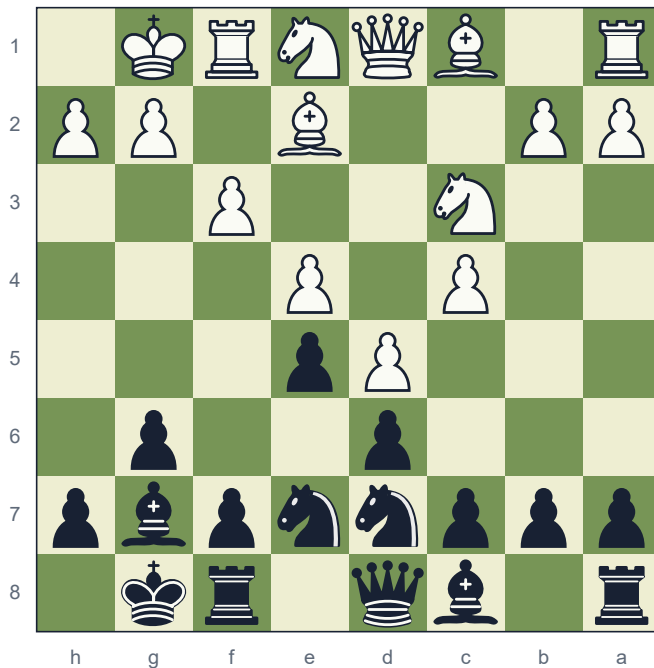
REMEMBER A transposition is the same board, not a similar diagram.

03 White challenges with g4

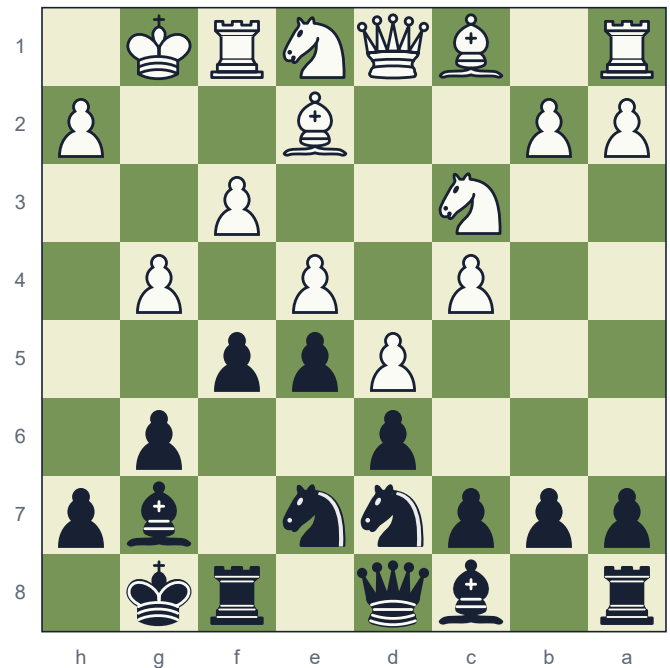
STUDY LINE 03-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. f3 f5 11. g4

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - Black to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White tries to reduce the force of ...f4 and attack the pawn base. The position becomes concrete before the normal attacking formation is complete.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Calculate ...fxg4, ...f4 and central alternatives. Compare the open lines after each capture; the printed continuation is a checked example, not a universal refutation.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A reflex ...f4 can leave your chain easier to undermine. Do not assume White's king must be the less safe one.

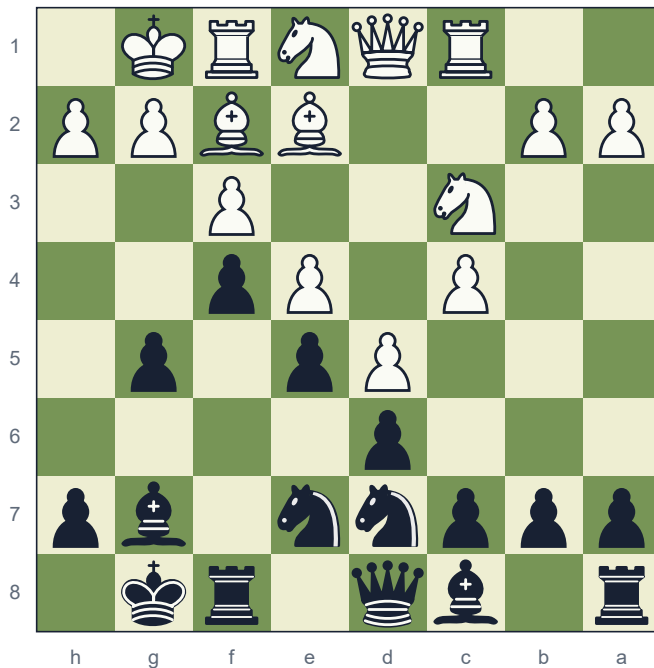
REMEMBER When White breaks the chain, calculate again.

04 White starts c5 quickly

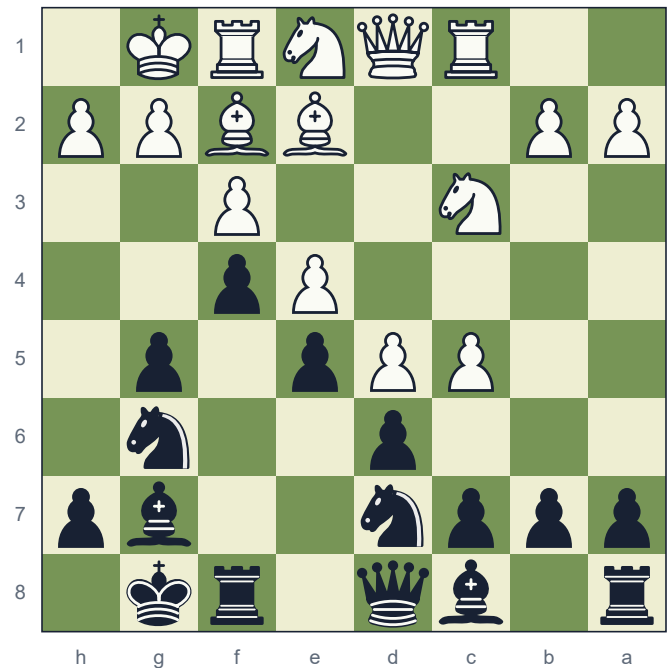
STUDY LINE 03-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Ne1 Nd7 10. f3 f5 11. Be3 f4 12. Bf2 g5 13. Rc1 Ng6 14. c5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 13... - Black to move



End of study line - Black to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Rc1 and c5 begin White's counterplay before Black's pieces finish regrouping. The c-pawn attacks d6 and may open a file.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

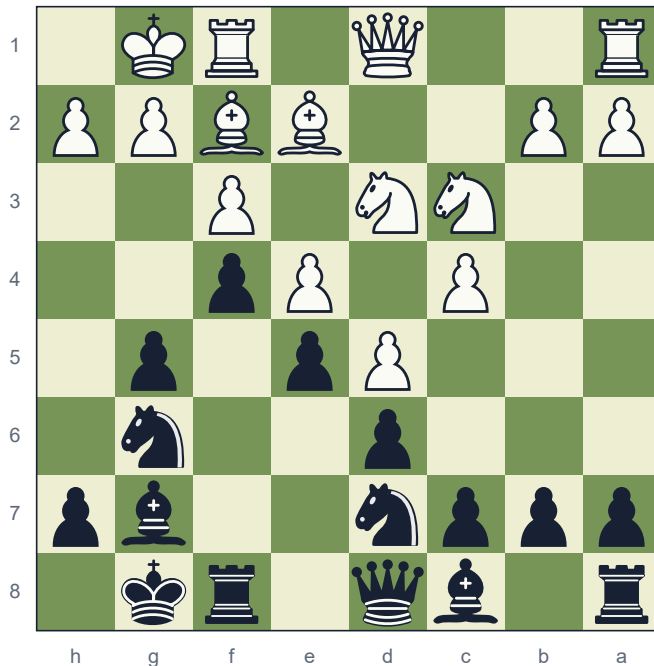
Compare maintaining d6 with exchanging on c5. Continue the attack only if you can survive the forcing queenside replies.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A fixed d6 pawn can become the entry point for an invasion. Do not dismiss checks on the c-file as a side issue.

REMEMBER Counterplay on the other wing is part of your calculation.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White has d5 and e4 against d6 and e5. After ...f4 the center and kingside gain a second chain, giving Black space but fixing targets.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Coordinate ...Nf6, ...h5 and queen or rook access before sacrificing. White will often play c5, so estimate whether you can tolerate a queenside file opening.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

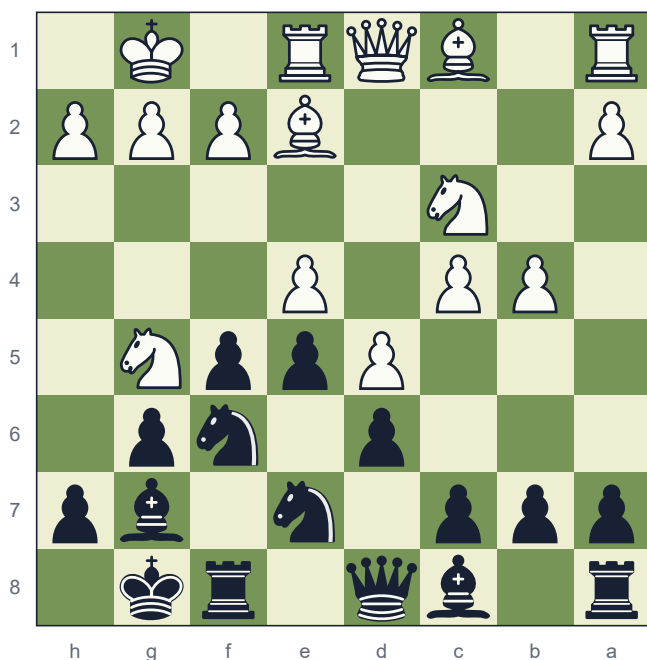
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Bayonet Attack - meet 9.b4 with ...Nh5

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...Nh5 to make room for ...f5 while pressuring f4. The Bayonet is a critical positional and tactical test, not a harmless early pawn move.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White gains queenside space with b4 and threatens c5. The e4 pawn can become tactically vulnerable after the knight reaches f4.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Keep the f4 outpost in sight.
2. Check e4 after every exchange.
3. Do not attack faster by ignoring c5.

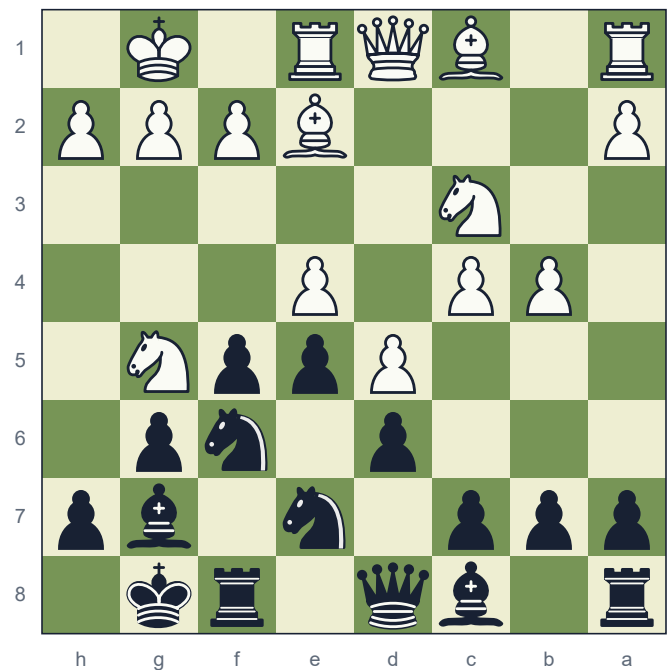
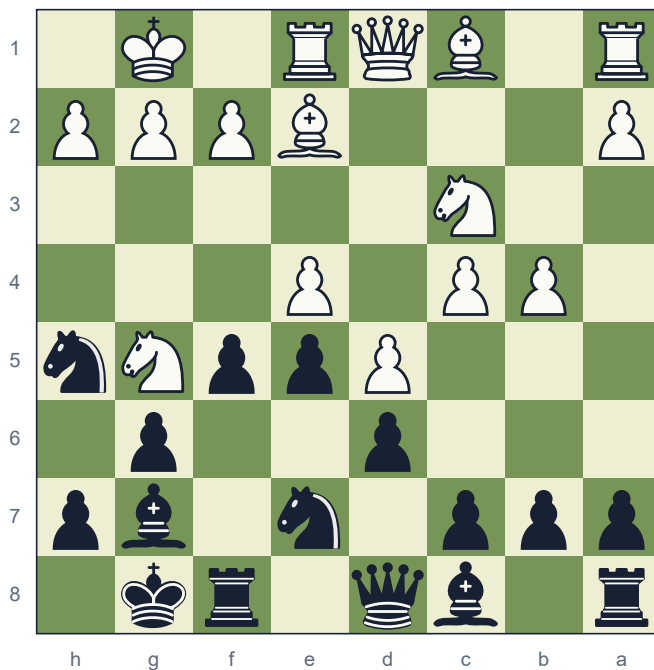
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Re1: the main development

STUDY LINE 04-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. Re1 f5 11. Ng5 Nf6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

Re1 supports e4. Ng5 adds pressure to e6 and h7, so Black returns the knight to f6 while keeping the f-pawn advanced.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...h6 only if it improves the tactical position, and consider ...a5 to question b4. White may trade on e6 or advance c5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The knight on h5 is not obliged to stay there. A retreat can complete the pawn break and improve coordination.

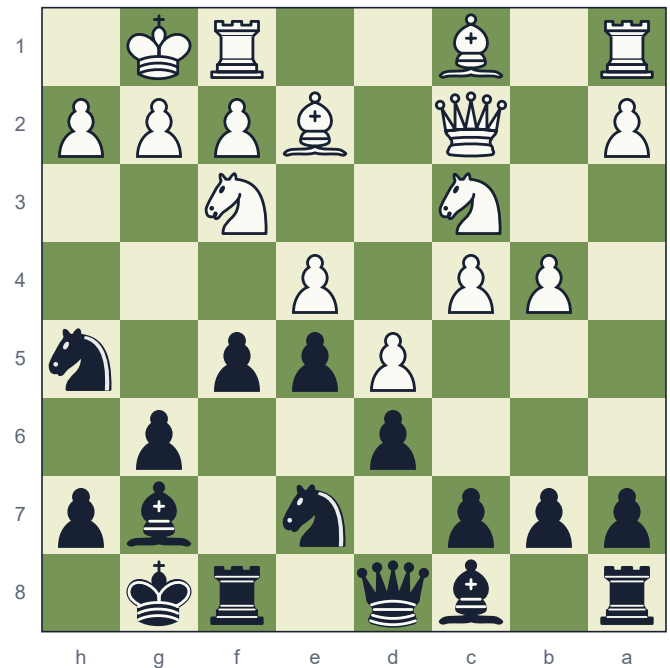
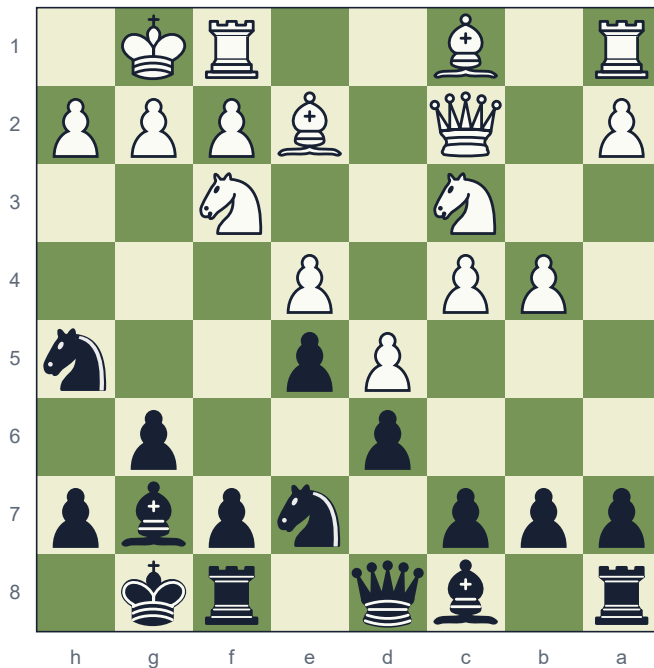
REMEMBER A retreat after ...f5 can be productive.

02 Qc2 instead of Re1

STUDY LINE 04-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. Qc2 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

Qc2 defends e4 and eyes the queenside. ...f5 immediately challenges that center and opens a route for the f8 rook if exchanges occur.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Watch for exf5 and c5. Choose recaptures by development and king safety, not by a desire to preserve the same pawn picture.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Qc2 and Re1 defend e4 in different ways; a combination from one line may fail in the other.

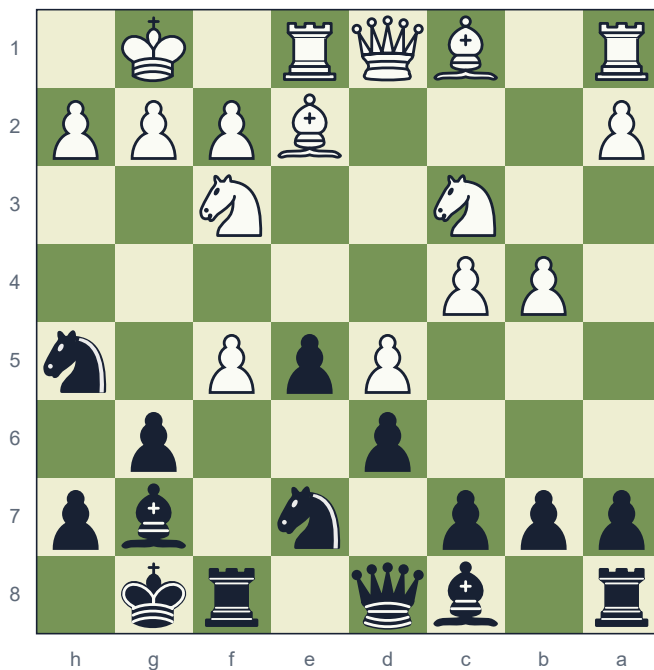
REMEMBER Identify the actual defender of e4.

03 exf5: the central ...e4 intermezzo

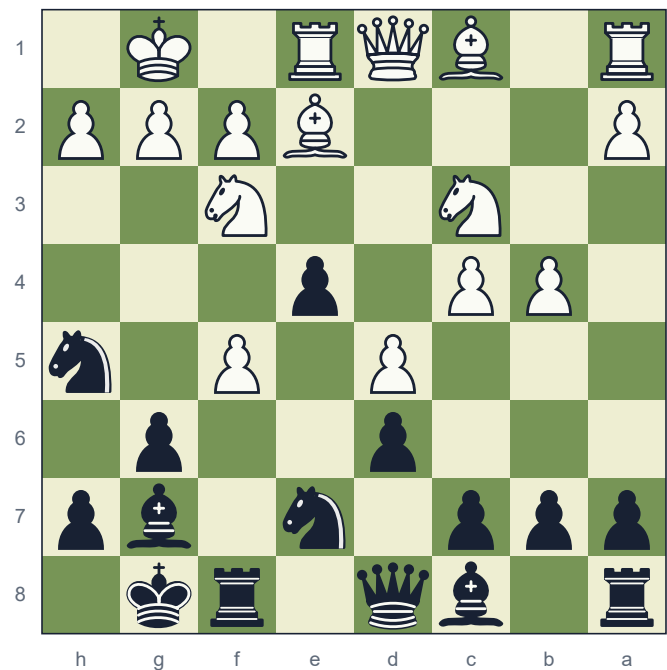
STUDY LINE 04-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. Re1 f5
11. exf5 e4

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 11... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Instead of recapturing automatically, ...e4 attacks Nf3 and clears the g7 bishop's diagonal toward Nc3. White must meet the combined threats.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Calculate the knight moves and Bxc3 ideas before recovering the f5 pawn. The checked continuation illustrates how central activity takes priority over a recapture.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Immediate ...gxf5 misses this tactical opportunity. The rook on e1, knight on c3 and bishop on g7 are all relevant.

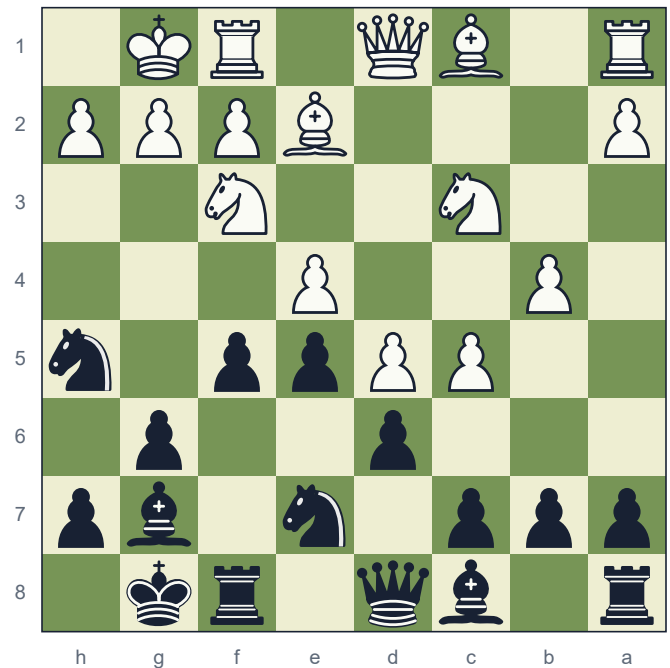
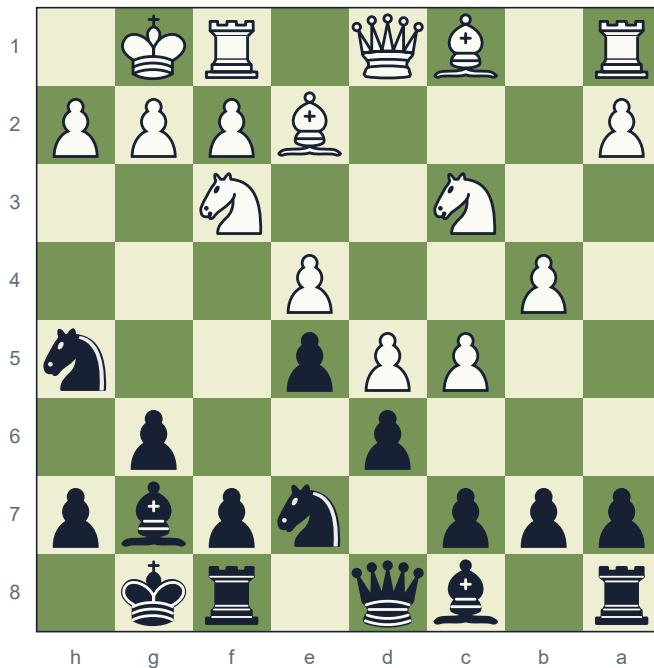
REMEMBER Before recapturing, look for a forcing intermediate move.

04 White pushes c5 immediately

STUDY LINE 04-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 Nh5 10. c5 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

White attacks d6 immediately, while ...f5 challenges e4. Both central pawn contacts must be calculated before either side follows a wing plan.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

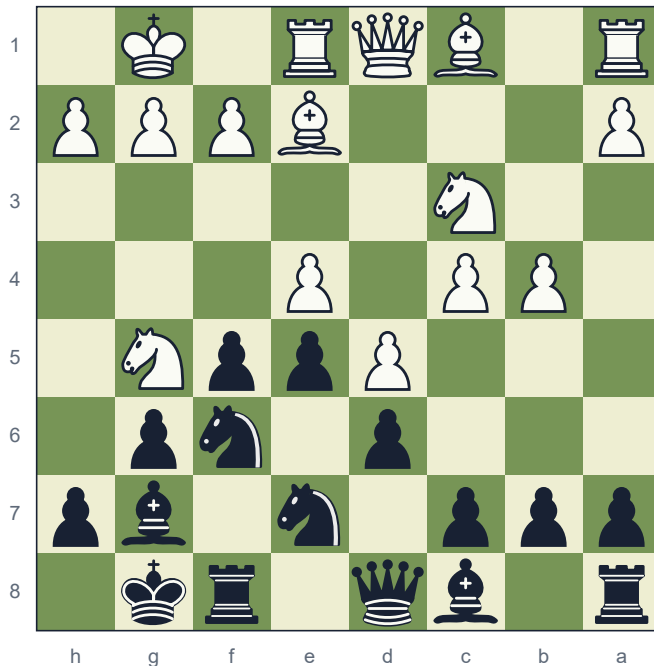
Compare cxd6, exf5 and captures in the center. Keep track of the g7 bishop when the e5 pawn moves.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A pawn chain can open in one move. Do not evaluate this as the quiet starting position of the Mar del Plata.

REMEMBER Two pawn contacts mean two tactical questions.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White gains queenside space with b4 and threatens c5. The e4 pawn can become tactically vulnerable after the knight reaches f4.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop ...h6 only if it improves the tactical position, and consider ...a5 to question b4. White may trade on e6 or advance c5.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

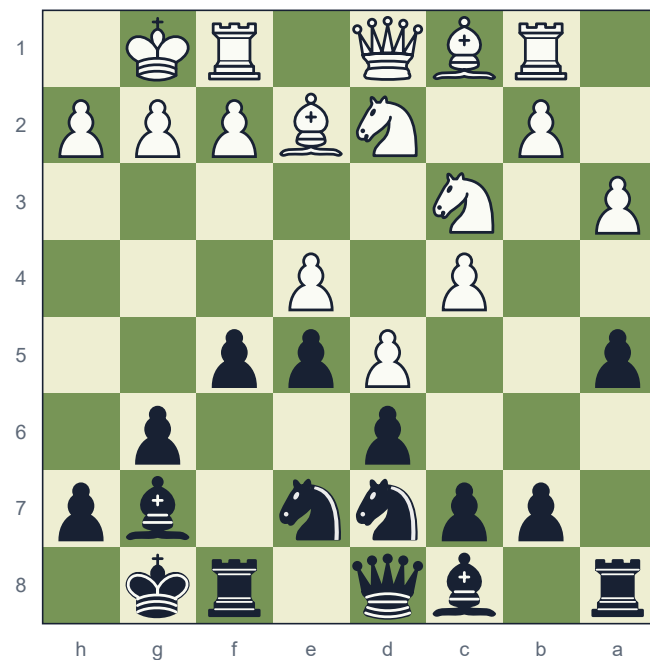
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Other ninth moves in the closed Classical

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Keep ...Nd7 and ...f5 as the main framework, but adjust to Nd2, Bd2, a4 and b3. The defender of e4 and the speed of c5 determine the details.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The locked d5/e4 versus d6/e5 center remains, but White's pieces may be prepared for defense or immediate queenside action.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Look for the role of the d2 square.
2. Do not let a maneuver lose e5.
3. Compare the speed of White's plan with 9.Ne1.

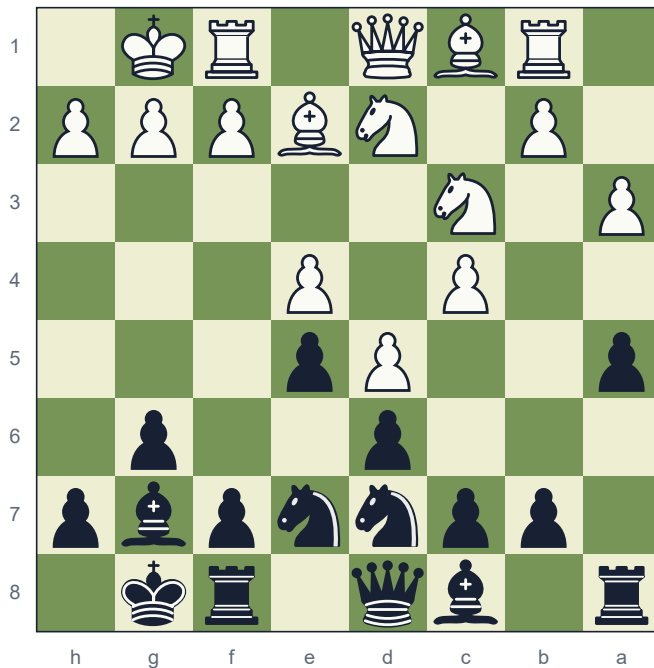
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 9.Nd2: the modern system

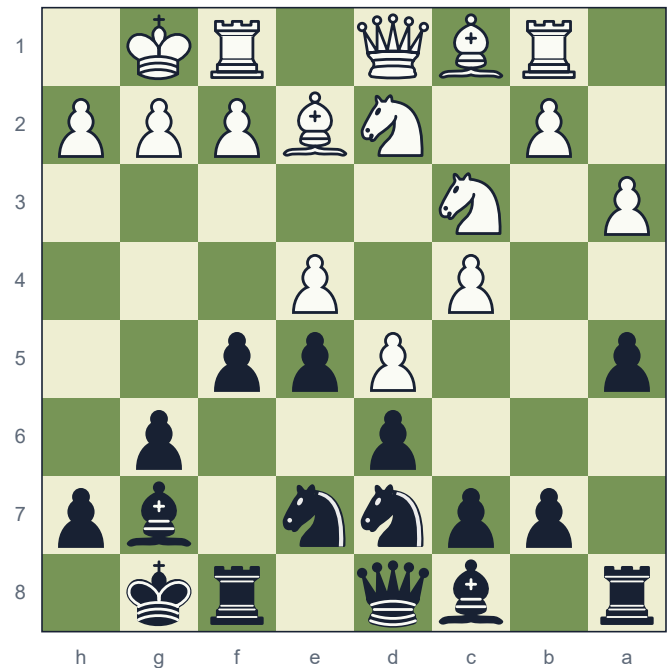
STUDY LINE 05-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Nd2 a5 10. a3 Nd7 11. Rb1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 11... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...a5 makes b4 harder. The f6 knight vacates for ...f5 only after White has spent time arranging the queenside.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...Nf6 or ...Nc5 according to the exchanges. White may use b4 anyway, or jump to c4 to target d6.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Nd2 may support c4 or allow f3 later. Avoid weakening b6 and d6 without compensation.

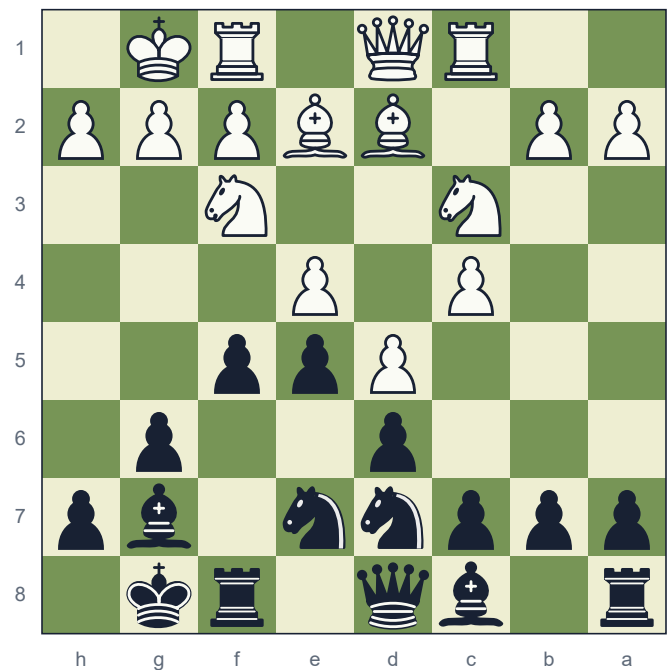
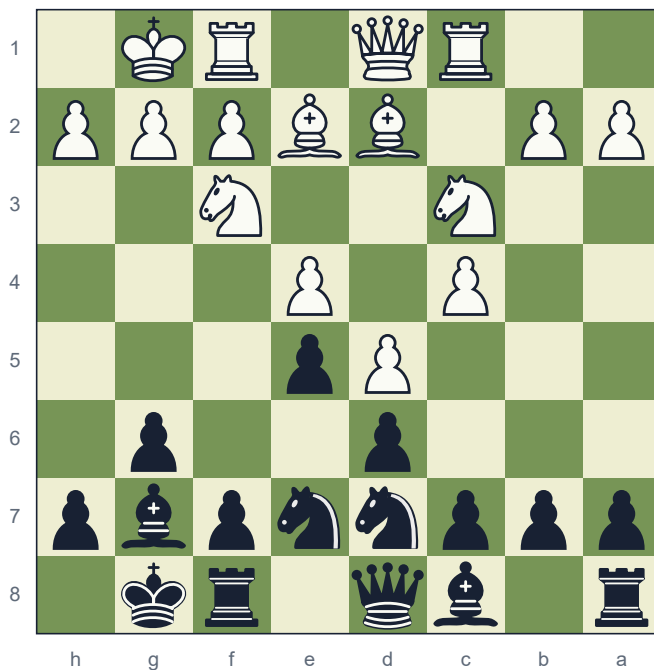
REMEMBER Restrain one break while preparing your own.

02 9.Bd2: flexible development

STUDY LINE 05-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. Bd2 Nd7 10. Rc1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

Bd2 connects White's development and Rc1 points at the queenside. Black clears f6 and contests e4.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Check whether ...f4 gains a useful tempo. If the bishop stays on d2, that tempo is absent and maintaining tension can matter.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The familiar ...f4 attack on Be3 does not exist when the bishop is on d2.

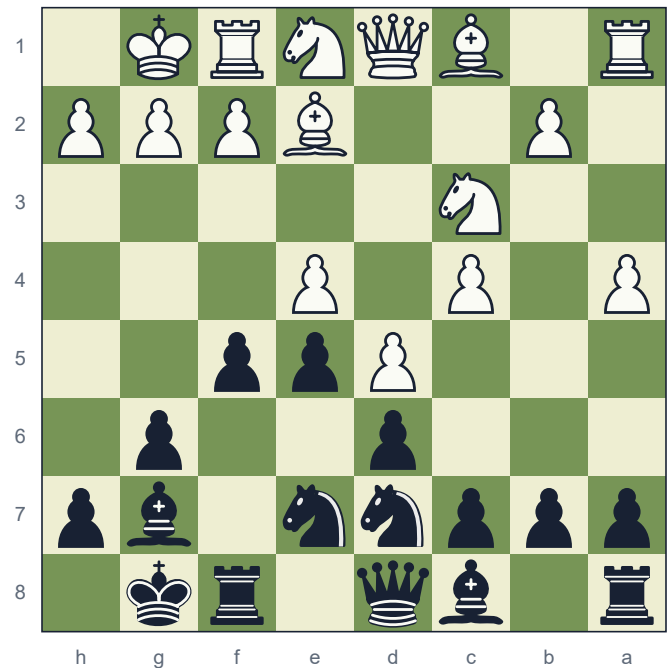
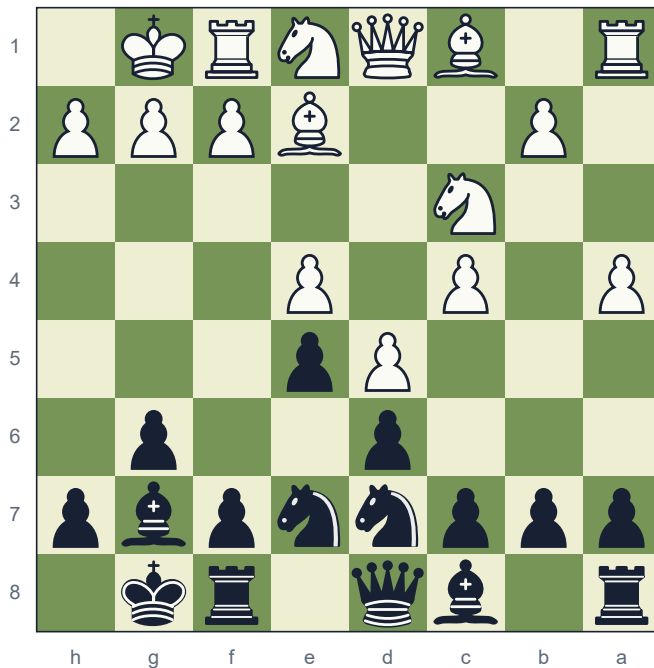
REMEMBER A pawn advance is better when it attacks something.

03 9.a4: White gains space

STUDY LINE 05-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. a4 Nd7 10. Ne1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

a4 restrains ...b5 but spends a move away from e4. Black follows the central break while remaining alert to a5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

After the center stabilizes, coordinate the kingside pieces. White has less direct b4 expansion but more a-file space.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not answer every flank pawn with a flank pawn; use the time to complete a meaningful plan.

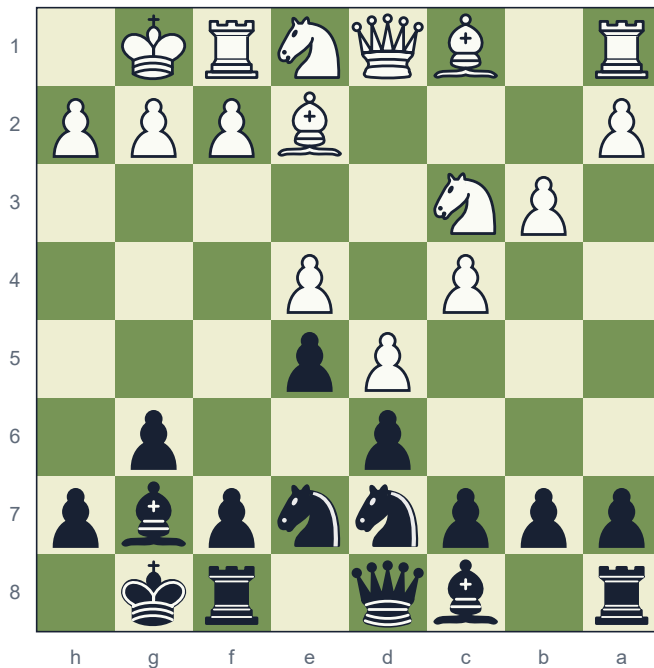
REMEMBER Space costs time; use the time purposefully.

04 9.b3: a queenside fianchetto

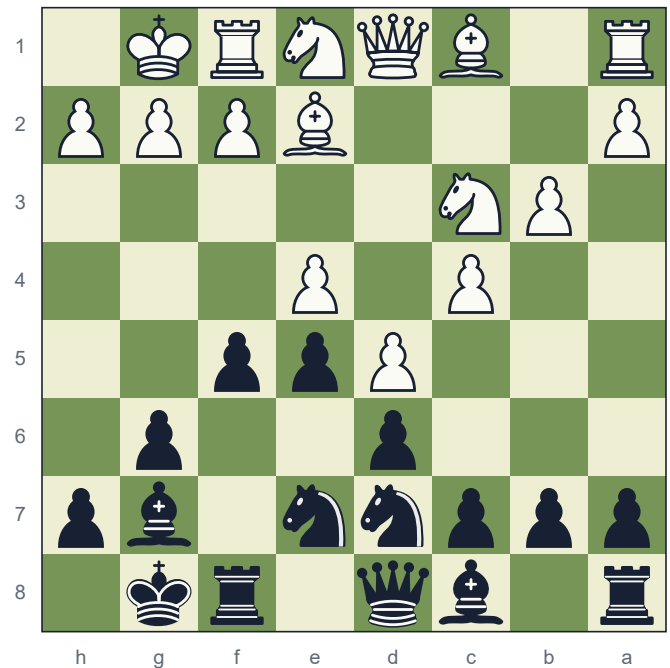
STUDY LINE 05-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b3 Nd7 10. Ne1 f5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

b3 prepares Bb2 and supports c4. Black develops the same pawn break against the strong center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

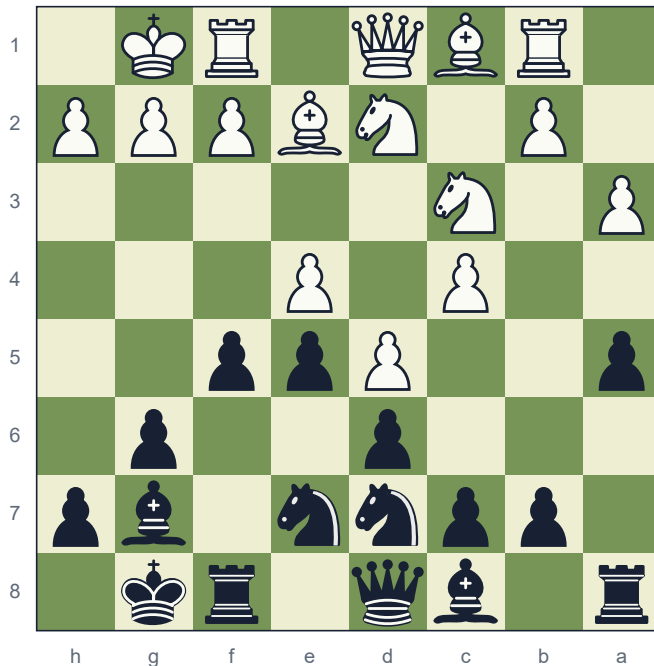
Assess the b2 bishop's diagonal when the center opens. Pressure on e4 may change after White advances c5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The long diagonal can become active suddenly after pawn exchanges. Count discovered attacks on g7.

REMEMBER A blocked bishop is not permanently inactive.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The locked d5/e4 versus d6/e5 center remains, but White's pieces may be prepared for defense or immediate queenside action.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Prepare ...Nf6 or ...Nc5 according to the exchanges. White may use b4 anyway, or jump to c4 to target d6.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

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PRACTICE

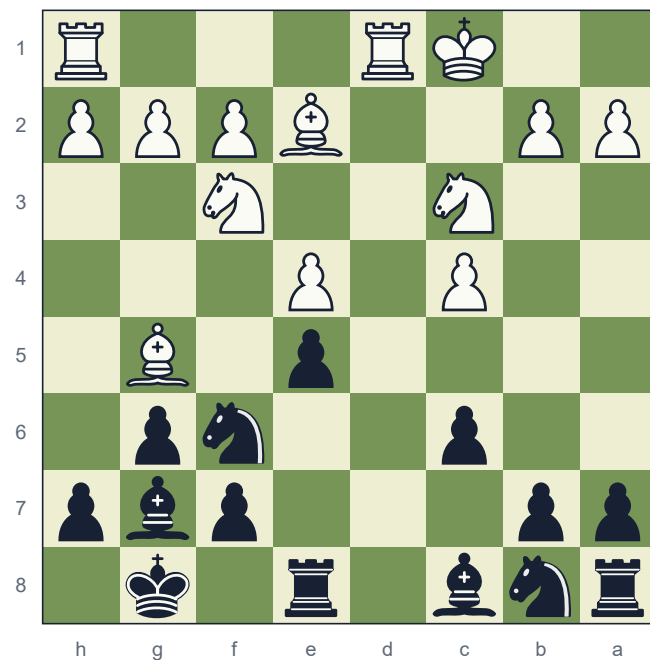
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Exchange Variation - play the queenless middlegame

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Recapture with the d-pawn. If White exchanges queens, activate the rook and contest d4. Do not measure success by whether you get a kingside attack.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The d-file opens, with White's e4 pawn facing Black's pawn on e5. Open files and minor-piece squares matter more than opposite-wing races.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Activate a rook on the open file.
2. Protect e5 before chasing a bishop.
3. Trade only when the resulting minor-piece position improves.

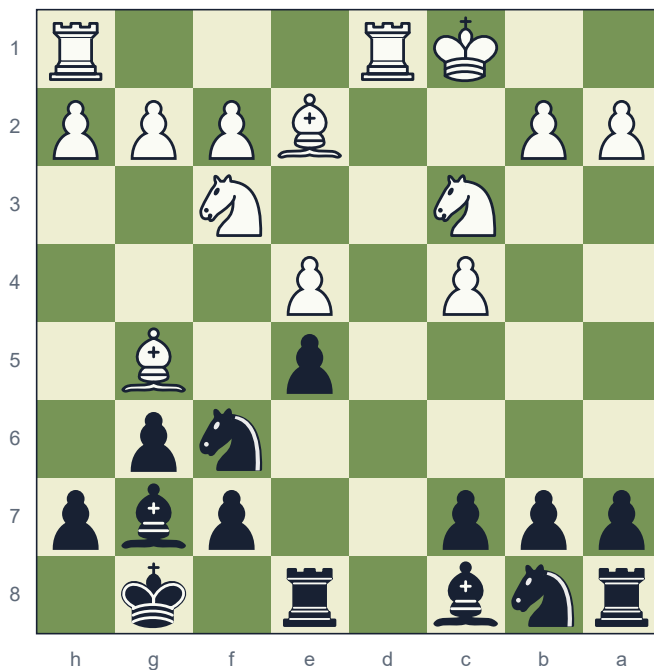
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Queens off and Bg5

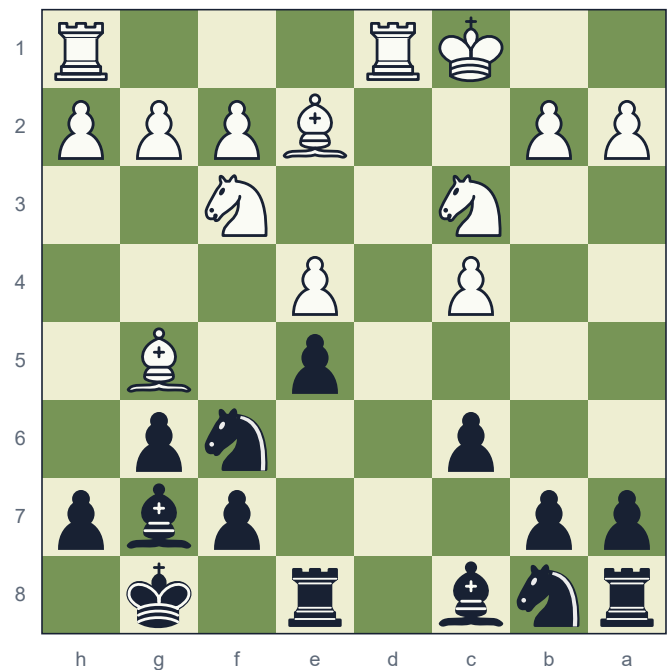
STUDY LINE 06-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8 9. Bg5 Re8 10. O-O-O c6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The rook recaptures on d8. Bg5 and long castling increase White's pressure, so ...Re8 supports e5 and ...c6 controls d5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the b8 knight and the c8 bishop, then challenge the d-file. Watch for a knight reaching d5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The lack of queens does not remove tactics. Pins and rook invasions still win material.

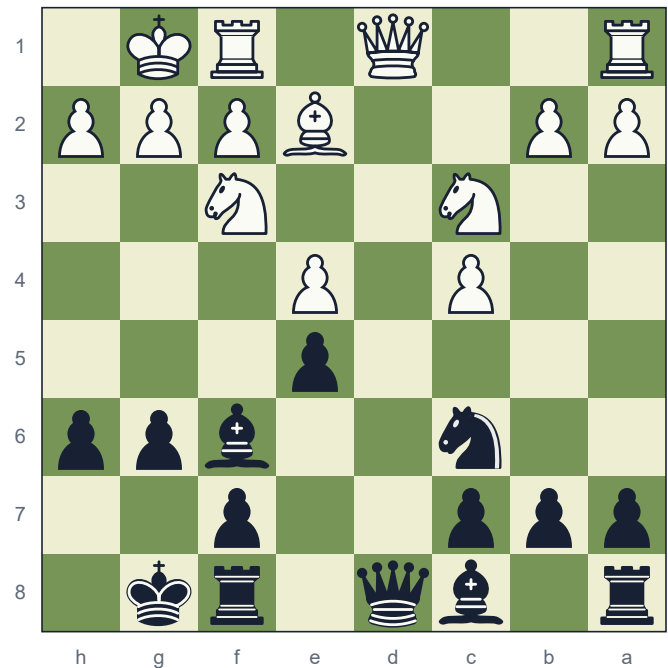
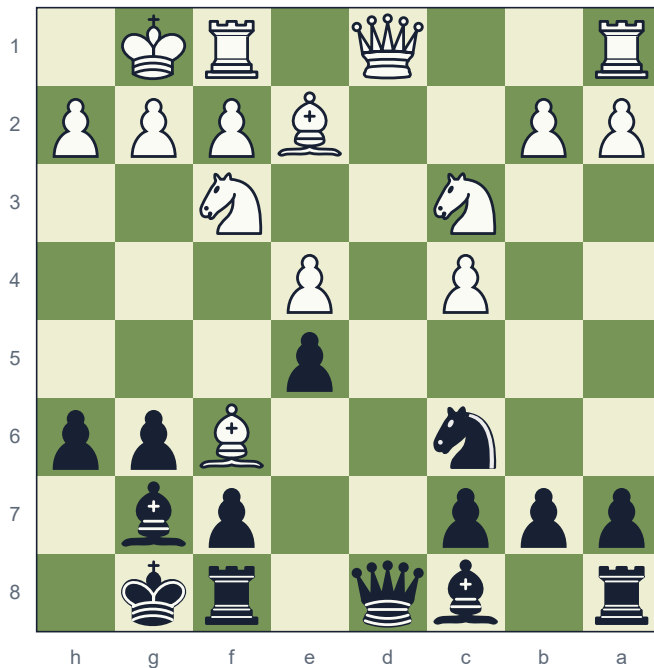
REMEMBER King safety improves, but calculation remains necessary.

02 White develops without trading queens

STUDY LINE 06-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. O-O Nc6 9. Bg5 h6 10. Bxf6 Bxf6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

White gives up the bishop to change your minor-piece balance. Recapturing with the bishop retains healthy pawns and a bishop pair.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Complete development and contest d4. Preserve the bishops when they have useful open diagonals.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not assume a bishop pair is automatically better; compare the knights' entry squares.

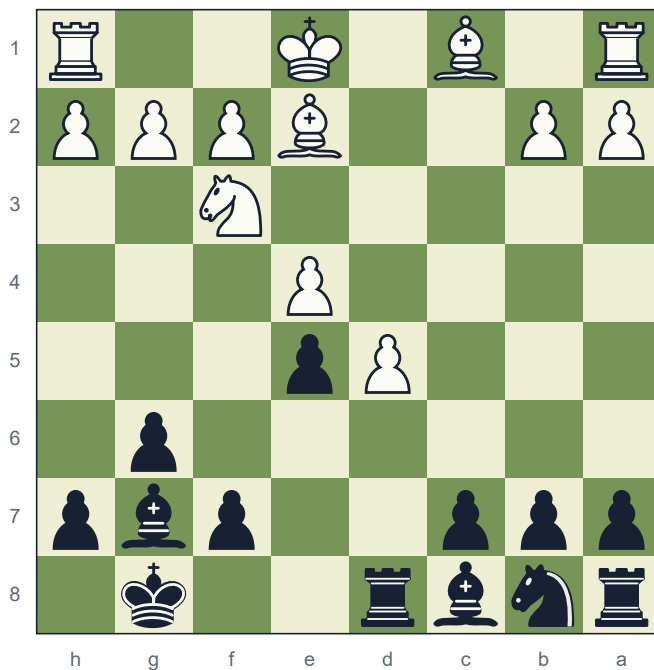
REMEMBER Keep the structure and activate the pair.

03 Nd5 after the queen trade

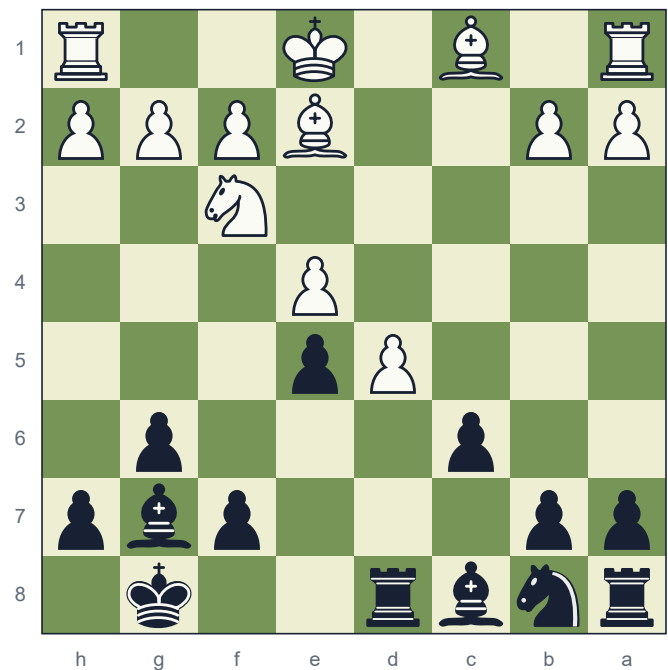
STUDY LINE 06-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8 9. Nd5 Nxd5
10. cxd5 c6

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White exchanges a knight to create a pawn on d5. ...c6 challenges that new wedge before it becomes a permanent cramp.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

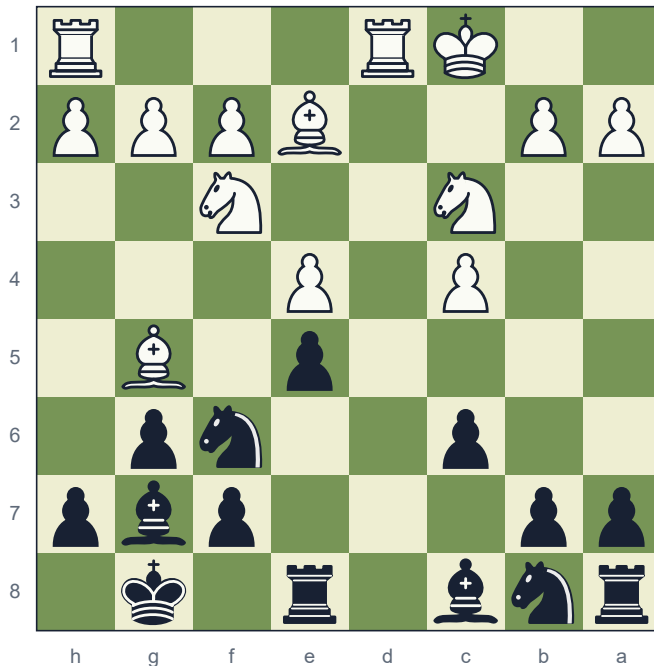
Evaluate dxc6 and ...cxd5 concretely. Use the open files and the g7 bishop as the structure changes.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Recaptures can create a passed pawn or expose a rook. Follow the entire exchange sequence.

REMEMBER Challenge a new wedge at its base.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The d-file opens, with White's e4 pawn facing Black's pawn on e5. Open files and minor-piece squares matter more than opposite-wing races.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop the b8 knight and the c8 bishop, then challenge the d-file. Watch for a knight reaching d5.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

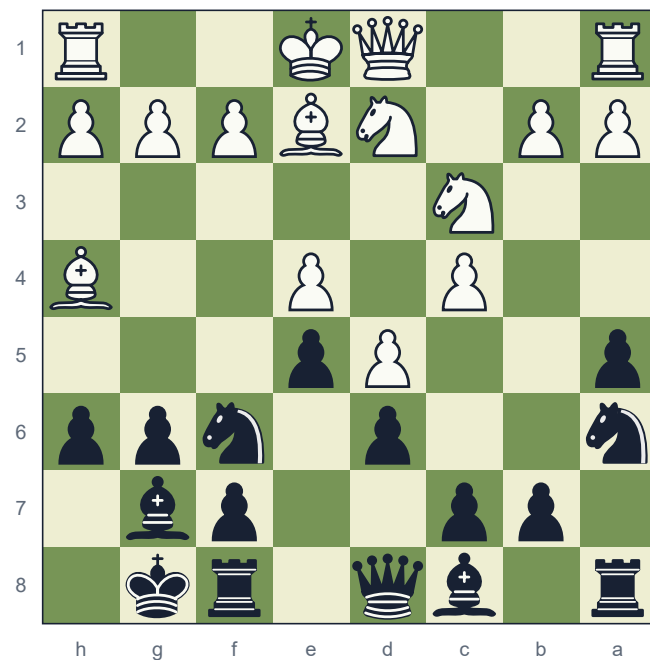
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Petrosian Variation - 7.d5 before castling

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. Bg5 h6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...a5 to restrain b4 before developing the b8 knight. White has closed the center without committing the king, so your kingside plan must stay flexible.



Main study anchor - Black to move

READ THE CENTER

The locked center resembles the Classical, but Black has not put the b8 knight on c6 and White can still choose Bg5, Be3 or h3.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Keep the b8 knight flexible.
2. Ask whether White has committed the king.
3. Treat Bg5 as a real restraint on ...f5.

Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Bg5 and queenside development

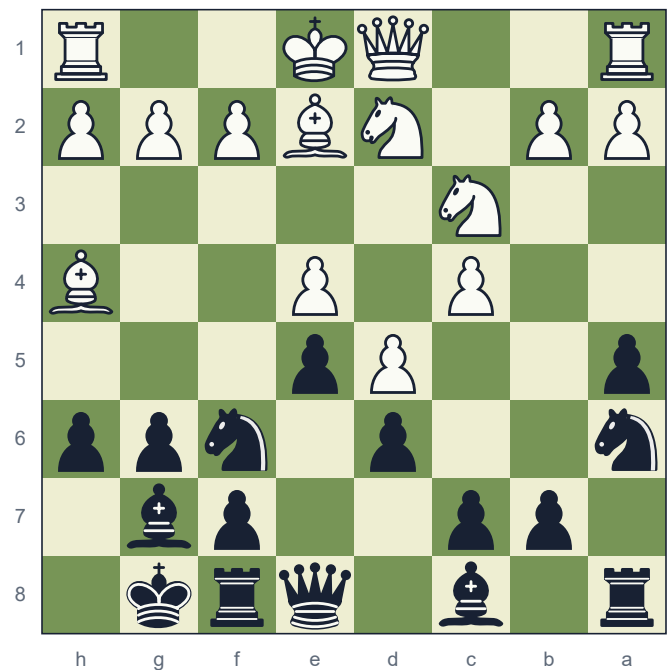
STUDY LINE 07-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 Na6 10. Nd2 Qe8

Selected anchor ends with 10. Nd2. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...a5 restrains b4; ...Na6 offers c5 without blocking the c-pawn. ...h6 asks the bishop to declare its square.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Support ...Nc5 and consider ...Qe8 or ...Bd7 before forcing kingside expansion. Resolve the pin when it actually matters.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A quick ...g5 may give White h4 with an immediate target. Do not weaken the king just to imitate another line.

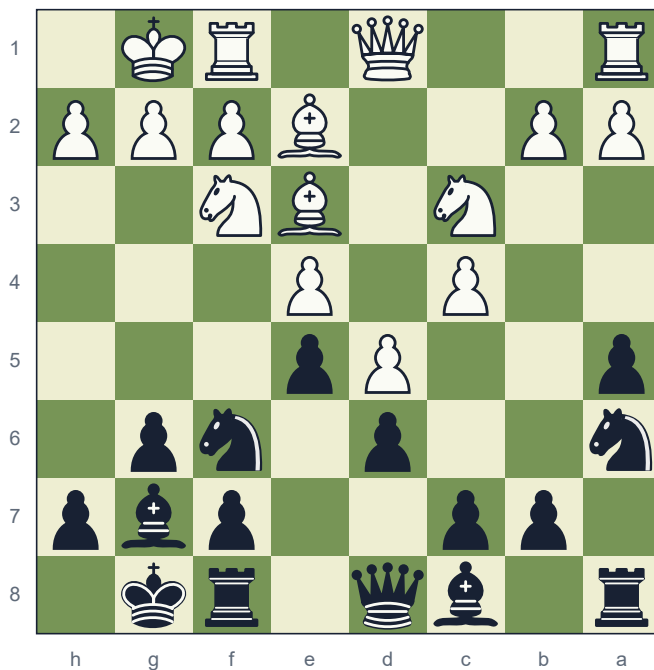
REMEMBER Flexibility comes from the knight and c-pawn.

02 White castles quietly

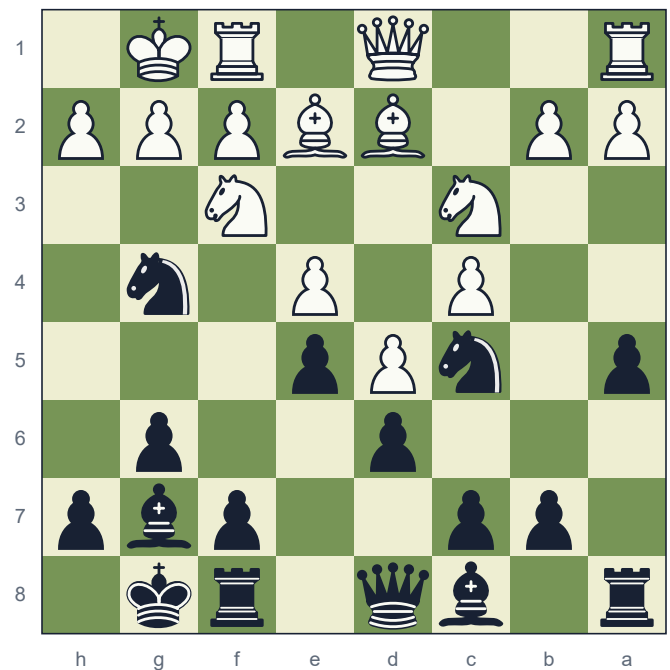
STUDY LINE 07-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. O-O Na6 9. Be3 Ng4 10. Bd2 Nc5

Selected anchor ends with 10. Bd2. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White's castling clarifies the king position. ...Ng4 questions Be3 while Na6 prepares a queenside route.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Choose ...f5 only after relocating the knight and securing e5. White still threatens queenside expansion.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Moving the same knight repeatedly must earn a concrete benefit, such as gaining the bishop pair or arranging a break.

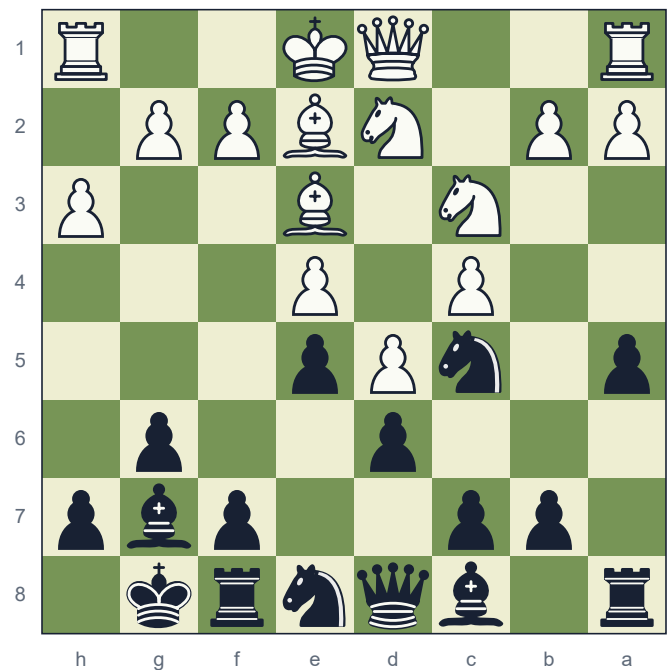
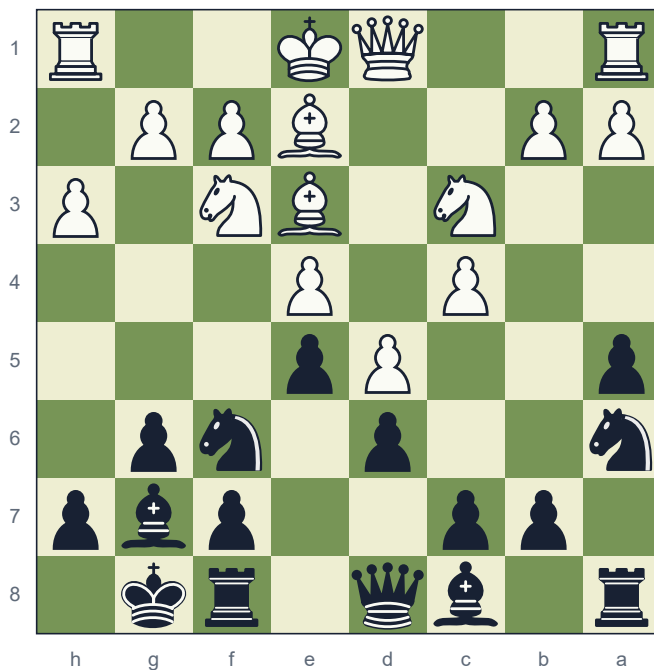
REMEMBER A tempo on a bishop can improve the whole setup.

03 White prevents the pin with h3

STUDY LINE 07-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. d5 a5 8. h3 Na6 9. Be3 Nc5 10. Nd2 Ne8

Selected anchor ends with 10. Nd2. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

h3 prevents ...Bg4 and restricts ...Ng4. Black seeks activity with ...Na6-c5 instead.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...Ne8 and ...f5 if the center and king safety permit; first decide how to meet a3 and b4 against the c5 knight.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A knight on c5 can be chased. Make sure retreat squares remain and e5 stays defended.

REMEMBER A good outpost still needs a retreat plan.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The locked center resembles the Classical, but Black has not put the b8 knight on c6 and White can still choose Bg5, Be3 or h3.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Support ...Nc5 and consider ...Qe8 or ...Bd7 before forcing kingside expansion. Resolve the pin when it actually matters.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

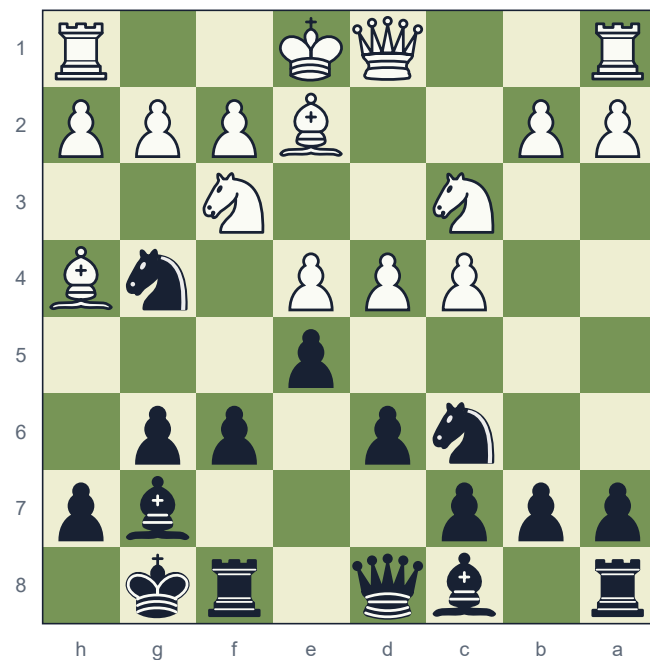
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Gligoric System - 7.Be3 before castling

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. Bg5 f6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...Ng4 to question the bishop before White gets an ideal flexible setup. Track White's choice of Bg5, Bc1, or a central exchange.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The center is still fluid. The f6 knight can attack e3, but moving it changes the defense of d5 and e4 tactics.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Find the attacked bishop.
2. Do not confuse a threat with a free capture.
3. Keep ...f5 subordinate to the center.

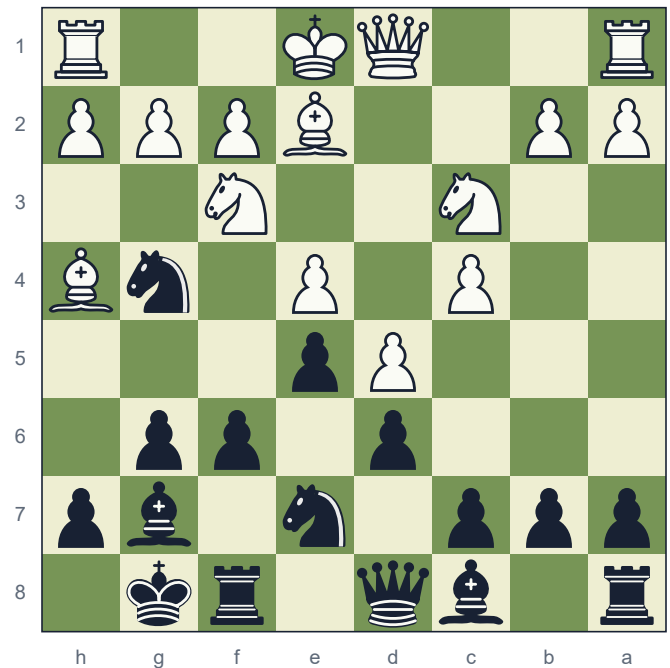
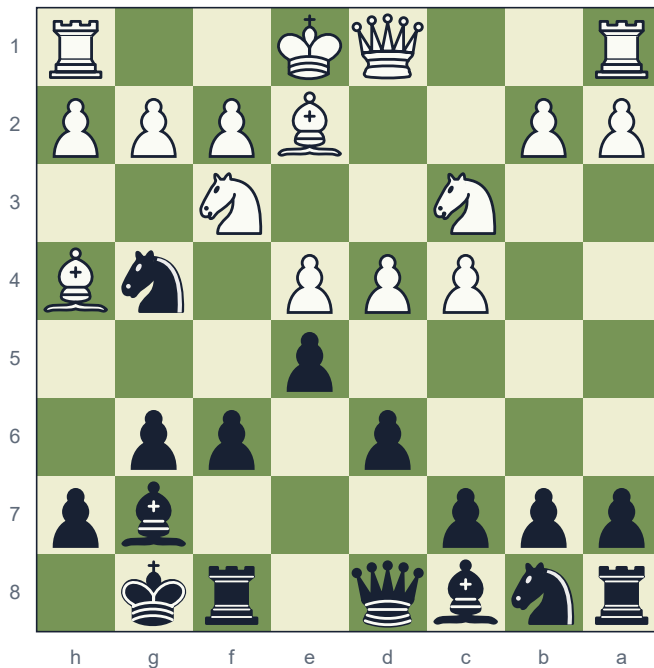
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Bg5 pins the queen line

STUDY LINE 08-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. Bg5 f6 9. Bh4 Nc6 10. d5 Ne7

Selected anchor ends with 9... Nc6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Bg5 creates pressure along the diagonal toward d8. ...f6 blocks that diagonal and asks the bishop to move.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

After development, compare d5 and central exchanges. The f-pawn is now on f6, so a later ...f5 takes another move.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The pawn on f6 can weaken dark squares. Keep the g7 bishop and king coordinated.

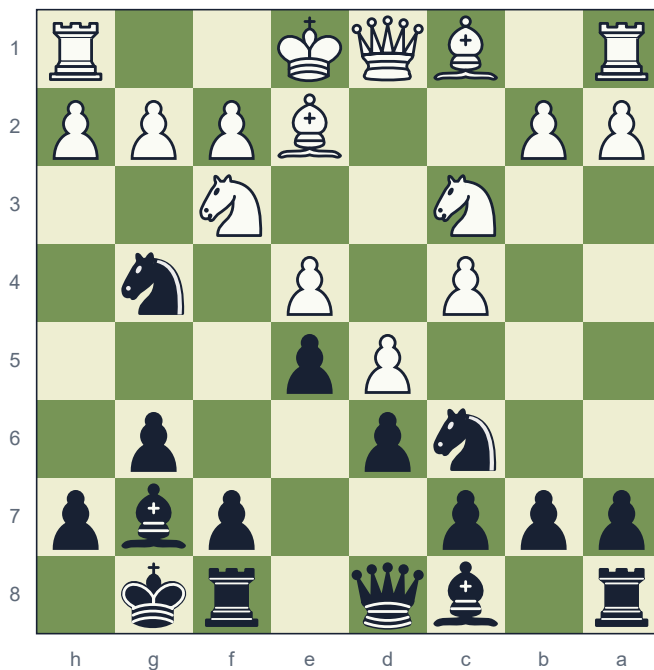
REMEMBER A defensive pawn move changes your attacking timetable.

02 White retreats to c1

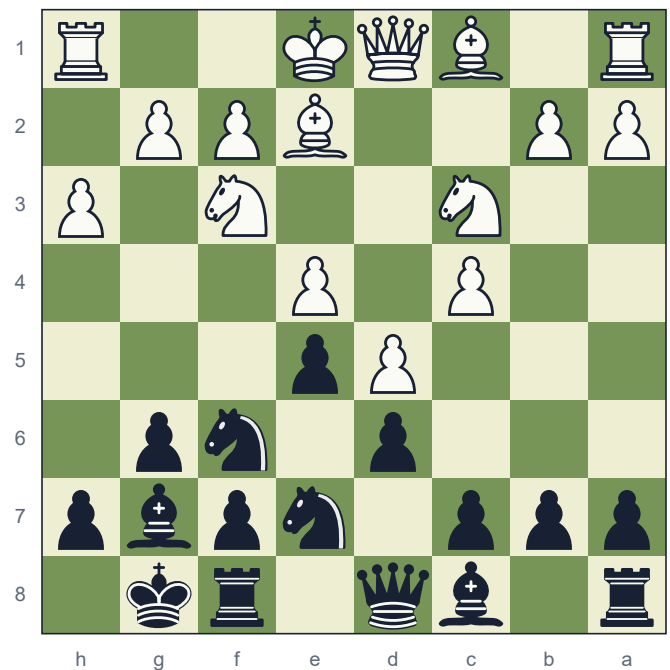
STUDY LINE 08-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. Bc1 Nc6 9. d5 Ne7 10. h3 Nf6

Selected anchor ends with 9... Ne7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black gains development while the bishop returns home. The center can then lock with a different knight placement from the standard Classical.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Return the g4 knight to f6 or seek a useful route; avoid leaving it exposed to h3 and f3.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A developed knight is not automatically well placed. It can become a target after the bishop retreats.

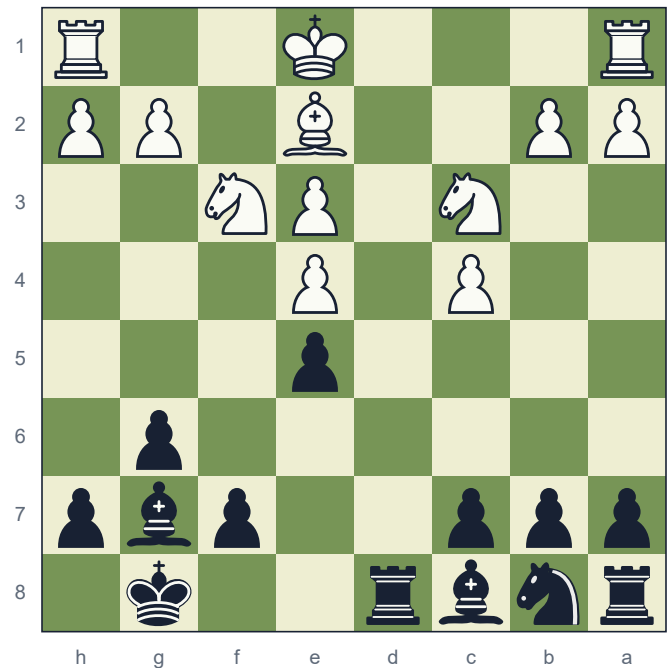
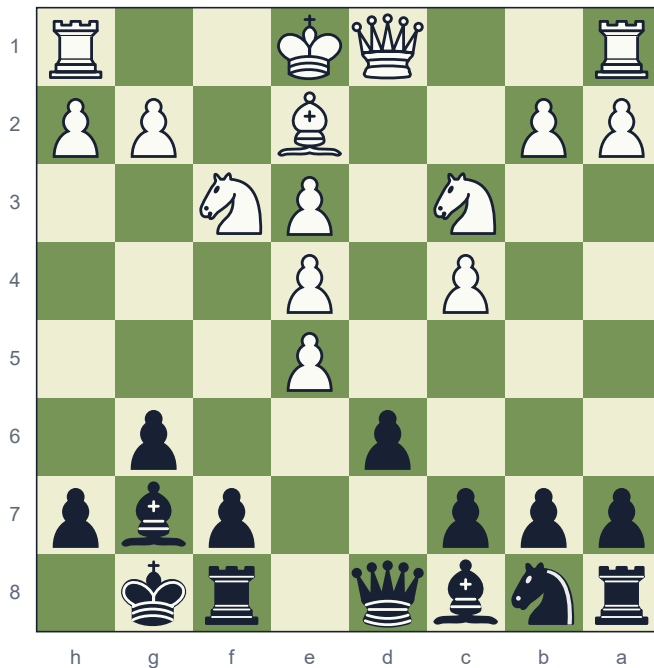
REMEMBER Use the gained tempo to improve coordination.

03 White exchanges the center

STUDY LINE 08-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. Be3 Ng4 8. dxe5 Nxe3 9. fxe3 dxe5 10. Qxd8 Rxd8

Selected anchor ends with 9... dxe5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Black trades the g4 knight for the e3 bishop. White's f-pawn recapture changes the structure and opens the f-file.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

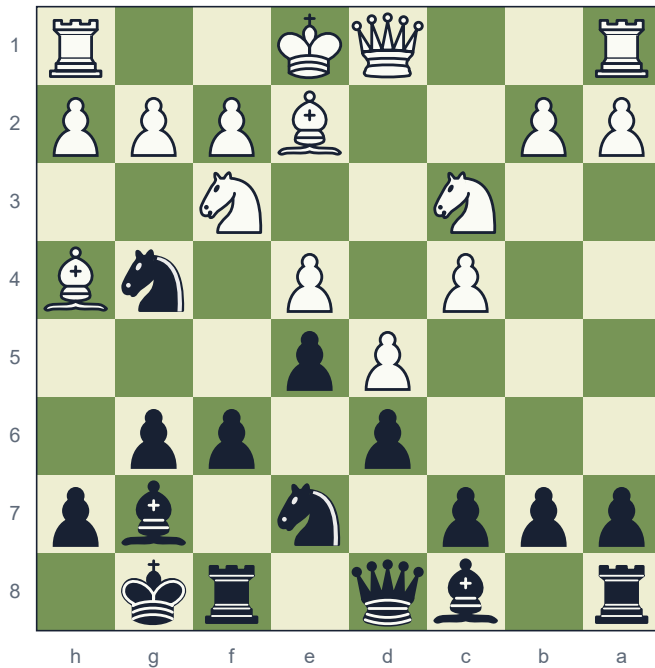
Develop the queenside and put pressure on e4 and e3. White may use the open f-file, so do not neglect defense.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Doubled pawns are not an immediate win. White has central control and rook activity as compensation.

REMEMBER A structural concession always has a practical price.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The center is still fluid. The f6 knight can attack e3, but moving it changes the defense of d5 and e4 tactics.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

After development, compare d5 and central exchanges. The f-pawn is now on f6, so a later ...f5 takes another move.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

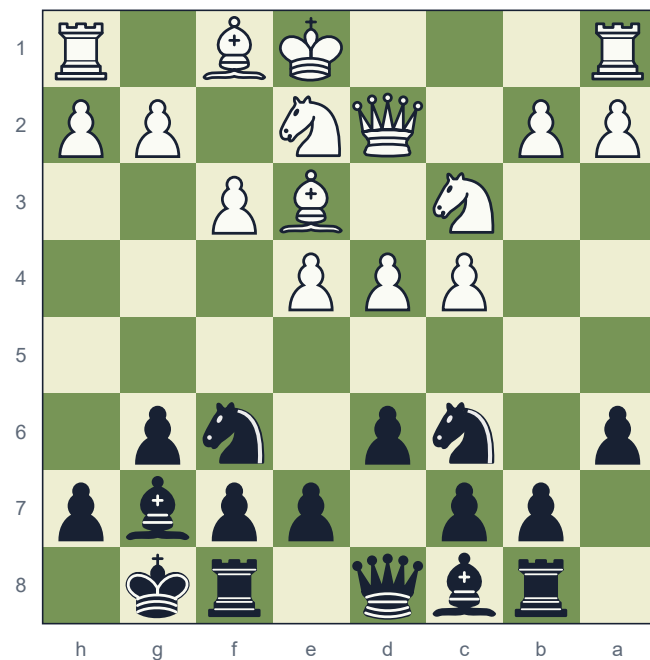
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Samisch - the Panno main repertoire

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. Nge2 a6 8. Qd2 Rb8

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...Nc6, ...a6 and ...Rb8 against the main Be3/Nge2 setup. The goal is active queenside and central counterplay; it is not the Classical kingside pawn storm.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White supports e4 with f3 and often leaves the king flexible. Black's c-pawn remains free, and the c6 knight pressures d4.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Find where White intends to castle.
2. After d5, move the attacked c6 knight.
3. Prepare ...b5; do not offer it without calculation.

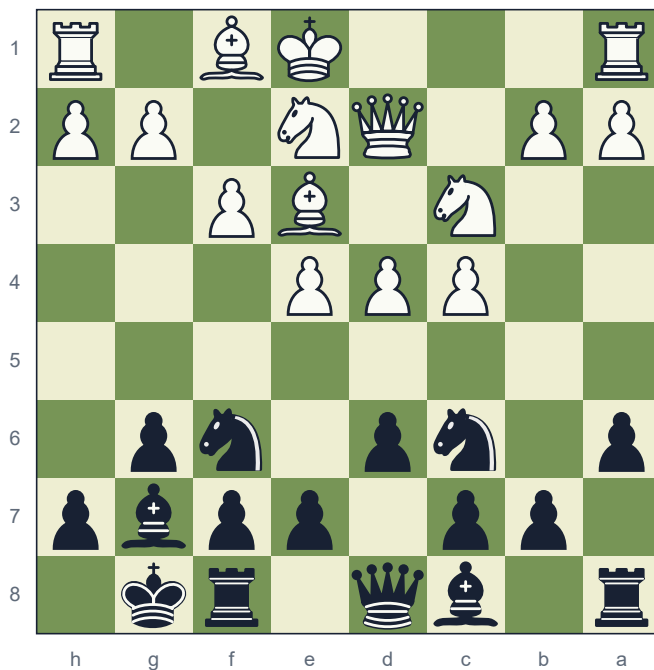
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main Panno: Nge2 and Qd2

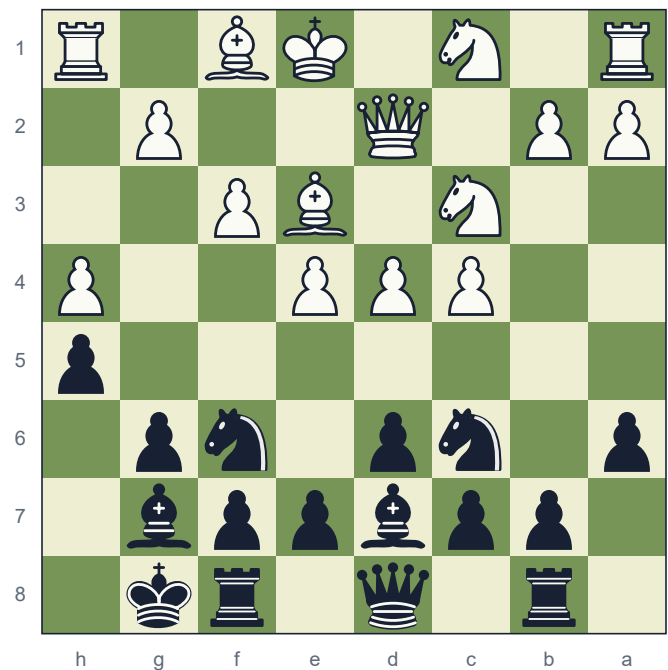
STUDY LINE 09-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. Nge2 a6 8. Qd2 Rb8 9. h4 h5 10. Nc1 Bd7

Selected anchor ends with 8... Rb8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...a6 and ...Rb8 prepare ...b5. The rook leaves a8 so a future queenside pawn exchange can open a useful b-file.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Against long castling, examine ...b5 as an attack on the king. Against a slower setup, compare ...e5 and central piece development.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The queenside expansion must survive d5, Bh6 and h4. White's attack can begin before either king commits.

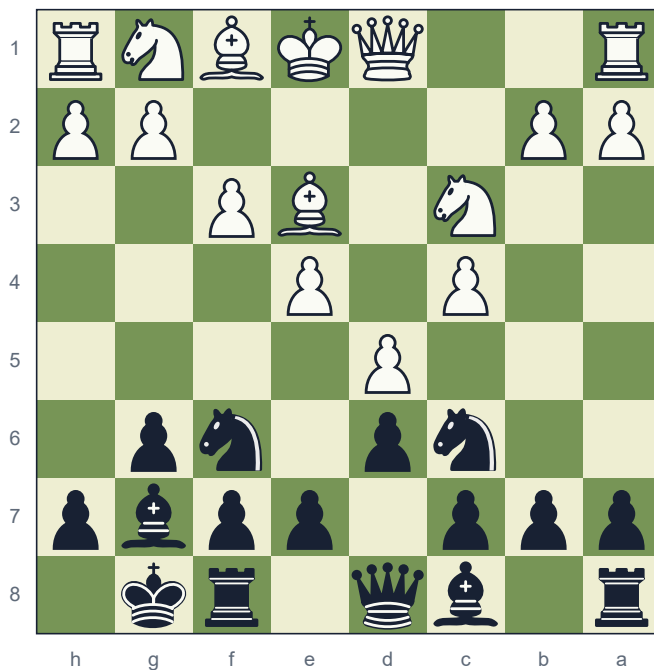
REMEMBER The Panno attacks the center and the queenside.

02 White closes with d5 immediately

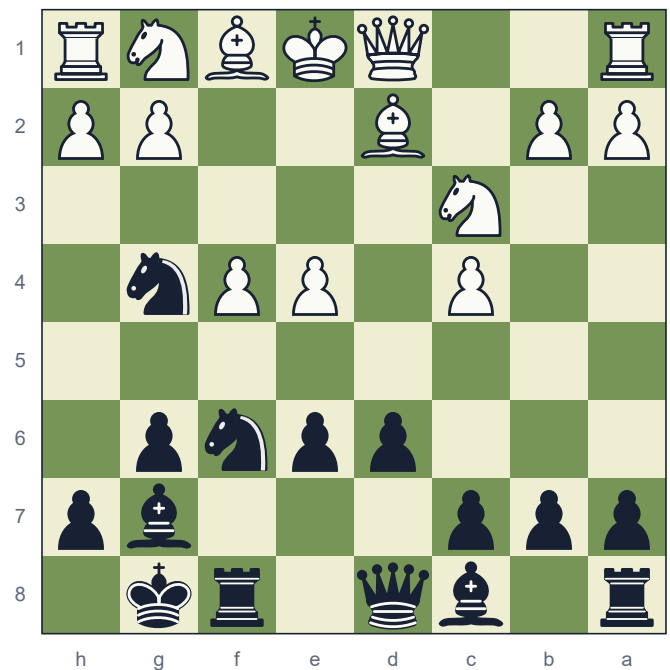
STUDY LINE 09-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. d5 Ne5 8. f4 Neg4 9. Bd2 e6 10. dxe6 fxe6

Selected anchor ends with 7... Ne5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

d5 attacks Nc6. ...Ne5 places it centrally and changes the fight from a flexible d4 center to a closed wedge.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...c6 or ...e6 to question the wedge. White may challenge the knight with f4, so keep an escape route.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not continue ...a6 while the knight is attacked. An opening setup never overrides a direct threat.

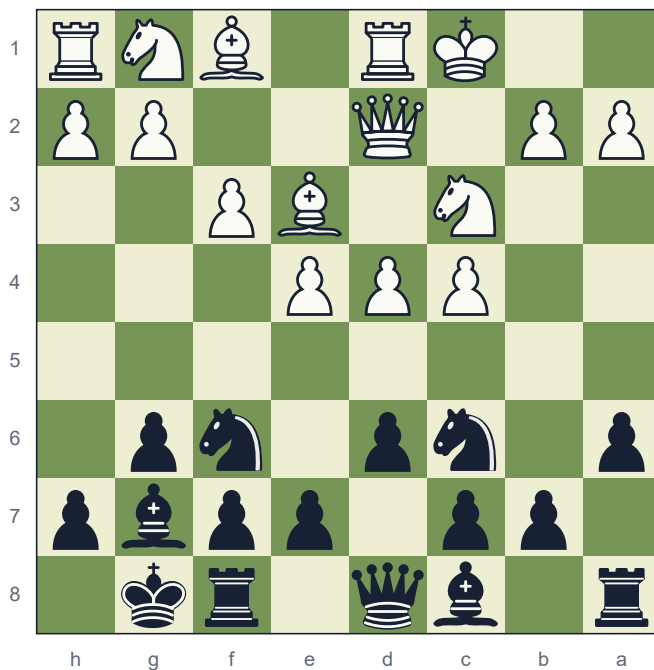
REMEMBER Answer d5 before completing the formation.

03 White castles long

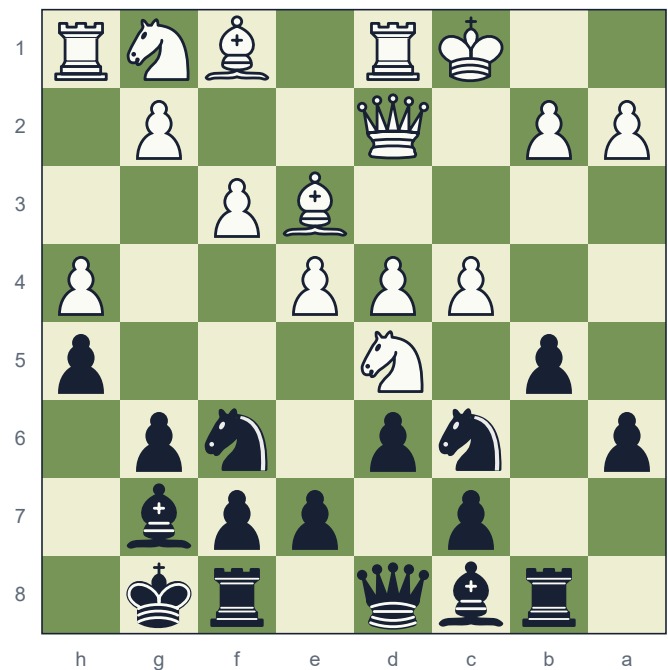
STUDY LINE 09-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. Qd2 a6 8. O-O-O Rb8 9. h4 h5 10. Nd5 b5

Selected anchor ends with 8... Rb8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White announces the king target. Black's rook and a-pawn prepare queenside lines against that king.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Calculate ...b5 and the resulting pawn captures. White will often use h4-h5 or Bh6, so count forcing moves on both wings.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

An opposite-side attack is a calculation race. A one-move defensive resource may be more valuable than another pawn push.

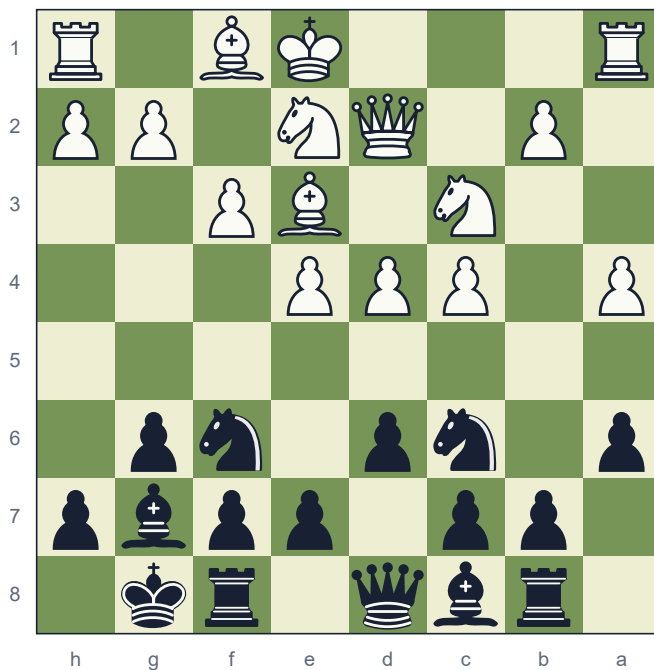
REMEMBER Attack with tempi and defend forcing threats.

04 White restrains ...b5 with a4

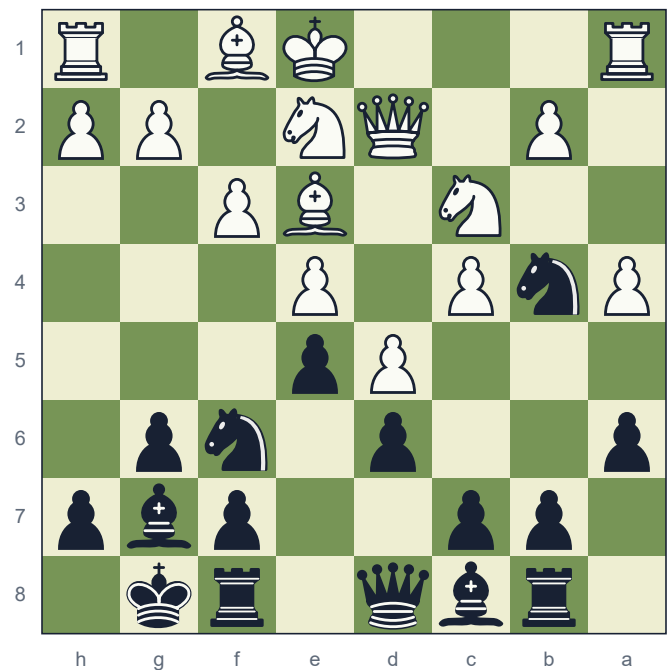
STUDY LINE 09-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. Nge2 a6 8. Qd2 Rb8 9. a4 e5 10. d5 Nb4

Selected anchor ends with 9... e5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

a4 makes a routine ...b5 harder. Black responds in the center, using development to question White's space.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Study d5 and dxe5 separately. A queenside restraint can leave White a tempo behind in development.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not push ...b5 only because it was the original plan. The a-pawn changed the calculation.

REMEMBER When a flank is restrained, test the center.

05 White keeps a flexible rook on c1

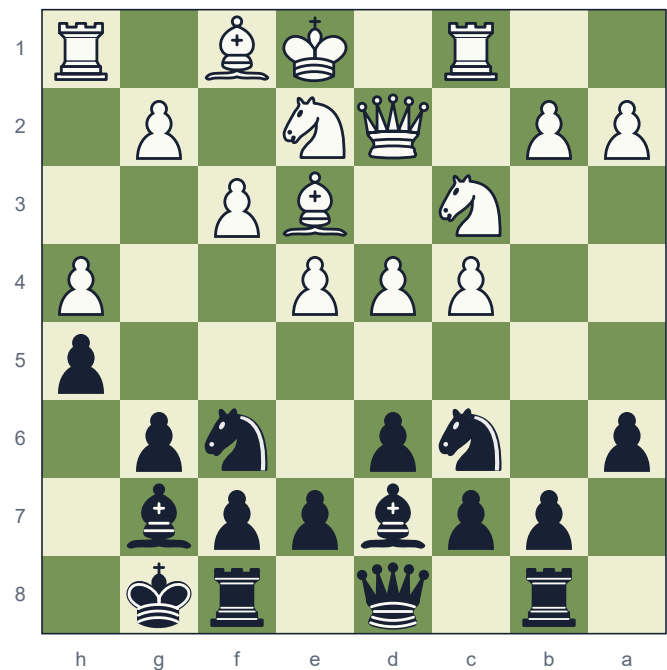
STUDY LINE 09-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. Nge2 a6 8. Qd2 Rb8 9. Rc1 Bd7 10. h4 h5

Selected anchor ends with 9... Bd7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Rc1 avoids committing the king and discourages a careless queenside opening. ...Bd7 connects development and supports future central play.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Choose between ...b5, ...e5 and improving a piece after White declares a plan. Keep the rook on b8 useful.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Rc1 is not queenside castling. The same pawn break may have a different purpose and risk.

REMEMBER Read the king placement, not just Qd2.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White supports e4 with f3 and often leaves the king flexible. Black's c-pawn remains free, and the c6 knight pressures d4.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Against long castling, examine ...b5 as an attack on the king. Against a slower setup, compare ...e5 and central piece development.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

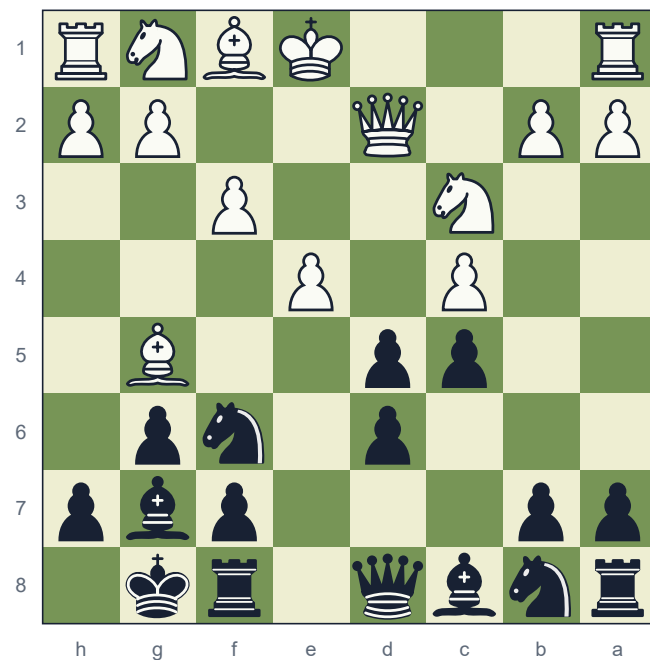
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Samisch deviations - Bg5 and early pawn attacks

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Qd2 exd5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...c5 against the early Bg5 branch and retain Panno ideas when White develops Nge2 or Qd2 first. Treat h4 and g4 as immediate changes to the position.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The f3 pawn supports e4 but takes f3 away from the g1 knight. White often needs Nge2 and several preparatory moves before completing development.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Check whether Bg5 is pinning a piece or the queen line.
2. Do not automatically capture an h-pawn.
3. Use a central break while White spends time on the flank.

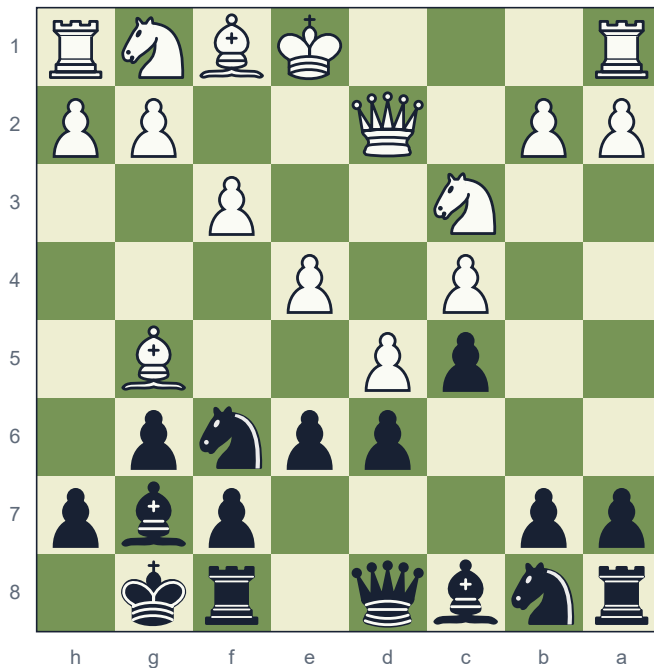
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 6.Bg5: answer with ...c5

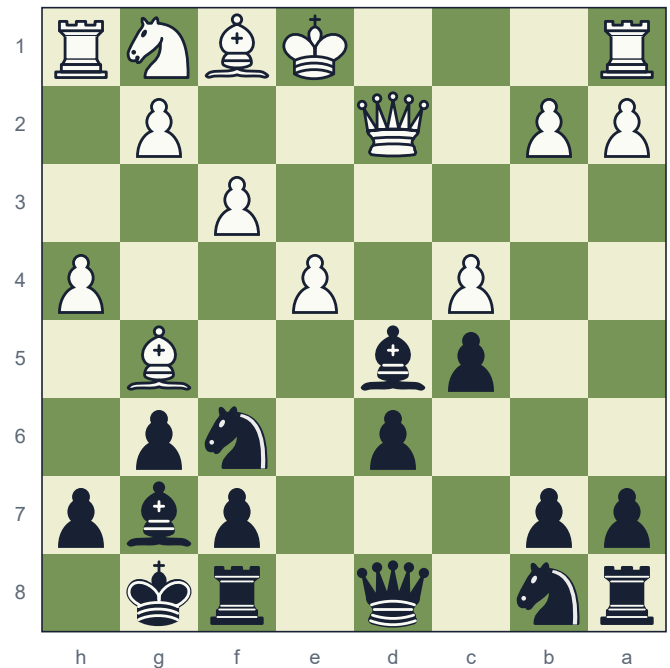
STUDY LINE 10-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Qd2 exd5 9. Nxd5 Be6 10. h4 Bxd5

Selected anchor ends with 8... exd5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...c5 contests d4 without first weakening the king. After d5, ...e6 opens another contact with the white center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Compare the c-pawn and knight recaptures on d5. Develop the queenside quickly and consider ...Re8 if the e-file opens.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The bishop on g5 can complicate knight movement. Do not play ...h6 and accept Bxh6 without calculating the attack.

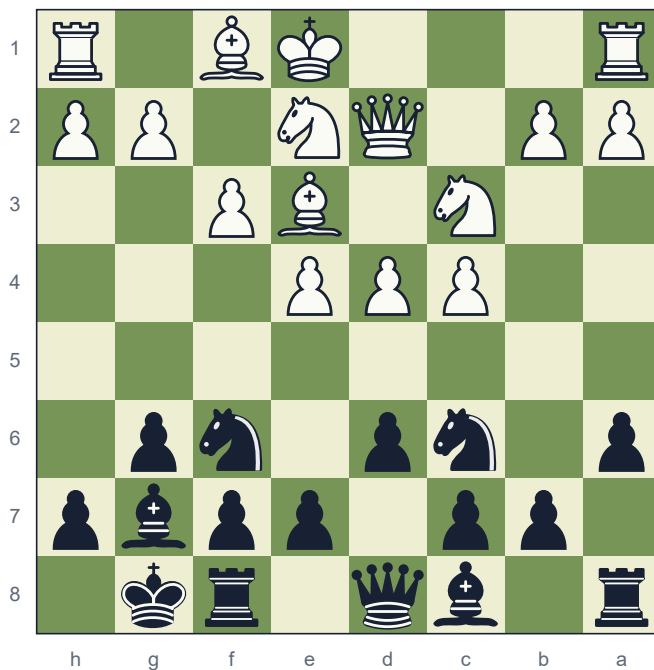
REMEMBER Break the center before chasing the bishop.

02 6.Nge2: White has not chosen a bishop square

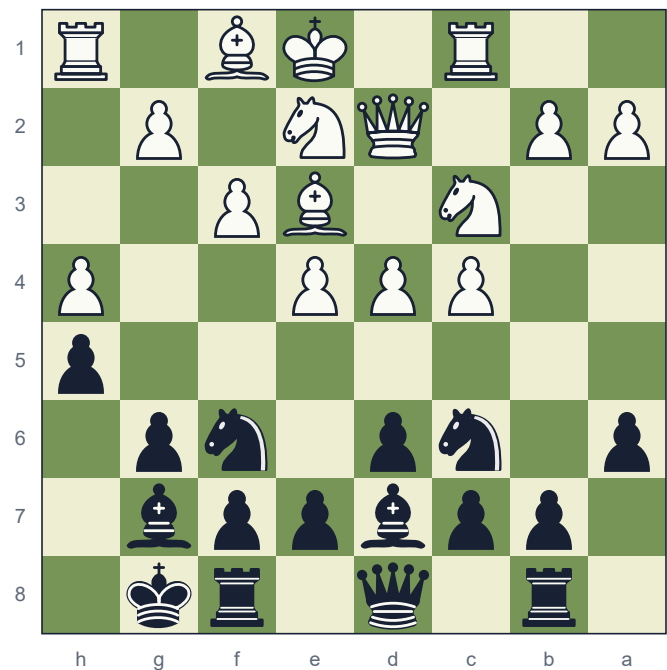
STUDY LINE 10-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Nge2 Nc6 7. Be3 a6 8. Qd2 Rb8 9. Rc1 Bd7 10. h4 h5

Selected anchor ends with 8... Rb8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White develops the knight first. Be3 returns the game to the main Panno formation through a different order.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use the main Panno decision tree: d5 requires a knight response; a4 encourages a central answer; long castling makes b-files valuable.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

If White plays Bg5 instead of Be3, the pin and c5 options need a fresh look.

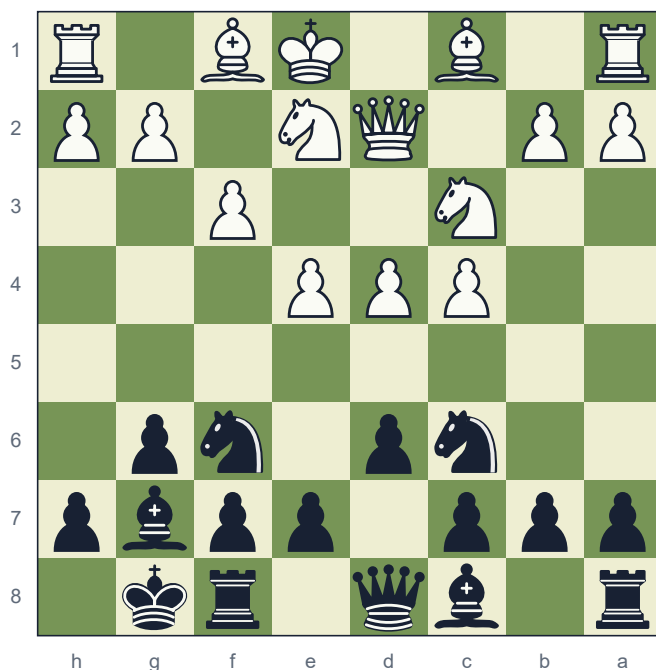
REMEMBER A transposition must include the bishop square.

03 6.Qd2: early queen development

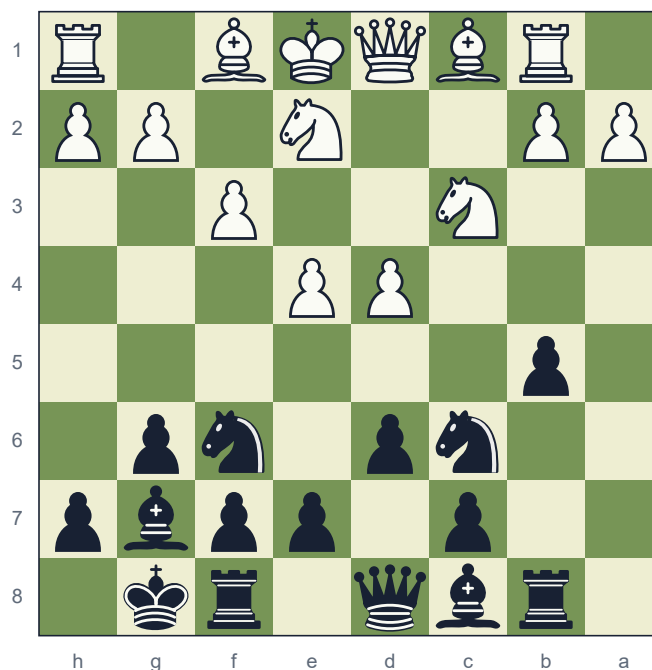
STUDY LINE 10-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Qd2 Nc6 7. Nge2 a6 8. Qd1 Rb8 9. Rb1 b5 10. cxb5 axb5

Selected anchor ends with 7... a6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Qd2 may support long castling and Bh6, but the c1 bishop has not moved. ...Nc6 pressures d4 and ...a6 prepares expansion.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Complete development in response to White's next bishop move. A direct ...e5 can become appropriate if White delays central action.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not assume queenside castling is legal merely because the queen moved: c1 must also be cleared.

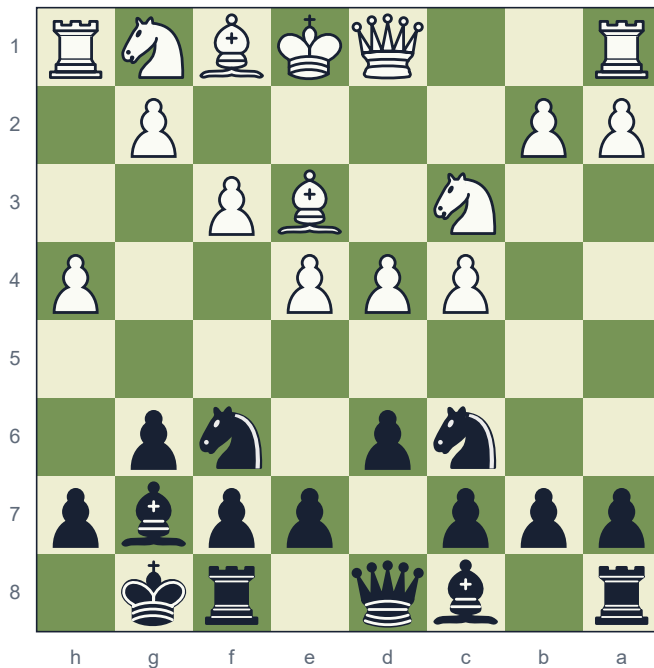
REMEMBER Check the whole castling path.

04 An early h4 against the Panno

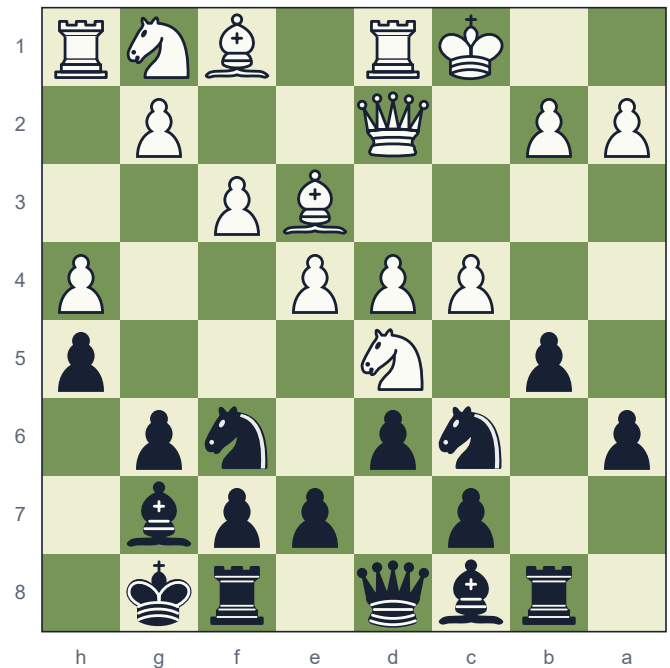
STUDY LINE 10-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. h4 h5 8. Qd2 a6 9. O-O-O Rb8 10. Nd5 b5

Selected anchor ends with 7... h5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

h4 threatens h5 and pressure on the g6 pawn. ...h5 fixes that contact before the h-file opens.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Continue queenside development and examine g4 as White's new lever. The square g5 and the h5 pawn now need attention.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Stopping one pawn does not end the attack. g4 can attack h5 and create a different file.

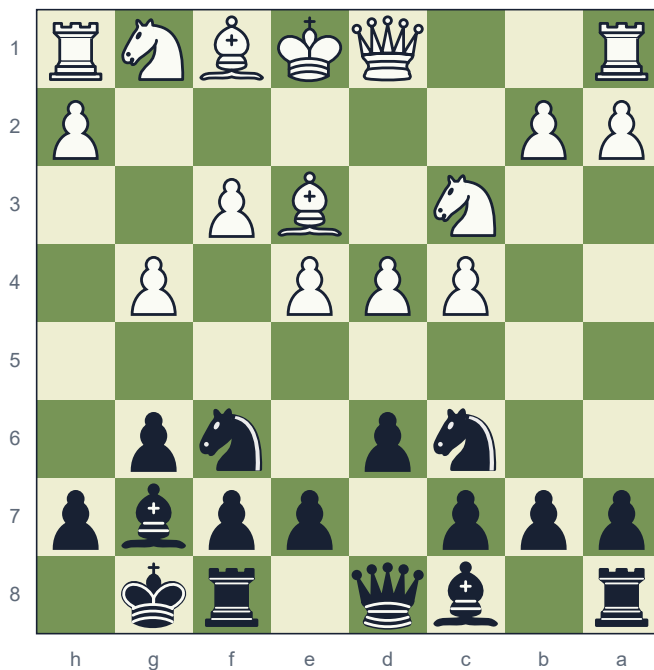
REMEMBER A blocking pawn move creates a new target.

05 An early g4 against the Panno

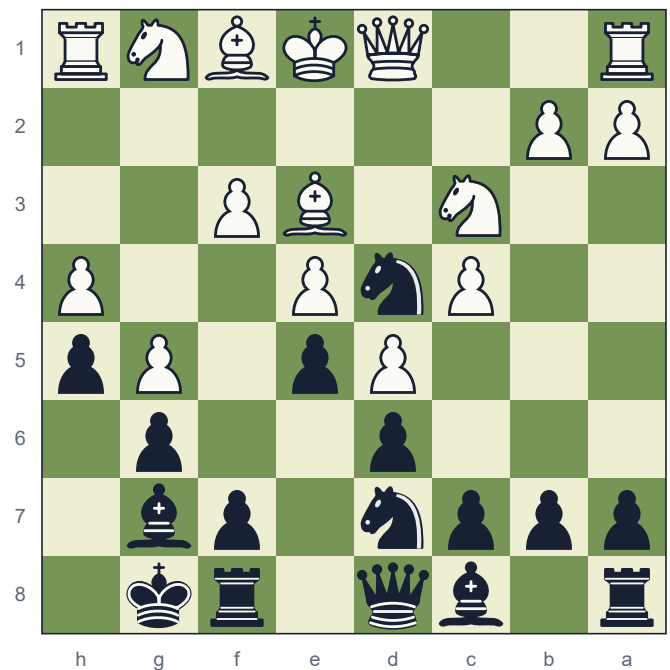
STUDY LINE 10-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f3 O-O 6. Be3 Nc6 7. g4 e5 8. d5 Nd4 9. h4 h5 10. g5 Nd7

Selected anchor ends with 7... e5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White expands before developing the king knight. Black challenges the center while the king remains on e1.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

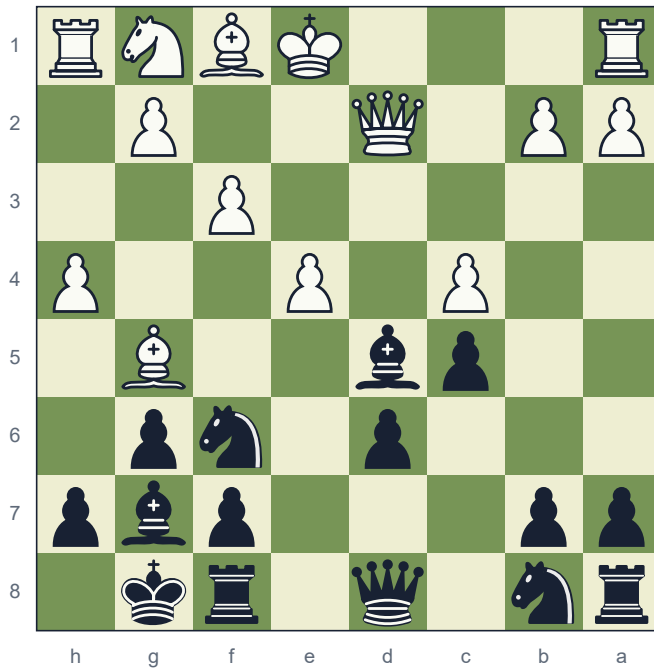
Calculate d5, dxe5 and g5 concretely. If the knight is attacked by g5, choose its square with central tactics in mind.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not treat flank pawn moves as automatically bad. White may have enough central control to support them.

REMEMBER Meet a flank attack with a justified central action.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The f3 pawn supports e4 but takes f3 away from the g1 knight. White often needs Nge2 and several preparatory moves before completing development.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Compare the c-pawn and knight recaptures on d5. Develop the queenside quickly and consider ...Re8 if the e-file opens.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

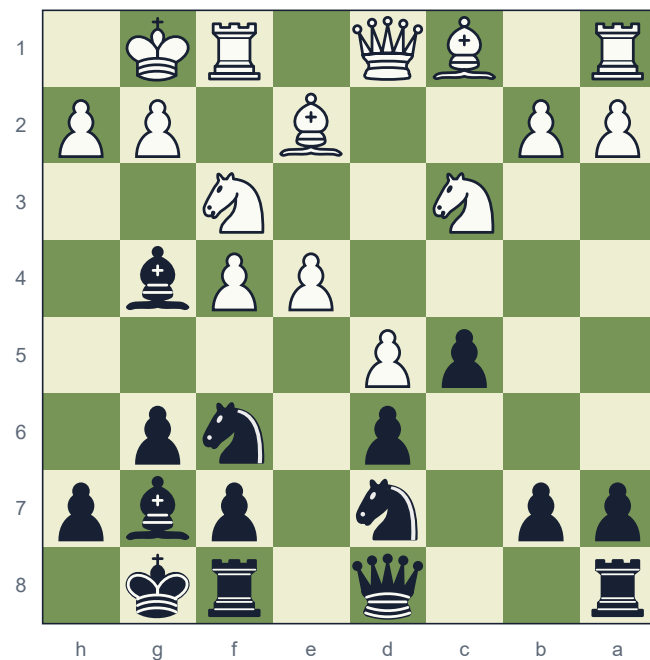
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Four Pawns Attack - strike with ...c5 and ...e6

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. Nf3 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Be2 exd5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Challenge the center before White consolidates. The main line uses ...c5 and ...e6, often reaching a Benoni structure with White's f-pawn already advanced.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White builds c4/d4/e4/f4. The pawn mass controls space but creates targets and leaves development unfinished.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Count e5 tactics before playing a quiet move.
2. Recognize a Benoni transition.
3. Do not grab pawns while development is behind.

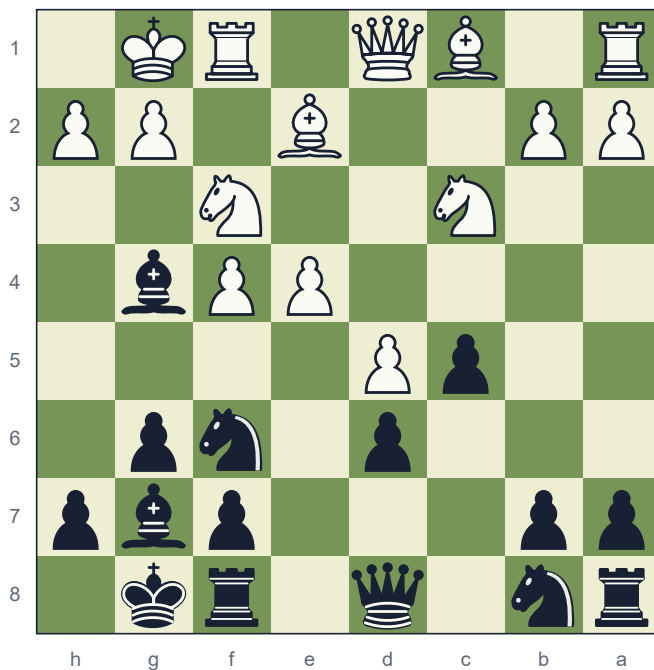
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main line with ...Bg4

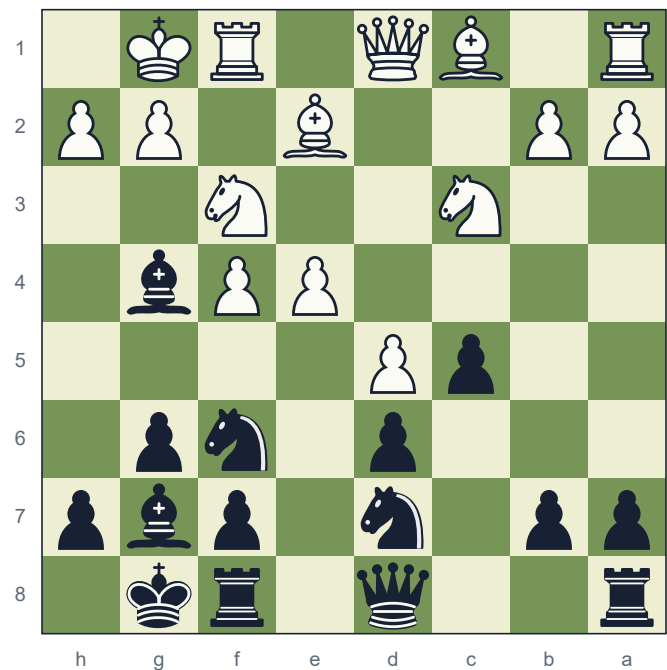
STUDY LINE 11-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. Nf3 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Be2 exd5 9. cxd5 Bg4 10. O-O Nbd7

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...Bg4 develops while threatening to exchange Nf3, a key supporter of e5. ...Nbd7 completes a flexible defensive arrangement.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use ...Re8, ...a6 and sometimes ...b5 after completing development. Watch White's e5 advance on every move.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The Benoni center differs from the ...e5 chain. A routine ...f5 can weaken e6 and d6 without stopping e5.

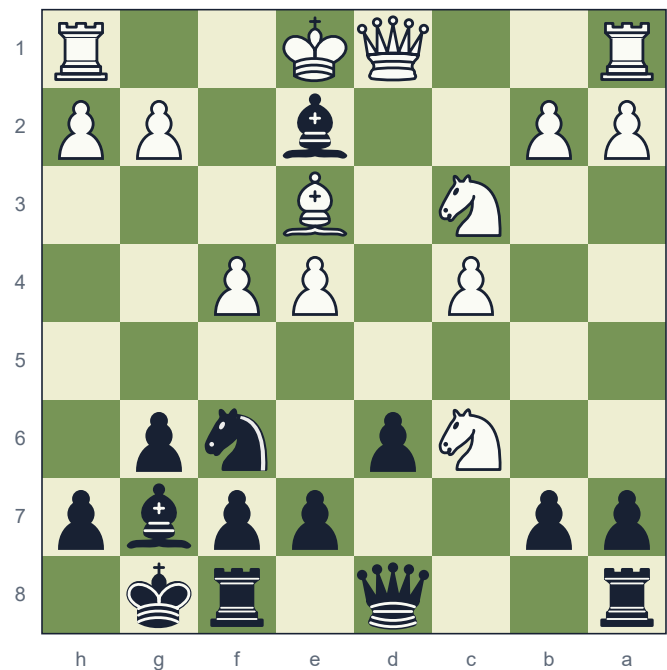
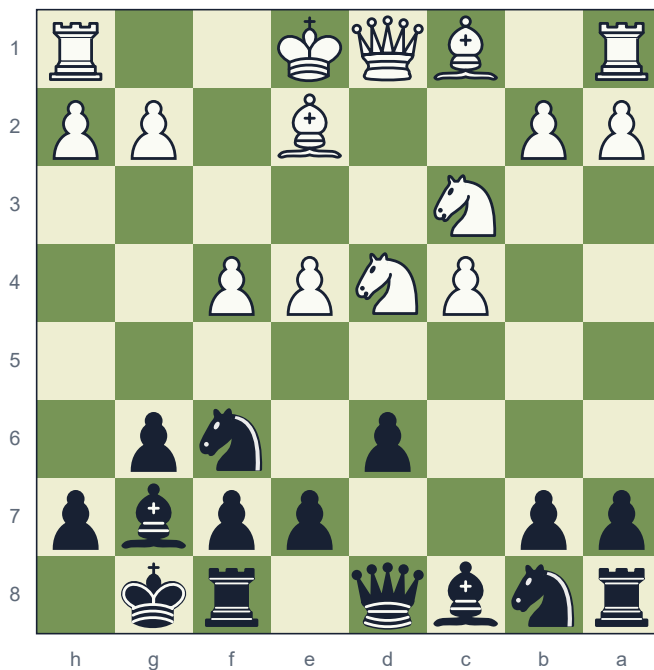
REMEMBER Challenge the supporters of the pawn mass.

02 White keeps the d4 tension

STUDY LINE 11-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. Nf3 c5 7. Be2 cxd4 8. Nxd4 Nc6 9. Be3 Bg4 10. Nxc6 Bxe2

Selected anchor ends with 9. Be3. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...cxd4 removes White's d-pawn. The remaining c4/e4 bind resembles a Maroczy structure, and the game no longer follows the closed KID.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...Bd7 and coordinate a ...d5 break only when tactically supported. Use pressure on d4 rather than forcing a kingside race.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A bind can be unpleasant if you only wait. Identify an active pawn break and the pieces needed to support it.

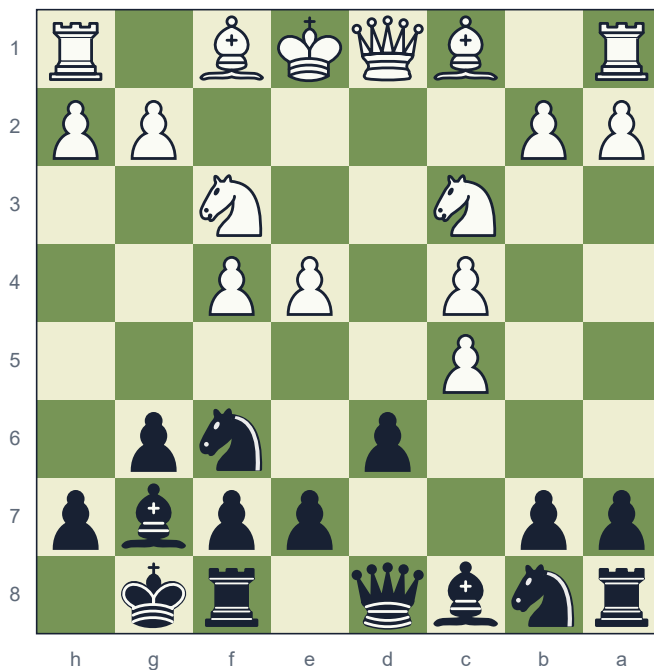
REMEMBER When the d-pawn disappears, change the plan.

03 White captures on c5

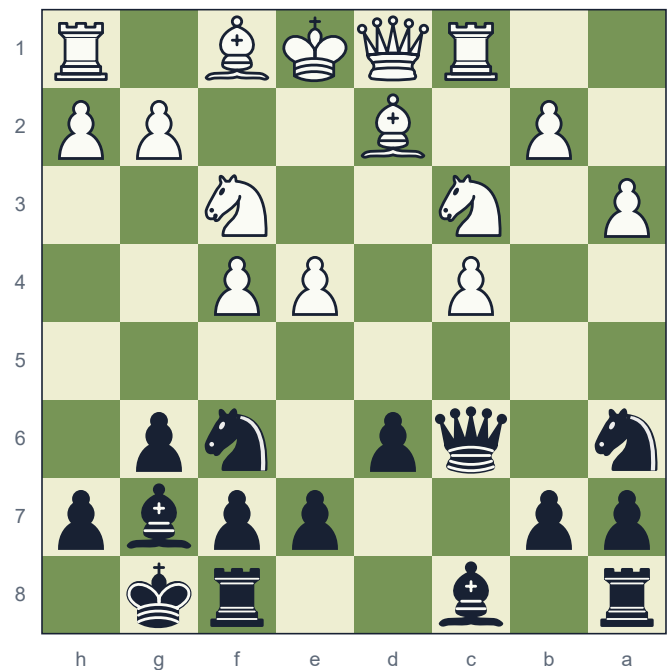
STUDY LINE 11-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. Nf3 c5 7. dxc5 Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Na6 10. a3 Qc6

Selected anchor ends with 7... Qa5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The queen attacks e4 along the diagonal and puts pressure on c5. It is a concrete answer to White opening the center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Recover material with development and keep the queen safe from Bd2 or other tempo attacks.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Count the queen's targets precisely. A double attack is useful only if the recapture sequence works.

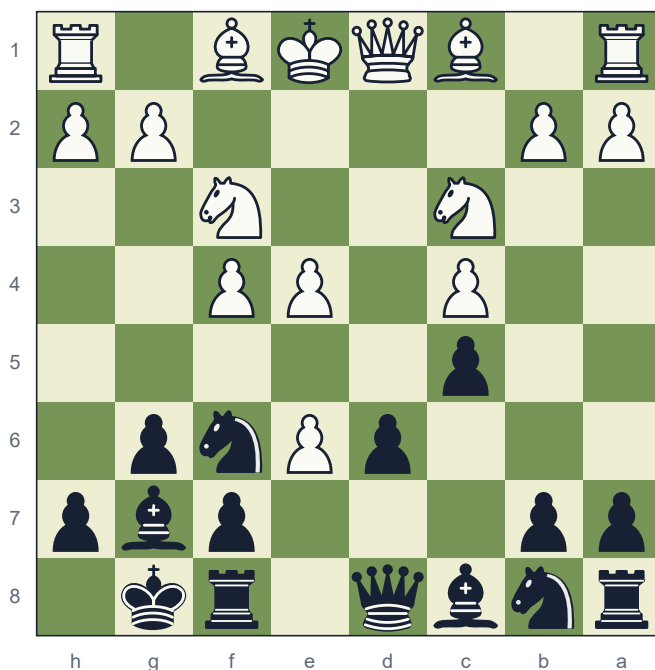
REMEMBER Central captures can expose two targets at once.

04 White exchanges on e6

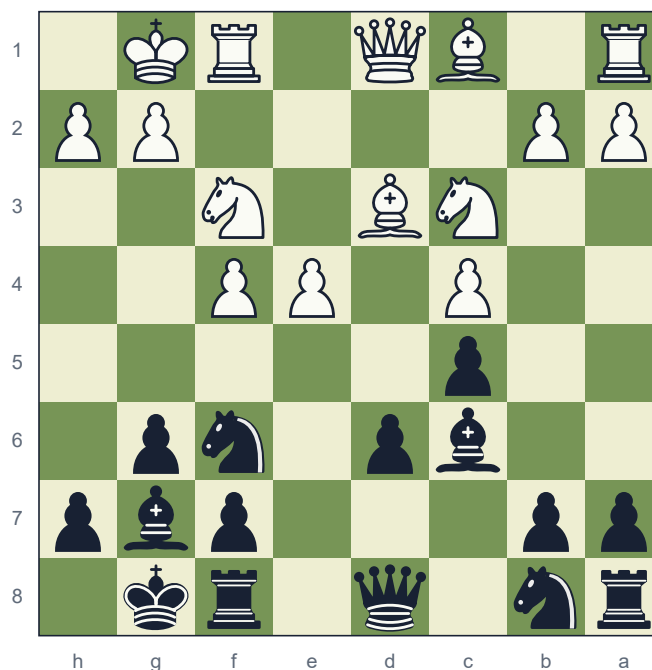
STUDY LINE 11-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. Nf3 c5 7. d5 e6 8. dxe6 Bxe6 9. Bd3 Bd7 10. O-O Bc6

Selected anchor ends with 8... Bxe6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The bishop develops by recapturing. White has removed the d5 wedge, giving Black more central squares.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Pressure c4 and e4 and bring the remaining pieces out. Choose ...Nc6 and ...Re8 based on White's development.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not recapture with the f-pawn by habit; compare bishop development and king safety first.

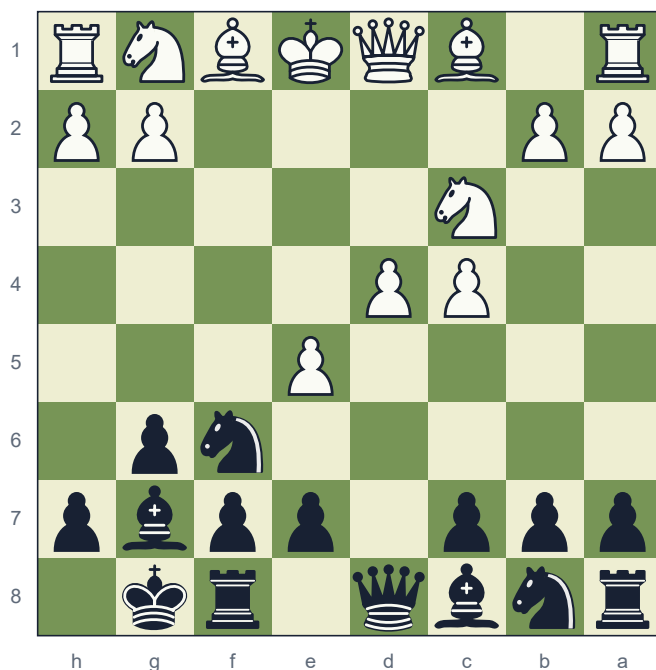
REMEMBER Use a recapture to improve a piece when justified.

05 White pushes e5 before Nf3

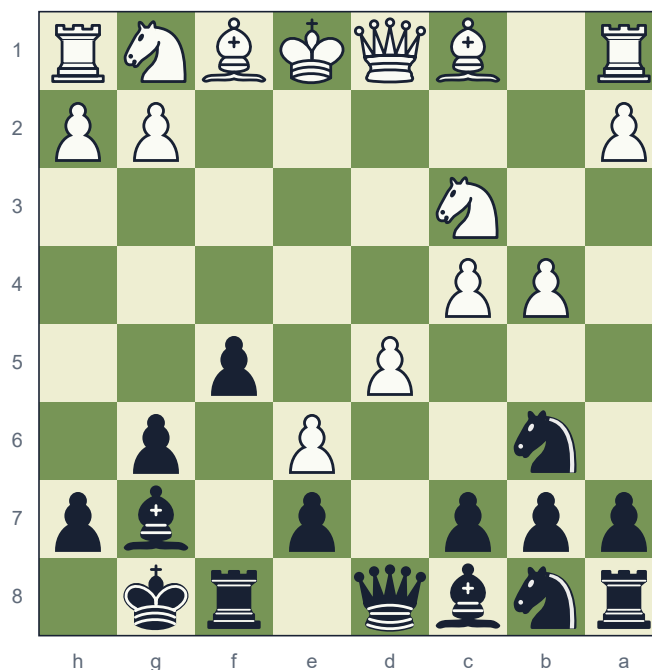
STUDY LINE 11-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. e5 dxe5 7. fxe5 Nfd7 8. b4 f6 9. e6 Nb6 10. d5 f5

Selected anchor ends with 7... Nfd7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The f-pawn recapture leaves a strong pawn on e5. ...Nfd7 attacks it while keeping the knight supported and leaving ...c5 available.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Challenge d4 with ...c5 and develop the b8 knight. White's center has advanced before the pieces are ready, but must be dismantled carefully.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

This is not the same position as an early e5 with a pawn still on f2. The more exposed ...Ng4 route is less convincing here.

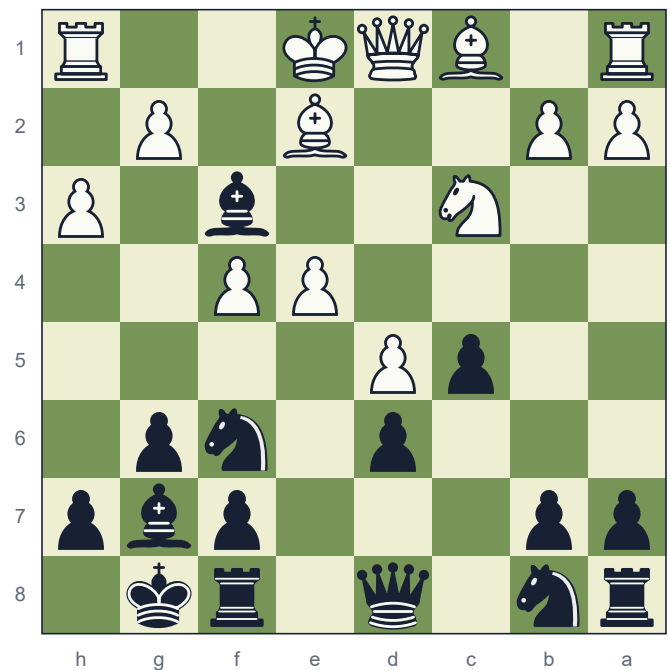
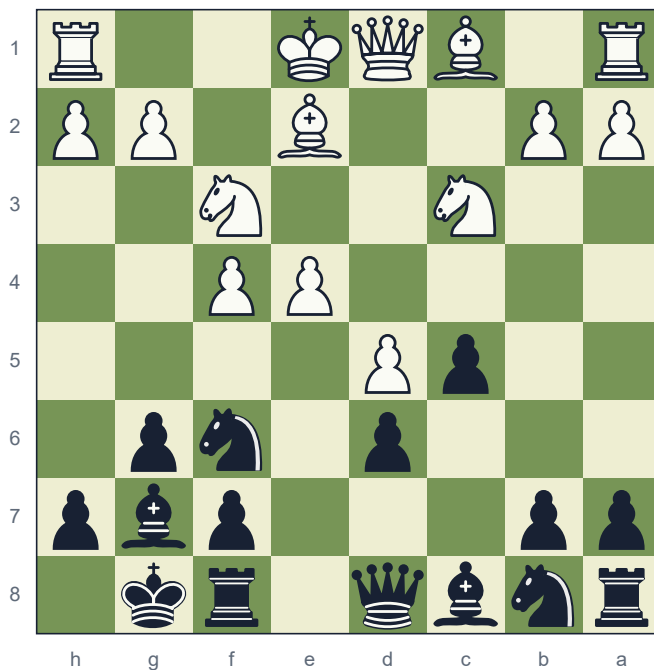
REMEMBER A changed recapturing pawn can change the knight retreat.

06 The early Be2 move order

STUDY LINE 11-06

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. f4 O-O 6. Be2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Nf3 exd5 9. cxd5 Bg4 10. h3 Bxf3

Selected anchor ends with 9... Bg4. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Be2 before Nf3 transposes to the main Four Pawns structure if White then develops the knight. The same ...Bg4 idea becomes available.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

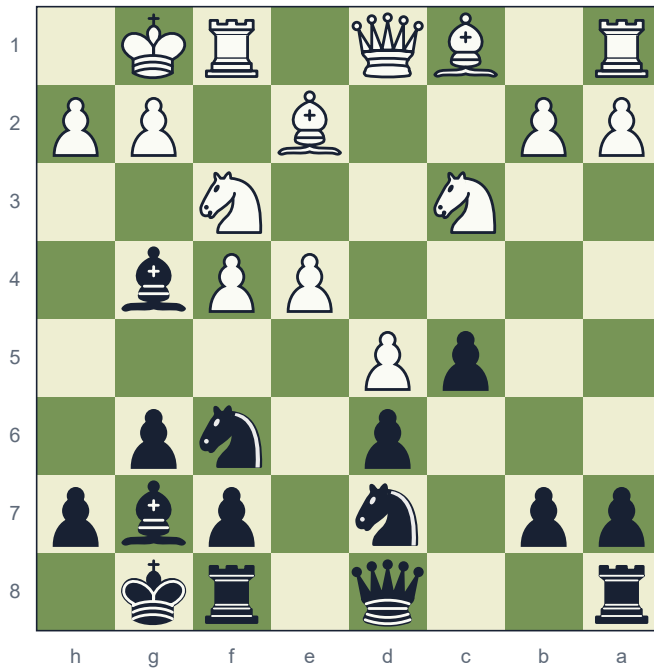
Complete ...Nbd7 and watch e5. If White instead plays g4 or dxe6, do not force this transposition.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Only the actual moves create a transposition. White is not obliged to develop Nf3 next.

REMEMBER Know the fork before the familiar line.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White builds c4/d4/e4/f4. The pawn mass controls space but creates targets and leaves development unfinished.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Use ...Re8, ...a6 and sometimes ...b5 after completing development. Watch White's e5 advance on every move.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

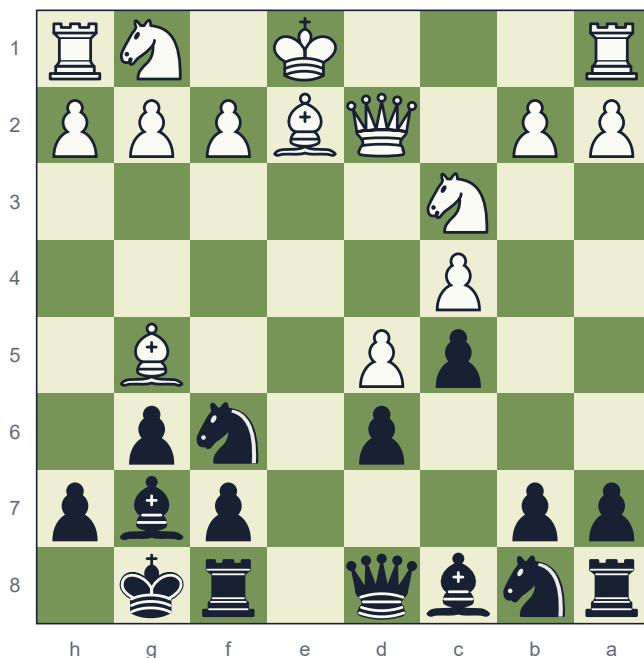
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Averbakh - meet 6.Bg5 with a central break

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Qd2 exd5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...c5 and ...e6 to challenge the center. White's bishop restrains the f6 knight, making an automatic ...f5 plan less convenient.



Main study anchor - Black to move

READ THE CENTER

The center often becomes a Benoni structure after d5 and ...exd5, with White's bishop already on g5.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Challenge the center before weakening the king.
2. Keep track of the g5-d8 diagonal.
3. Compare each possible recapture on d5.

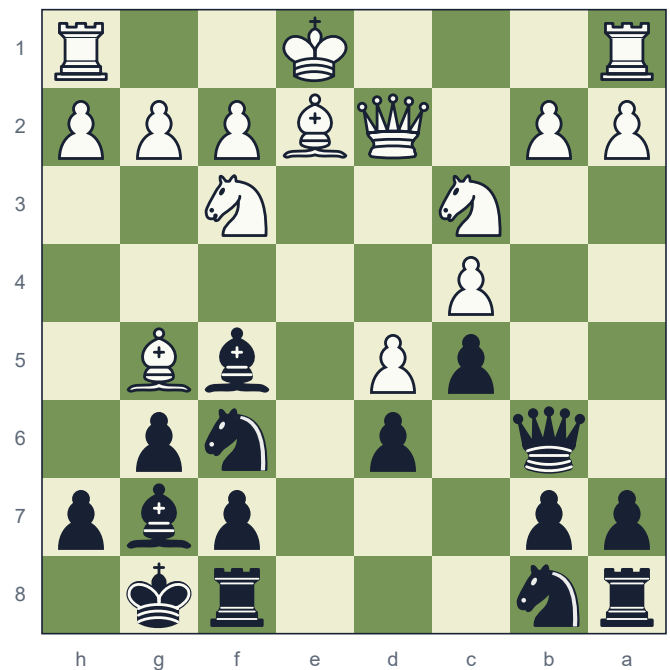
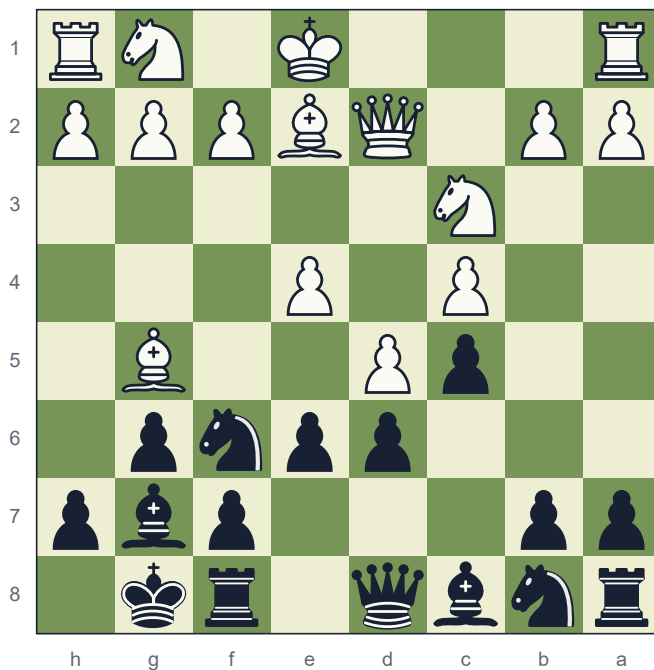
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main Benoni transition

STUDY LINE 12-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Qd2 exd5 9. exd5 Qb6 10. Nf3 Bf5

Selected anchor ends with 9. exd5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...e6 adds pressure to d5. An e-pawn recapture keeps White's pawns on c4 and d5 and opens the e-file completely.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...Re8, ...Nbd7 and the queen bishop actively. Inspect whether ...h6 wins a useful tempo or merely gives White an attacking target.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The pawn on d5 came from e4 here. A line using cxd5 can have different tactics and plans.

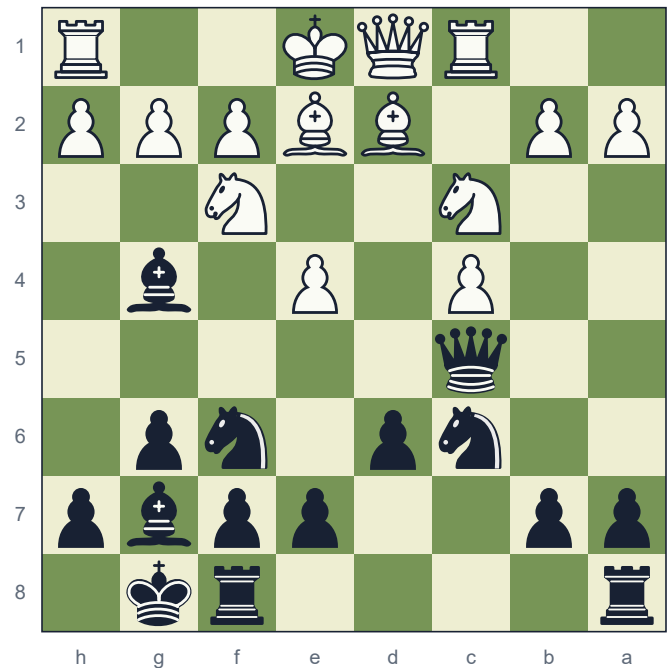
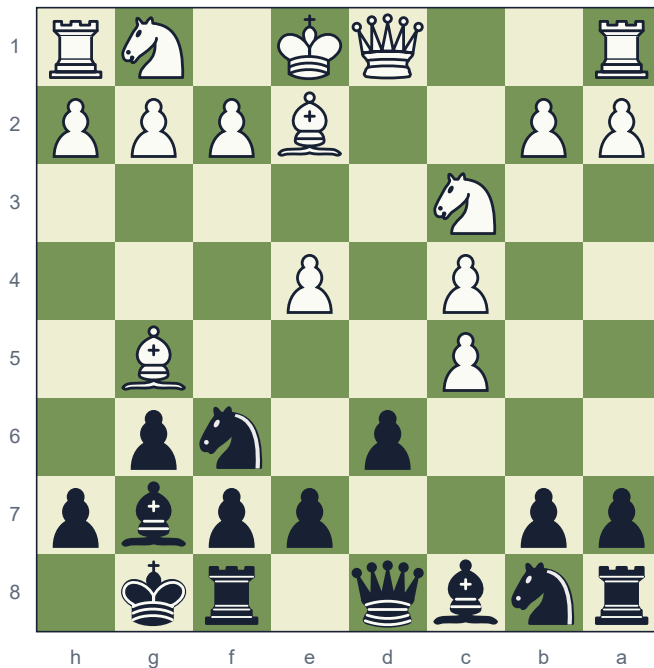
REMEMBER The identity of the recapturing pawn matters.

02 White captures on c5

STUDY LINE 12-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. dxc5 Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Nc6 10. Nf3 Bg4

Selected anchor ends with 7... Qa5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

The queen pressures c5 and e4 after White releases the central tension. This is a concrete resource against the exchange.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Recover the pawn and develop while watching attacks on the queen. Keep the g5 bishop's influence in mind.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not treat ...Qa5 as a move that always wins material. Check White's interpositions and development.

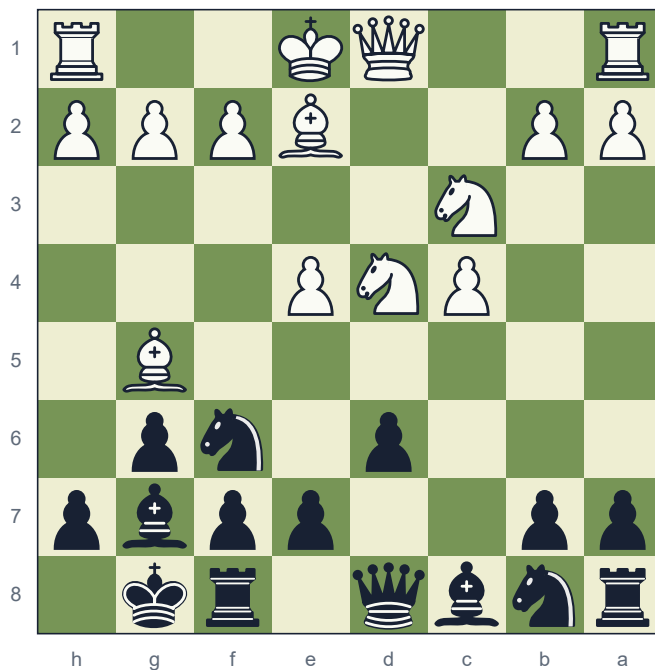
REMEMBER Use the opened diagonal, then bring the pieces out.

03 White adds Nf3

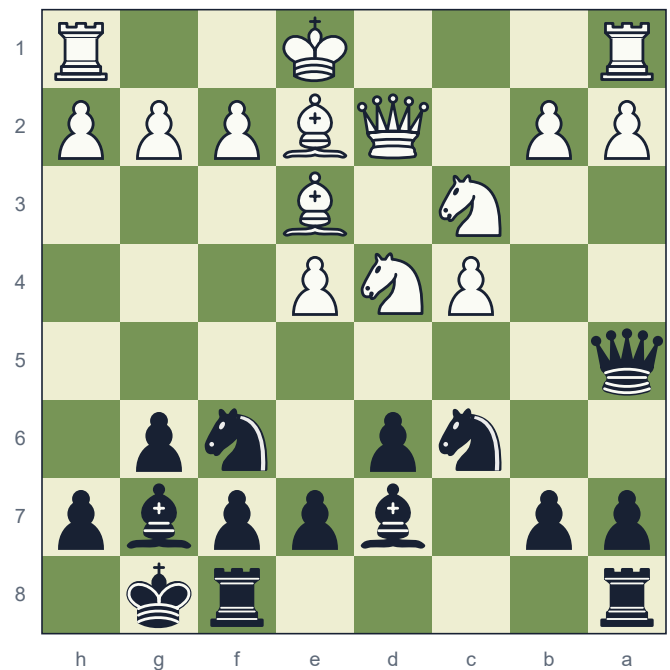
STUDY LINE 12-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. Nf3 cxd4 8. Nxd4 Nc6 9. Be3 Bd7 10. Qd2 Qa5

Selected anchor ends with 8... Nc6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White chooses normal development while retaining d4. Black exchanges the c-pawn and puts a knight on c6 to pressure d4.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Complete development and assess ...Nxd4 or ...Qa5 if supported. The position is open enough for piece play.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not continue the closed-chain pawn storm after the d-pawn has left the board.

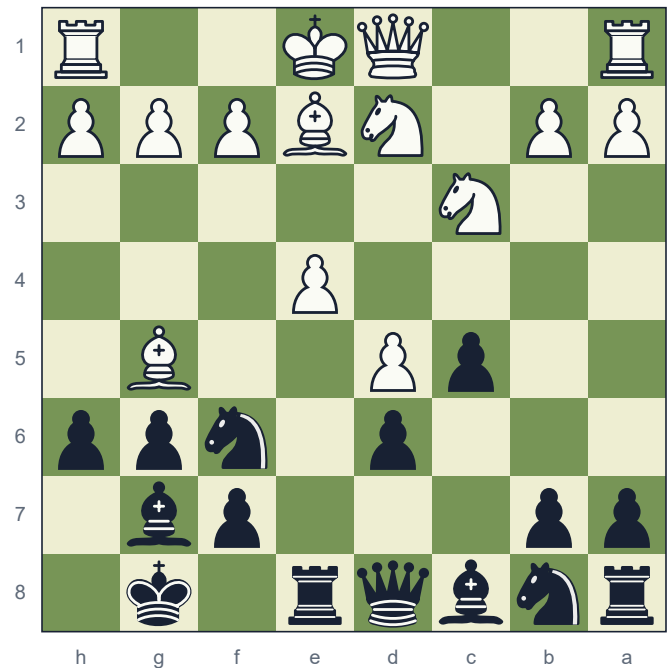
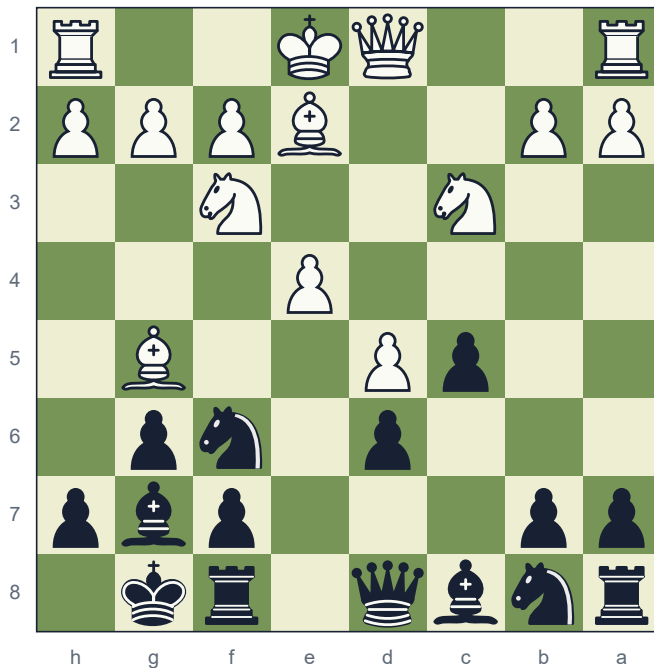
REMEMBER Open central squares reward active pieces.

04 White advances and develops Nf3

STUDY LINE 12-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Bg5 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Nf3 exd5 9. cxd5 Re8 10. Nd2 h6

Selected anchor ends with 9... Re8. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...Re8 uses the newly opened e-file. White's bishop and knight influence different central squares, so the tactical details differ from the Four Pawns line.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

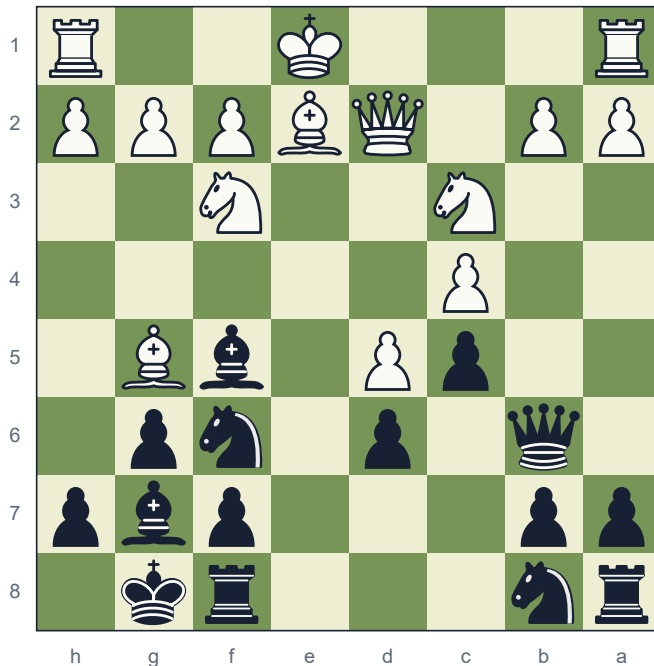
Develop ...Nbd7 and examine ...h6 or ...a6. Keep e4 under pressure without allowing an easy e5 advance.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A pawn on f2 instead of f4 changes the e5 calculation. Do not import a Four Pawns sacrifice unchanged.

REMEMBER Same pawn skeleton, different tactical support.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

The center often becomes a Benoni structure after d5 and ...exd5, with White's bishop already on g5.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop ...Re8, ...Nbd7 and the queen bishop actively. Inspect whether ...h6 wins a useful tempo or merely gives White an attacking target.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

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Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

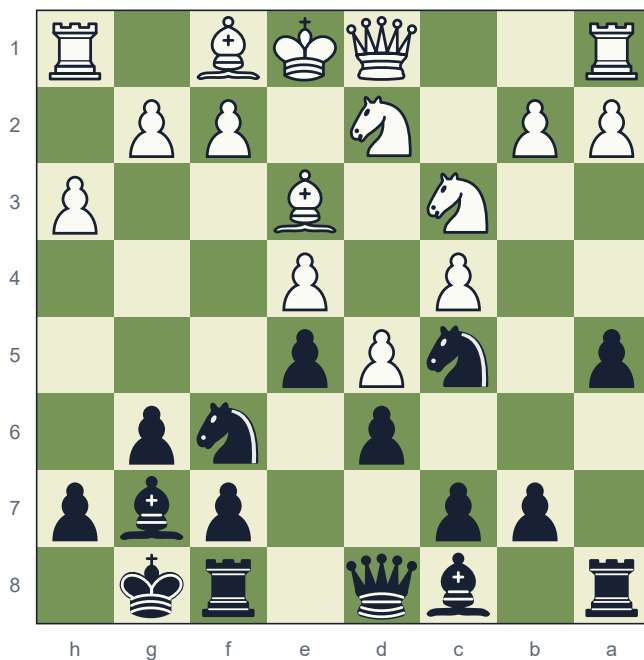
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Makogonov and h3 systems

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. Be3 Nc5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...e5 against the main h3/Nf3 setup and retain ...Na6 ideas after d5. White is building restraints against ...Bg4, ...Ng4 and a quick kingside attack.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

h3 keeps the g-pawn flexible and controls g4. White may keep the king in the center, castle short, or attack your king.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Identify White's king plan.
2. Do not force ...g5 just because h3 was played.
3. Use ...c6 or queenside squares if the kingside is restrained.

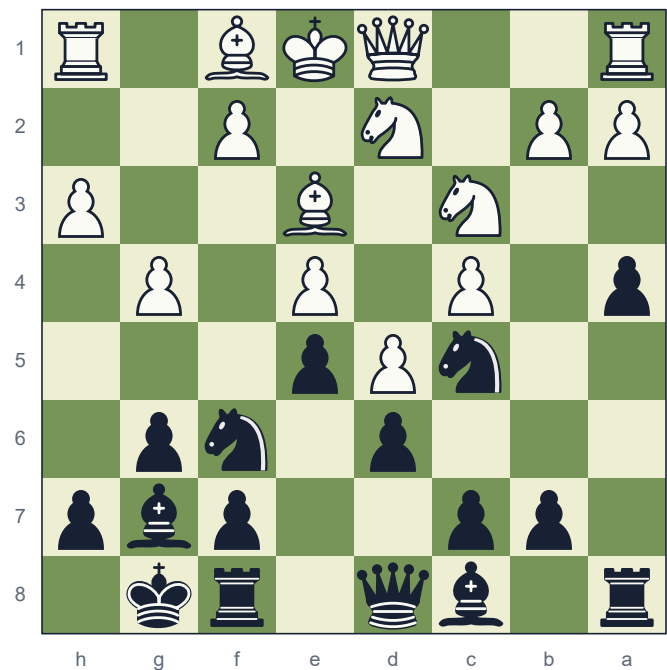
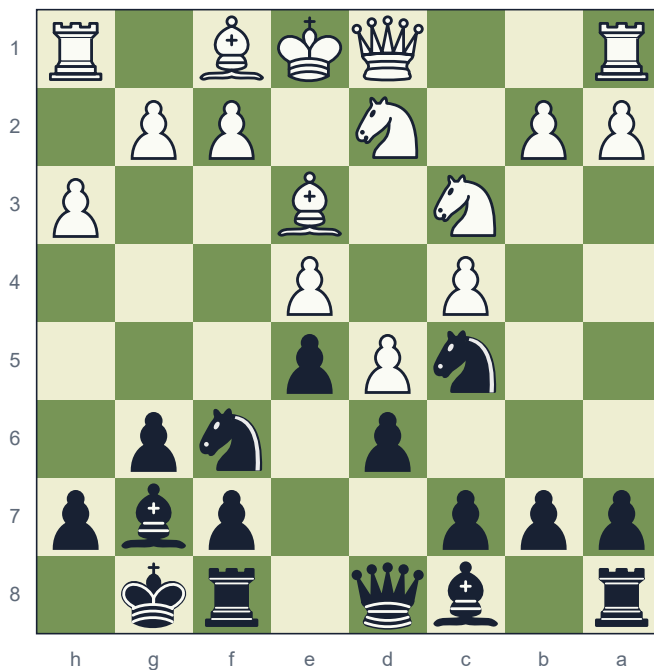
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Main h3 and Nf3 structure

STUDY LINE 13-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. Be3 Nc5 9. Nd2 a5 10. g4 a4

Selected anchor ends with 9... a5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...Na6-c5 develops toward d3, e4 and b3; ...a5 supports the knight against b4. White's h3 removes easy ...Ng4 ideas.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Improve the queen bishop and prepare a central or kingside break with support. Keep the c5 knight from becoming a fixed target.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White may play g4 and delay castling. A kingside pawn race can then favor White.

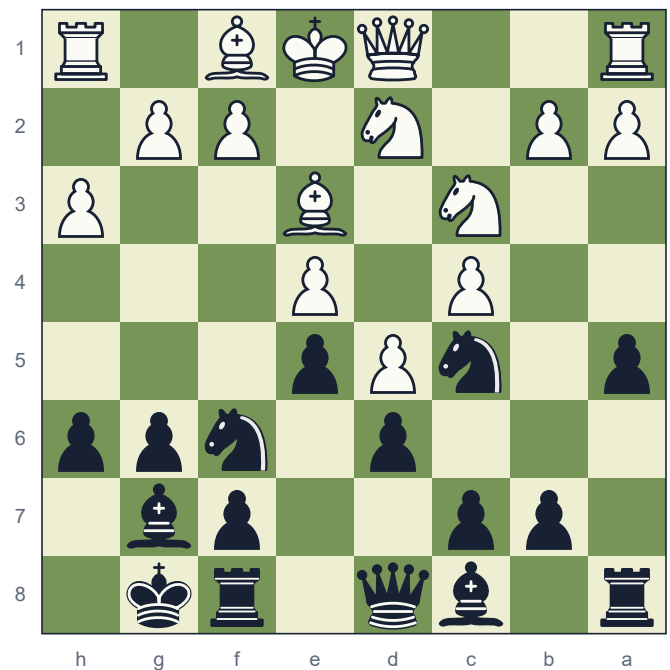
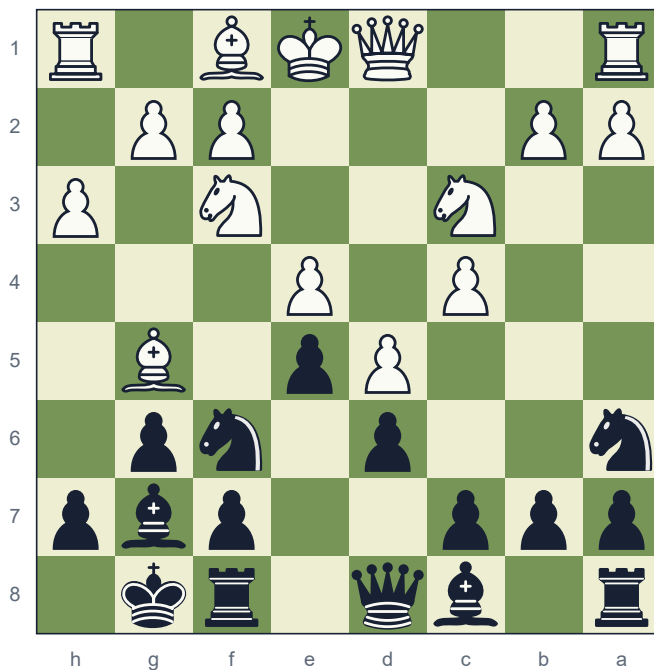
REMEMBER Respect the restraint and find another useful square.

02 White chooses Bg5

STUDY LINE 13-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. Bg5 h6 9. Be3 Nc5 10. Nd2 a5

Selected anchor ends with 9. Be3. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

The bishop pins Nf6 along the queen diagonal. ...h6 asks it to choose a square without yet committing ...g5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...Nc5 and consider ...Qe8 or ...Nh7 only when the center is secure. Watch the h6 pawn as a possible target.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White can use h3 to support g4. Do not mistake a bishop retreat for the end of White's attack.

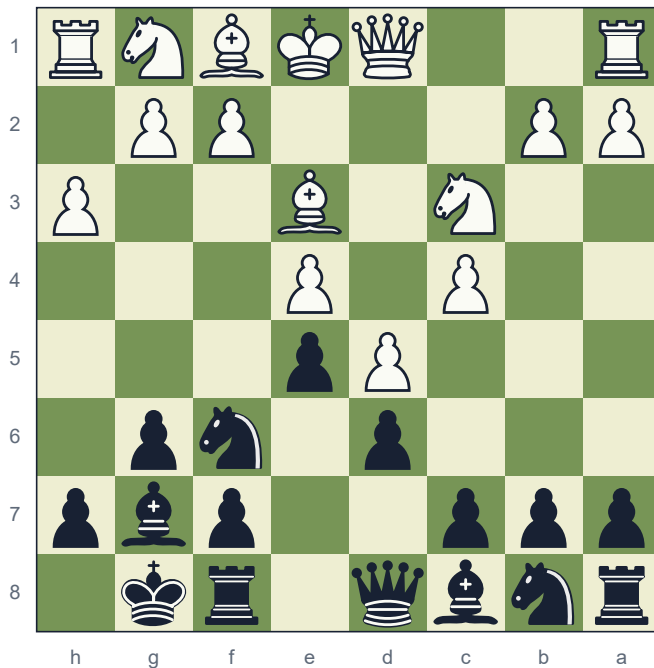
REMEMBER A small question to the bishop is enough for now.

03 Be3 before Nf3

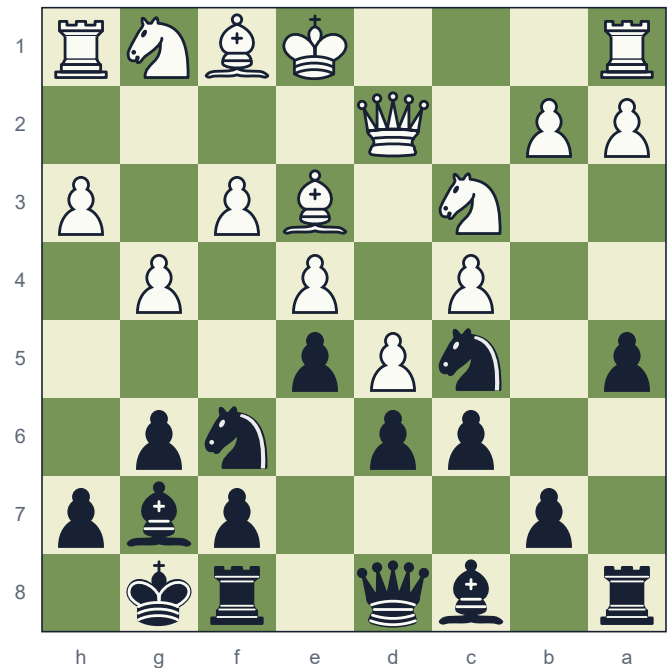
STUDY LINE 13-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Be3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. g4 Nc5 9. f3 a5 10. Qd2 c6

Selected anchor ends with 7... Na6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White keeps the king knight flexible. Black develops toward c5 while preserving choices for the f6 knight.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Watch whether White plays Nf3, Nge2 or g4. Choose your break from the resulting position rather than from the move number.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The absence of Nf3 changes which squares are defended and how quickly White can play f4.

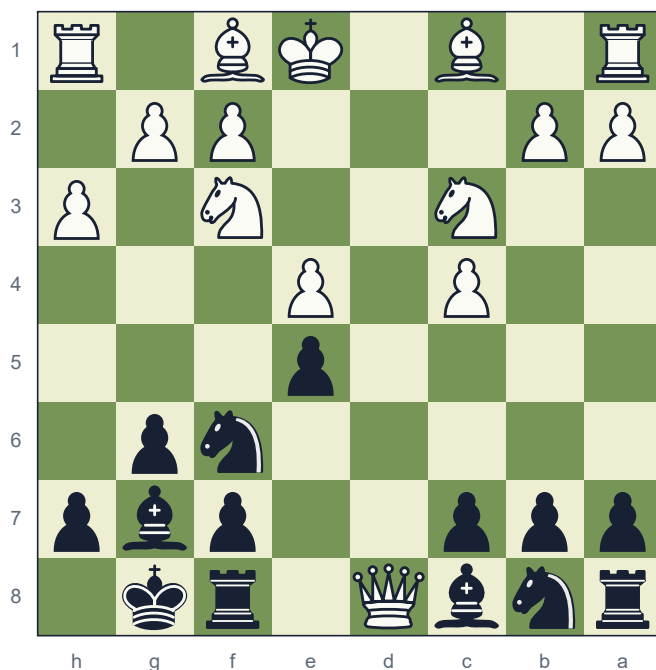
REMEMBER Delayed development can preserve dangerous options.

04 White exchanges rather than closes

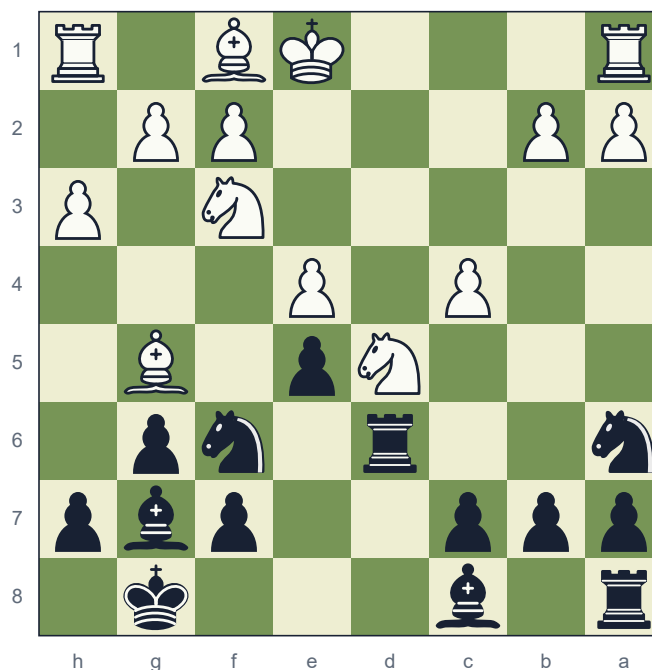
STUDY LINE 13-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. dxe5 dxe5 8. Qxd8 Rxd8 9. Bg5 Na6 10. Nd5 Rd6

Selected anchor ends with 8... Rxd8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The queen exchange makes h3 a useful restraint, but it does not justify a wing attack. Black has an open d-file and active rook.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

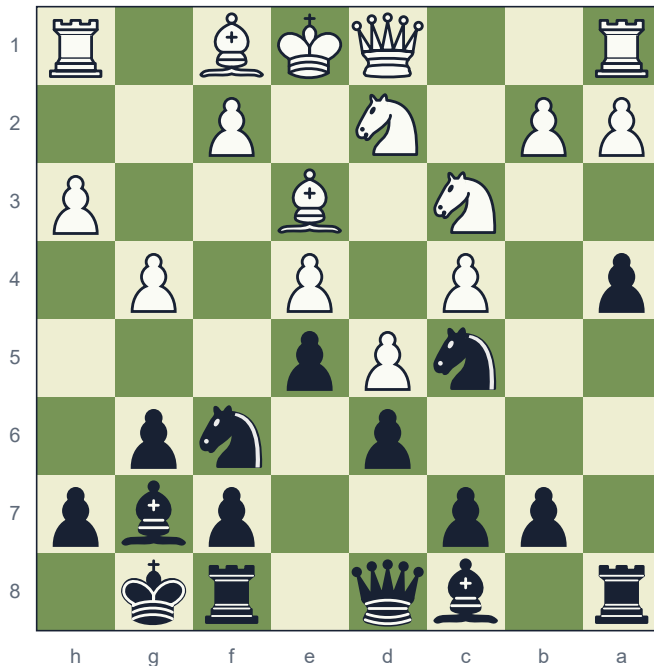
Develop ...Nc6, contest d4 and bring the bishop into play. Compare minor-piece activity before exchanging.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The same h3 label can lead to a completely different center.

REMEMBER The center determines the plan more than the name.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

h3 keeps the g-pawn flexible and controls g4. White may keep the king in the center, castle short, or attack your king.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Improve the queen bishop and prepare a central or kingside break with support. Keep the c5 knight from becoming a fixed target.

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Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

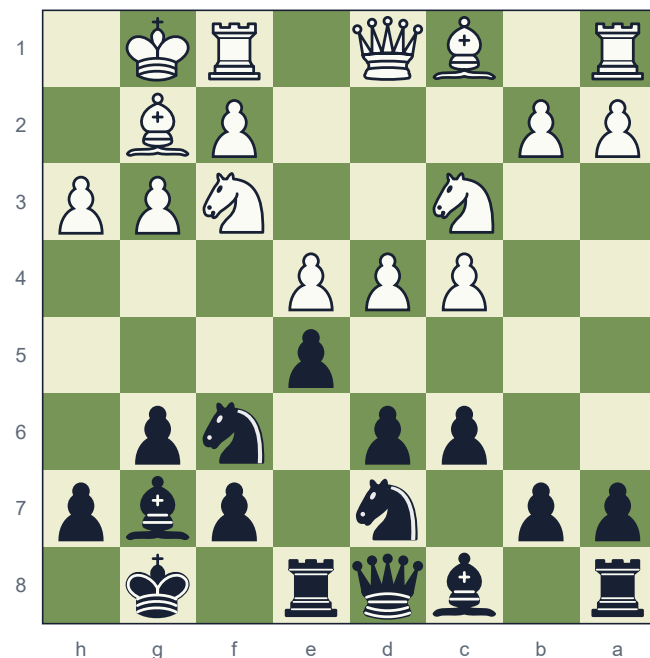
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Fianchetto - a classical ...Nbd7 repertoire

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use ...Nbd7 and ...e5, with ...c6 against a broad e4 center. White's g2 bishop makes the usual kingside pawn storm much harder to justify.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

The long diagonal is a major feature. The center may stay tense, close with d5, or open through ...exd4.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants a safe king, strong central control, and pressure on the long diagonal. White often meets attacks by exchanging the center.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Keep the long diagonal in the calculation.
2. Prepare ...exd4 and ...Nc5 when useful.
3. Do not weaken the king with a reflex ...f5.

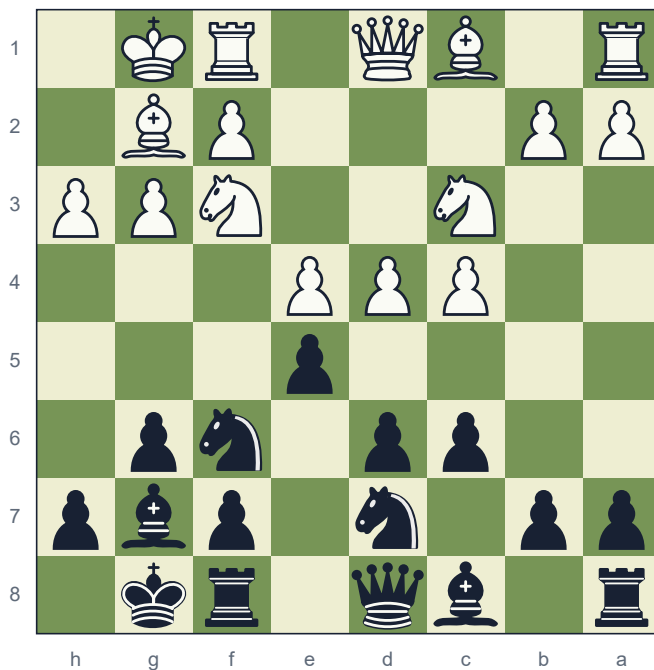
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Classical main setup with ...c6

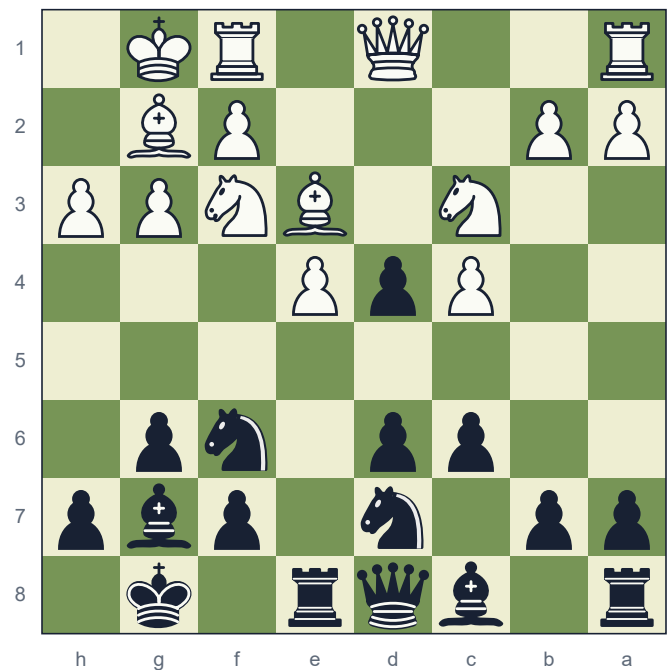
STUDY LINE 14-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6 9. h3 Re8 10. Be3 exd4

Selected anchor ends with 9... Re8. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...c6 supports a possible ...d5 and controls d5; ...Re8 reinforces e5. Black develops a central plan against White's solid king.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Compare ...exd4 followed by ...Nc5 with keeping the tension. Use ...a5 if it helps the knight or restrains b4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White can release the g2 bishop by central exchanges. Count attacks along the diagonal before moving the b-pawn.

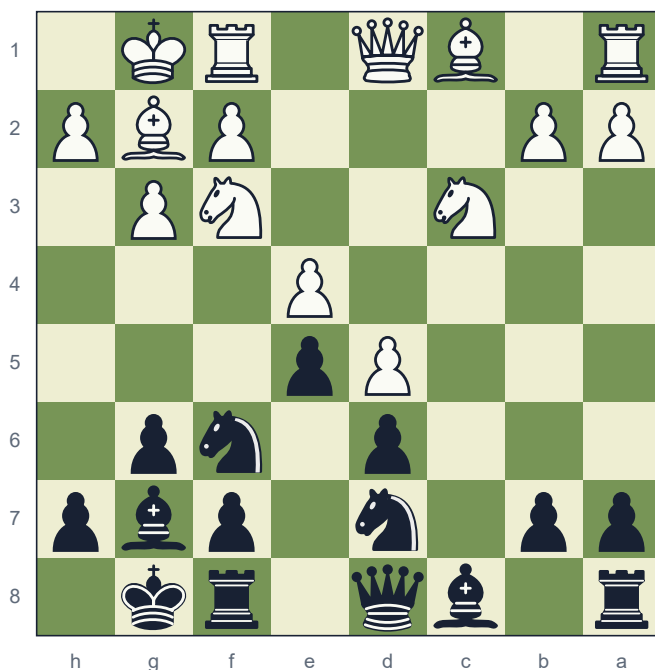
REMEMBER Central counterplay is the main engine of activity.

02 Early d5 closes the center

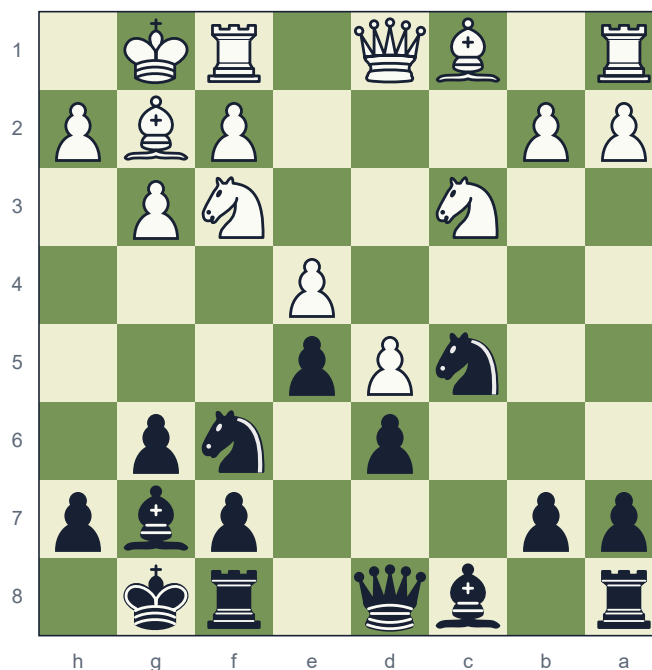
STUDY LINE 14-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 c6 9. d5 cxd5 10. cxd5 Nc5

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



Before 10... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The c-pawn exchange changes the closed center and gives Nc5 a useful square. Black pressures e4 while White keeps a space advantage.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...a5, ...Bd7 or ...Re8 as the position requires. Look for activity against e4 and the queenside.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White can chase Nc5 with b4; make sure the knight has a useful retreat and the center remains supported.

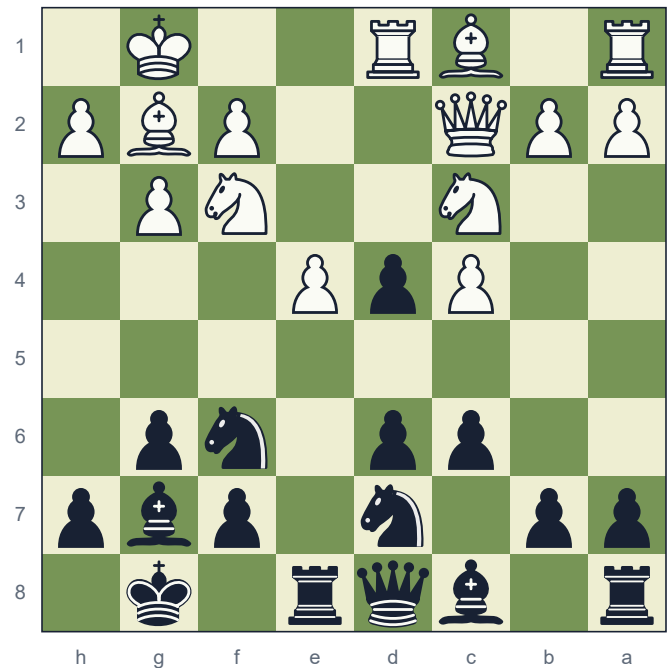
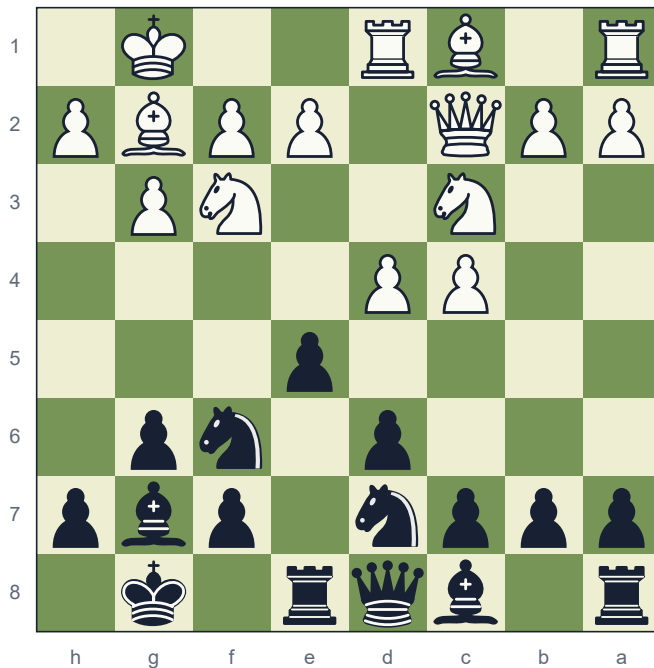
REMEMBER Use the c-pawn to create squares for pieces.

03 White waits with Qc2

STUDY LINE 14-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. Qc2 Re8 9. Rd1 c6 10. e4 exd4

Selected anchor ends with 9... c6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Qc2 supports central play and Rd1 increases pressure on d6. Black reinforces the center without deciding the pawn structure prematurely.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Complete development and watch e4 or d5. A later ...exd4 can activate pieces if White's recapture gives a good square.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The d6 pawn may become a target if you move its defenders. Do not abandon it while chasing a wing initiative.

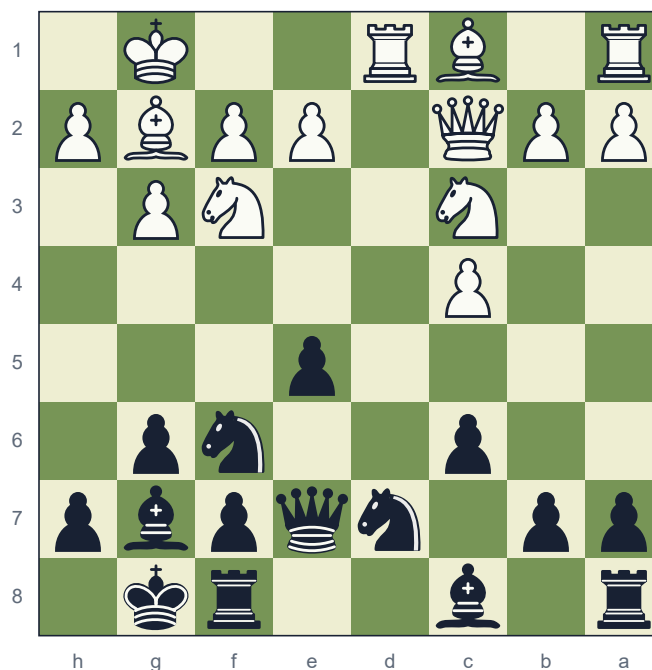
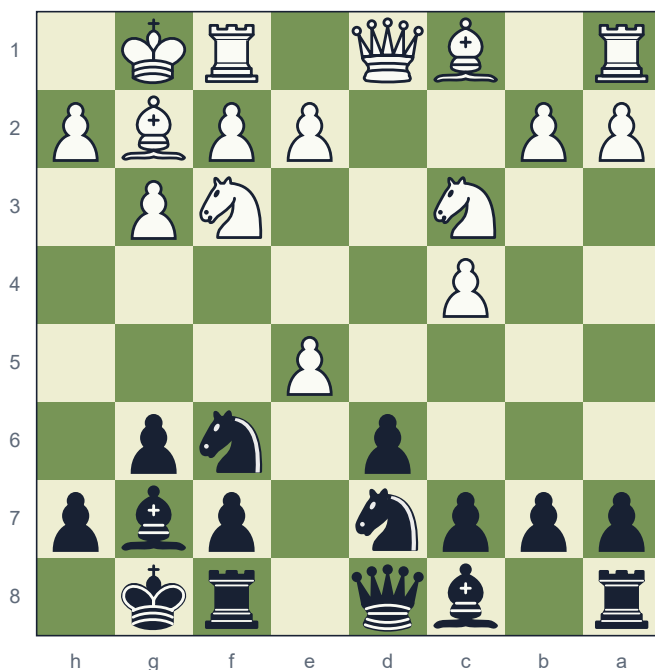
REMEMBER A flexible center demands flexible development.

04 White exchanges the d-pawn

STUDY LINE 14-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. dxe5 dxe5 9. Qc2 Qe7 10. Rd1 c6

Selected anchor ends with 8... dxe5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White gives up the d4 pawn for the e5 pawn, and Black's d-pawn recaptures on e5. The open d-file replaces the locked-chain battle.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the remaining pieces, contest d4, and use the d-file. Compare a queen trade with maintaining piece activity.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The g2 bishop can pressure b7 through an opened center. Verify every queenside pawn move.

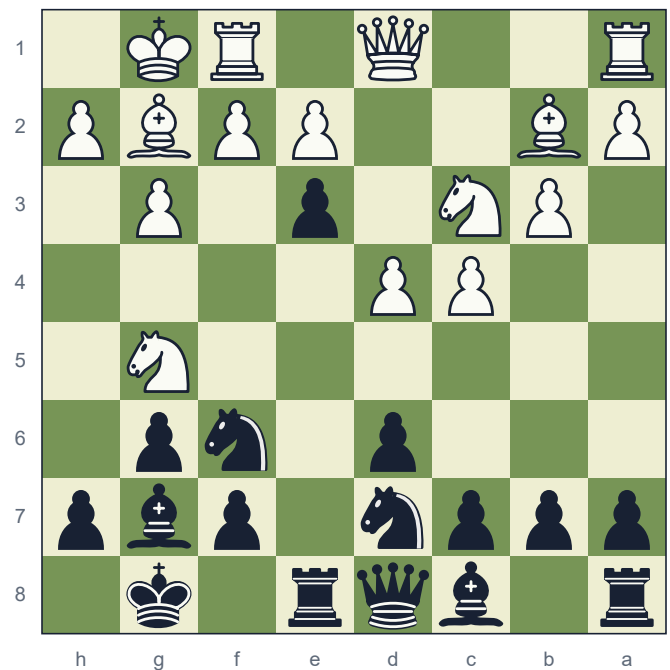
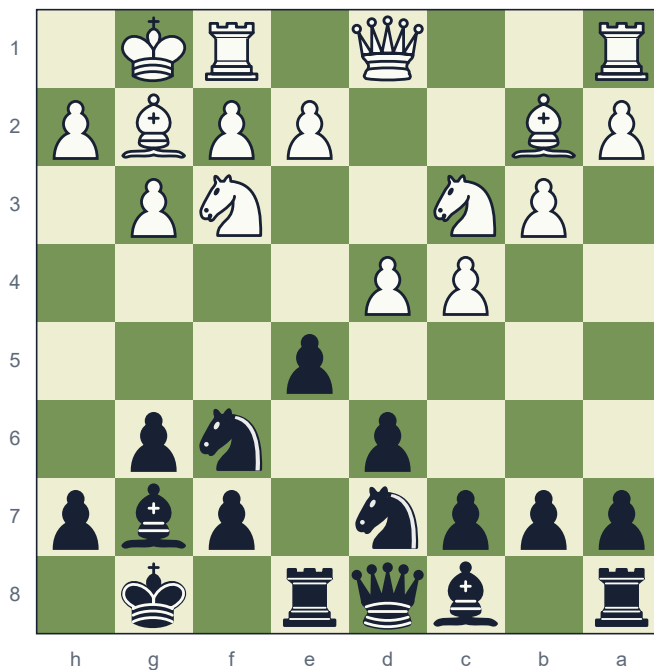
REMEMBER Open files and diagonals replace pawn-storm plans.

05 Double fianchetto with b3

STUDY LINE 14-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. b3 Re8 9. Bb2 e4 10. Ng5 e3

Selected anchor ends with 9... e4. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White develops both bishops but gives Black a chance to gain central space with tempo against Nf3.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

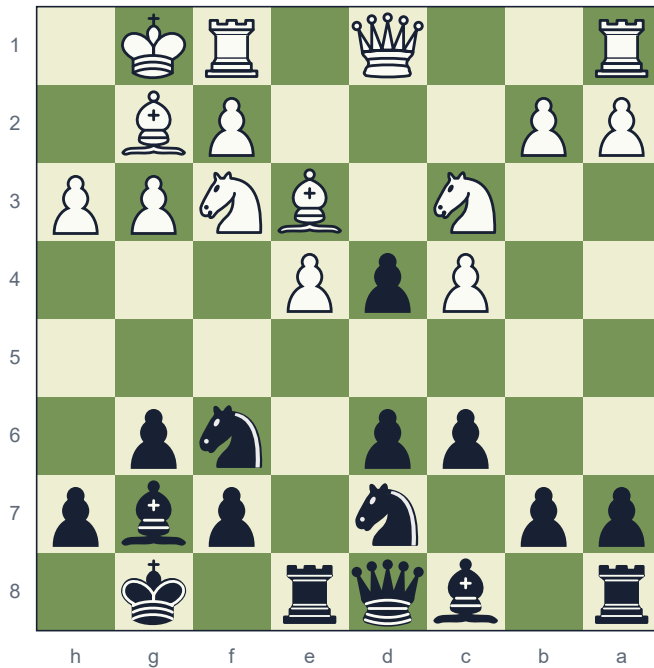
Support the advanced e4 pawn and finish development. White will attack that pawn or reroute the knight around it.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A central advance gains space but can become overextended. Count the defenders after exchanges.

REMEMBER Punish slow development with a supported central gain.

Review before your next game

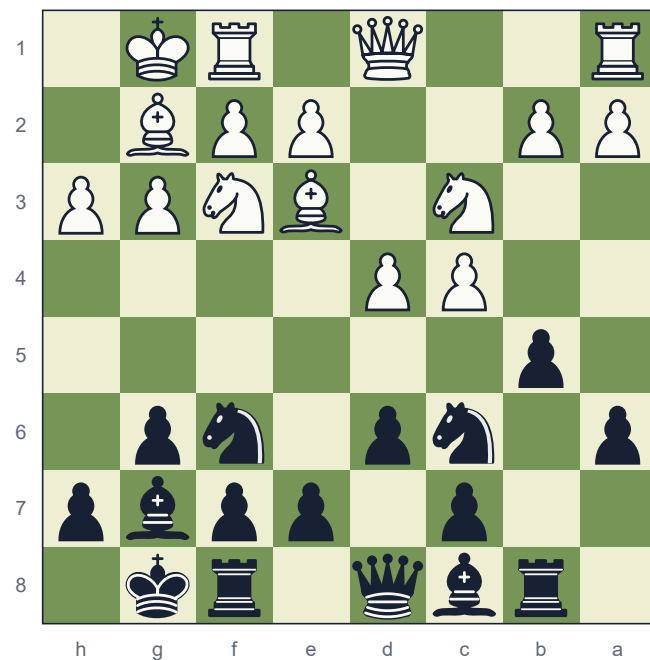


Optional Fianchetto expansion - the Panno

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nc6 7. Nc3 a6 8. h3 Rb8

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

This is an optional second repertoire. Learn Booklet 14 first. ...Nc6, ...a6 and ...Rb8 create queenside play, with a specific answer to d5.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

Black keeps the c-pawn flexible. White's g2 bishop controls the long diagonal, making queenside pawn openings tactically sensitive.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White can close with d5 and challenge the c6 knight, or play h3 and Be3 while preparing central play.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Keep optional and core repertoires separate.
2. Know the answer to d5 before choosing ...Nc6.
3. Check the g2-b7 diagonal.

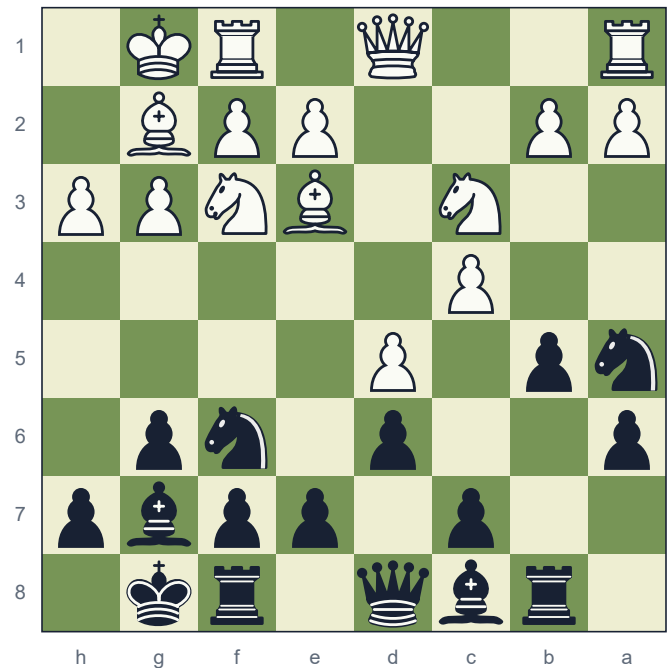
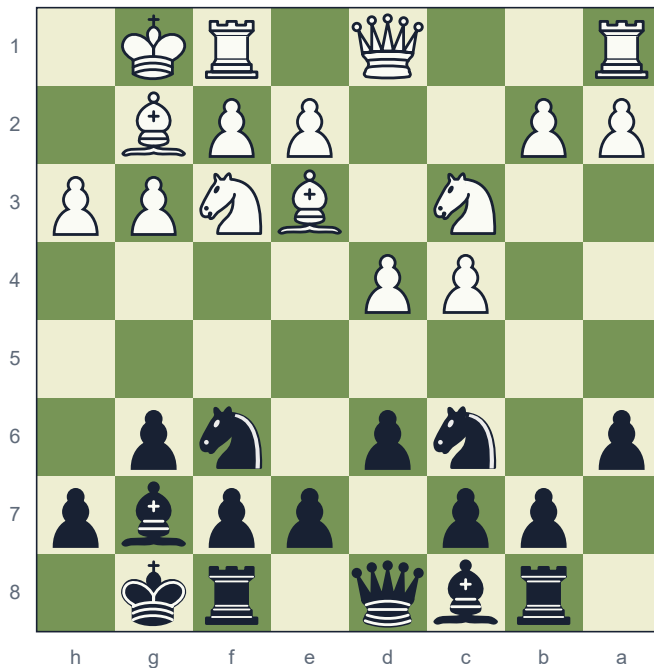
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 h3 and the queenside plan

STUDY LINE 15-01 | OPTIONAL REPERTOIRE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nc6 7. Nc3 a6 8. h3 Rb8 9. Be3 b5 10. d5 Na5

Selected anchor ends with 9... b5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...Rb8 and ...b5 seek space and an open b-file. h3 does not stop that queenside expansion.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Calculate cxb5 and d5 before continuing. White can strike in the center while your pawns move on the flank.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The g2 bishop makes b7 tactically important. Do not copy a Samisch Panno capture without checking the diagonal.

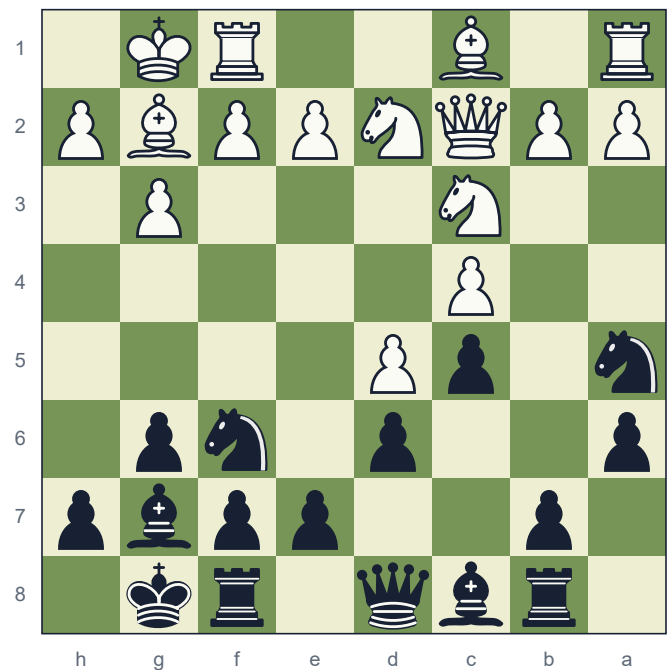
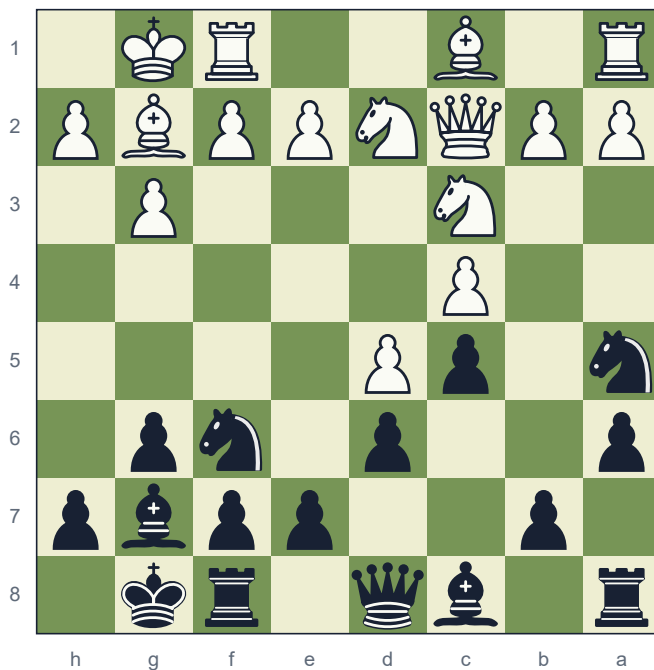
REMEMBER A shared name does not guarantee shared tactics.

02 d5 drives the knight to a5

STUDY LINE 15-02 | OPTIONAL REPERTOIRE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nc6 7. Nc3 a6 8. d5 Na5 9. Nd2 c5 10. Qc2 Rb8

The full printed sequence is the selected study anchor. Learn the decisions, not a forced script.



WHY THESE MOVES

...Na5 attacks c4. ...c5 secures a foothold and ...Rb8 prepares queenside expansion.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Support ...b5 if possible, or use ...e5 to stabilize the center. Keep the a5 knight from being trapped by b3 and a3.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A rim knight needs targets and return squares. Do not leave it stranded after the c4 pawn moves.

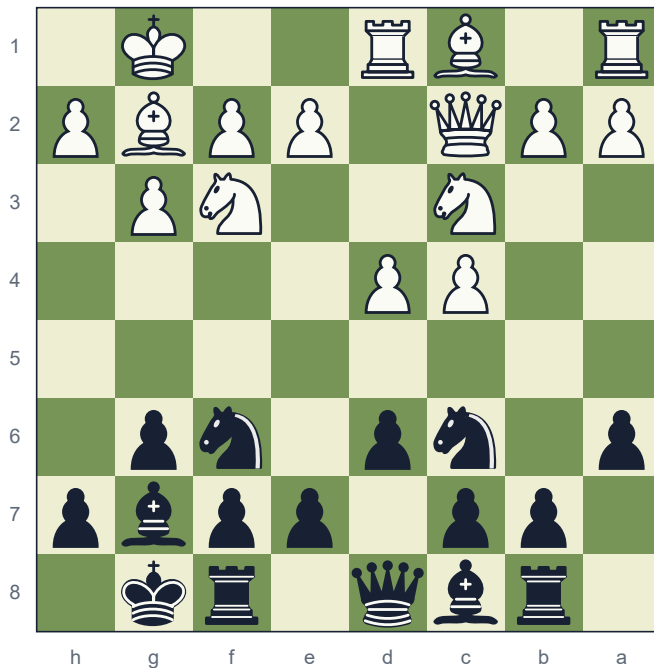
REMEMBER The knight on a5 works because c4 is a target.

03 White keeps tension with Qc2

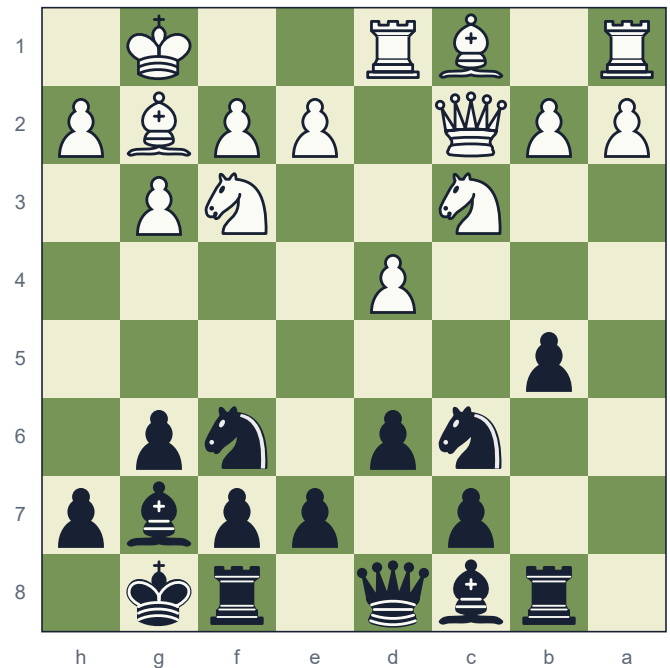
STUDY LINE 15-03 | OPTIONAL REPERTOIRE

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. g3 O-O 5. Bg2 d6 6. O-O Nc6 7. Nc3 a6 8. Qc2 Rb8 9. Rd1 b5 10. cxb5 axb5

Selected anchor ends with 9... b5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 9... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White aligns pieces with the central files while Black begins queenside expansion. The position stays flexible and tactical.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

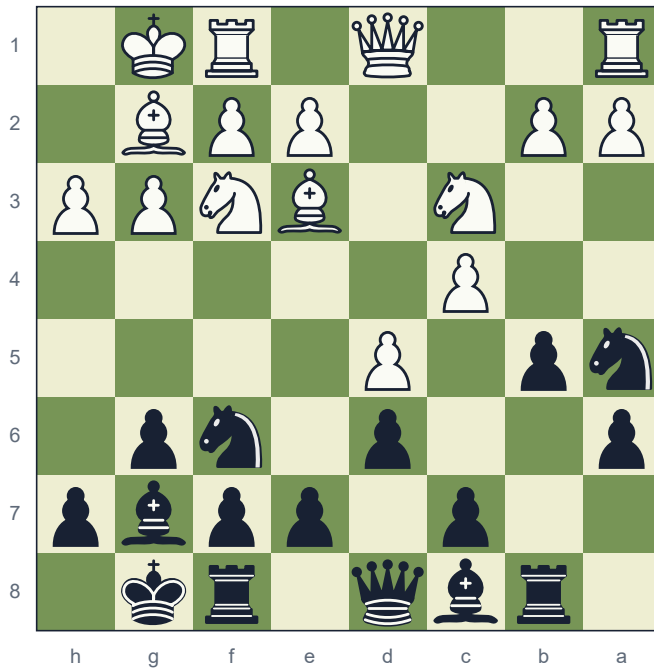
Analyze captures on b5 and the d5 advance. A rook on d1 makes d6 a potential target after central exchanges.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not open the b-file at the cost of a decisive central breakthrough.

REMEMBER A flank break must survive central replies.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

Black keeps the c-pawn flexible. White's g2 bishop controls the long diagonal, making queenside pawn openings tactically sensitive.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White can close with d5 and challenge the c6 knight, or play h3 and Be3 while preparing central play.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Calculate cxb5 and d5 before continuing. White can strike in the center while your pawns move on the flank.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

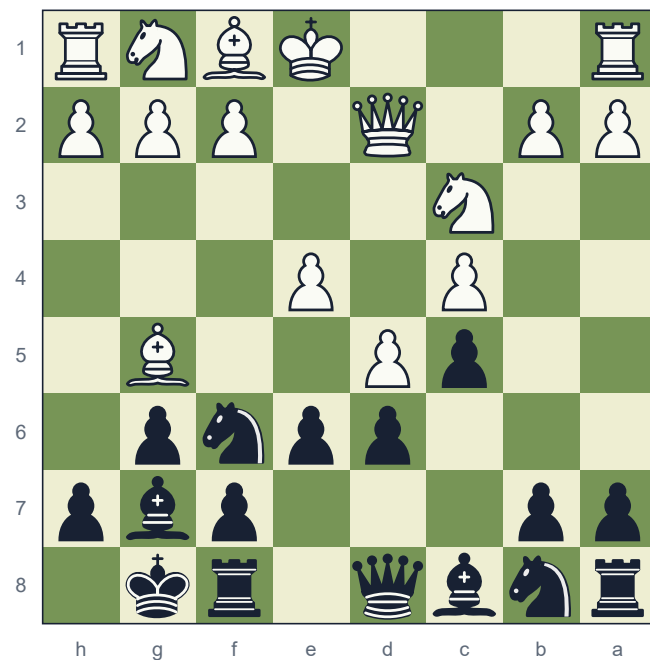
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Early bishops and unusual central systems

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Bg5 O-O 6. Qd2 c5 7. d5 e6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Distinguish early Bg5, Be3, Bd3, Nge2 and h4. Use a sound central challenge and develop against the actual threat. White has not promised to enter the Classical.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White often keeps the broad d4/e4 center but changes a bishop square or the g1 knight route. That can alter pins and the safety of ...e5.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Check the bishop's full diagonal.
2. Ask whether e4 is protected tactically.
3. Do not punish an unusual move without calculation.

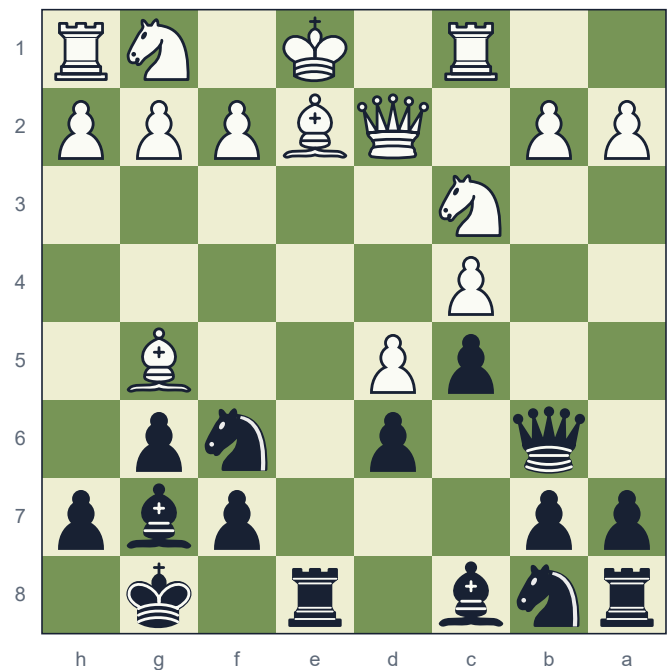
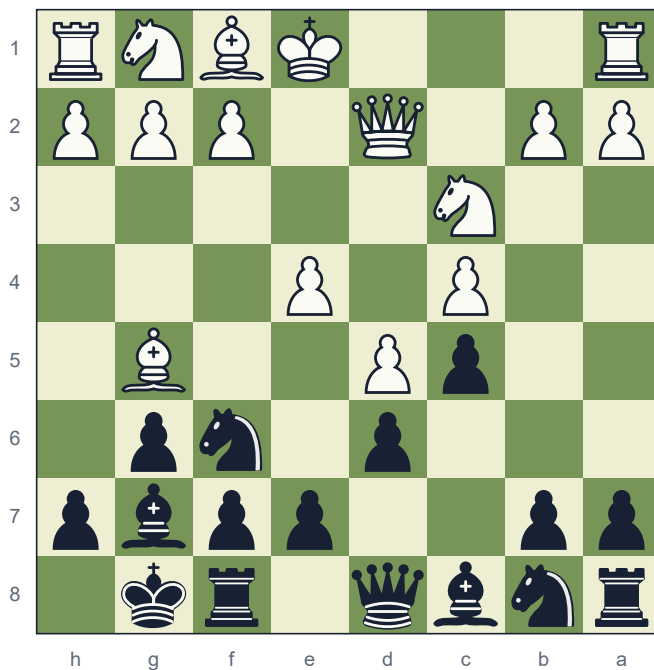
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Accelerated Averbakh: 5.Bg5

STUDY LINE 16-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Bg5 O-O 6. Qd2 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Be2 exd5 9. exd5 Qb6 10. Rc1 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 7... e6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White develops the bishop before Be2. ...c5 and ...e6 question the center while the king knight is still on g1.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop against the resulting pawn structure. Be alert to Bh6 and to the queen's role in supporting d4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A queen on d2 is not the same defender as a knight on f3. Check recaptures instead of forcing a familiar line.

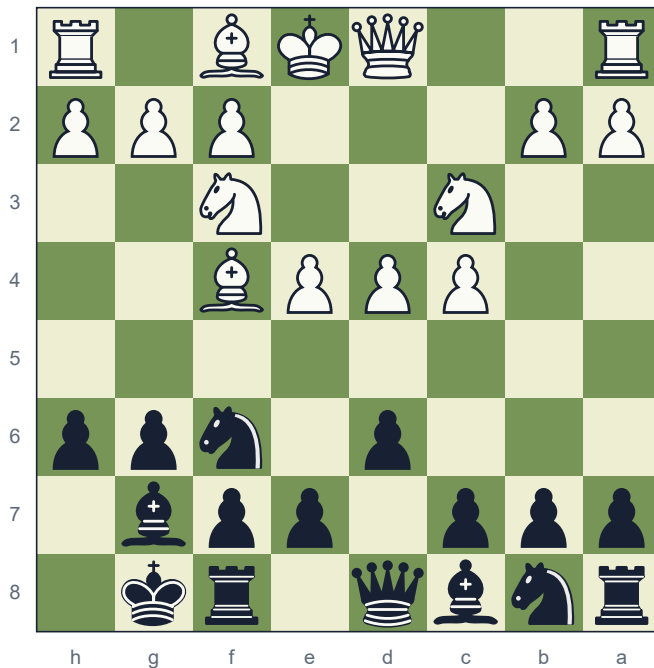
REMEMBER Early bishop development changes the tactical support.

02 Zinnowitz: Nf3 and Bg5

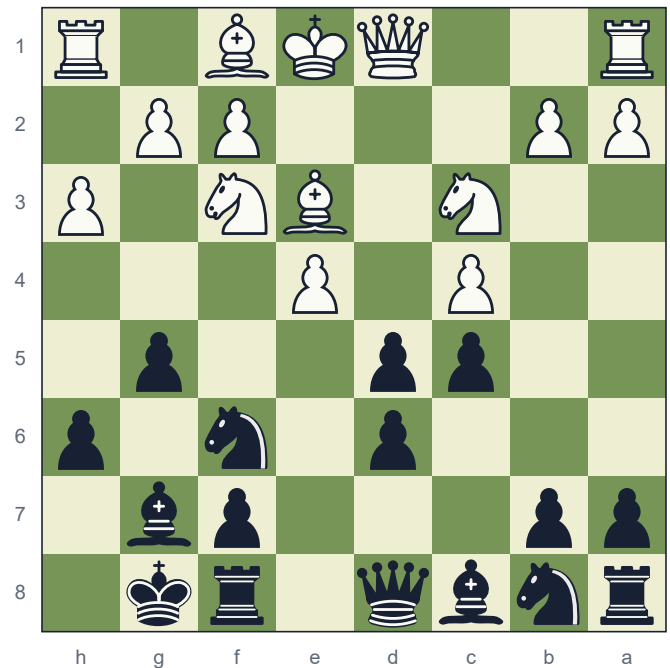
STUDY LINE 16-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Bg5 h6 7. Bf4 c5 8. d5 g5 9. Be3 e6 10. h3 exd5

Selected anchor ends with 7... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...h6 questions the bishop; after Bf4, ...c5 challenges d4. White has developed actively without choosing Be2.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use central exchanges to activate pieces. Keep d6 defended against the bishop on f4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The f4 bishop attacks d6. Moving Nf6 or the queen can change whether that pawn can be captured.

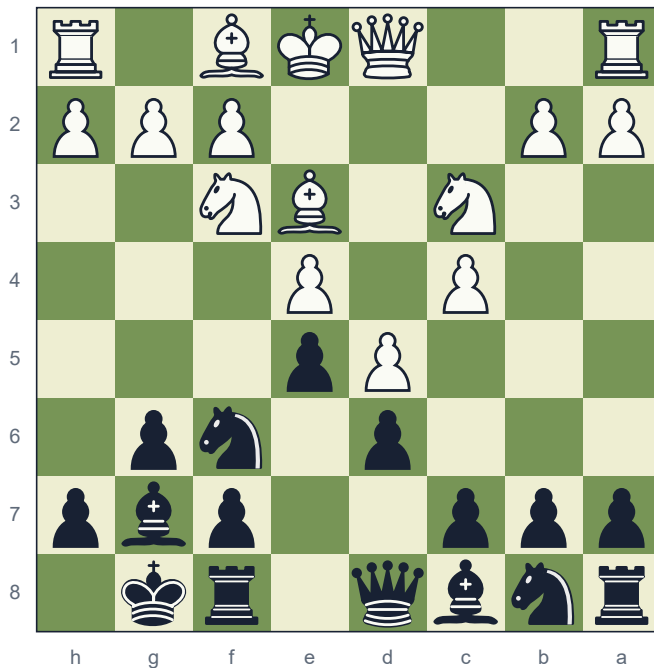
REMEMBER An active bishop creates a real target.

03 Larsen system: Nf3 and Be3

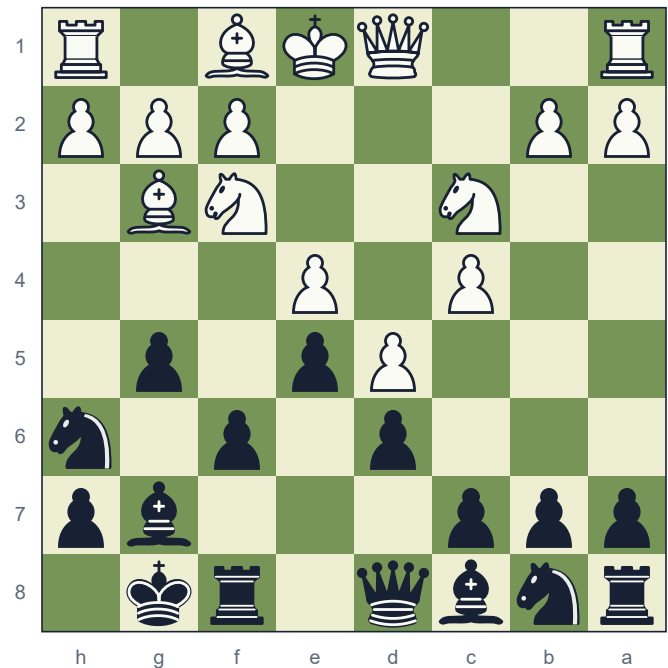
STUDY LINE 16-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be3 e5 7. d5 Ng4 8. Bg5 f6 9. Bh4 g5 10. Bg3 Nh6

Selected anchor ends with 7... Ng4. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Black contests d4 with ...e5. After d5, ...Ng4 questions the bishop before White gets a comfortable closed center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the b8 knight and complete a coordinated plan. If the bishop retreats, improve the knight rather than leaving it exposed.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

White has not spent a tempo on Be2. The extra flexibility can matter in a kingside attack.

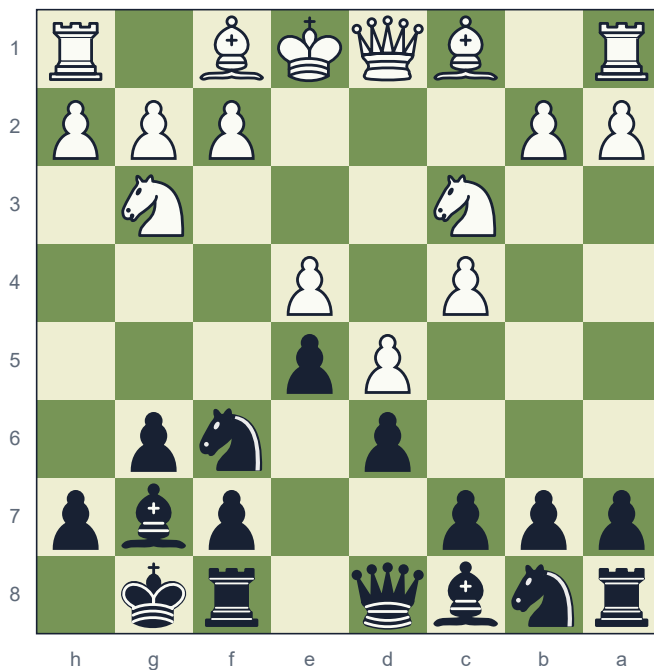
REMEMBER Gain a useful tempo, then develop.

04 Kramer system: 5.Nge2

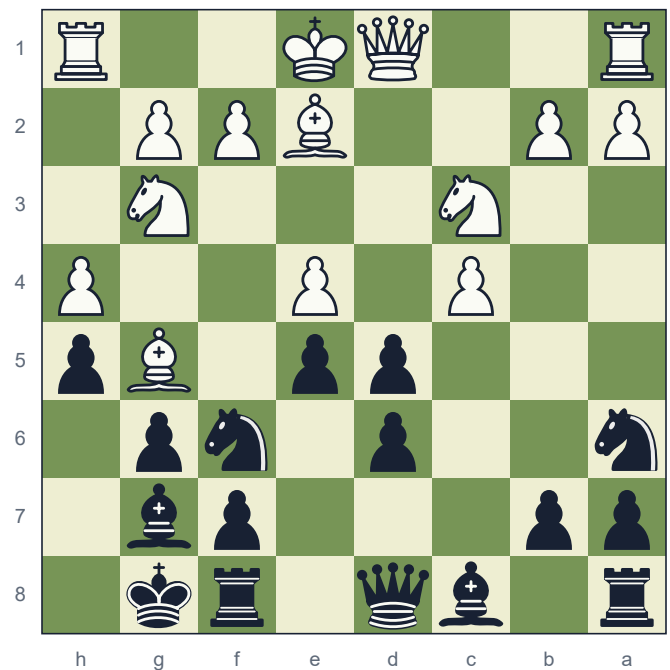
STUDY LINE 16-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Nge2 O-O 6. Ng3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. h4 h5 9. Bg5 c6 10. Be2 cxd5

Selected anchor ends with 7... Na6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White sends the knight toward g3 to support e4 and future kingside play. Black closes the center only after challenging it and develops toward c5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Watch f4 and h4. Use ...Nc5, ...c6 or a prepared ...f5 according to White's king choice.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The knight on g3 controls f5 and h5. A standard pawn attack may run into additional defenders.

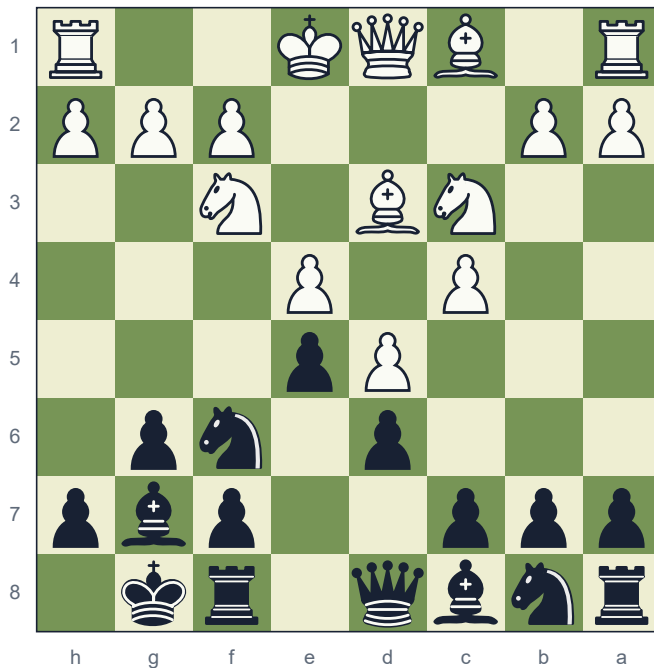
REMEMBER Count the new defenders on the kingside.

05 Bd3: protect e4 with the bishop

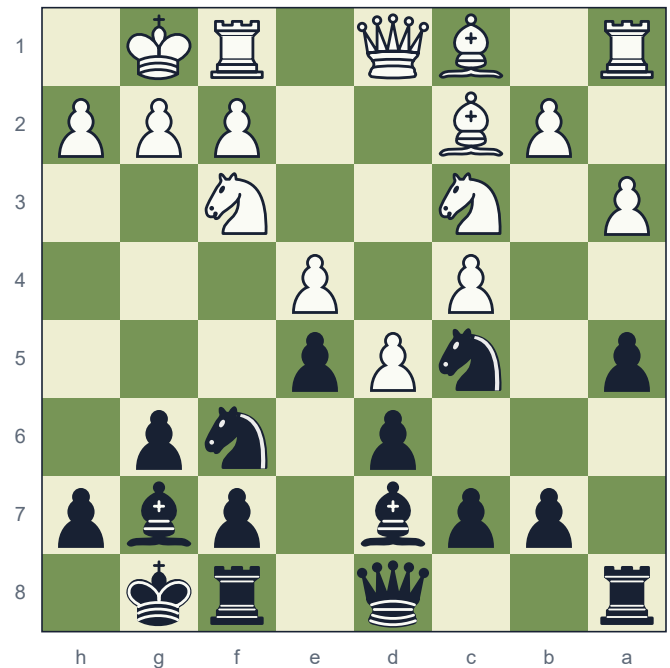
STUDY LINE 16-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Bd3 O-O 6. Nf3 e5 7. d5 Na6 8. a3 Nc5 9. Bc2 a5 10. O-O Bd7

Selected anchor ends with 7... Na6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Bd3 supports e4 but can become a target after central pawn advances. Black develops the queenside knight toward c5.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Improve the c8 bishop and keep ...Nc5 or ...Nh5 ideas in mind when they gain time on a bishop.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A bishop on d3 can point at h7 after the center opens. Do not open lines around your king carelessly.

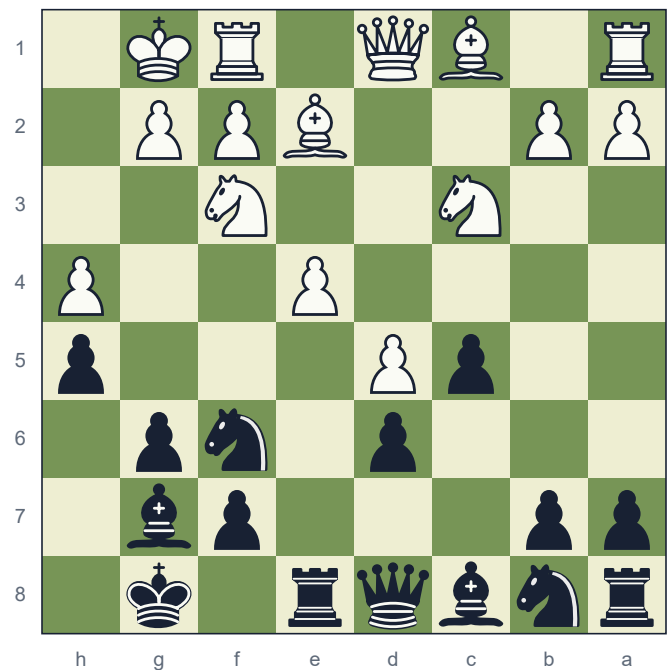
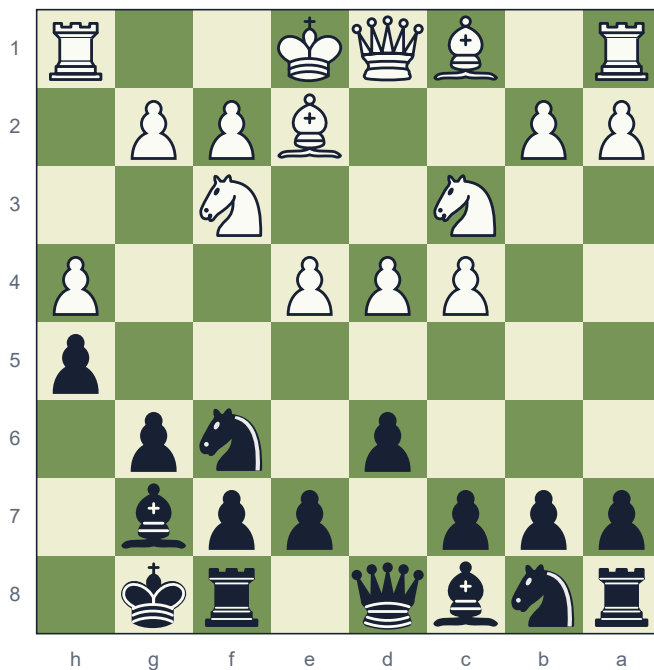
REMEMBER Bishop placement matters when pawn lines open.

06 An early h4 before development

STUDY LINE 16-06

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. h4 h5 6. Nf3 O-O 7. Be2 c5 8. d5 e6 9. O-O exd5 10. cxd5 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 7... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

...h5 blocks the immediate h4-h5 lever. Black then develops and challenges d4 rather than answering every pawn move with another pawn.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Meet g4 as a new concrete threat. Decide central captures by piece activity and king safety.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The h5 pawn can be undermined by g4. It is a restraint and a target at the same time.

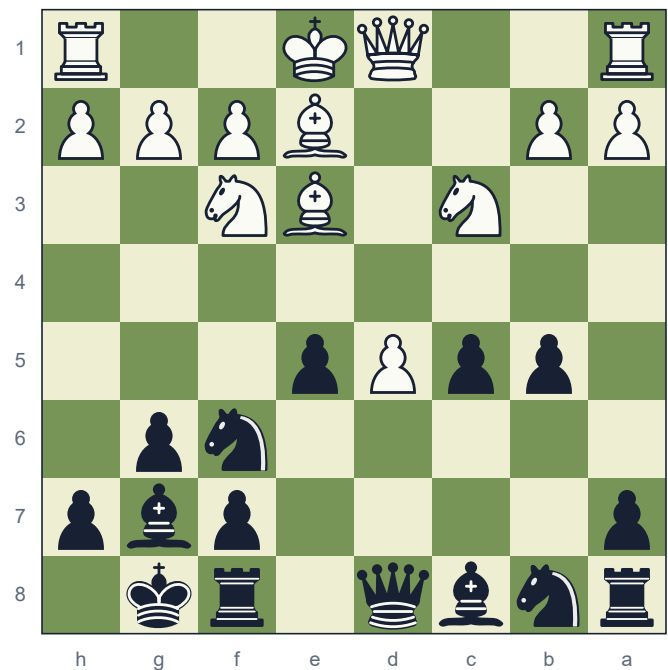
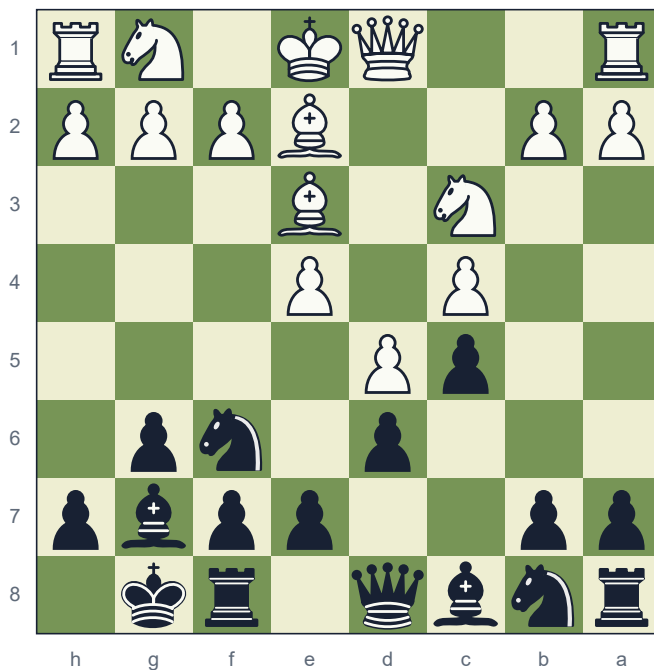
REMEMBER Block a lever, then fight for the center.

07 Semi-Averbakh: Be2 and Be3 without Nf3

STUDY LINE 16-07

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. Be2 O-O 6. Be3 c5 7. d5 e6 8. Nf3 exd5 9. cxd5 b5 10. e5 dxe5

Selected anchor ends with 7... e6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White develops both bishops while keeping the g1 knight flexible. ...c5 and ...e6 challenge the center before White can choose a comfortable attacking formation.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Compare recaptures on d5 and develop against the resulting Benoni structure. White may choose Nf3, Nge2, f3 or f4, so keep those changes separate.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

This is not the Gligoric position: White has not put the knight on f3. Do not import its ...Ng4 sequence automatically.

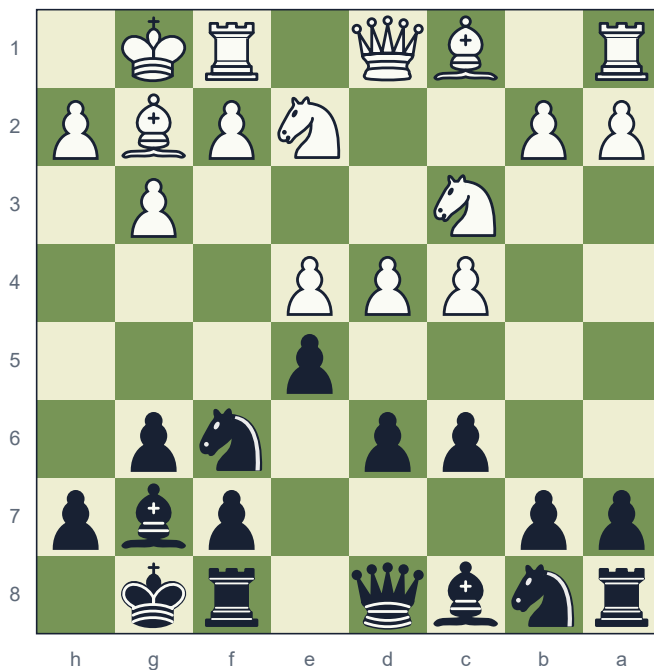
REMEMBER An undeveloped knight can preserve several different plans.

08 Delayed Fianchetto with Nge2

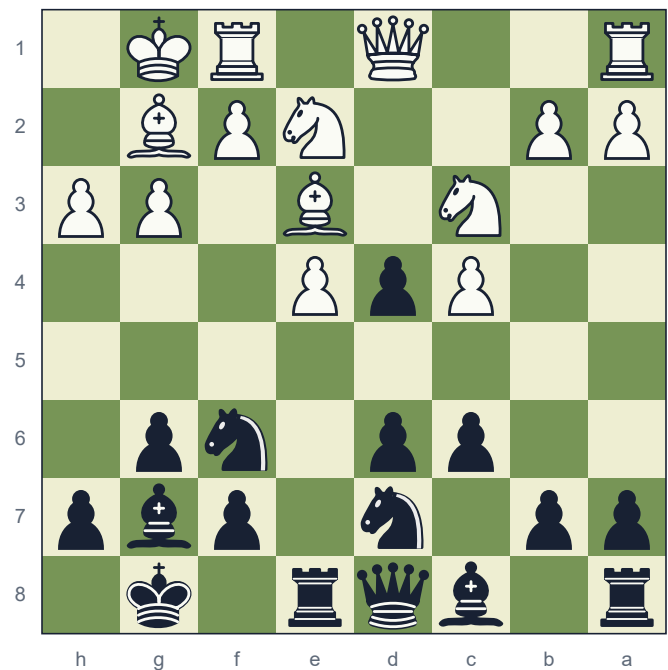
STUDY LINE 16-08

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. e4 d6 5. g3 O-O 6. Bg2 e5 7. Nge2 c6 8. O-O Nbd7 9. h3 Re8 10. Be3 exd4

Selected anchor ends with 8... Nbd7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 8... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White combines the broad e4 center with a fianchetto and develops the king knight to e2. Black reinforces the center with ...c6 and ...Nbd7.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...Re8 and compare ...exd4 or a supported ...d5. White may play f4 more easily because Nf3 is absent.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The knight on e2 does not defend e5 and g5 like Nf3, but it leaves the f-pawn free. Recalculate any central advance or kingside break.

REMEMBER A different knight route changes the pawn-break timing.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White often keeps the broad d4/e4 center but changes a bishop square or the g1 knight route. That can alter pins and the safety of ...e5.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop against the resulting pawn structure. Be alert to Bh6 and to the queen's role in supporting d4.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

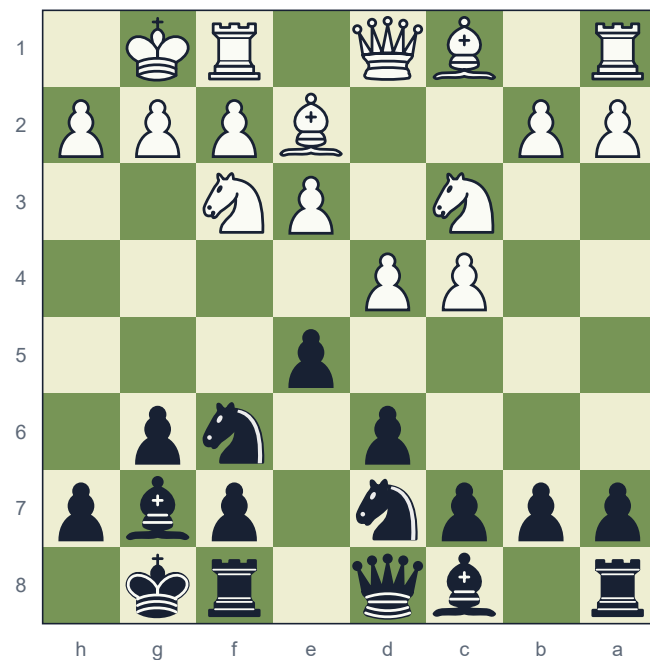
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

White omits e4 - e3 and quiet c4 systems

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Be2 Nbd7 7. O-O e5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Develop with ...d6 and ...Nbd7, then challenge with ...e5. White's smaller center allows different piece play and may transpose to e4 systems later.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

White has d4/e3 instead of d4/e4. The g7 bishop may see more of the center, and Black can gain central space.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Check whether e4 has actually been played.
2. Use central space without overextending.
3. Reclassify the position after e4.

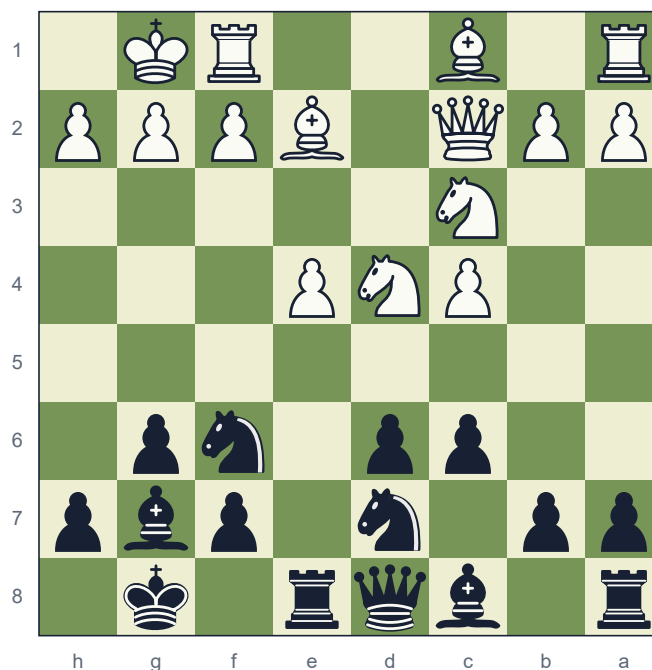
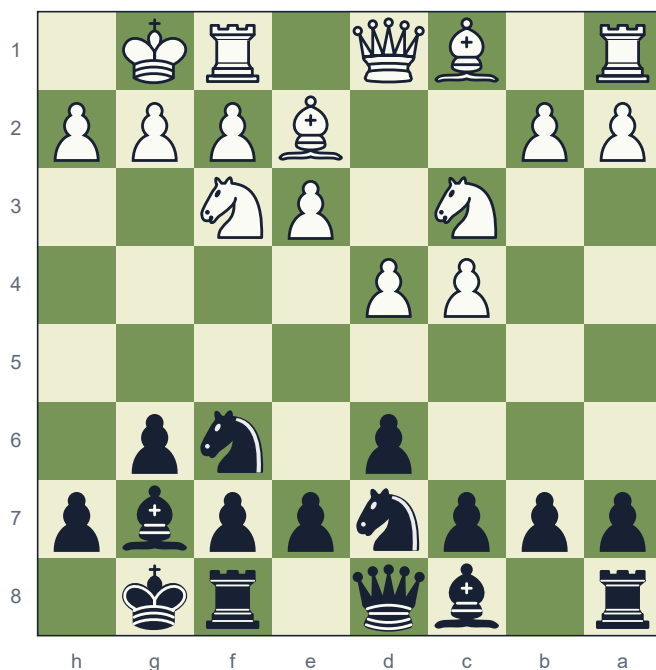
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Be2 and central development

STUDY LINE 17-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Be2 Nbd7 7. O-O e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 c6 10. Qc2 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 7... e5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Black completes development and establishes a central pawn contact. White has not yet claimed e4.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Compare ...Re8 and ...c6, and watch dxe5 or d5. Choose a plan from the new center after White resolves the tension.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not assume d5 creates the same strong White chain; e3 rather than e4 changes central control.

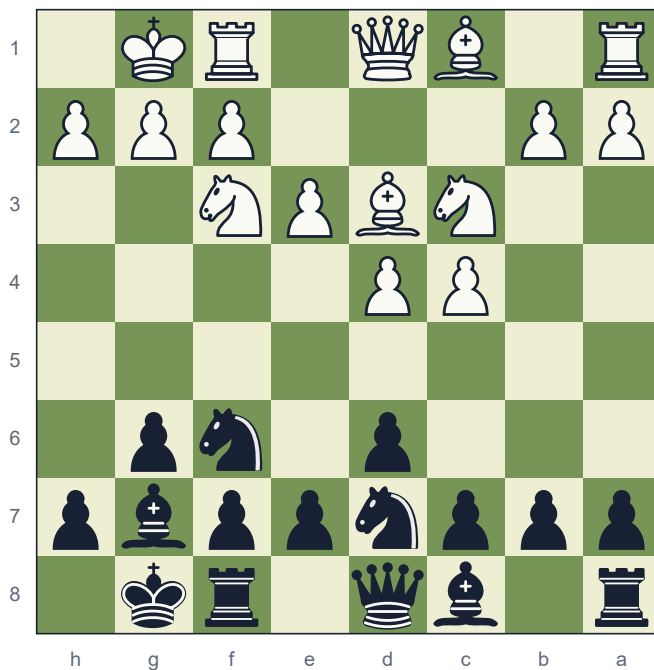
REMEMBER A smaller center gives Black more room to choose.

02 Bd3 before castling

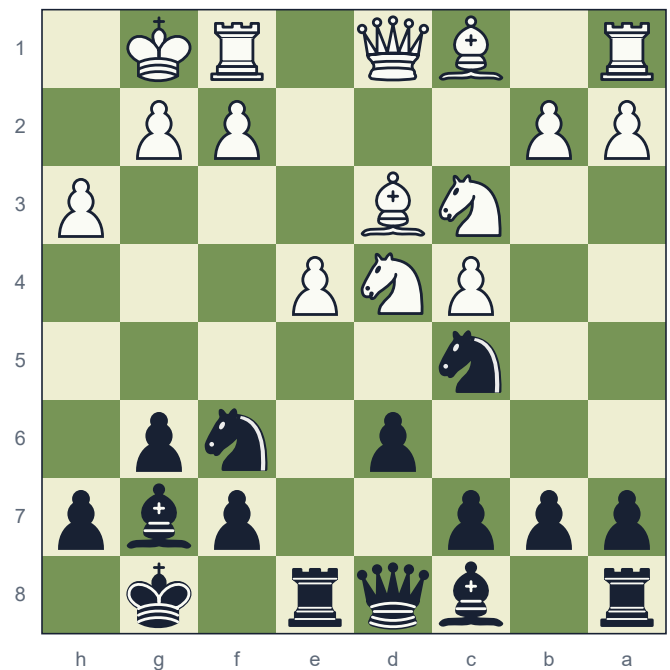
STUDY LINE 17-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Bd3 Nbd7 7. O-O e5 8. h3 Re8 9. e4 exd4 10. Nxd4 Nc5

Selected anchor ends with 7... e5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Bd3 supports a later e4 but can also face a tempo-gaining ...e4 if White neglects the center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Improve the rooks and calculate the central advance before playing it. Maintain pressure on d4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A pawn fork on e4 works only if the pawn can survive its defenders and captures.

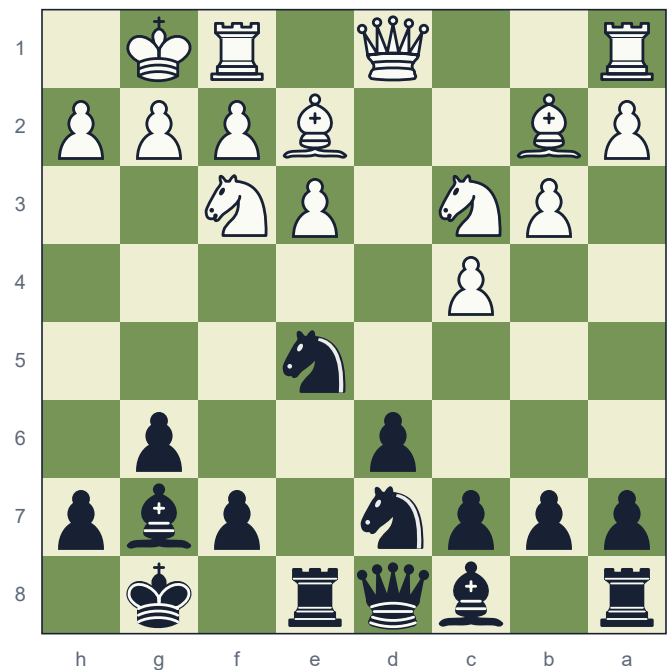
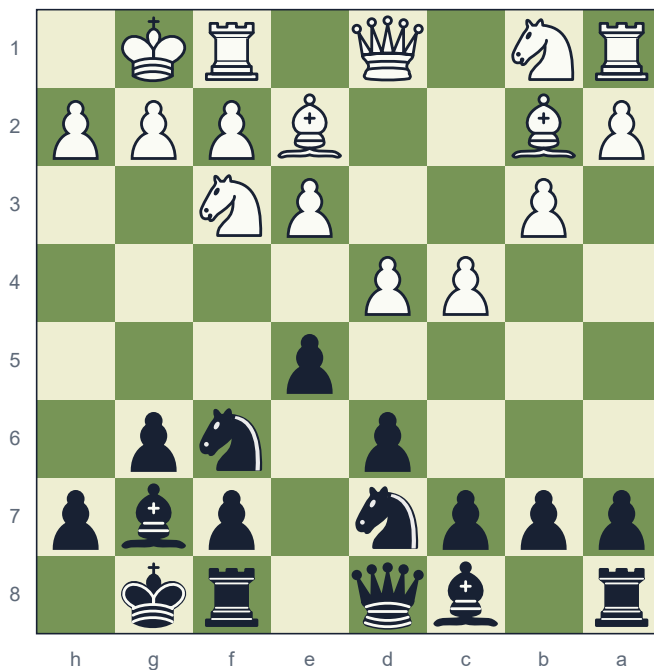
REMEMBER A familiar bishop square can be a tactical target.

03 Double fianchetto without e4

STUDY LINE 17-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nf3 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O Nbd7 7. b3 e5 8. Bb2 Re8 9. dxe5 Ng4 10. Nc3 Ngxe5

Selected anchor ends with 8... Re8. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White develops both bishops behind a compact center. Black gains space and reinforces e5 with the rook.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare a useful central break or piece maneuver. Keep the long diagonal from b2 to g7 in view.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

An opening of the e-file or long diagonal can change king safety quickly.

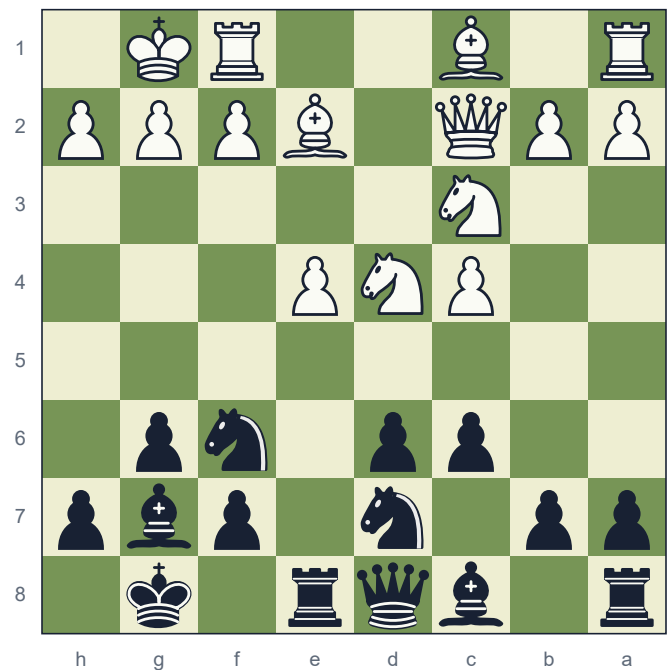
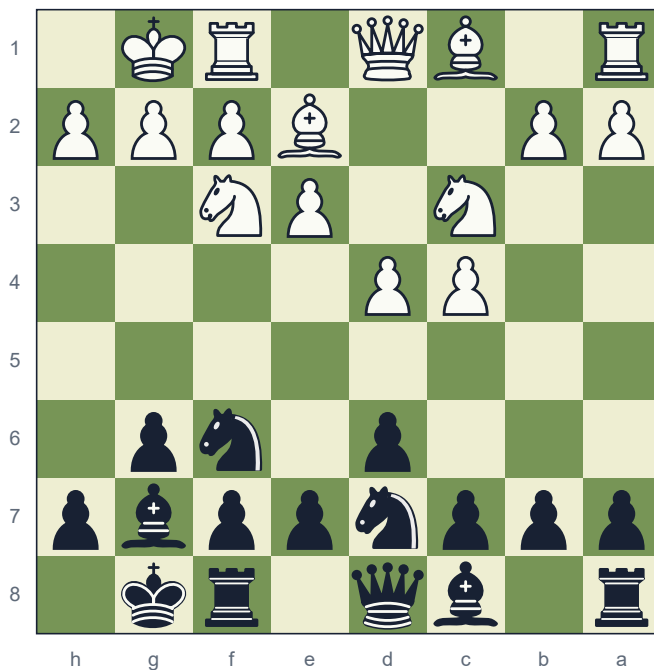
REMEMBER Central space and long diagonals must be evaluated together.

04 White adds e4 later

STUDY LINE 17-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. Nc3 Bg7 4. Nf3 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Be2 Nbd7 7. O-O e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 c6 10. Qc2 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 8. e4. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White spends two moves reaching e4, but the resulting center is familiar. Black's b8 knight is on d7, not c6.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

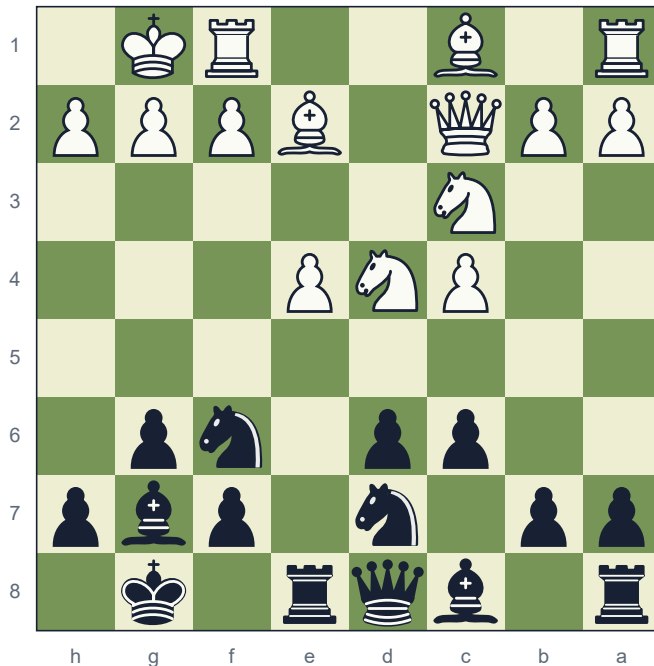
Use ...Re8 or ...c6 as appropriate and decide how to meet d5. Do not invent a c6-knight retreat in a position without that knight.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A transposition must include the tempo count and knight placement.

REMEMBER Check every piece before declaring a transposition.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

White has d4/e3 instead of d4/e4. The g7 bishop may see more of the center, and Black can gain central space.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Compare ...Re8 and ...c6, and watch dxe5 or d5. Choose a plan from the new center after White resolves the tension.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

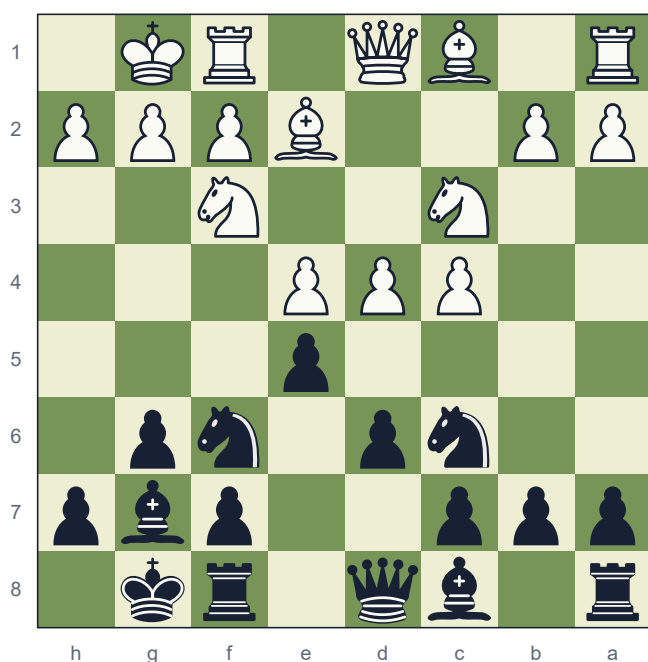
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

English and Reti move orders

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 g6 3. e4 d6 4. d4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Aim for a King's Indian if White supplies d4 and e4. If White avoids d4, use a separate central plan; a reversed opening is not the same position.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

Without a white pawn on d4, ...e5 can gain space without inviting the usual d5 chain. English structures often revolve around d4 and d5 squares.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may fianchetto, play a Botvinnik c4/d3/e4 setup, or transpose late to a standard King's Indian.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Ask whether d4 has been played.
2. Treat the English as a real opening, not a delayed KID.
3. Do not play a race against a pawn chain that does not exist.

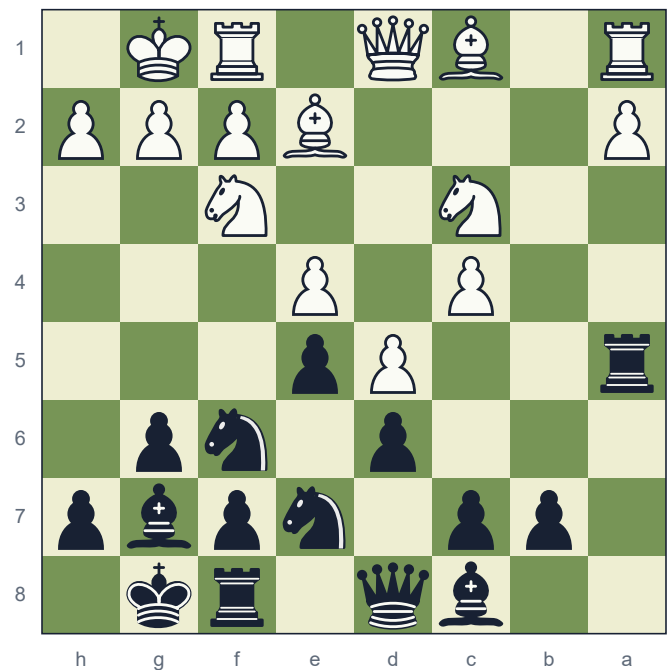
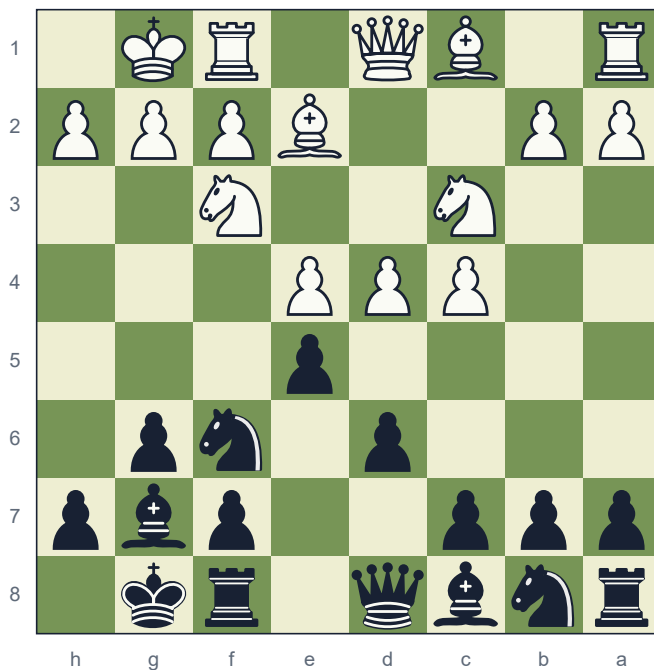
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 English transposes to the Classical

STUDY LINE 18-01

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 g6 3. e4 d6 4. d4 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Be2 e5 7. O-O Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 a5 10. bxa5 Rxa5

Selected anchor ends with 7... Nc6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Once White plays d4, the familiar broad center appears. The moves reach the Classical through an English start.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use the main gateway: d5, dxe5 or continued tension. Follow Booklets 02-08 according to White's choice.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Before d4, the center was different. Do not assume the transposition happens on move one.

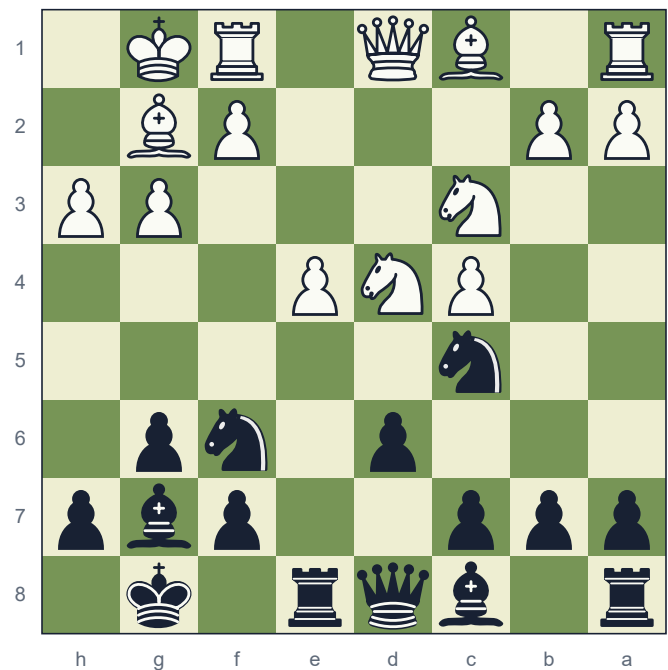
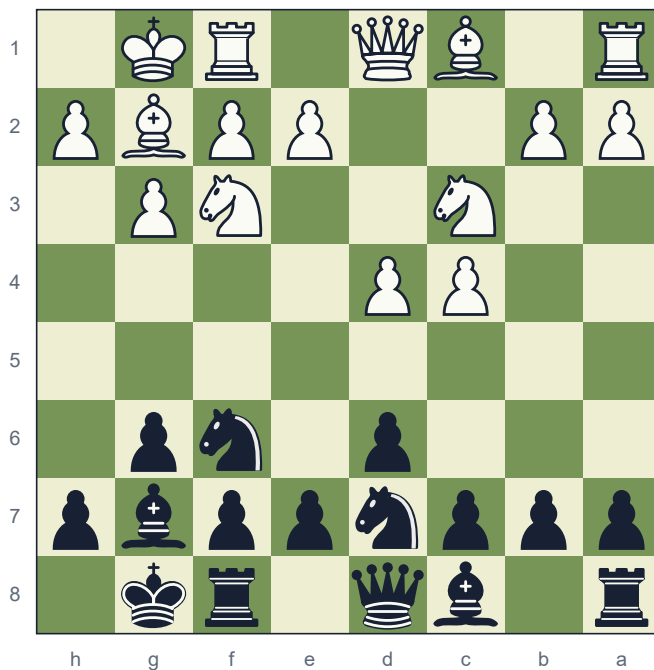
REMEMBER A real transposition is permission to reuse your study.

02 Reti transposes to the Fianchetto

STUDY LINE 18-02

1. Nf3 Nf6 2. c4 g6 3. g3 Bg7 4. Bg2 O-O 5. O-O d6 6. d4 Nbd7 7. Nc3 e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 Nc5 10. h3 Re8

Selected anchor ends with 7... e5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White reaches a standard Fianchetto setup once d4 is played. Black's ...Nbd7 repertoire remains consistent.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use Booklet 14: respond to e4, d5 or central exchanges. Keep the g2 bishop's diagonal central to the plan.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not start ...f5 just because both kings have castled.

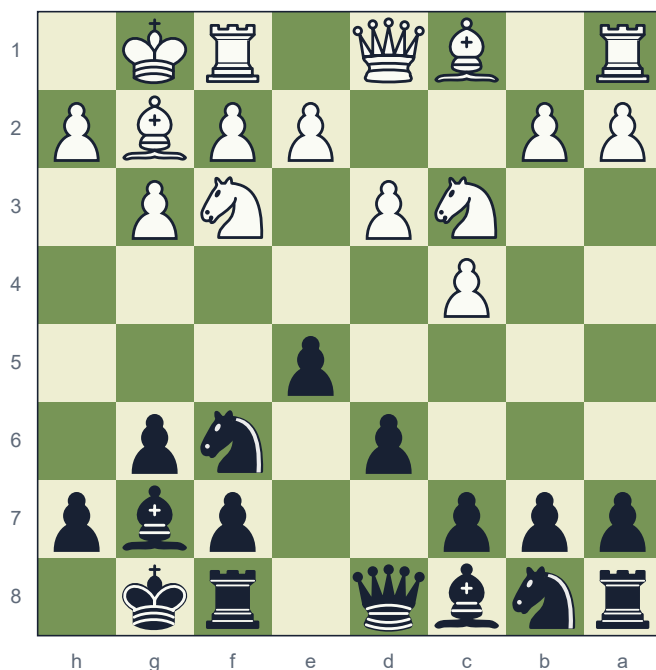
REMEMBER Fianchetto positions need their own central plan.

03 English without d4

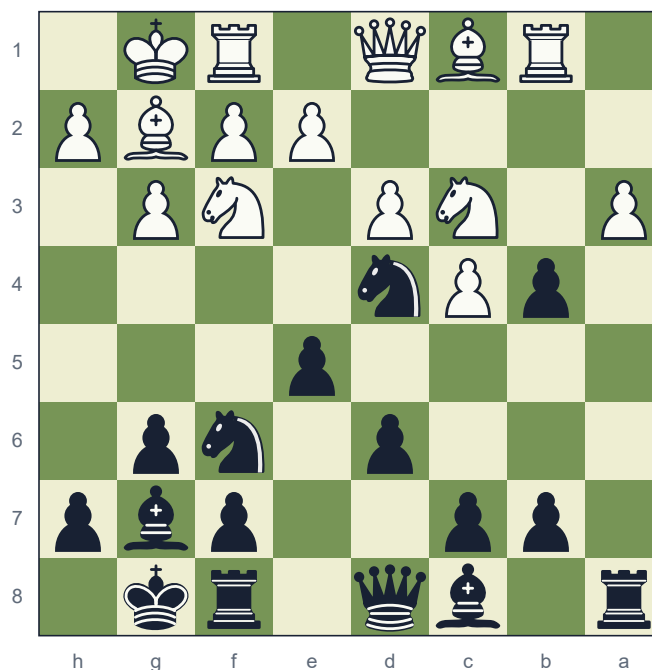
STUDY LINE 18-03

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 g6 3. g3 Bg7 4. Bg2 O-O 5. Nf3 d6 6. O-O e5 7. d3 Nc6 8. Rb1 a5 9. a3 Nd4 10. b4 axb4

Selected anchor ends with 7... Nc6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White keeps d3. Black occupies e5 and develops toward the central squares rather than waiting for a d5 advance that is not available yet.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Prepare ...Re8, ...Be6 or a supported ...d5. White may play Rb1 and b4 or challenge with d4 later.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The normal KID wing race is absent. ...f5 may be possible later, but it is not the default goal.

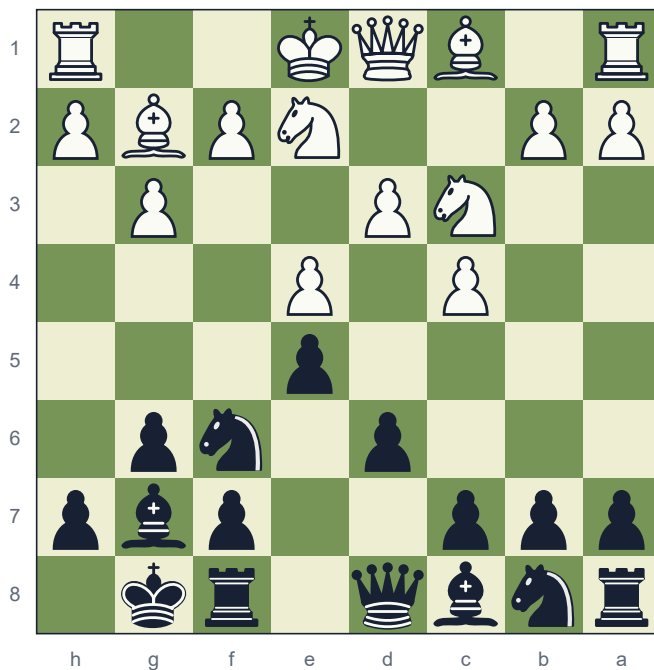
REMEMBER No d4 means a different central battle.

04 Botvinnik-style English center

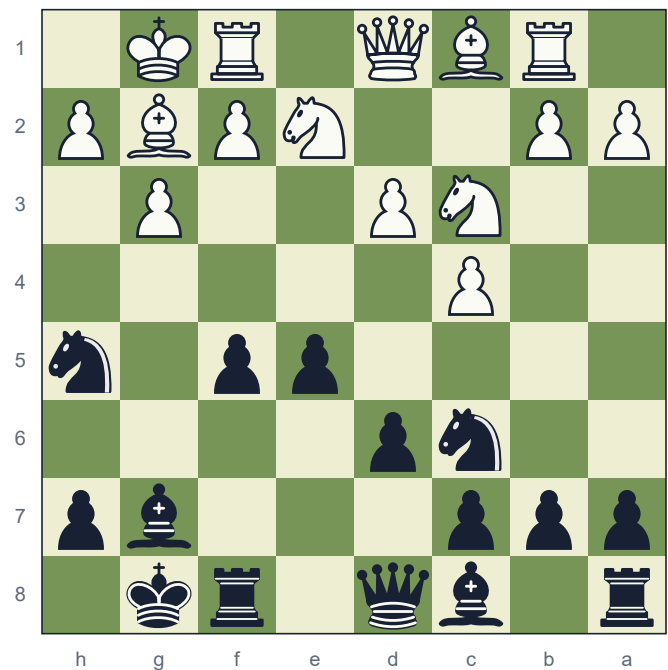
STUDY LINE 18-04

1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 g6 3. e4 d6 4. g3 Bg7 5. Bg2 O-O 6. Nge2 e5 7. d3 Nc6 8. O-O Nh5 9. Rb1 f5 10. exf5 gxf5

Selected anchor ends with 7... Nc6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White establishes c4/d3/e4 and keeps the king knight on e2. Black develops behind an e5 foothold.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

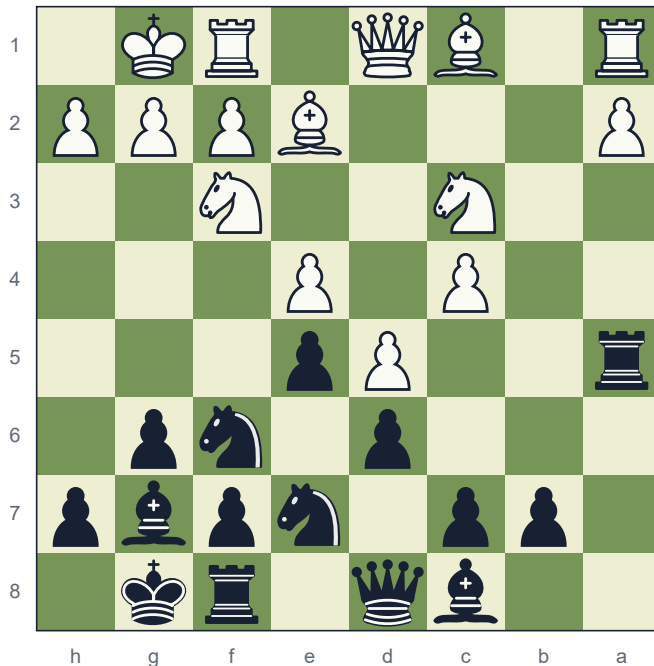
Compare ...Be6, ...Qd7 and a timely ...Nd4. White can seek f4 or b4, so keep both wings in view.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A knight on d4 may be exchanged; evaluate the recapturing pawn structure before jumping in.

REMEMBER Use outposts in relation to the pawn recapture.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

Without a white pawn on d4, ...e5 can gain space without inviting the usual d5 chain. English structures often revolve around d4 and d5 squares.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may fianchetto, play a Botvinnik c4/d3/e4 setup, or transpose late to a standard King's Indian.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Use the main gateway: d5, dxe5 or continued tension. Follow Booklets 02-08 according to White's choice.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

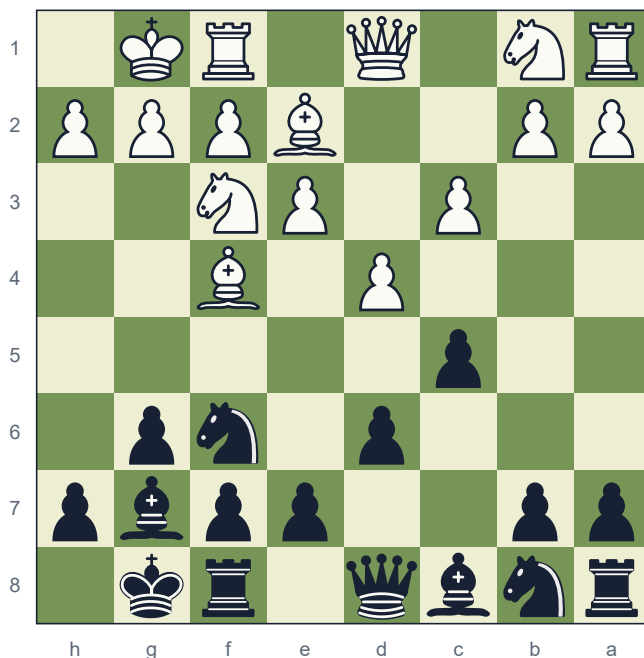
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

London Torre and Colle - when White omits c4

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O c5 7. c3

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use the fianchetto when it fits, but develop a central answer with ...d6 and ...c5. These are companion defenses, not King's Indian main lines.



Main study anchor - Black to move

READ THE CENTER

Without c4 and e4 together, White has a smaller center and different bishop activity. The dark-squared bishop may develop outside the pawn chain.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Identify the early bishop's target.
2. Challenge d4 before White gets e4 for free.
3. Do not assume a system player is making no threats.

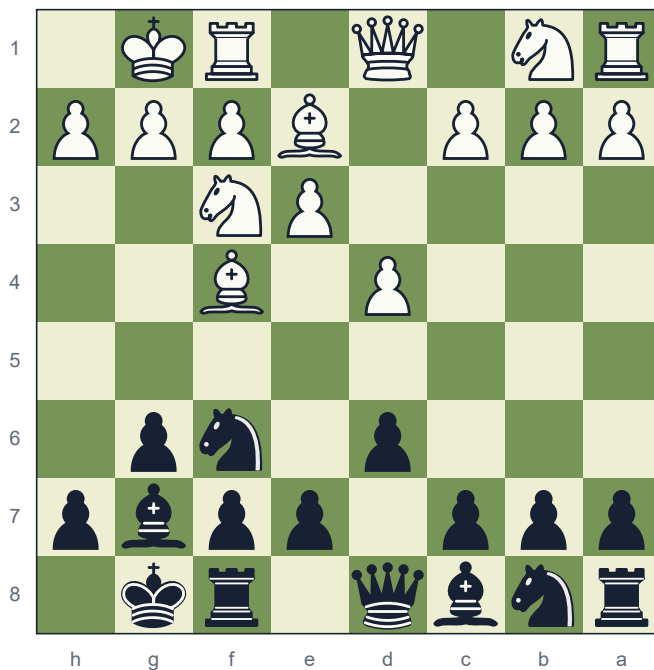
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 London with Nf3 and Bf4

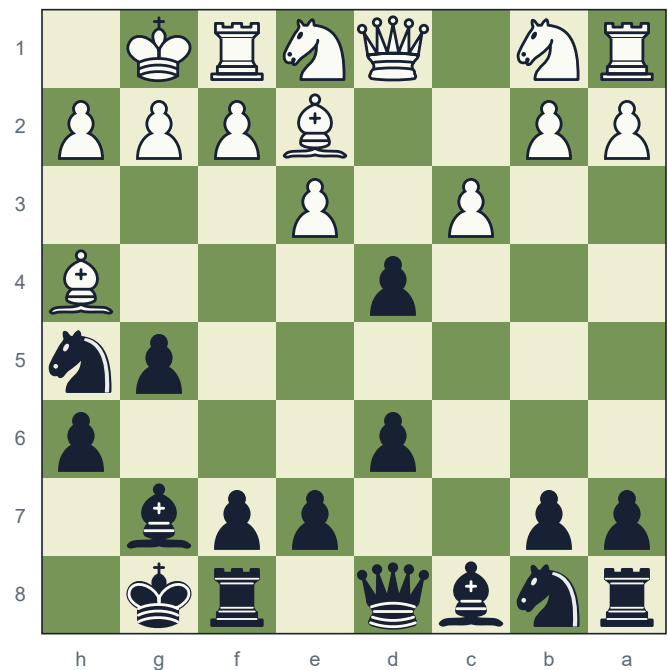
STUDY LINE 19-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bf4 Bg7 4. e3 O-O 5. Be2 d6 6. O-O c5 7. c3 Nh5 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 g5 10. Ne1 cxd4

Selected anchor ends with 7. c3. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 6... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

The bishop develops outside the pawn chain. ...c5 challenges d4 before White can build an unopposed center.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...Nc6 and pressure d4. Keep d6 defended against Bf4 and look for an active queen square.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Capturing on d4 can help White develop with cxd4 or exd4. Compare the resulting structure before exchanging.

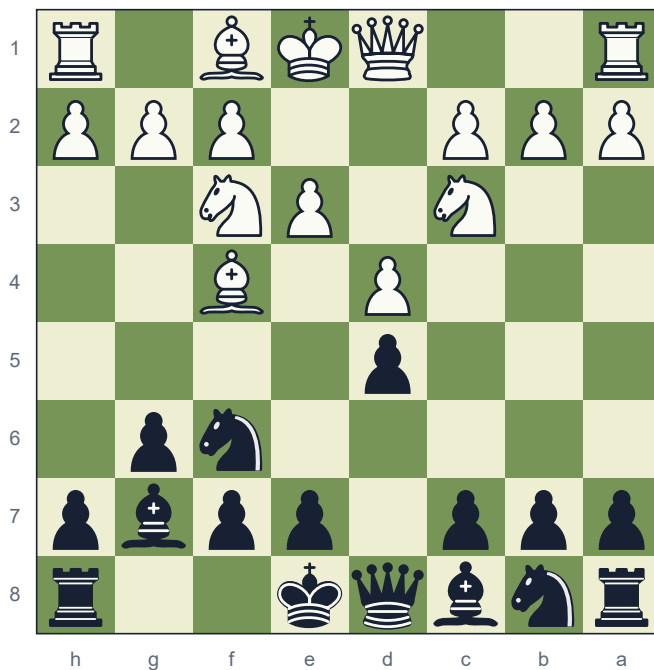
REMEMBER Fight the center, not the name of the system.

02 London with an early 2.Bf4

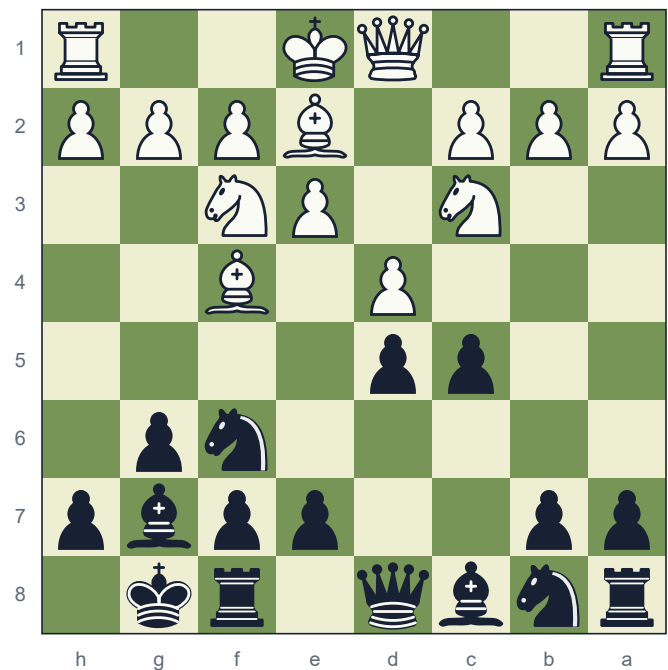
STUDY LINE 19-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bf4 g6 3. Nc3 d5 4. e3 Bg7 5. Nf3 O-O 6. Nb5 Na6 7. Nc3 Nb8 8. Nb5 Na6 9. Nc3 Nb8 10. Be2 c5

Selected anchor ends with 5... O-O. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 5... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

Nc3 signals an early e4 plan and a Jobava-style setup. ...d5 contests that square immediately and changes the opening family.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Meet Nb5 ideas and complete ...c5 when supported. Do not switch to ...d6 after the pawn has already claimed d5.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The early b1 knight makes e4 more urgent than in a slow London.

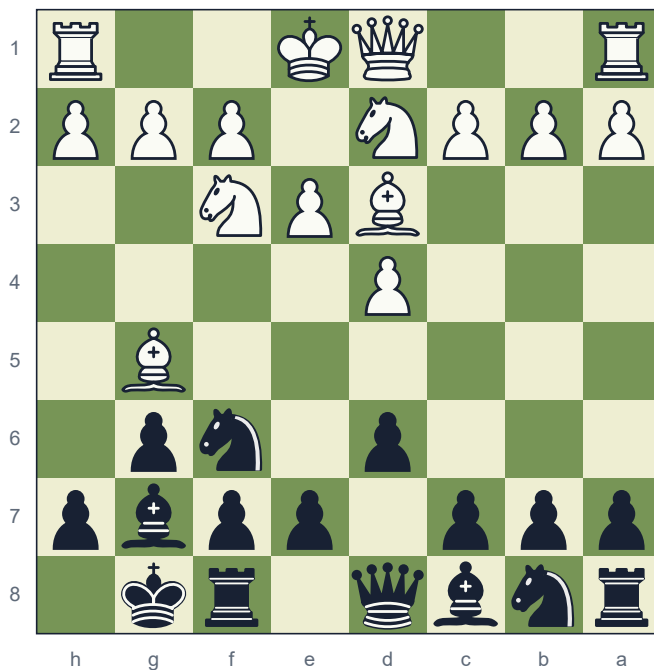
REMEMBER A new knight square can require a new central answer.

03 Torre with Nf3 and Bg5

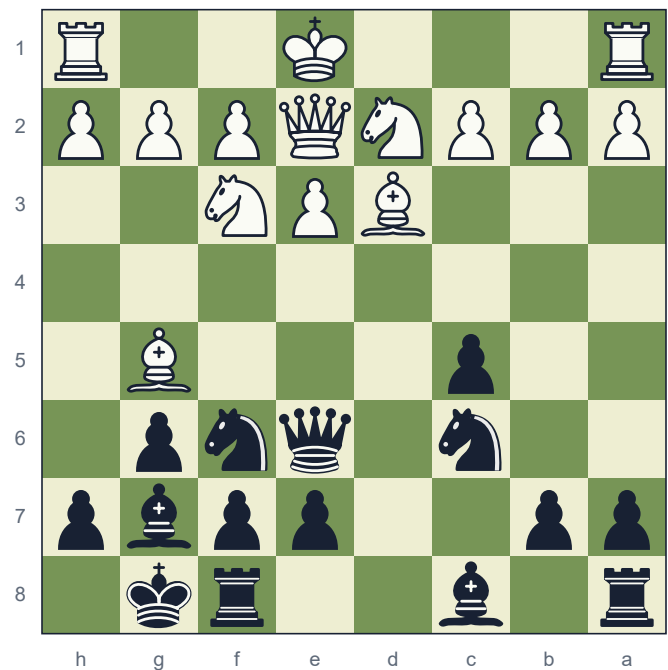
STUDY LINE 19-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. Bg5 Bg7 4. Nbd2 O-O 5. e3 d6 6. Bd3 c5 7. dxc5 dxc5 8. Qe2 Qb6 9. Nc4 Qe6 10. Ncd2 Nc6

Selected anchor ends with 6... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 6... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White pins the knight and aims for e4. Black develops and challenges d4 from the side.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Use ...Nc6 and central pressure. If h4 appears, reassess king safety before asking the bishop with ...h6.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

A pin can make a pawn break tactically impossible even when it is strategically desirable.

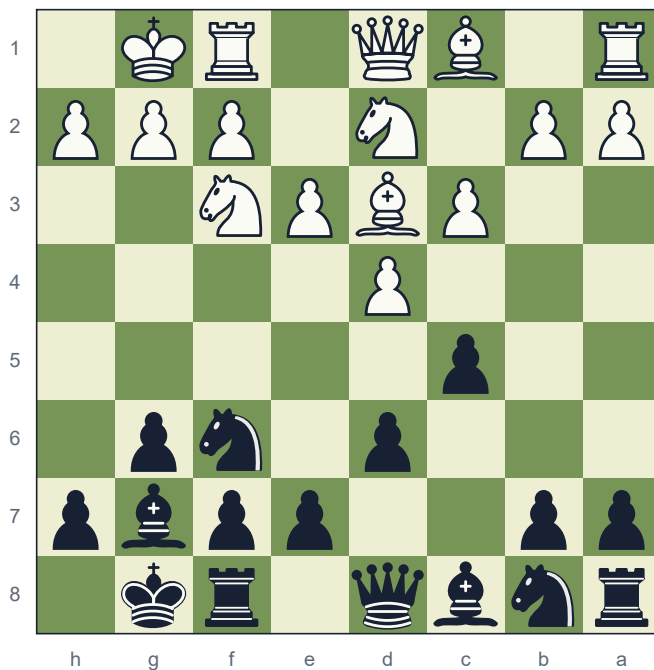
REMEMBER Resolve the pin in the calculation, not by slogan.

04 Colle with e3 and Bd3

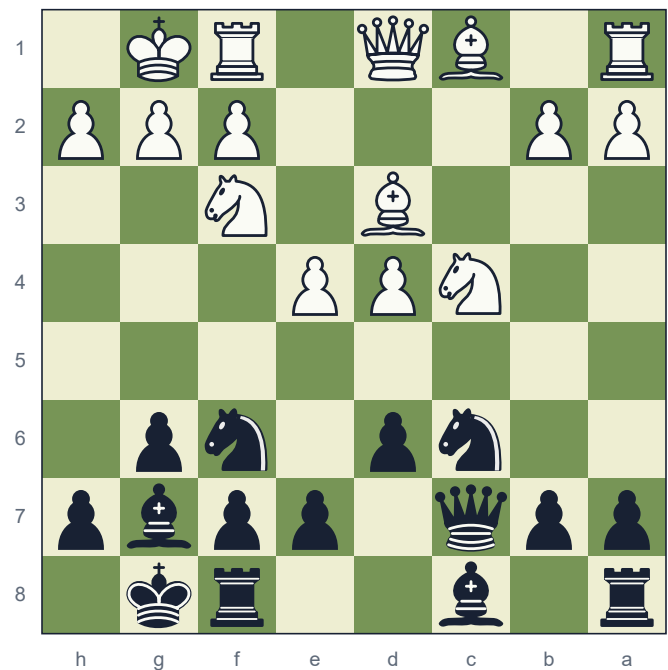
STUDY LINE 19-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nf3 g6 3. e3 Bg7 4. Bd3 O-O 5. O-O d6 6. c3 c5 7. Nbd2 Nc6 8. e4 cxd4 9. cxd4 Qb6 10. Nc4 Qc7

Selected anchor ends with 7... Nc6. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 7... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

White prepares e4 behind a compact center. ...c5 and ...Nc6 increase pressure on d4 and contest that expansion.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

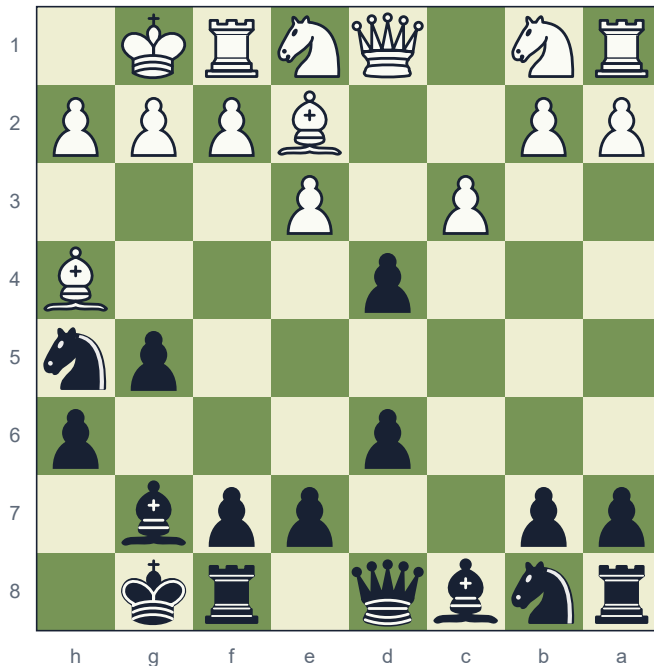
Develop the c8 bishop and choose central exchanges according to the e4 threat. Keep enough control of the light squares.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The bishop on d3 can become dangerous against h7 if the center opens. Development must include king defense.

REMEMBER Challenge the coming break before it arrives.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

Without c4 and e4 together, White has a smaller center and different bishop activity. The dark-squared bishop may develop outside the pawn chain.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop ...Nc6 and pressure d4. Keep d6 defended against Bf4 and look for an active queen square.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

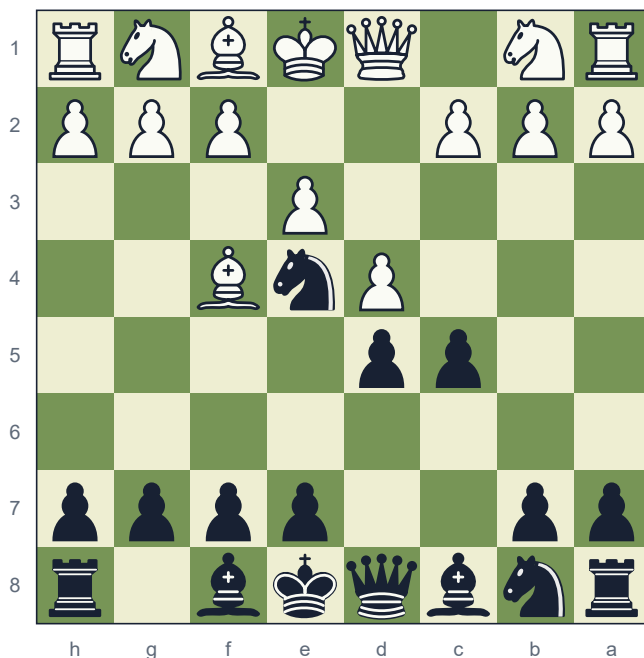
Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Trompowsky Veresov and early deviations

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 Ne4 3. Bf4 d5 4. e3 c5

YOUR BLACK REPERTOIRE CHOICE

Use explicit companion lines when a King's Indian setup would concede an easy center or ignore a threat. The repertoire chooses ...d5 against 2.Nc3, avoiding an obligatory Pirc.



Main study anchor - White to move

READ THE CENTER

An early Bg5 changes the knight's freedom. An early Nc3 supports e4 without c4. These positions require their own plans.

WHAT WHITE WANTS

White may double your pawns, seize e4, or use Nb5 and Bf4 to attack c7. The aim is active development and concrete central control.

THREE HABITS TO BUILD

1. Do not play ...g6 as a universal second move.
2. Recognize the Pirc boundary.
3. Verify whether a sacrifice is actually sound.

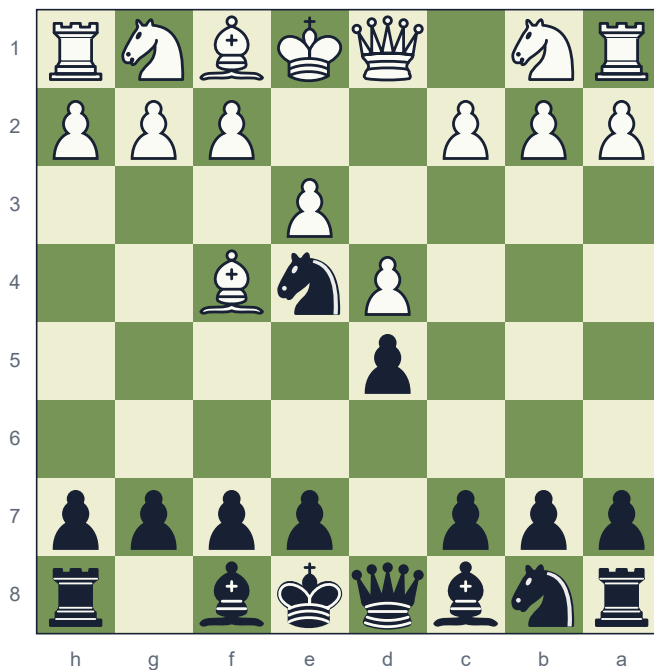
Original repertoire choices and commentary. Public opening names and move-order references, plus local Stockfish checks. Sources and method: Booklet 26.

01 Trompowsky: question the bishop with ...Ne4

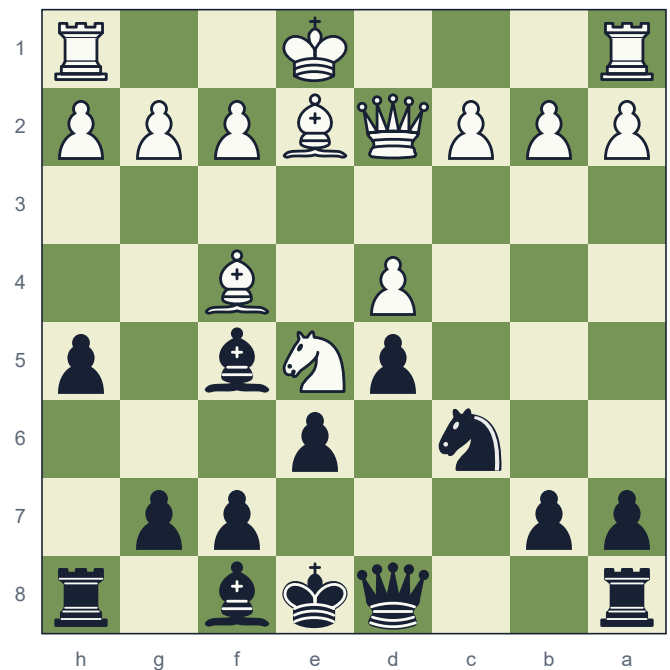
STUDY LINE 20-01

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 Ne4 3. Bf4 d5 4. e3 c5 5. Nd2 Nxd2 6. Qxd2 cxd4 7. exd4 Bf5 8. Nf3 Nc6 9. Ne5 h5
10. Be2 e6

Selected anchor ends with 4... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 4... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...Ne4 attacks Bg5. ...d5 supports central space and ...c5 challenges d4 before White establishes a quiet setup.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop the queenside and choose how to maintain or exchange the e4 knight. White may play f3 to drive it back.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

The knight on e4 can become a target. Do not spend more tempi defending it than its activity is worth.

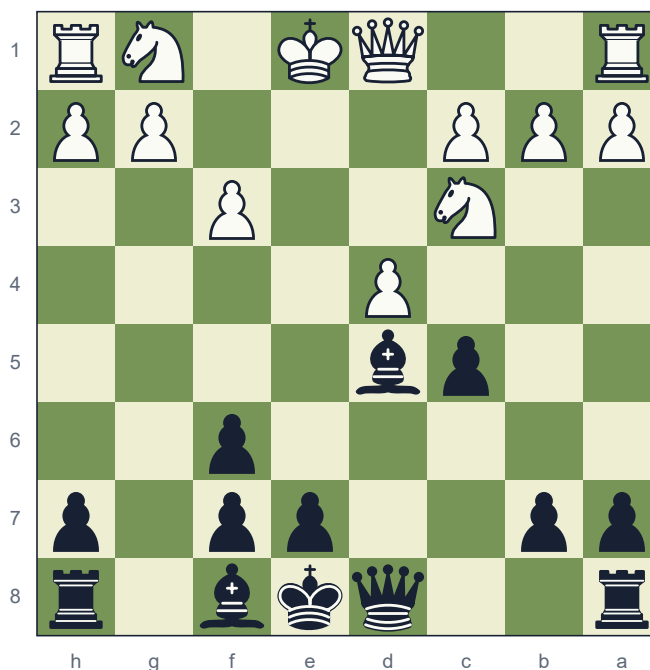
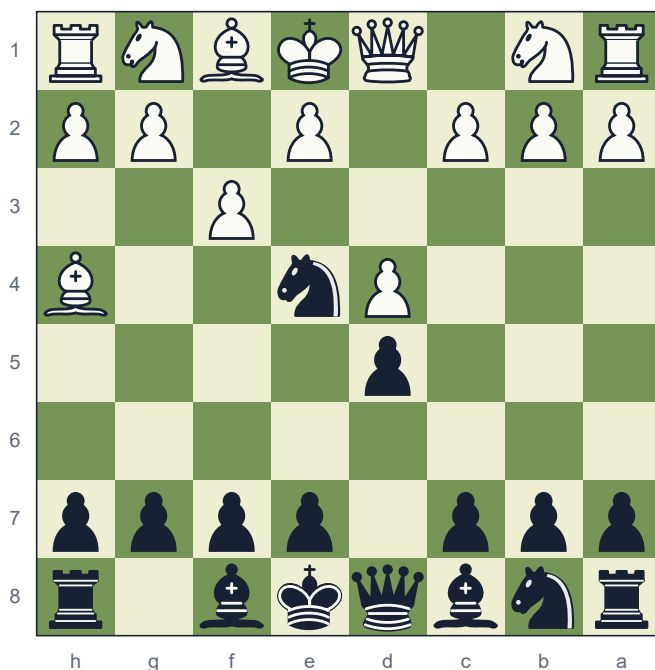
REMEMBER Active central play replaces the fianchetto script.

02 Trompowsky: the bishop retreats to h4

STUDY LINE 20-02

1. d4 Nf6 2. Bg5 Ne4 3. Bh4 d5 4. f3 Nf6 5. Nc3 c5 6. e4 Nc6 7. Bb5 Bd7 8. Bxc6 Bxc6 9. Bxf6 gxf6 10. exd5 Bxd5

Selected anchor ends with 4... Nf6. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

White spends f3 to challenge the knight. Returning to f6 is sound development logic: Black has induced a pawn move that blocks Nf3.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Develop ...c5 or ...Bf5 according to the center. White may build e4, so challenge the space before it settles.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Do not cling to e4 when the retreat completes a useful exchange of tempi.

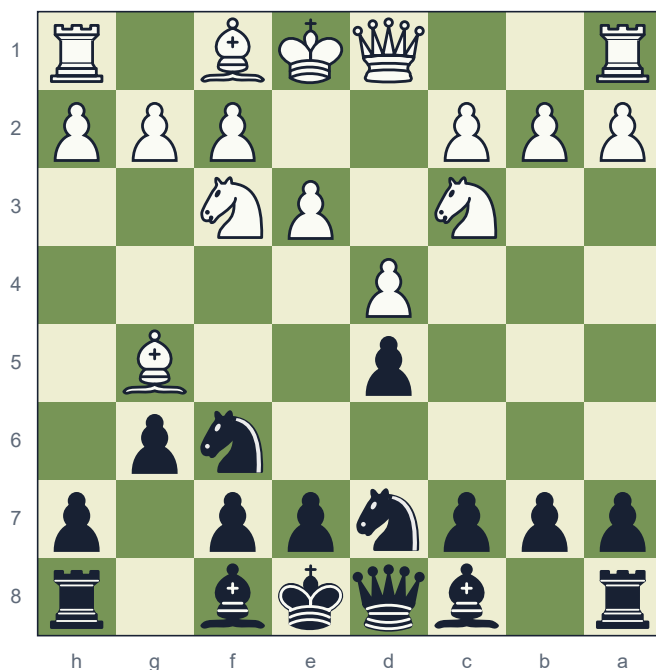
REMEMBER A retreat can preserve the benefits of an early sortie.

03 Veresov: Nc3 and Bg5

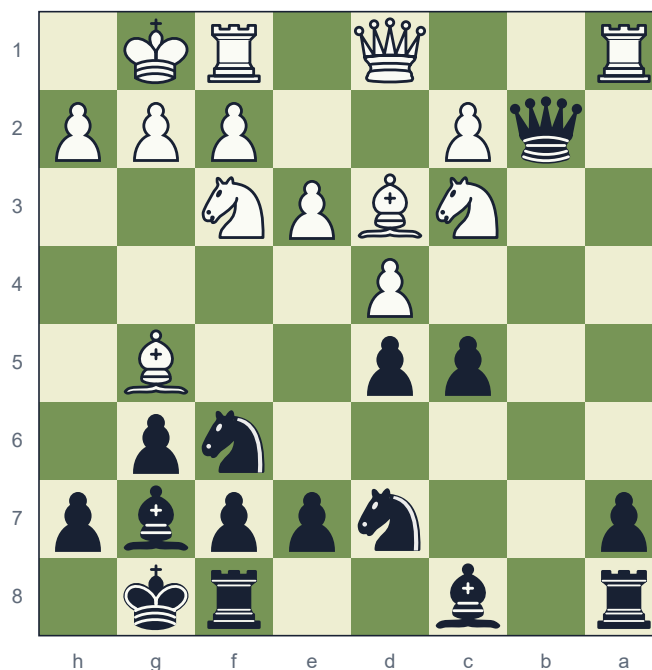
STUDY LINE 20-03

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bg5 Nbd7 4. Nf3 g6 5. e3 Bg7 6. a4 O-O 7. a5 c5 8. Bd3 b6 9. axb6 Qxb6 10. O-O Qxb2

Selected anchor ends with 5... Bg7. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 5... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...d5 prevents a free e4 center. ...Nbd7 develops behind the pin and supports central squares.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Castle and prepare ...c5 or ...e5 with support. White may exchange on f6 or push e4.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

This is a Veresov structure, not the d6/e5 King's Indian chain.

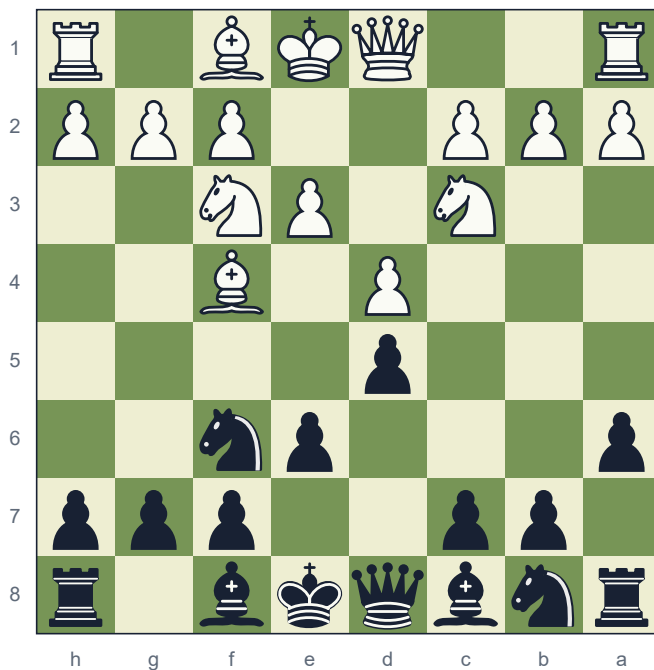
REMEMBER Use the central structure you actually have.

04 Jobava: Bf4 and the Nb5 threat

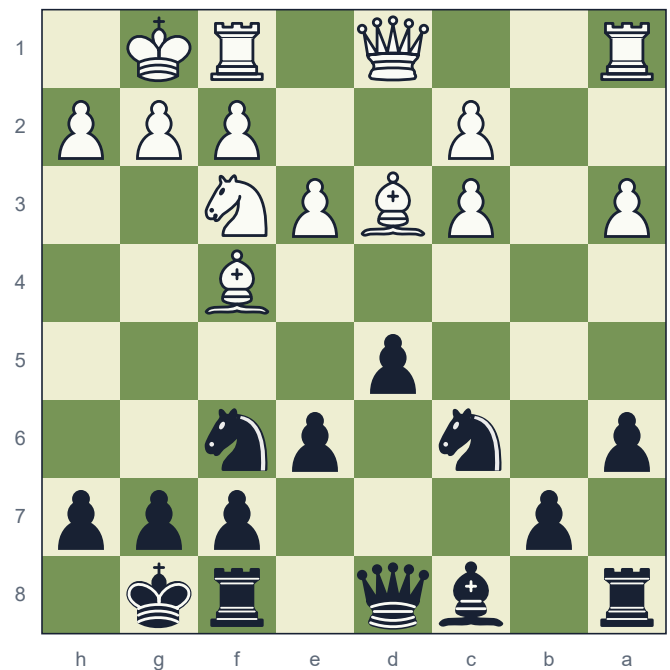
STUDY LINE 20-04

1. d4 Nf6 2. Nc3 d5 3. Bf4 a6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 c5 6. dxc5 Bxc5 7. Bd3 Nc6 8. O-O Bb4 9. a3 Bxc3 10. bxc3 O-O

Selected anchor ends with 5... c5. Later moves show one checked example.



Before 5... - Black to move



End of study line - White to move

WHY THESE MOVES

...a6 prevents Nb5 from attacking c7. Black then challenges d4 and develops a normal central game.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

Complete ...Nc6 and ...Be7 or ...Bd6 as appropriate. Count the e4 break and bishop exchanges.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

Ignoring Nb5 can force awkward concessions. A modest pawn move can answer a specific threat.

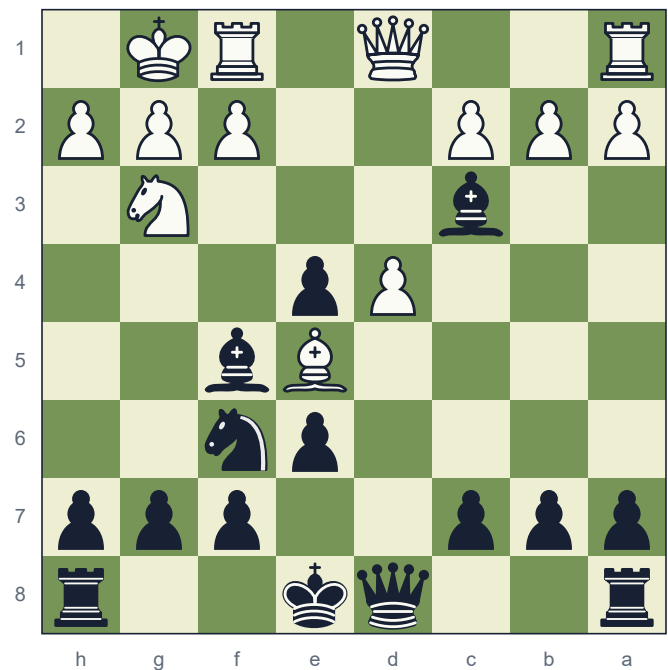
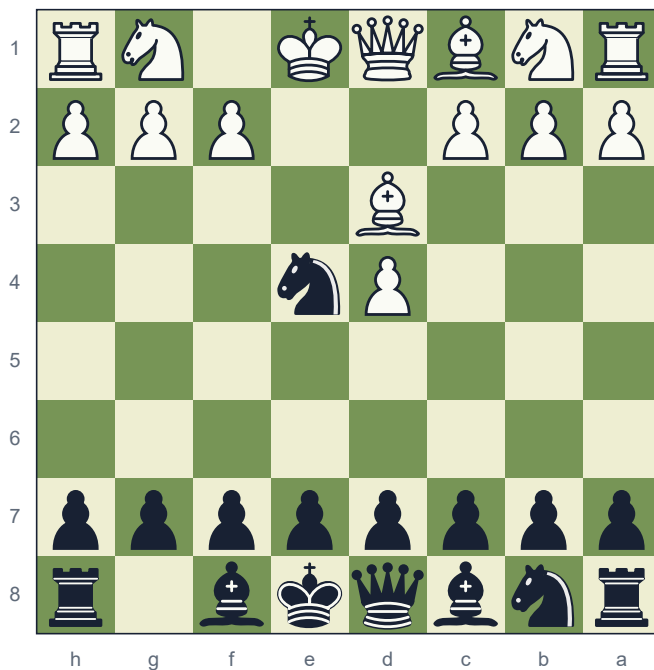
REMEMBER Prevent the concrete jump, then develop actively.

05 An immediate 2.e4 pawn offer

STUDY LINE 20-05

1. d4 Nf6 2. e4 Nxe4 3. Bd3 d5 4. Bxe4 dxe4 5. Nc3 Bf5 6. Nge2 e6 7. Bf4 Nd7 8. Ng3 Bb4 9. O-O Nf6 10. Be5 Bxc3

Selected anchor ends with 3... d5. Later moves show one checked example.



WHY THESE MOVES

Black accepts the unprotected e4 pawn, then supports the knight while claiming central space. White receives development chances for the pawn.

YOUR NEXT PLAN

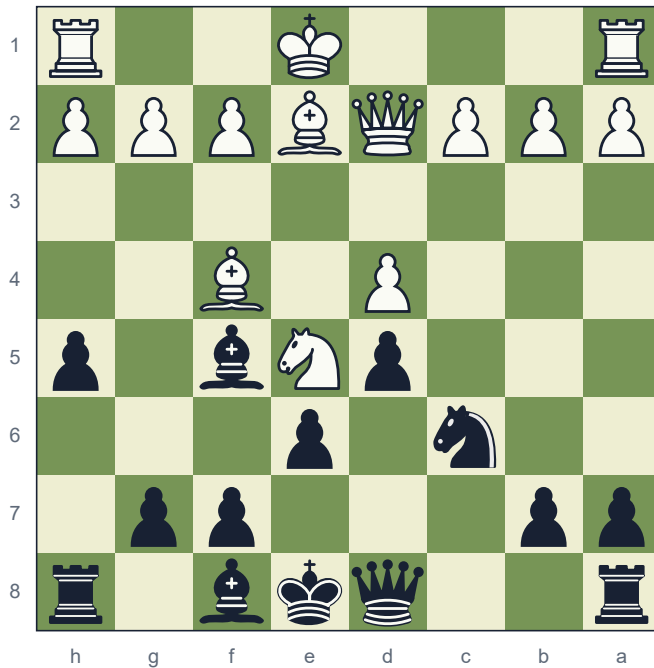
Develop safely and return material if necessary to complete development. Watch checks and attacks on the knight.

WHITE RESOURCE TO RESPECT

An extra pawn does not excuse repeated knight moves or an unsafe king.

REMEMBER Accept material, then finish development.

Review before your next game



Main-line endpoint - White to move

1. CLASSIFY THE CENTER

An early Bg5 changes the knight's freedom. An early Nc3 supports e4 without c4. These positions require their own plans.

2. NAME WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may double your pawns, seize e4, or use Nb5 and Bf4 to attack c7. The aim is active development and concrete central control.

3. CHOOSE A USEFUL JOB

Develop the queenside and choose how to maintain or exchange the e4 knight. White may play f3 to drive it back.

RECONSTRUCT

Set up the starting position and play this booklet's main line. Before every Black move, state White's threat and why your move is safe. Stop at the first point you cannot explain.

BRANCH TEST

Choose one alternative White move from this booklet. Explain what changed: a defender, a pawn contact, a king choice or a tempo. Then reconstruct the response without looking.

PRACTICE

Play the endpoint against a partner or a chess program, switching colors after one game. Record the first new position and your candidate moves. Use the line ID to find it in Repertoire_Lines.pgn.

Read the center before choosing a wing

THREE QUESTIONS

Which pawn contact can open the position? Which side has a lead in development? Where are the kings? Answer those questions before deciding whether to attack on the kingside, queenside or in the center.

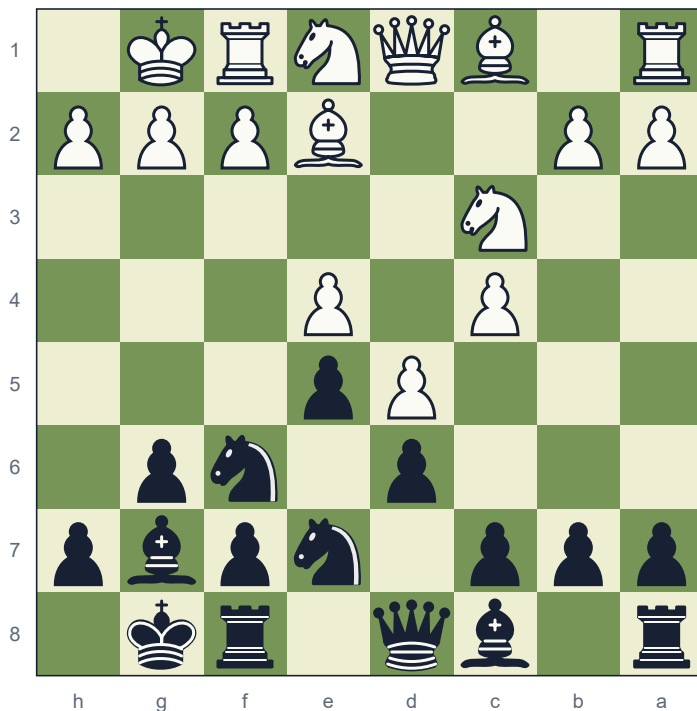
USE THE DIAGRAMS ACTIVELY

For each diagram, name Black's worst piece and White's strongest useful reply. Write one plan and the pawn break that makes it possible. A plan is a sequence of decisions, not a promise to play the same moves against everything.

THE DIAGRAMS ARE LEGAL COURSE POSITIONS

These positions come from the checked repertoire. Some are White to move; the lesson still asks you to understand Black's plan after White's reply. The caption always gives the actual side to move.

The locked Classical chain



Black to move | from 03-01

DIAGNOSE

White's d5/e4 chain faces Black's d6/e5 chain. Neither d-pawn can move straight forward. The chain gives a direction to the plans, but either side can open it with a pawn lever.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Prepare ...f5 by moving the f6 knight and coordinating the pieces. If ...f4 fixes the center, use the gained space to bring pieces toward the king.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White expands with c5 and may invade on the c-file. White can also undermine the attack with g4. Count how many moves your pieces need.

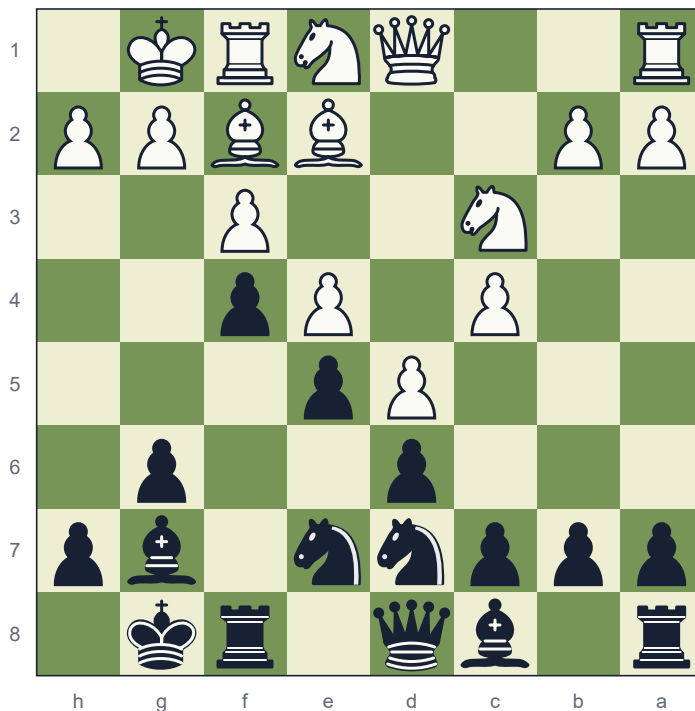
THINK BEFORE MOVING

Which knight must move before ...f5, and what is White's fastest central or queenside reply?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

After ...f4: space is not a mating attack



Black to move | from 03-01

DIAGNOSE

The f4 pawn gains space and restricts White's pieces. It also fixes targets and closes lines your own rooks might otherwise use.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Support the pawn with ...g5 only if the pieces can join. Typical jobs include ...Ng6, ...Nf6, ...h5 and queen access. Identify the entry square, not just the next pawn.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may play c5, g4, or bring defenders to f2 and d3. If the attack slows, the queenside weaknesses can become decisive.

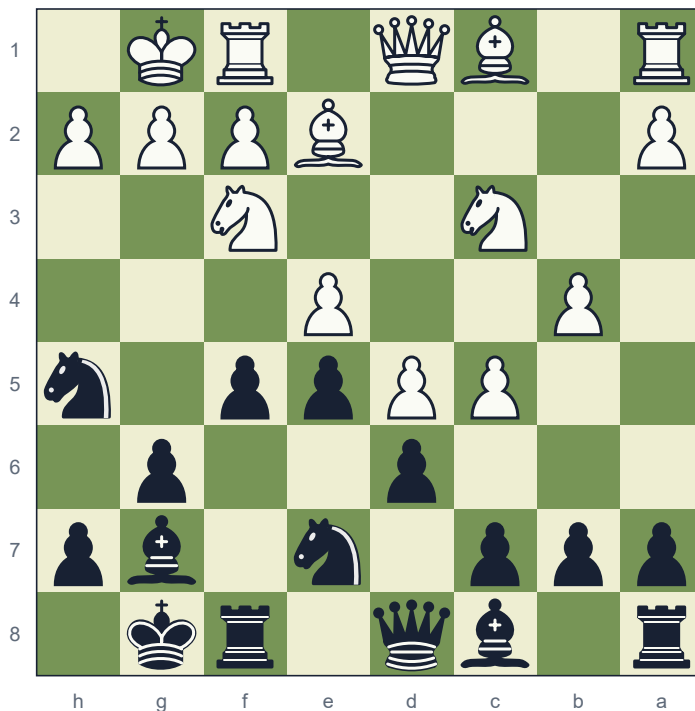
THINK BEFORE MOVING

Name the first piece that should join the attack and the line it will use.

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

The Bayonet: two simultaneous pawn contacts



White to move | from 04-04

DIAGNOSE

White's c5 attacks d6 while Black's f5 attacks e4. The locked center can open from either end, so a one-wing evaluation is incomplete.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Compare ...f4, ...fxe4 and a d-pawn exchange only after analyzing White's captures. Preserve piece activity if the pawn skeleton changes.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White can trade on d6 or f5 and use open files before Black finishes regrouping.

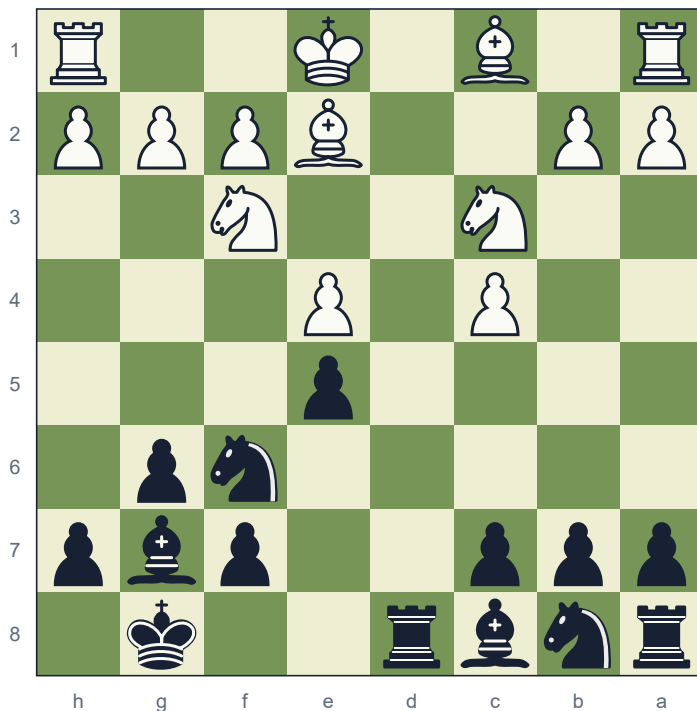
THINK BEFORE MOVING

Which captures can change the center immediately, and what file opens after each?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

The open d-file after an exchange



White to move | from 06-01

DIAGNOSE

Both d-pawns have left the d-file, and the queens are gone. A direct mating race has been replaced by piece coordination and control of d4 and d5.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Develop the remaining pieces and contest the d-file. Keep e5 defended, especially if a bishop pins Nf6. A rook on an open file needs support and entry squares.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may invade d5 with a knight or double rooks. A passive black bishop can be worse than a small pawn weakness.

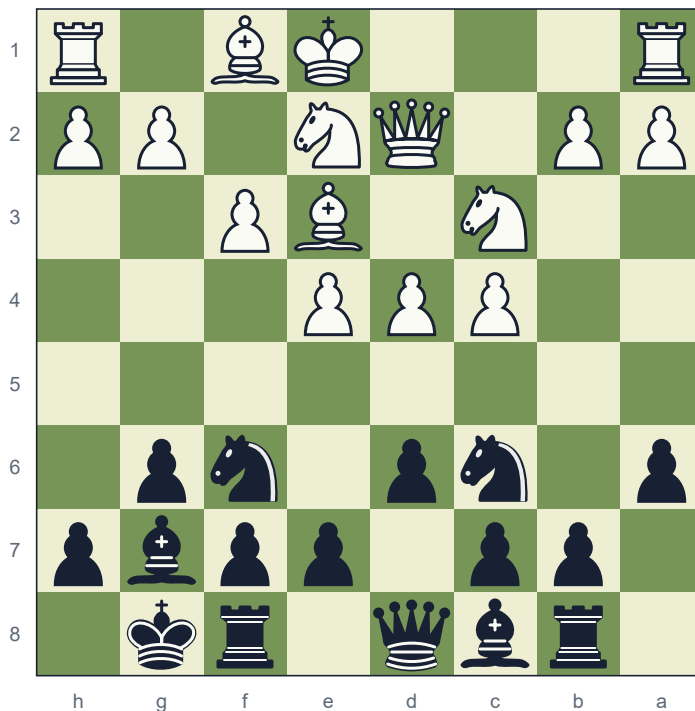
THINK BEFORE MOVING

What would make a rook trade favorable, and which minor-piece square must you control?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

Panno: the queenside break



White to move | from 09-01

DIAGNOSE

Black has ...Nc6, ...a6 and ...Rb8. White's f3 pawn supports the center but delays natural king-knight development.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Prepare ...b5 when the captures work. If White restrains it with a4, compare ...e5. If White closes with d5, answer the knight attack first.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

Bh6, h4 and g4 can threaten the king. White may avoid long castling and turn the queenside opening into a central game.

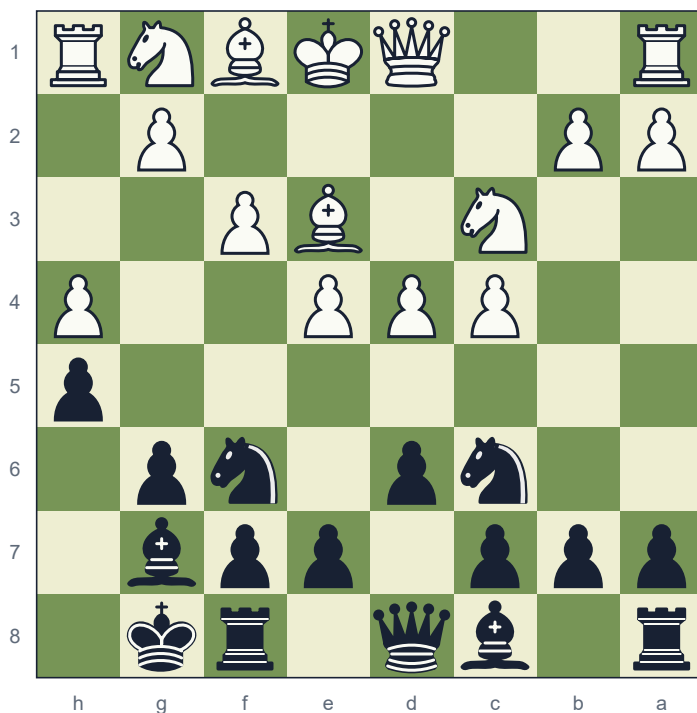
THINK BEFORE MOVING

What would change your decision between ...b5 and ...e5?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

Samisch: defending the king without passivity



White to move | from 10-04

DIAGNOSE

The h-pawns face one another after ...h5. The h-file is closed for now, but White can create a new lever with g4.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Finish development and create central or queenside counterplay. Defend forcing threats directly. Keep a defender near g6 and avoid unnecessary dark-square weaknesses.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may play g4, sacrifice on h5, or exchange the g7 bishop with Bh6. A blocked h-file is not permanent safety.

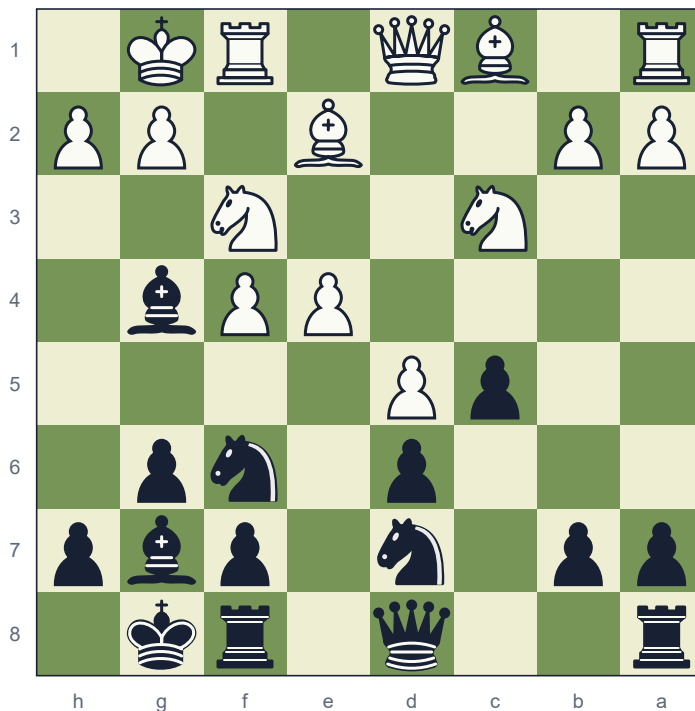
THINK BEFORE MOVING

Which new pawn lever attacks h5, and what active counterplay can Black prepare?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

Benoni structure against the Four Pawns



White to move | from 11-01

DIAGNOSE

White has a d5 wedge and an e4/f4 center; Black has d6 and c5. Black's e-pawn has been exchanged, opening the e-file.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Pressure e4, challenge the knight that supports e5, and develop rapidly. Prepare queenside expansion only when d6 and the king are secure.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White threatens e5 with tempo or a kingside attack. A passive setup lets the space advantage grow.

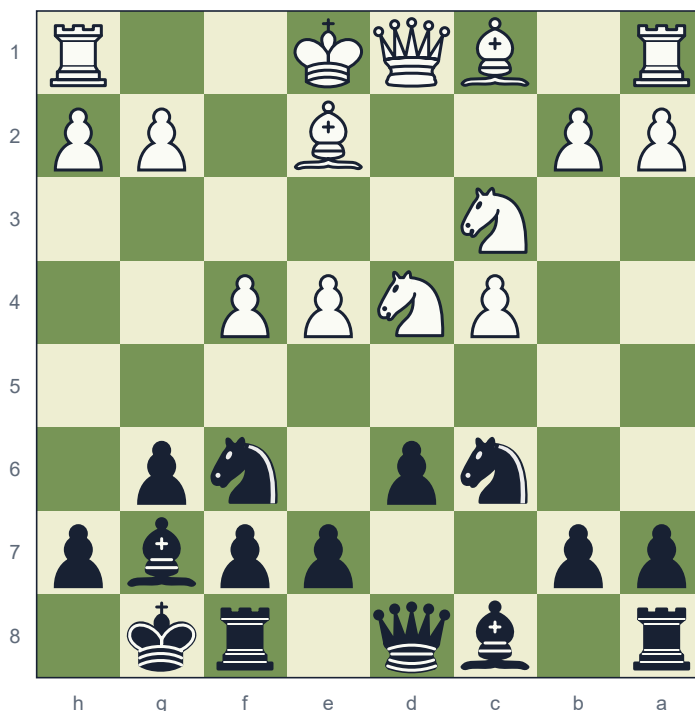
THINK BEFORE MOVING

Which white piece supports e5, and why is exchanging it potentially useful?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

The central bind after ...cxd4



White to move | from 11-02

DIAGNOSE

White's d-pawn has disappeared. Pawns on c4 and e4 control d5, restricting Black's central break.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Develop toward a supported ...d5 or create useful queenside pressure. Trade a pair of pieces when it reduces the cramp without conceding a permanent weakness.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White can maintain the bind, improve pieces and attack d6. An unsupported ...d5 may simply lose a pawn.

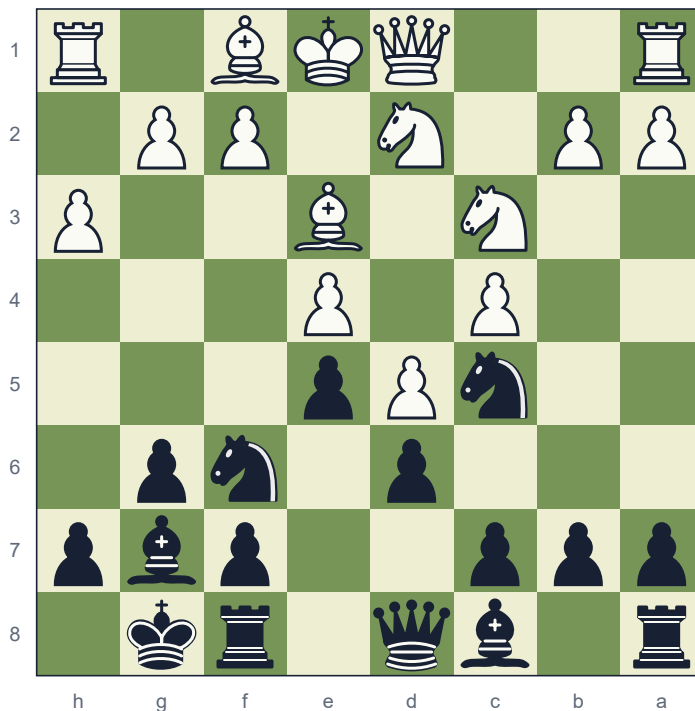
THINK BEFORE MOVING

What preparation would make ...d5 a freeing break rather than a pawn sacrifice?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

Makogonov: restraint before attack



Black to move | from 13-01

DIAGNOSE

h3 restrains g4 and supports a possible g4 advance. The c5 knight gives Black activity but can be challenged by b4.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Coordinate pieces behind the center. Compare ...a5, ...c6 and a prepared ...f5; choose according to White's king and the knight's safety.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White can attack on the kingside while delaying castling, or gain queenside space against Nc5.

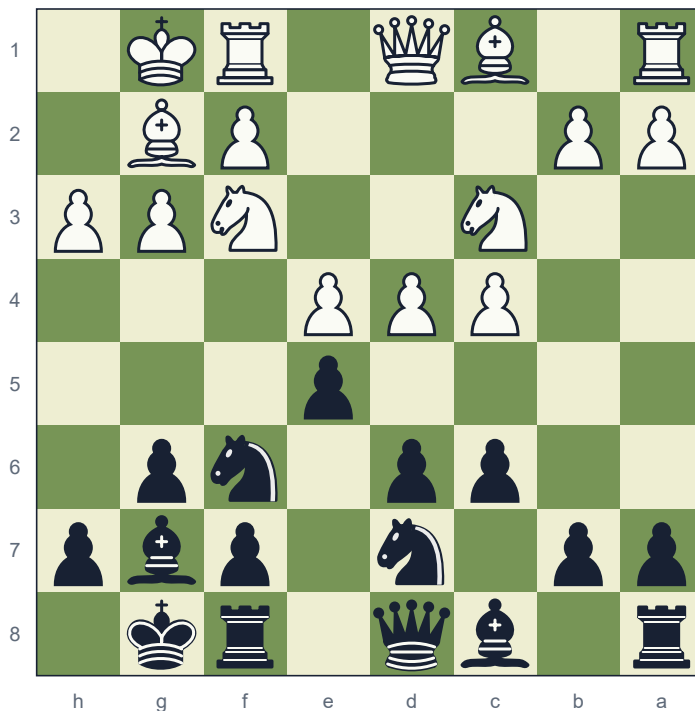
THINK BEFORE MOVING

What information about White's king do you need before launching a pawn storm?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

Fianchetto: pressure through the center



Black to move | from 14-01

DIAGNOSE

Both kings have fianchettoed bishops. White's g2 bishop adds a defender and a long-range attacker, changing the value of a kingside pawn advance.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Develop central pressure with ...Re8, ...exd4 and a knight on c5 when justified. ...c6 can support a later ...d5 break.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White may open the long diagonal with a central exchange. An exposed b7 pawn or loose c6 piece can then become a target.

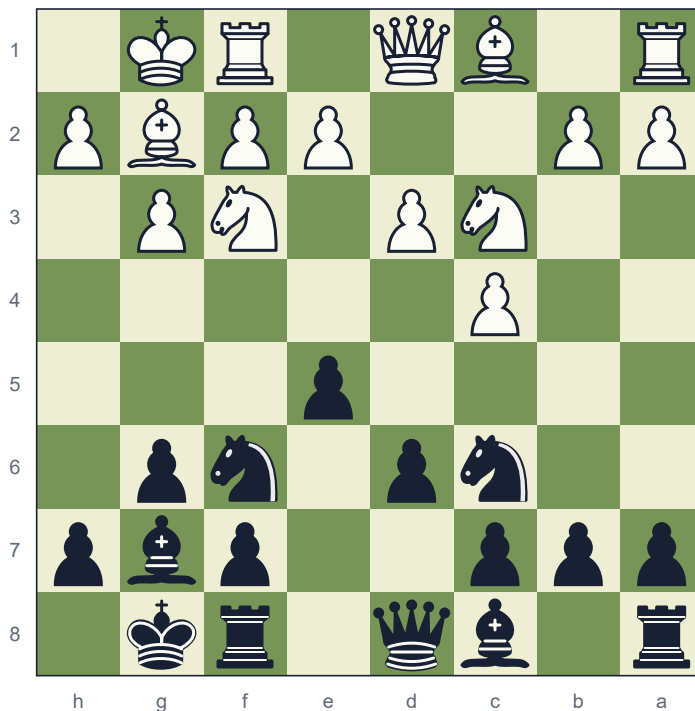
THINK BEFORE MOVING

Which central exchange activates the g2 bishop, and what must Black recheck afterward?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

English: no d4 wedge



White to move | from 18-03

DIAGNOSE

White uses d3 rather than d4. Black's e5 foothold controls d4, and there is no locked d5/e4 chain.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Develop the queen bishop and consider a well-supported ...d5. Watch queenside expansion and use central squares for pieces.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White can play Rb1/b4, f4, or d4 later. Each advance changes which pawn break is most relevant.

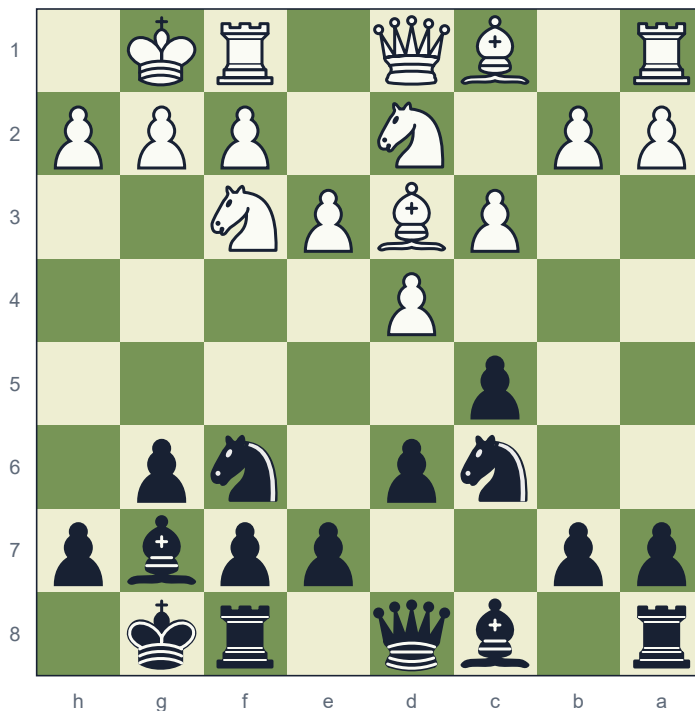
THINK BEFORE MOVING

Why is a routine Mar del Plata kingside race inappropriate in this diagram?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

System openings: stop a free e4 break



White to move | from 19-04

DIAGNOSE

White has a compact d4/e3 center and Bd3. Black attacks d4 with ...c5 and develops against the coming e4 advance.

YOUR BLACK PLAN

Increase central pressure with ...Nc6 and useful bishop development. Resolve the pawn tension only when the resulting structure helps you.

WHITE'S COUNTERPLAY

White can prepare e4 with Nbd2 and Re1. If the center opens, Bd3 may create threats toward h7.

THINK BEFORE MOVING

What is White's intended central break, and which black pieces should contest it?

PRACTICE

Write two candidate moves and calculate White's most forcing reply to each. Then choose the move that improves your position without giving away the opponent's immediate resource.

Calculate the position, then use the pattern

PATTERNS ARE PROMPTS

A knight fork, a long diagonal or a pawn storm tells you where to look. It does not prove a combination works. Every lesson below points to a specific calculation or practical decision.

DEFENDING IS PART OF PLAYING AN ATTACKING OPENING

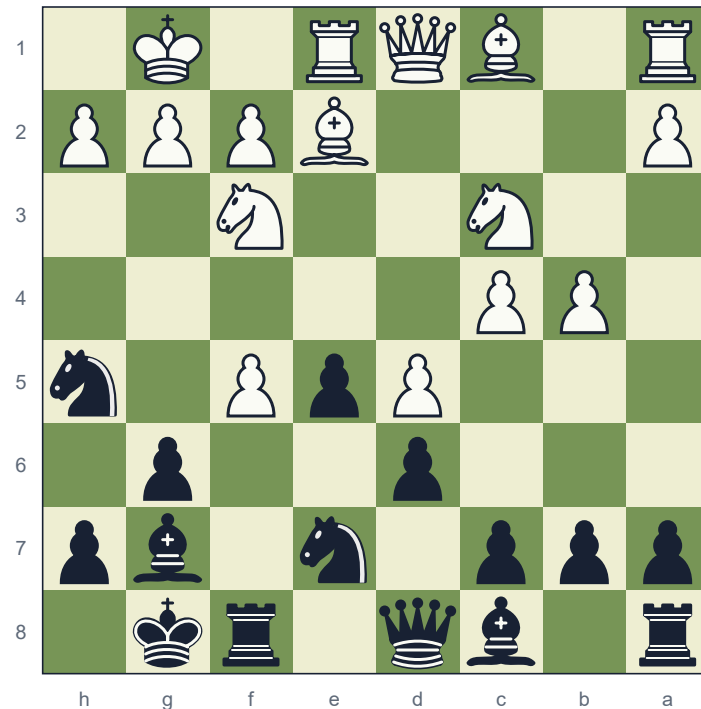
You must be able to stop a forcing threat, exchange queens when necessary and play a reduced-material position. Refusing every trade is as limiting as trading automatically.

HOW TO USE THE ENDGAME-TRANSITION PAGES

The diagrams show opening or middlegame starting points for decisions about simplification. They are not claimed to be theoretical endgame studies or forced winning positions. The task is to judge what a proposed exchange leaves behind.

The central intermediate move

TACTICAL DECISION | 04-03



Black to move

THE IDEA

After White captures on f5 in this exact Bayonet line, ...e4 attacks Nf3 while clearing the g7 bishop's diagonal toward Nc3. Looking only at recaptures misses the combined threat.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

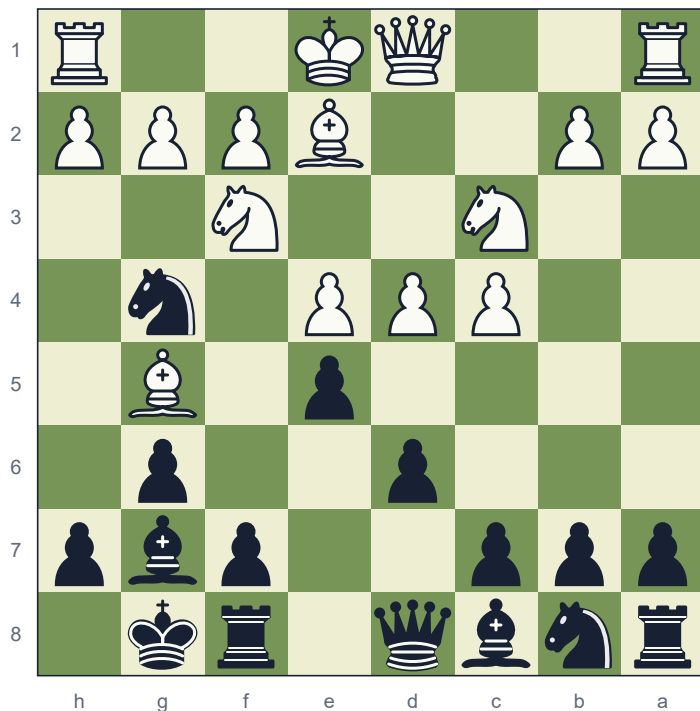
List White's knight moves and the effect of ...Bxc3. Check whether a recapture on f5 can wait. This is a concrete motif tied to the current piece placement, not a rule to push ...e4 after every exf5.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Before any automatic recapture, spend a moment looking for checks, stronger captures and attacks on two pieces.

Pins can decide a pawn break

TACTICAL DECISION | 08-01



Black to move

THE IDEA

Bg5 influences the diagonal toward the black queen. A knight move that seems natural can expose a queen or allow a central capture. ...f6 is a concrete way to interrupt that diagonal in this line.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

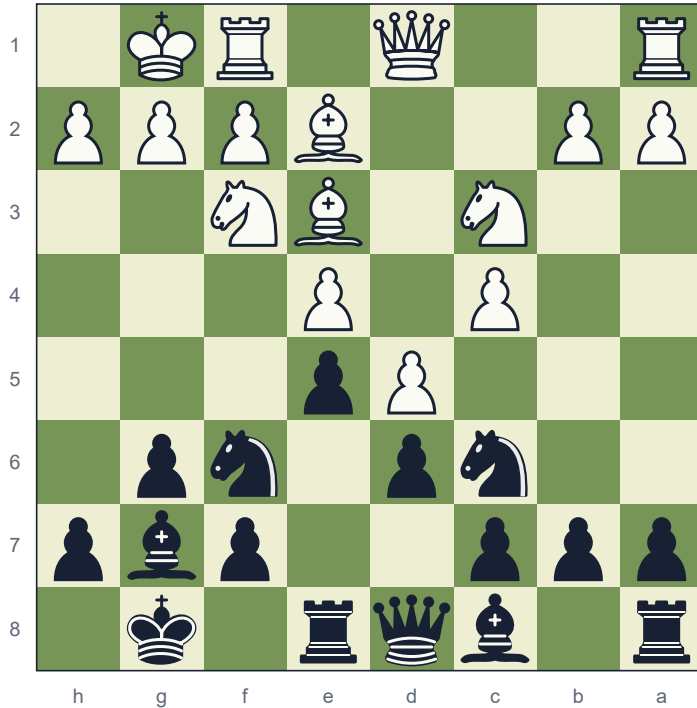
Trace the whole diagonal from the bishop to its target. A relative pin against a queen is different from an absolute pin against a king, but either can constrain your practical choices.

HABIT TO RETAIN

When you want ...f5 or a knight retreat, verify that the pinned piece can actually move without a tactical loss.

A forward retreat: ...Nd4

TACTICAL DECISION | 02-02



Black to move

THE IDEA

After ...Re8 and d5, the c6 knight need not always retreat to e7. Here ...Nd4 uses support from e5 and pressure on the e-file.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

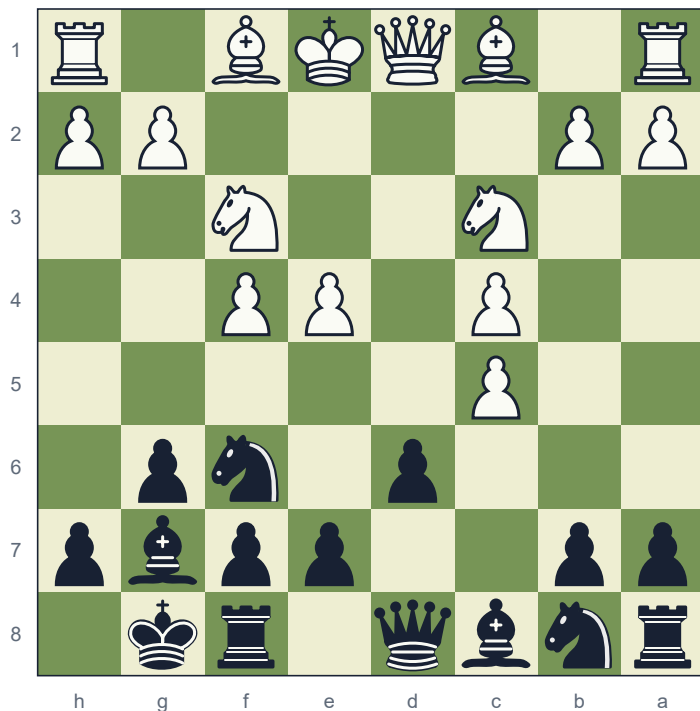
Calculate both Bxd4 and Nxd4, including the pawn recapture and the opening of the g7 bishop. A defended outpost is strongest when exchanges improve the rest of your pieces.

HABIT TO RETAIN

When a piece is attacked, search active squares as well as backward moves.

The queen attacks two central pawns

TACTICAL DECISION | 11-03



Black to move

THE IDEA

After $dx c5$ in the Four Pawns line, $\dots Qa5$ creates pressure on $c5$ and $e4$. The queen uses the diagonal that White's central capture helped expose.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

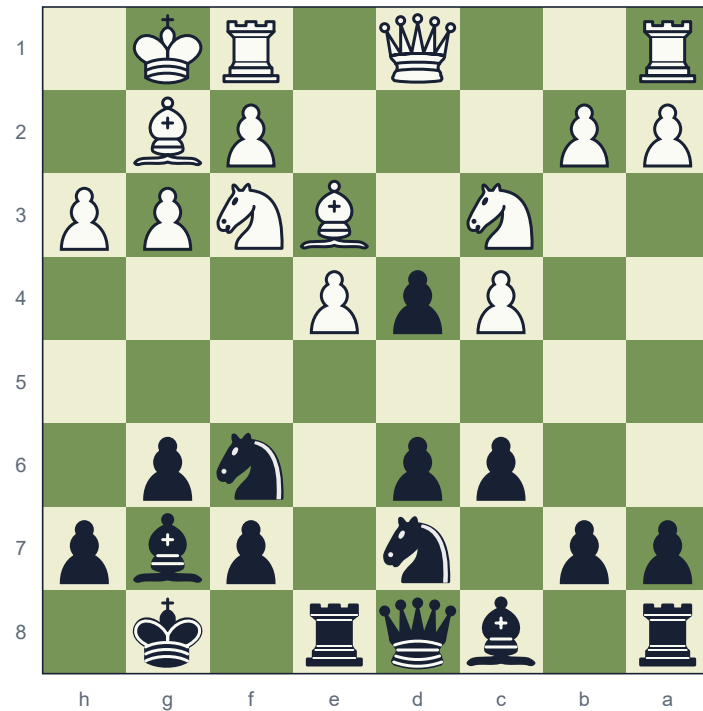
Do not stop the calculation at a double attack. Look for $Bd2$, a queen exchange, or a move that develops while defending both targets. Then decide which pawn can be recovered safely.

HABIT TO RETAIN

A queen sortie should achieve something concrete and leave a safe route back.

The bishop on g7: defender and attacker

TACTICAL DECISION | 14-01



White to move

THE IDEA

The fianchetto bishop protects dark squares near the king and can attack through the center. A blocked diagonal does not make the bishop disposable.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

Before exchanging it for a knight, compare the remaining dark-square defenders, White's queen access and the pawn structure. In a concrete position the exchange may be excellent; the point is to know what protection you give up.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Name both the attacking diagonal and the defensive squares before trading the bishop.

Defending against Bh6

TACTICAL DECISION | 09-03



White to move

THE IDEA

White often uses Be3 and Qd2 to offer an exchange on h6. Removing Bg7 can weaken the dark squares and make h-pawn attacks more dangerous.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

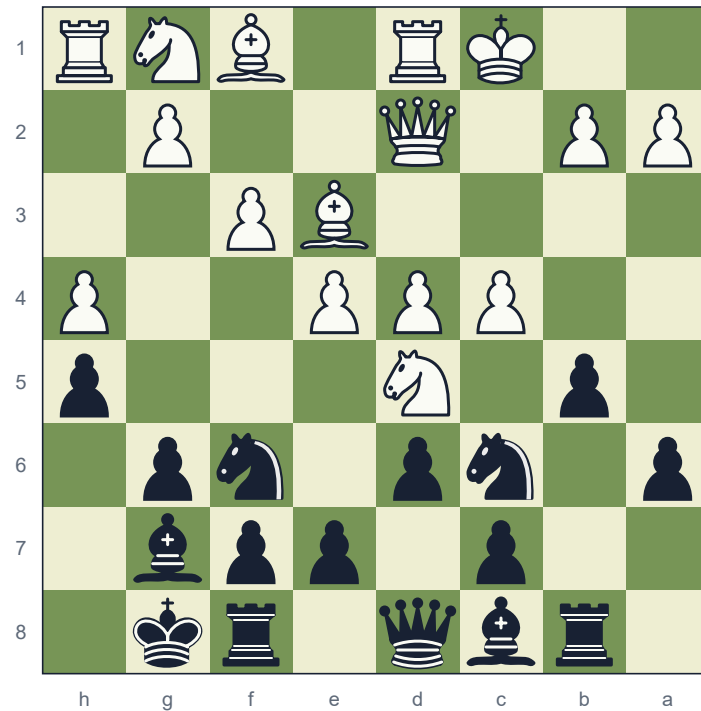
Compare allowing the exchange, moving the bishop, or creating a forcing counterthreat. Do not assume ...Bxh6 is compulsory. The center and queen placement decide whether a bishop trade is safe.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Answer the threat with a calculation, then restore active counterplay.

When not to capture a pawn near your king

TACTICAL DECISION | 10-04



White to move

THE IDEA

A pawn on h5 or g5 can be bait. Capturing it may open the h-file or a diagonal toward your king, especially when White has a rook ready on h1.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

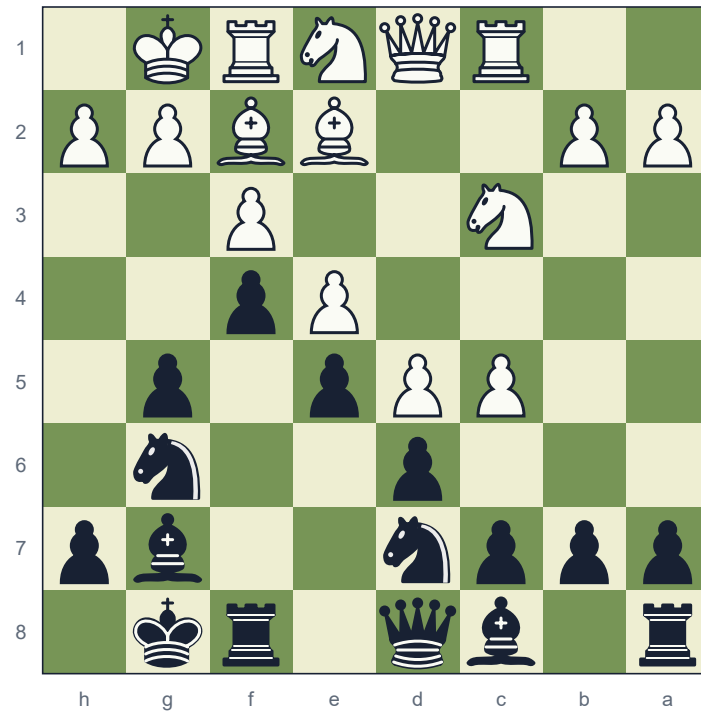
After each candidate capture, draw the newly opened file mentally and count attacking and defending pieces. Compare declining the pawn and striking in the center.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Material near the king is worth taking only if the resulting lines are safe.

Exchange sacrifices: a calculation standard

TACTICAL DECISION | 03-04



Black to move

THE IDEA

Closed KID positions can produce sacrifices that remove a key defender or open an entry file. The opening's attacking reputation is not sufficient compensation by itself.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

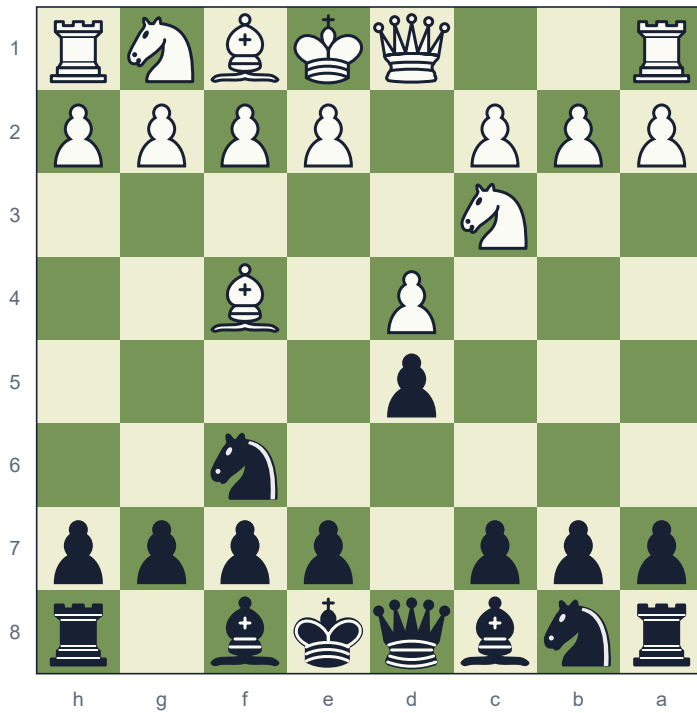
Count immediate forcing moves, the number of pieces that can join, the stability of your center, and White's chance to return material. If the attack depends on White ignoring a defense, reject the sacrifice.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Write a concrete continuation to a clear outcome or a stable position before committing material.

Defend a forcing threat before continuing the race

TACTICAL DECISION | 20-04



Black to move

THE IDEA

In the Jobava companion line, Nb5 would attack c7. ...a6 answers that specific threat before Black completes normal central development.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

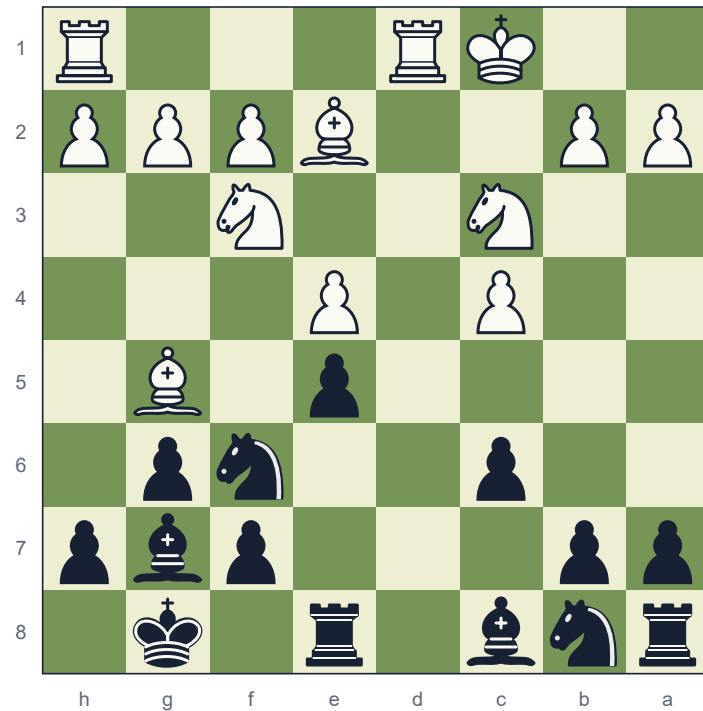
A defensive move is productive when it removes a forcing resource and lets your pieces develop smoothly. Compare the cost of one pawn move with the cost of an awkward forced response later.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Prophylaxis means identifying the opponent's actual resource, not making every possible precaution.

Queenless does not mean planless

ENDGAME TRANSITION | 06-01



White to move

THE IDEA

After the opening queen exchange, stop counting mating attackers and start counting active pieces, entry squares and pawn targets. Bring the king toward the center when checks and tactics permit.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

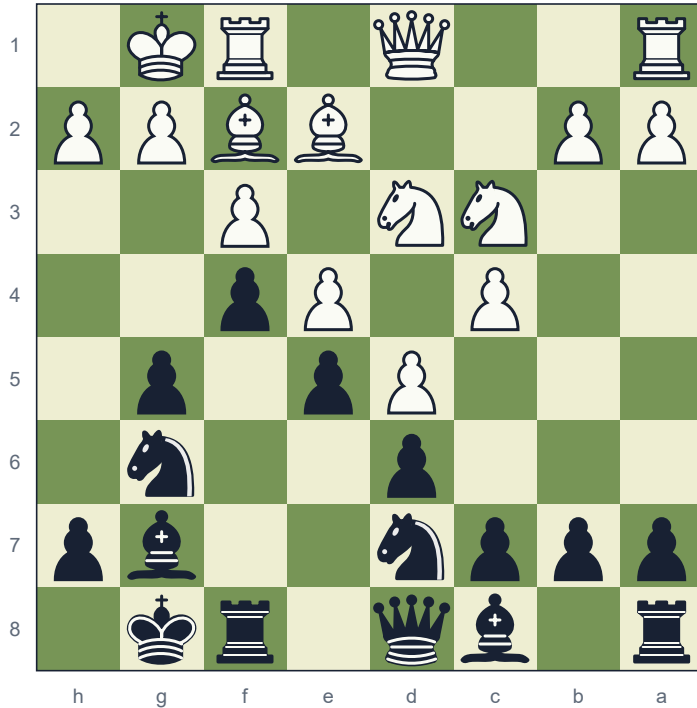
A rook trade is attractive if it leaves a favorable minor-piece ending or removes the opponent's only active piece. It is unattractive if it strands your bishop behind fixed pawns.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Before offering a trade, describe the position after both sides recapture. The remaining pieces decide the evaluation.

A bad bishop can still defend important squares

ENDGAME TRANSITION | 03-01



White to move

THE IDEA

The g7 bishop may appear restricted by e5 and d6, but it can restrain breaks and protect the king. Opening the center or changing the pawn chain may activate it later.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

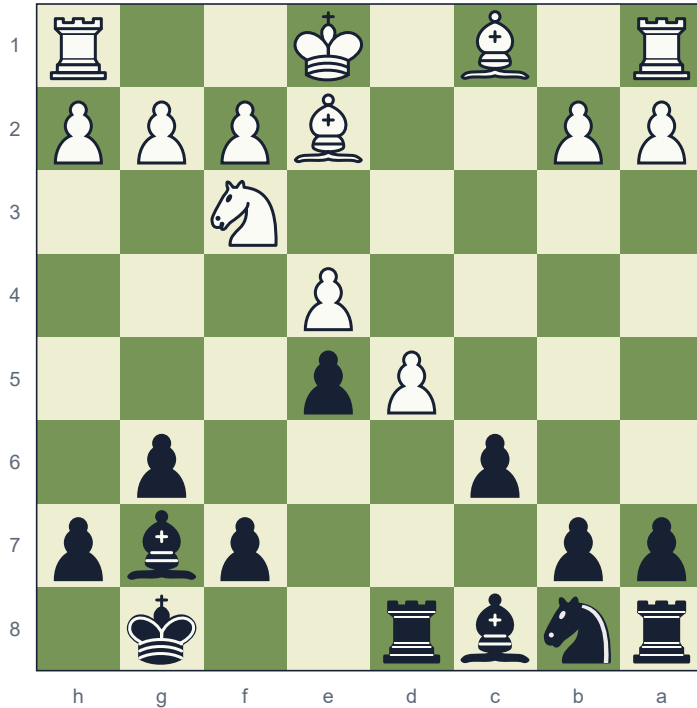
If queens come off, compare your bishop with White's knight outposts. Look for a pawn break that frees the bishop rather than exchanging automatically into a passive ending.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Do not label the bishop bad without naming which squares and pawn breaks it controls.

Use the king only when the position allows it

ENDGAME TRANSITION | 06-03



THE IDEA

An active king is valuable in reduced material, but rooks and minor pieces can still create mating nets or win pawns with checks. Centralization is a calculated route, not a one-move slogan.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

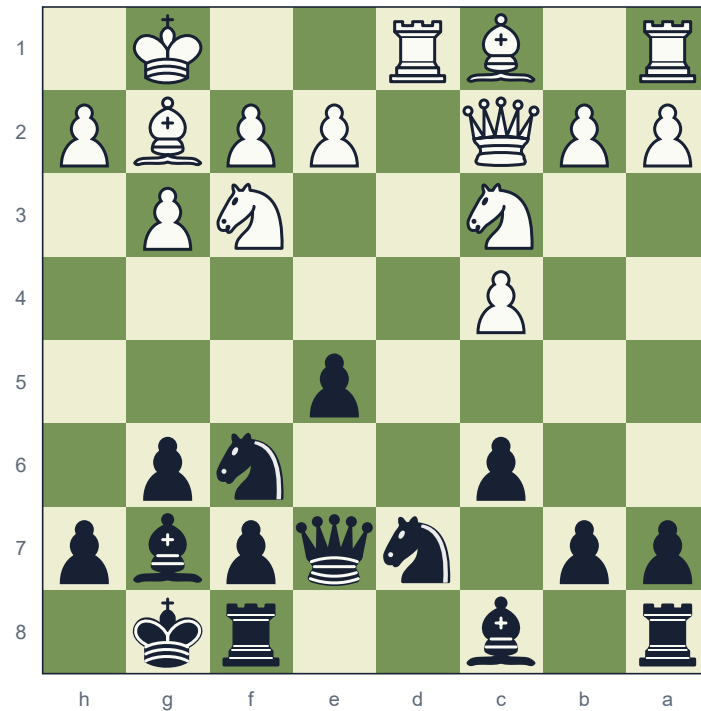
Find safe entry squares, count checks, and coordinate the king with a rook or minor piece. If the king cannot advance, improve a piece or create a pawn target first.

HABIT TO RETAIN

The opening plan is finished only when you have reassessed the new material balance.

Rook activity versus pawn protection

ENDGAME TRANSITION | 14-04



White to move

THE IDEA

Central exchanges may leave an open d-file and isolated targets. A rook tied to one pawn can become less useful than an active rook that creates counterplay elsewhere.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

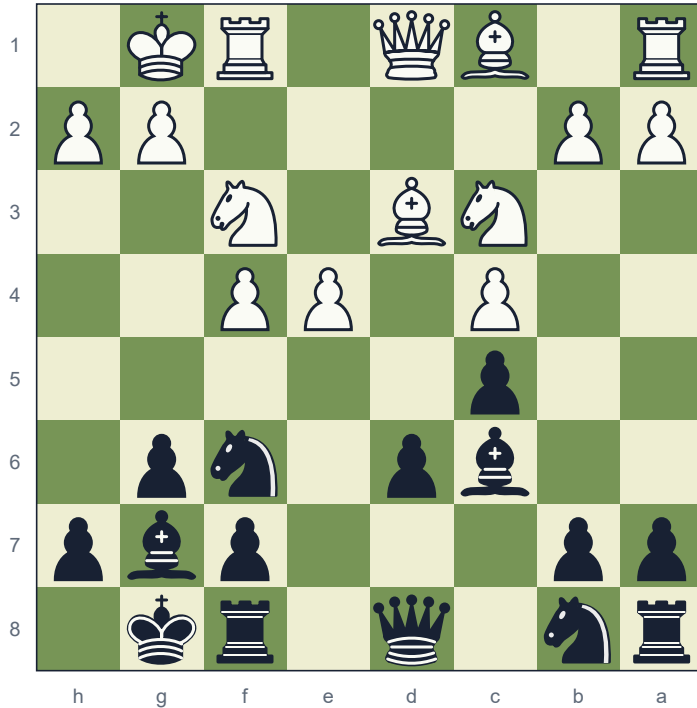
Compare active defense, a counterattack on another pawn, and a passive defense. Giving a pawn for activity needs a concrete line showing how the rook enters or how the pawn can be recovered.

HABIT TO RETAIN

In your review, identify the first moment a rook became passive and propose an active alternative.

Passed pawns and the choice of exchanges

ENDGAME TRANSITION | 11-04



White to move

THE IDEA

Benoni-style exchanges can create pawn majorities and potential passers. Count the pawn races only after checking blockades, king activity and whether a rook belongs behind a passer.

WORK THROUGH THE DECISION

Do not exchange into an ending merely because queens are dangerous. Compare the passer your opponent receives with the piece activity you retain.

HABIT TO RETAIN

Before a simplifying exchange, name the future passed pawn for both sides and the piece that can stop it.

From the opening anchor to independent decisions

ORIGINAL TRAINING CONTINUATIONS

These ten laboratories were extended with local Stockfish analysis. They are not historical master games. They illustrate one legal continuation to roughly moves 20-24, including White's replies.

START WITH BLACK TO MOVE

Each laboratory starts at a Black decision after White has played the next move beyond the opening study line. Cover the following pages and write a candidate move, its purpose and White's best reply.

COMPARE THE ALTERNATIVES

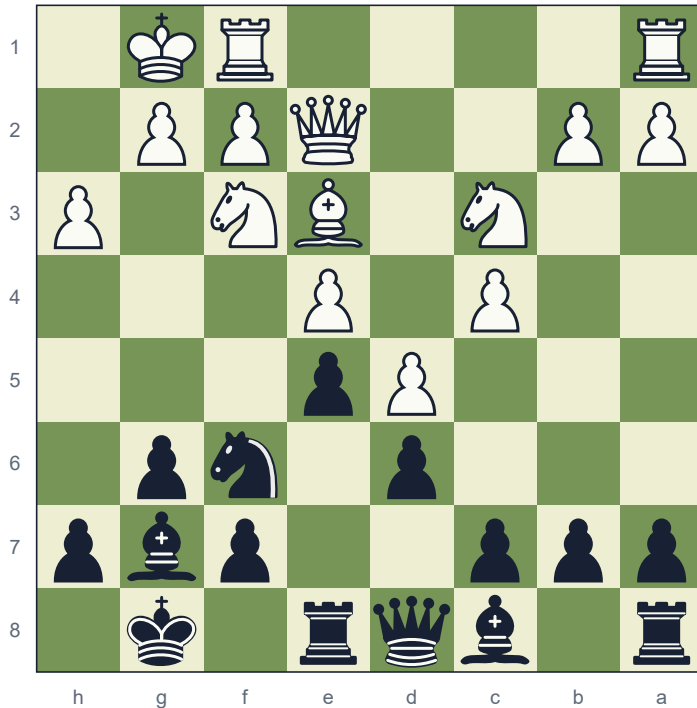
The decision page gives two searched candidates and short principal variations. Those variations are calculation samples, not forced scripts. Compare what each move changes rather than trying to memorize all of them.

PLAY THE POSITION

Use Middlegame_Laboratory.pgn to replay or set up the position. Play it with both colors. A move different from the sample is not automatically a mistake; analyze the first new decision after the game.

Classical gateway / start

LAB 02-02 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Calculate Bxd4 and Nxd4 before choosing a recapture. Finish development while using the active knight and the central files.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The defining choice is whether d4 meets e5 by advancing, exchanging, or remaining in contact. Only the advance creates the familiar locked chain.

Classical gateway / compare decisions

11... NH5 VERSUS H6

Vacates f6 for the f-pawn and influences f4. Keep a safe route if White attacks the knight.

Sample A: 11... Nh5 12. a4 a5 13. Ra3 b6 14. Nb5

Sample B: 11... h6 12. b4 a5 13. a3 Nh5 14. c5

13... B6 VERSUS BD7

Improves the pawn on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 13... b6 14. Bg5 Bf6 15. Bd2 Bg7 16. Rfe1

Sample B: 13... Bd7 14. Ra3

15... BF6 VERSUS QC8

Improves the bishop on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Bf6 16. Be3 Nf4 17. Qd1 Bg7 18. Kh2

Sample B: 15... Qc8

17... BG7 VERSUS RF8

Improves the bishop on g7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

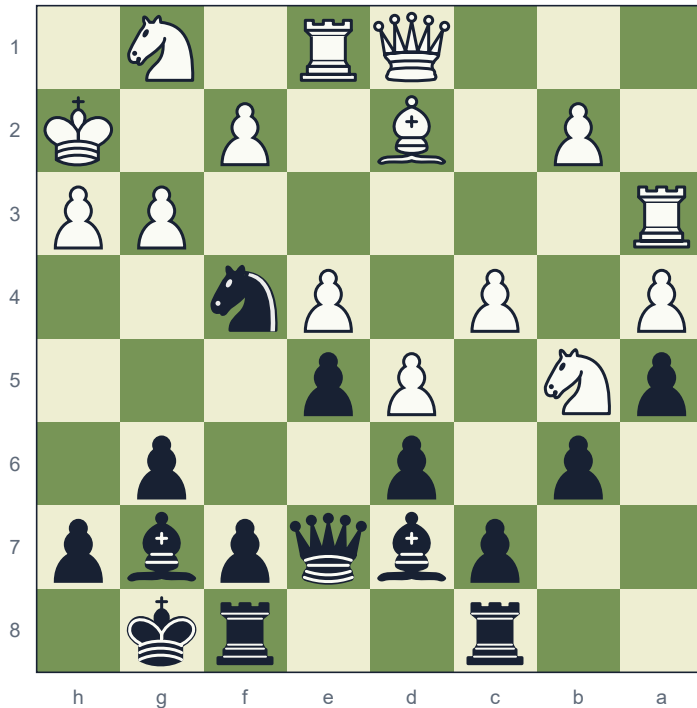
Sample A: 17... Bg7 18. Kh2 Rf8 19. Qc1 Ne2 20. Qc2

Sample B: 17... Rf8 18. Kh2 Bg7 19. Qc1 Ne2 20. Qa1

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Classical gateway / sample play

11... Nh5 12. a4 a5 13. Nb5 b6 14. Ra3 Bd7 15. Bg5 Bf6 16. Bd2 Nf4 17. Qd1 Bg7 18. Kh2 Rf8 19. Ng1 Qe7 20. Re1 Rac8 21. g3



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

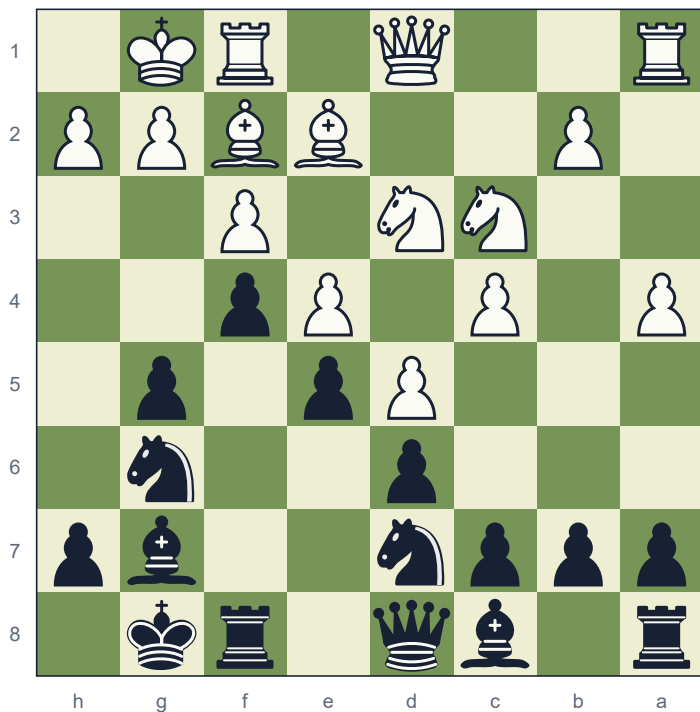
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Mar del Plata / start

LAB 03-01 | Begin at 14... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Coordinate ...Nf6, ...h5 and queen or rook access before sacrificing. White will often play c5, so estimate whether you can tolerate a queenside file opening.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White has d5 and e4 against d6 and e5. After ...f4 the center and kingside gain a second chain, giving Black space but fixing targets.

Mar del Plata / compare decisions

14... NF6 VERSUS KH8

Improves the knight on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 14... Nf6 15. a5

Sample B: 14... Kh8 15. a5 Nf6 16. c5 h5 17. cxd6

16... BXA6 VERSUS B6

The pawn captures on a6. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 16... bxa6 17. Nb4 g4 18. Nc6 Qd7 19. c5

Sample B: 16... b6

18... QD7 VERSUS QE8

Improves the queen on d7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 18... Qd7 19. c5 g3 20. Be1 h4 21. h3

Sample B: 18... Qe8 19. c5

20... H4 VERSUS NH7

Improves the pawn on h4. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

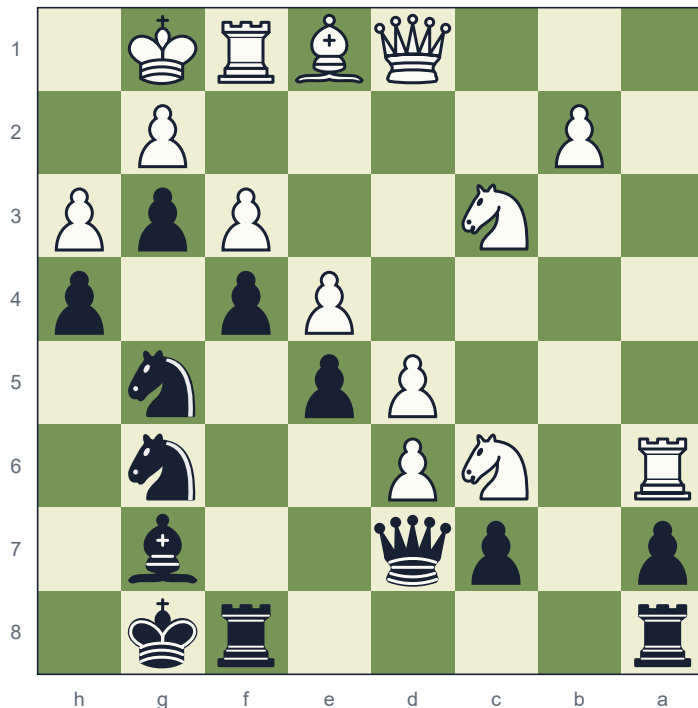
Sample A: 20... h4 21. h3 Nh7 22. Bxa6 Bxa6 23. Rxa6

Sample B: 20... Nh7 21. hxg3

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Mar del Plata / sample play

14... Nf6 15. a5 h5 16. a6 bxa6 17. Nb4 g4 18. Nc6 Qd7 19. c5 g3 20. Be1 h4 21. h3 Nh7 22. Bxa6 Bxa6
23. Rxa6 Ng5 24. cxd6



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

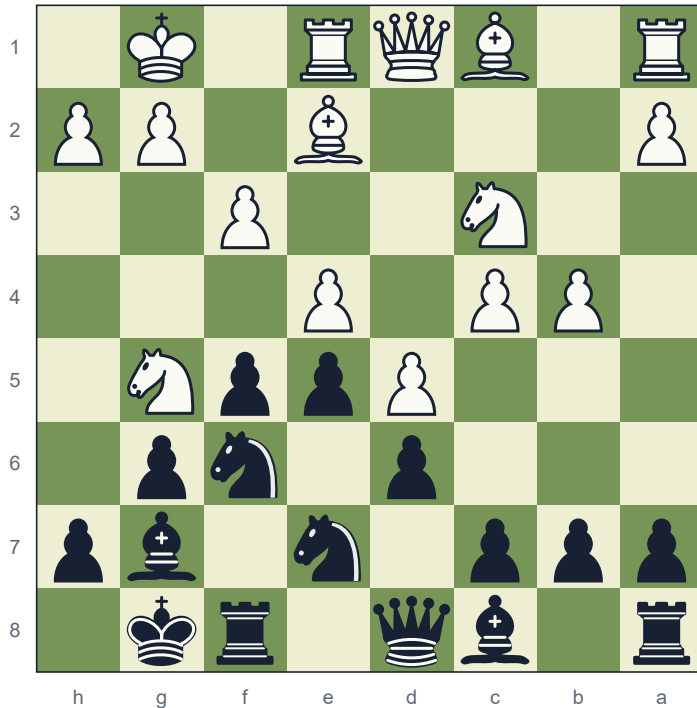
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Bayonet Attack / start

LAB 04-01 | Begin at 12... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop ...h6 only if it improves the tactical position, and consider ...a5 to question b4. White may trade on e6 or advance c5.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White gains queenside space with b4 and threatens c5. The e4 pawn can become tactically vulnerable after the knight reaches f4.

Bayonet Attack / compare decisions

12... KH8 VERSUS C6

Improves the king on h8. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 12... Kh8 13. a4 Nh5 14. c5 Nf4 15. Bc4

Sample B: 12... c6 13. Be3 Bh6 14. c5 f4 15. Bf2

14... NH5 VERSUS RE8

Vacates f6 for the f-pawn and influences f4. Keep a safe route if White attacks the knight.

Sample A: 14... Nh5 15. c5 Nf4 16. Bc4 fxe4 17. Rxe4

Sample B: 14... Re8

16... FXE4 VERSUS DXC5

The pawn captures on e4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 16... fxe4 17. Rxe4 Nf5 18. Bxf4 exf4 19. Nd5

Sample B: 16... dxc5 17. bxc5

18... DXE4 VERSUS EXF4

The pawn captures on e4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

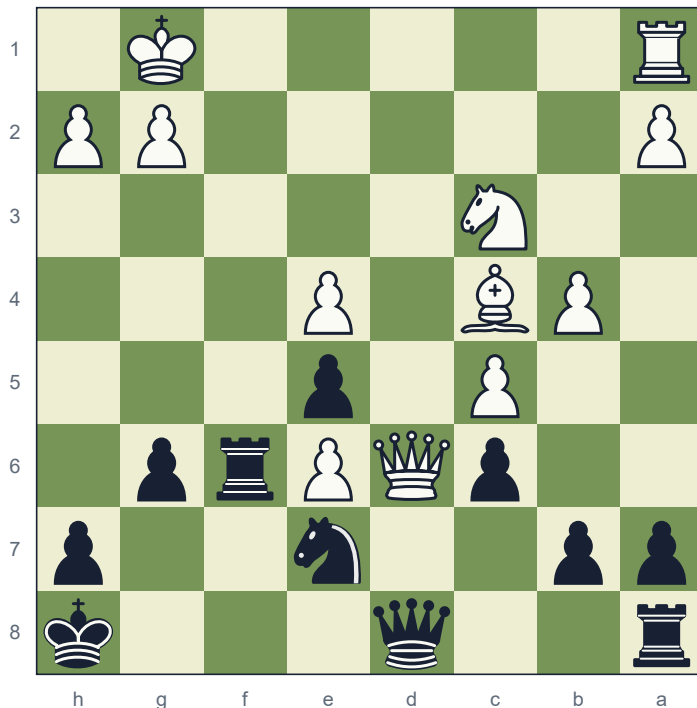
Sample A: 18... dxe4 19. Bg5 Bf6 20. Bxf6+ Rxf6 21. Nxe4

Sample B: 18... exf4 19. Nxd5 Nxd5 20. Bxd5 Qe7 21. c6

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Bayonet Attack / sample play

12... Kh8 13. Ne6 Bxe6 14. dxe6 Nh5 15. c5 Nf4 16. Bc4 fxe4 17. Rxe4 d5 18. Bxf4 dxe4 19. Bg5 Bf6
20. Bxf6+ Rxf6 21. fxe4 c6 22. Qd6



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

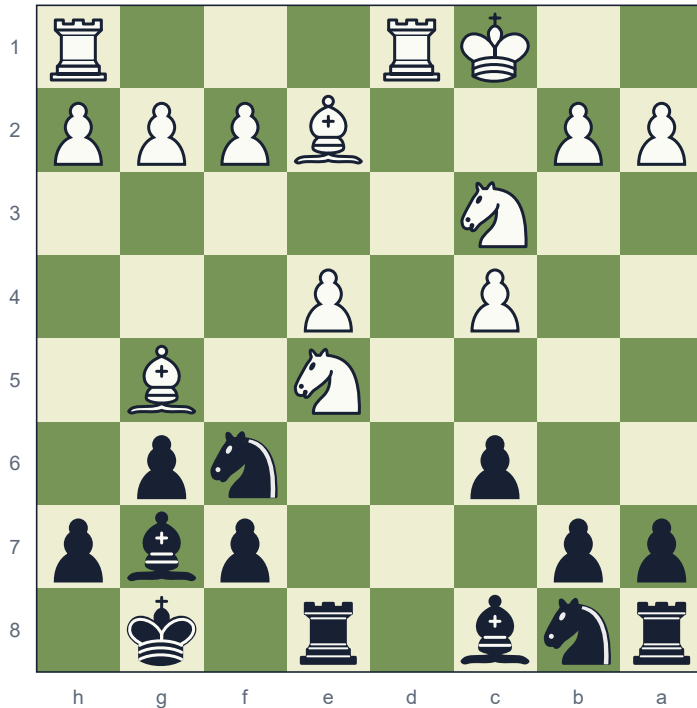
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Exchange Variation / start

LAB 06-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop the b8 knight and the c8 bishop, then challenge the d-file. Watch for a knight reaching d5.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The d-file opens, with White's e4 pawn facing Black's pawn on e5. Open files and minor-piece squares matter more than opposite-wing races.

Exchange Variation / compare decisions

11... H6 VERSUS NA6

Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target.

Sample A: 11... h6 12. Bf4 Na6 13. Bf3 Nh7 14. Nd7

Sample B: 11... Na6 12. Rd6

13... NC5 VERSUS NXE4

Uses a central outpost to pressure e4 and nearby squares; check White's b4 advance.

Sample A: 13... Nc5 14. Bf3 g5 15. Bh2 Be6 16. b3

Sample B: 13... Nxe4 14. Nxe4

15... A5 VERSUS H5

Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5.

Sample A: 15... a5

Sample B: 15... h5 16. b4 Ncd7 17. Nxd7 Nxd7 18. Kc2

17... A4 VERSUS RAD8

Improves the pawn on a4. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

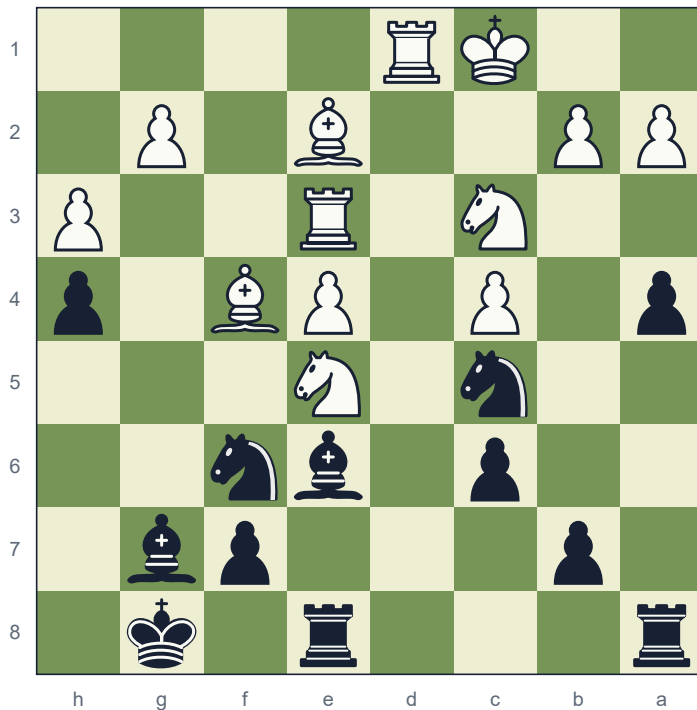
Sample A: 17... a4 18. Re3

Sample B: 17... Rad8 18. Rxd8 Rxd8 19. Rd1 Rxd1+ 20. Kxd1

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Exchange Variation / sample play

11... h6 12. Bf4 Na6 13. h3 Nc5 14. Bf3 g5 15. Bg3 a5 16. Rhe1 Be6 17. Bh2 a4 18. Re3 h5 19. Be2 h4 20. f4 gxf4 21. Bxf4



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Samisch / start

LAB 09-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Against long castling, examine ...b5 as an attack on the king. Against a slower setup, compare ...e5 and central piece development.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White supports e4 with f3 and often leaves the king flexible. Black's c-pawn remains free, and the c6 knight pressures d4.

Samisch / compare decisions

11... A5 VERSUS RA8

Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5.

Sample A: 11... a5

Sample B: 11... Ra8 12. Be2 a5 13. O-O-O a4 14. Na1

13... E6 VERSUS C6

Improves the pawn on e6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 13... e6

Sample B: 13... c6 14. Nb3 b5 15. cxb5 cxb5 16. Nd4

15... C5 VERSUS C6

Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated.

Sample A: 15... c5 16. dxc6 bxc6 17. Nc4 Nxc4 18. Bxc4

Sample B: 15... c6 16. dxc6 bxc6 17. Nc4 Nxc4 18. Bxc4

17... NXC4 VERSUS NE8

The knight captures on c4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

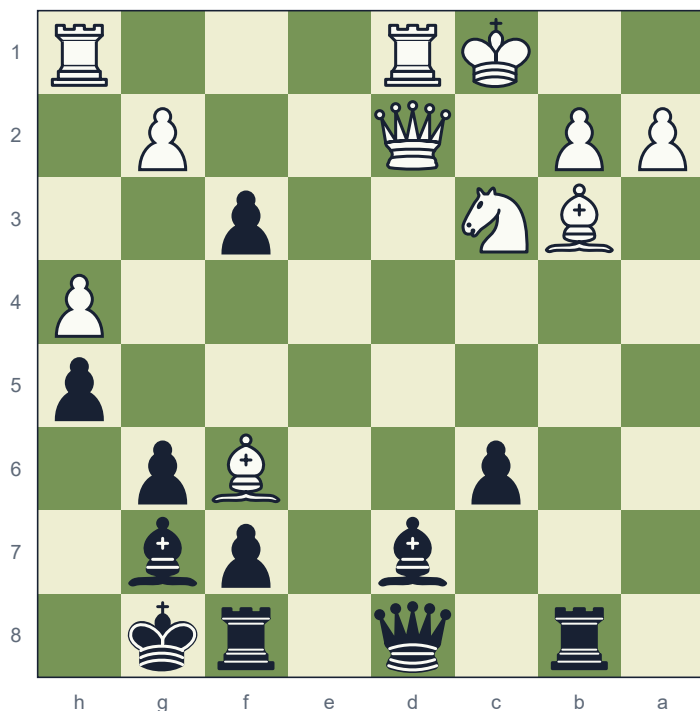
Sample A: 17... Nxc4 18. Bxc4 d5 19. Bb3 Rxb3 20. axb3

Sample B: 17... Ne8 18. Bh6 Be6 19. Bxg7 Nxc4 20. Bxc4

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Samisch / sample play

11... a5 12. d5 Ne5 13. Nxa5 e6 14. O-O-O exd5 15. cxd5 c5 16. dxc6 bxc6 17. Nc4 Nxc4 18. Bxc4 d5
19. Bb3 dxe4 20. Bg5 exf3 21. Bxf6



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

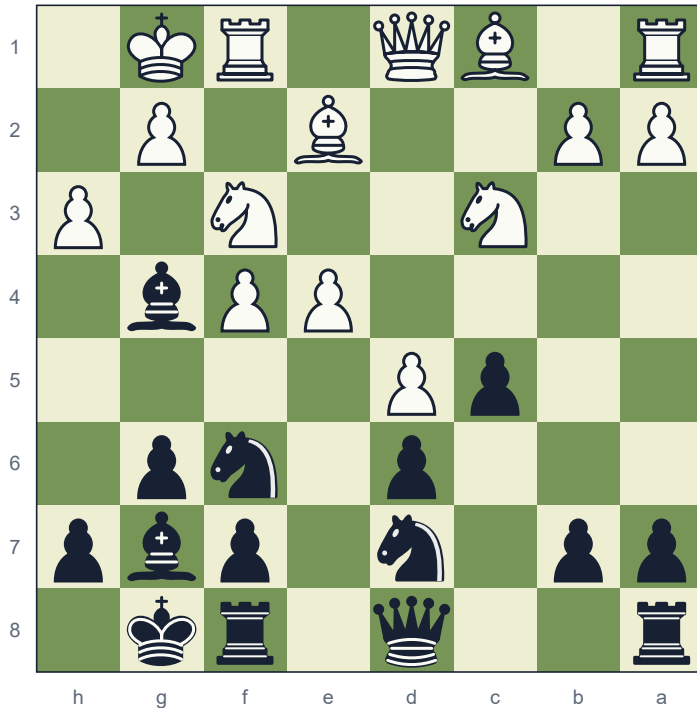
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Four Pawns Attack / start

LAB 11-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Use ...Re8, ...a6 and sometimes ...b5 after completing development. Watch White's e5 advance on every move.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White builds c4/d4/e4/f4. The pawn mass controls space but creates targets and leaves development unfinished.

Four Pawns Attack / compare decisions

11... Bxf3 VERSUS Bh5

The bishop captures on f3. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 11... Bxf3 12. Bxf3

Sample B: 11... Bh5 12. g4 Nxg4 13. hxg4 Bxg4 14. Ng5

13... H6 VERSUS B5

Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target.

Sample A: 13... h6

Sample B: 13... b5 14. g5 Nh5 15. Ne2 c4 16. Be3

15... NH7 VERSUS DXE5

Improves the knight on h7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Nh7 16. e6 gxf4 17. exd7 Qxd7 18. Kg2

Sample B: 15... dxe5 16. fxg5 Nh7 17. Ne4 f5 18. gxf6

17... QXD7 VERSUS RE7

The queen captures on d7. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

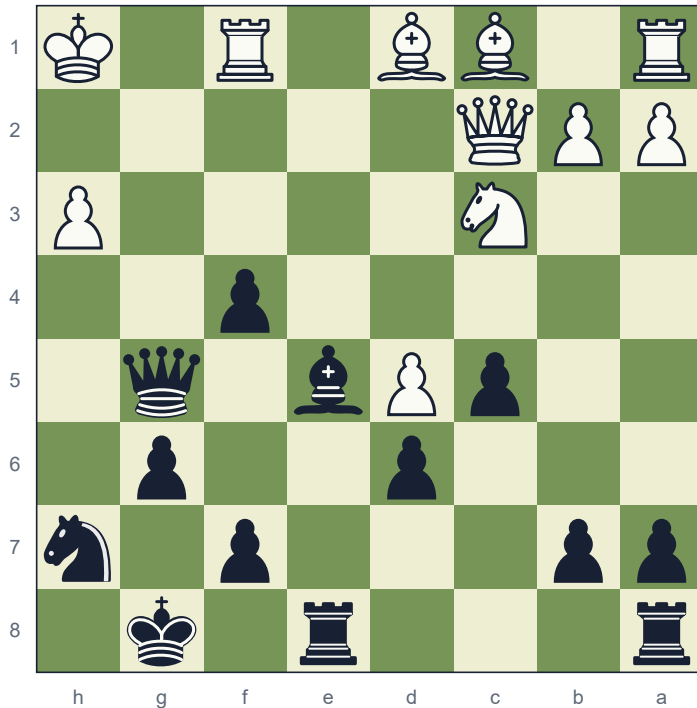
Sample A: 17... Qxd7

Sample B: 17... Re7 18. Bxf4 Qxd7 19. Kg2 Be5 20. Qd2

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Four Pawns Attack / sample play

11... Bxf3 12. Bxf3 Re8 13. g4 h6 14. g5 hxg5 15. e5 Nh7 16. e6 gxf4 17. exd7 Qxd7 18. Kg2 Be5 19. Qc2 Qd8 20. Bd1 Qg5+ 21. Kh1



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Averbakh / start

LAB 12-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop ...Re8, ...Nbd7 and the queen bishop actively. Inspect whether ...h6 wins a useful tempo or merely gives White an attacking target.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The center often becomes a Benoni structure after d5 and ...exd5, with White's bishop already on g5.

Averbakh / compare decisions

11... NE4 VERSUS BC8

Improves the knight on e4. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 11... Ne4 12. Nxe4 Bxe4 13. f3 h6 14. Bxh6

Sample B: 11... Bc8 12. O-O Re8 13. Rfe1 Nbd7 14. h3

13... H6 VERSUS QXB2

Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target.

Sample A: 13... h6 14. Bxh6 Bxh6 15. Qxh6 Qxb2 16. Rc1

Sample B: 13... Qxb2 14. Rc1 Qxd2+ 15. Kxd2 Bf5 16. Nxf5

15... QXB2 VERSUS BC2

The queen captures on b2. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 15... Qxb2

Sample B: 15... Bc2 16. Qc1 Qa5+ 17. Kf2 Qd8 18. g3

17... BC2 VERSUS BF5

Improves the bishop on c2. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

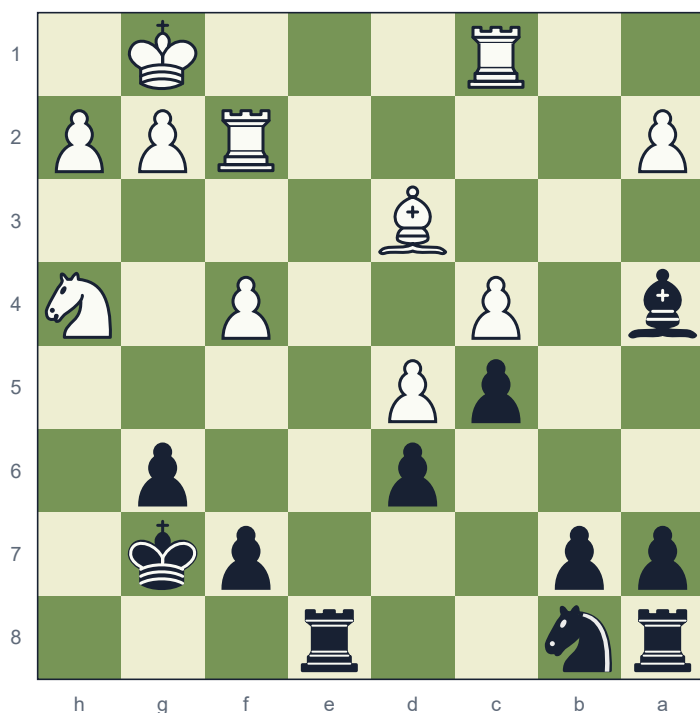
Sample A: 17... Bc2 18. Rf2 Ba4 19. Bf1 Qg7 20. Qg5

Sample B: 17... Bf5

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Averbakh / sample play

11... Ne4 12. Nxe4 Bxe4 13. f3 h6 14. Bxh6 Bxh6 15. Qxh6 Qxb2 16. Rc1 Re8 17. O-O Bc2 18. Rf2 Ba4 19. Bd3 Qg7 20. Qxg7+ Kxg7 21. f4



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

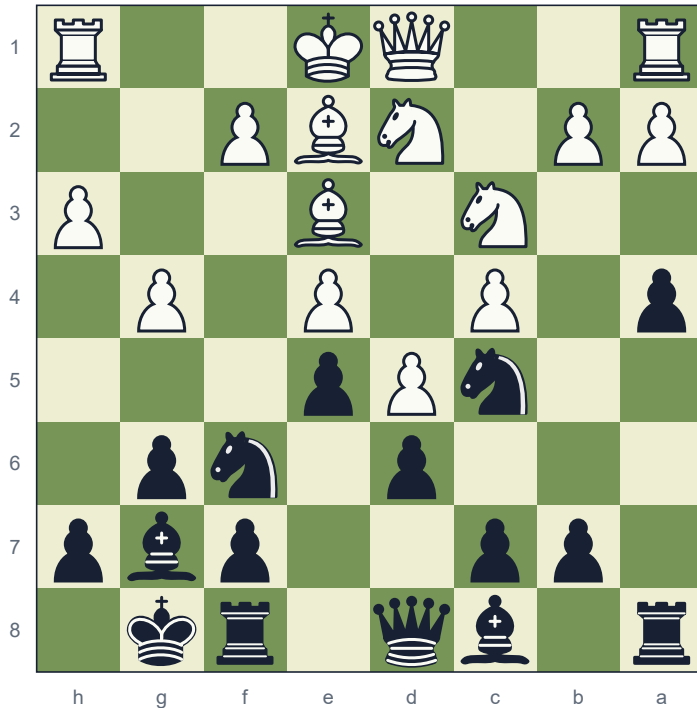
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Makogonov and h3 systems / start

LAB 13-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Improve the queen bishop and prepare a central or kingside break with support. Keep the c5 knight from becoming a fixed target.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

h3 keeps the g-pawn flexible and controls g4. White may keep the king in the center, castle short, or attack your king.

Makogonov and h3 systems / compare decisions

11... C6 VERSUS NE8

Controls d5 and can support a later ...d5 break or challenge a white d5 wedge.

Sample A: 11... c6

Sample B: 11... Ne8 12. h4 f5 13. g5 a3 14. b4

13... NH5 VERSUS NE8

Vacates f6 for the f-pawn and influences f4. Keep a safe route if White attacks the knight.

Sample A: 13... Nh5

Sample B: 13... Ne8 14. h4 f6 15. f3 Qa5 16. O-O-O

15... QA5 VERSUS KH8

Creates concrete pressure on central or queenside targets; count tempo attacks on the queen.

Sample A: 15... Qa5 16. Ke2 h4 17. b4 axb3 18. axb3

Sample B: 15... Kh8 16. Bxc5

17... AXB3 VERSUS QXB4

The immediate en passant capture changes the pawn contact and opens lines; check the resulting attacks.

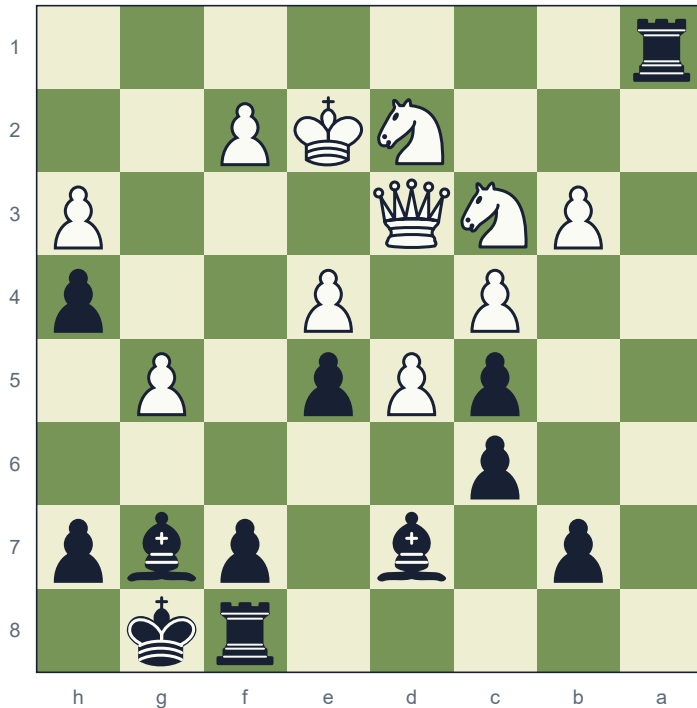
Sample A: 17... axb3 18. axb3

Sample B: 17... Qxb4 18. Rab1 Qa5 19. Bxc5 Qxc5 20. Nxa4

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Makogonov and h3 systems / sample play

11... c6 12. Qc2 Bd7 13. g5 Nh5 14. Bxh5 gxh5 15. Rg1 Qa5 16. Ke2 h4 17. b4 axb3 18. axb3 Qxa1 19. Rxa1 Rxa1 20. Bxc5 dxc5 21. Qd3



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

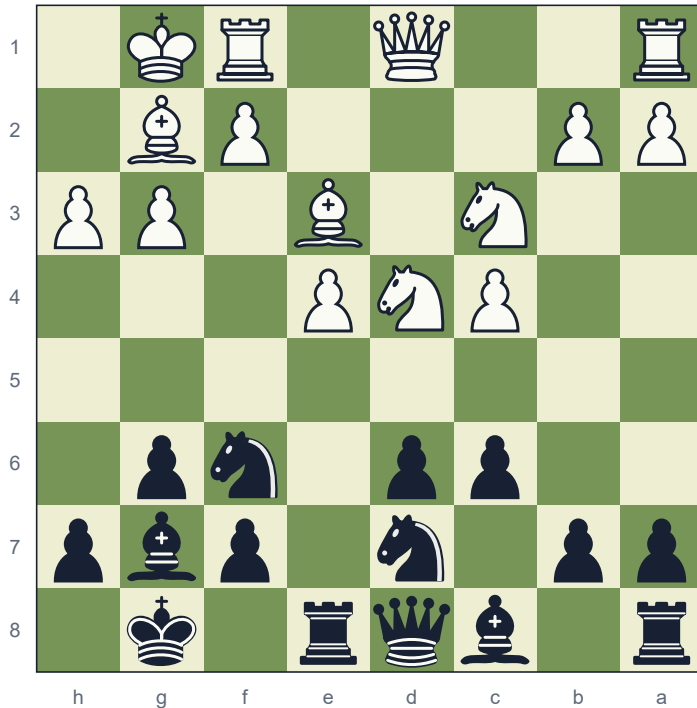
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Fianchetto / start

LAB 14-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Compare ...exd4 followed by ...Nc5 with keeping the tension. Use ...a5 if it helps the knight or restrains b4.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants a safe king, strong central control, and pressure on the long diagonal. White often meets attacks by exchanging the center.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The long diagonal is a major feature. The center may stay tense, close with d5, or open through ...exd4.

Fianchetto / compare decisions

11... A5 VERSUS NC5

Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5.

Sample A: 11... a5 12. Qc2 a4 13. Rad1 Qa5 14. Rfe1

Sample B: 11... Nc5

13... NB6 VERSUS QE7

Improves the knight on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 13... Nb6 14. c5 Nc4 15. Bc1 a3 16. b3

Sample B: 13... Qe7 14. Re1

15... NB6 VERSUS QE7

Improves the knight on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Nb6

Sample B: 15... Qe7 16. Re1 Nc5 17. Rad1 Qc7 18. f4

17... QE7 VERSUS RA6

Improves the queen on e7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

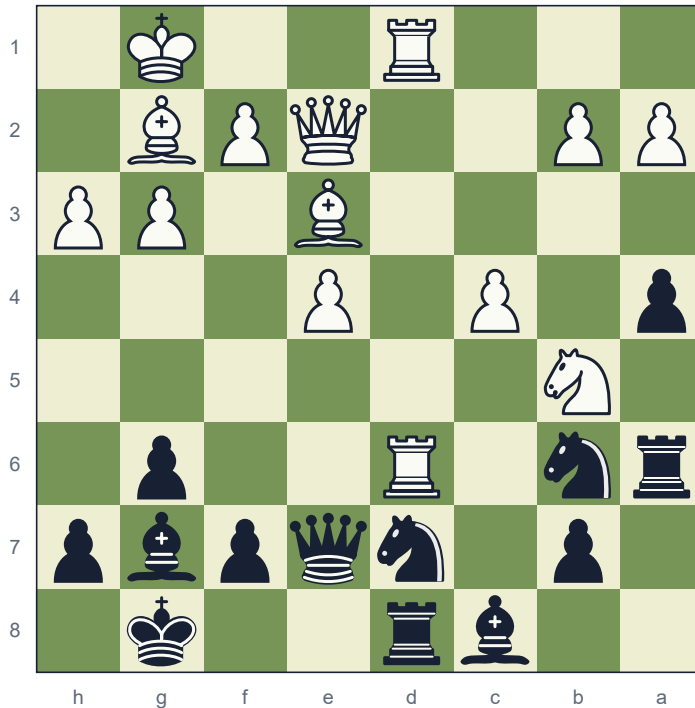
Sample A: 17... Qe7 18. Re1 Nc5 19. Rbd1 Qf8 20. b3

Sample B: 17... Ra6

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Fianchetto / sample play

11... a5 12. Qc2 a4 13. Rfd1 Nb6 14. Bf1 Nbd7 15. Bg2 Nb6 16. Qe2 Nfd7 17. Rab1 Qe7 18. Ndb5 cxb5
19. Nxb5 Rd8 20. Rxd6 Ra6 21. Rbd1



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

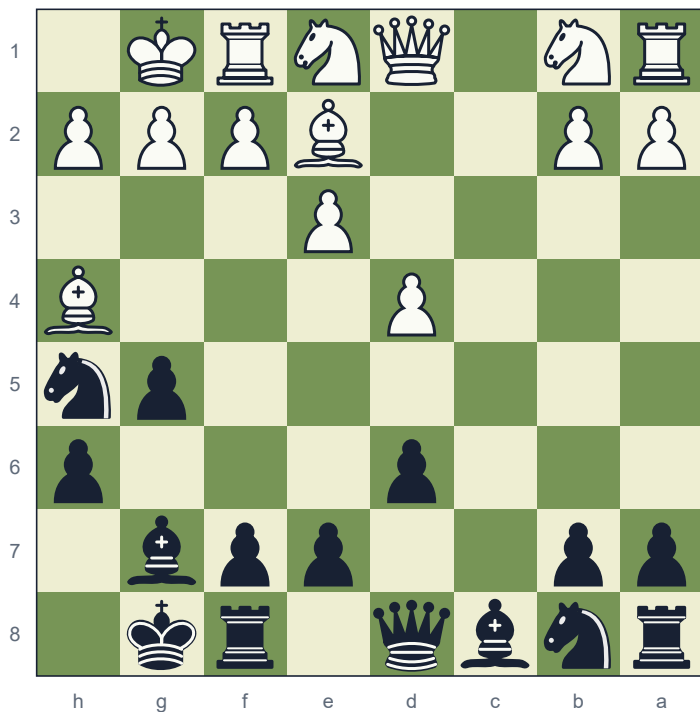
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

London Torre and Colle / start

LAB 19-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop ...Nc6 and pressure d4. Keep d6 defended against Bf4 and look for an active queen square.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

Without c4 and e4 together, White has a smaller center and different bishop activity. The dark-squared bishop may develop outside the pawn chain.

London Torre and Colle / compare decisions

11... GXH4 VERSUS NF4

The pawn captures on h4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 11... gxh4 12. Bxh5 e5 13. dxe5 dxe5 14. Nc3

Sample B: 11... Nf4 12. exf4

13... DXE5 VERSUS ND7

The pawn captures on e5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 13... dxe5 14. Nc3 Nd7 15. Bg4 Nc5 16. Bxc8

Sample B: 13... Nd7 14. Nc3 dxe5 15. Be2 h3 16. Bg4

15... NB6 VERSUS NF6

Improves the knight on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Nb6

Sample B: 15... Nf6 16. h3 e4 17. Nxe4 Nxe4 18. Bxe4

17... QE7 VERSUS RB8

Improves the queen on e7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

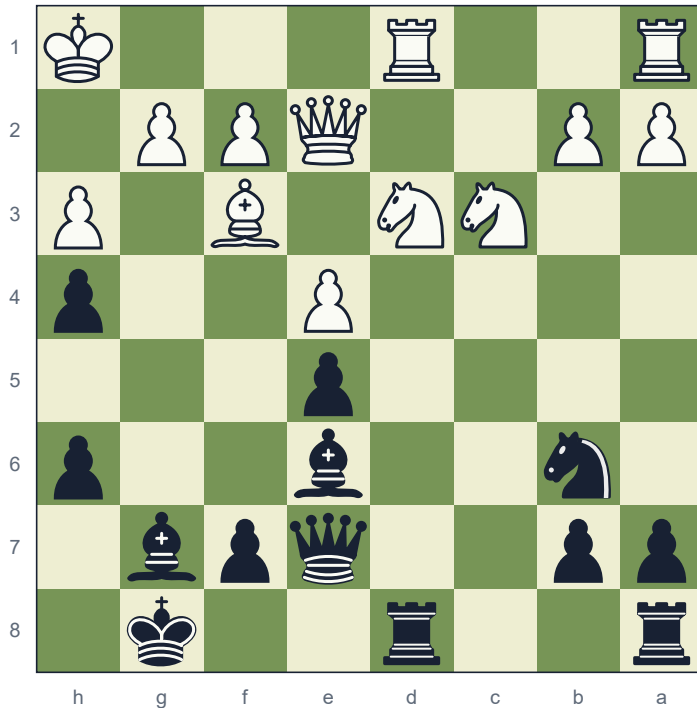
Sample A: 17... Qe7 18. Nd5 Nxd5 19. Bxd5 e4 20. Nc2

Sample B: 17... Rb8 18. Qe2

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

London Torre and Colle / sample play

11... gxf4 12. Bxf4 e5 13. dxe5 dxe5 14. Nc3 Nd7 15. Bf3 Nb6 16. h3 Qg5 17. Kh1 Qe7 18. Nd3 Rd8 19. Qe2 Bf5 20. e4 Be6 21. Rfd1



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Test the decision, not just the move

THREE SECTIONS

Exercises 1-48 test repertoire recall, 49-60 test plans and structures, and 61-72 test concrete opening decisions. Recall and concrete decisions are Black to move. Structure tasks always ask for Black's plan, but the diagram caption gives the actual side to move.

HOW TO ANSWER

Write the move or plan, its purpose, and White's strongest relevant resource. Calculate forcing lines before choosing a move. Cover the answer section until you finish a group.

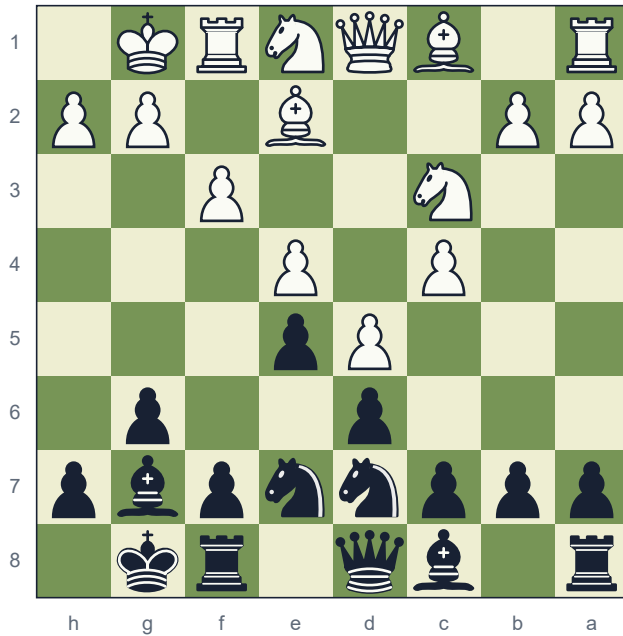
SCORING

Award one point for a sound move or plan, one for the explanation, and one for White's counterplay: maximum 216. The recall key gives the course move, not a claim that every alternative is wrong. Use the score to locate weak topics, not as an Elo estimate.

HOW TO REPAIR A MISS

Find the referenced booklet and line ID. Reconstruct the position, explain the missed idea, and replay the line tomorrow without looking. Repeat after three days and again after one week.

Exercises 01-02



Black to move

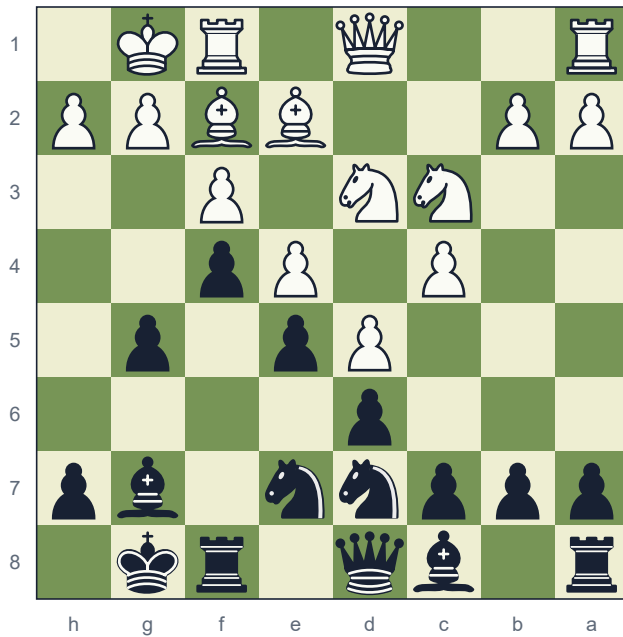
01. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

02. Black repertoire recall

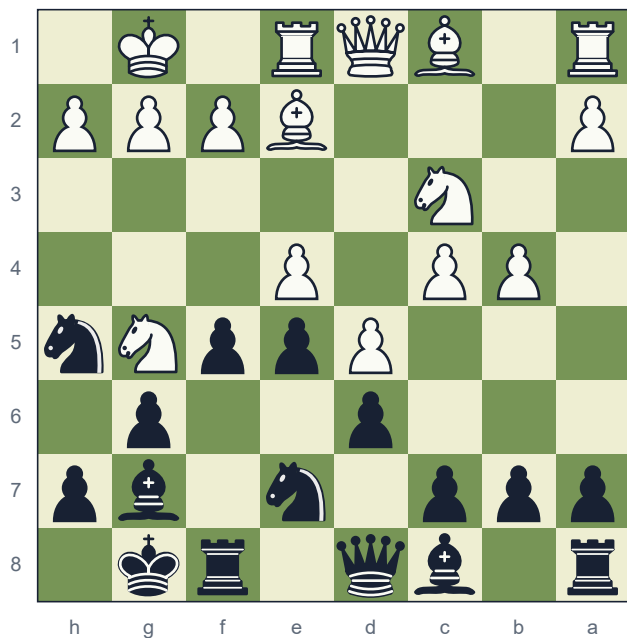
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 03-04



Black to move

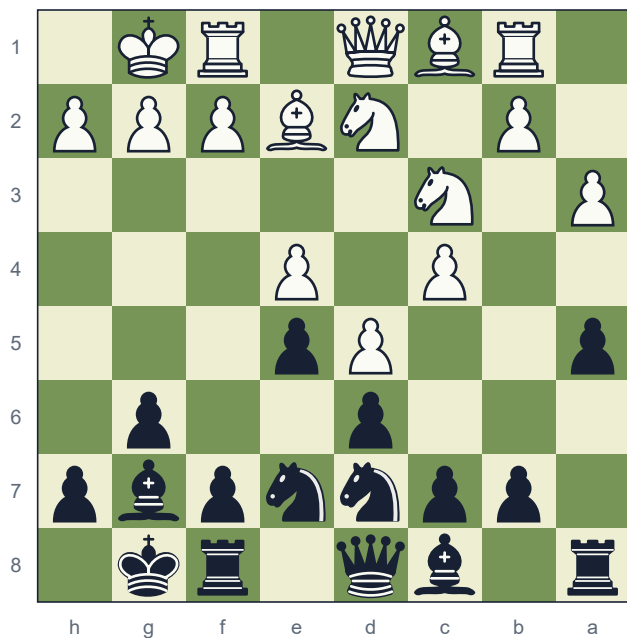
03. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

04. Black repertoire recall

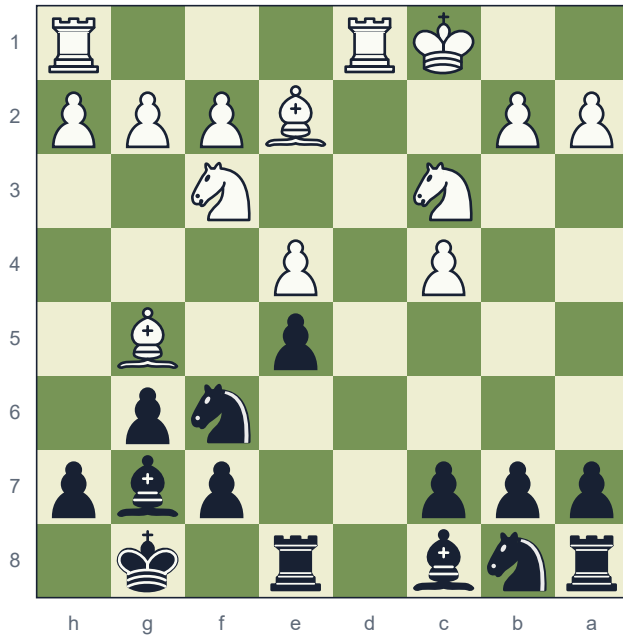
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 05-06



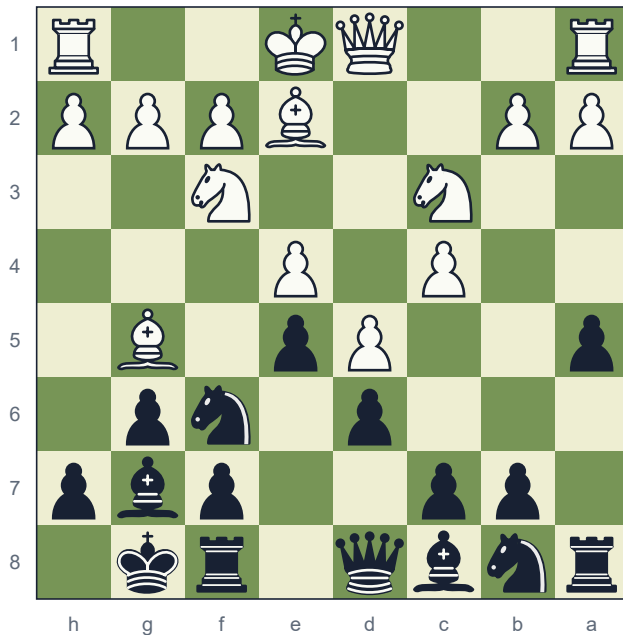
05. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



06. Black repertoire recall

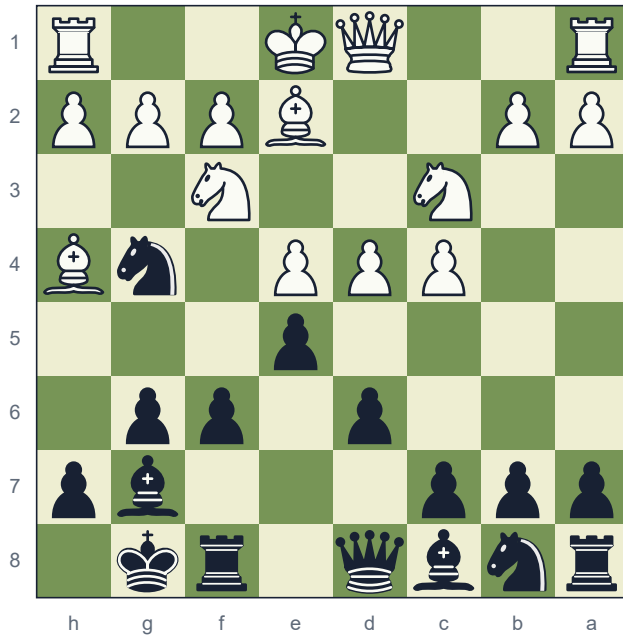
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 07-08



Black to move

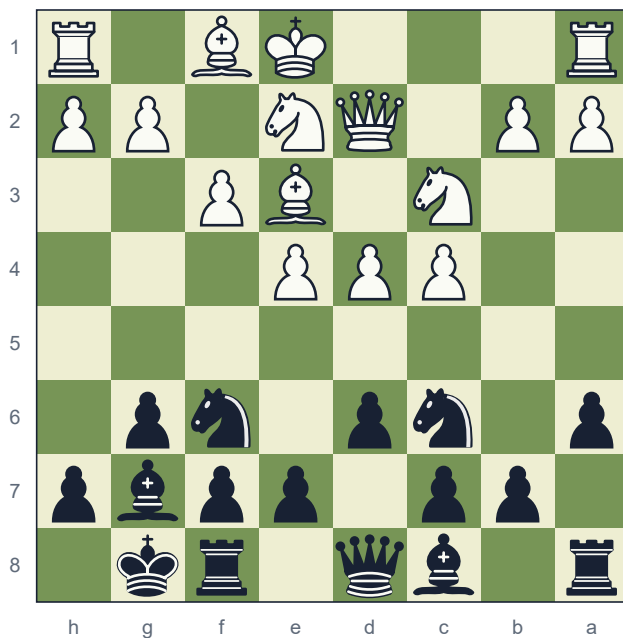
07. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

08. Black repertoire recall

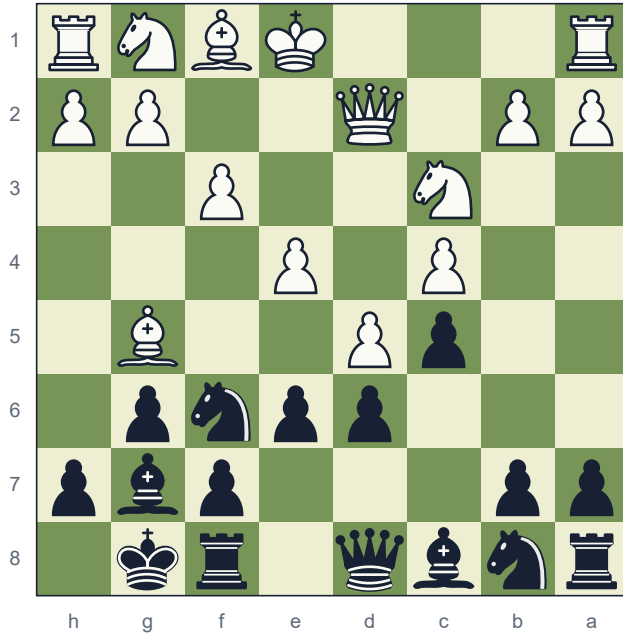
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 09-10



Black to move

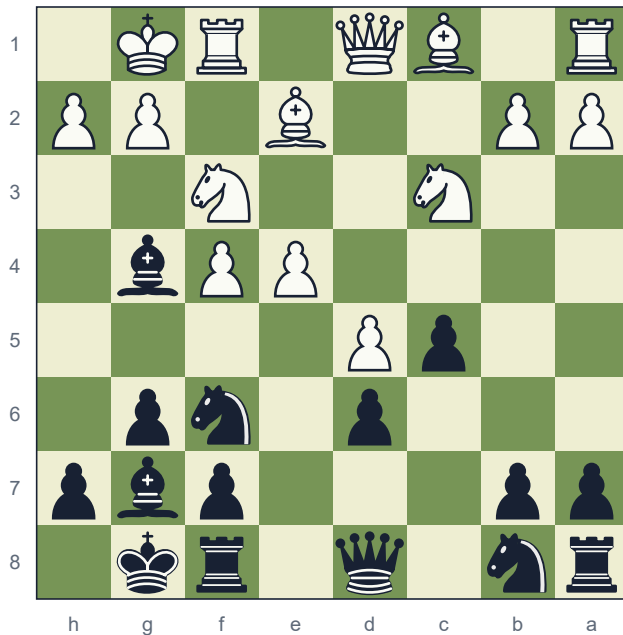
09. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

10. Black repertoire recall

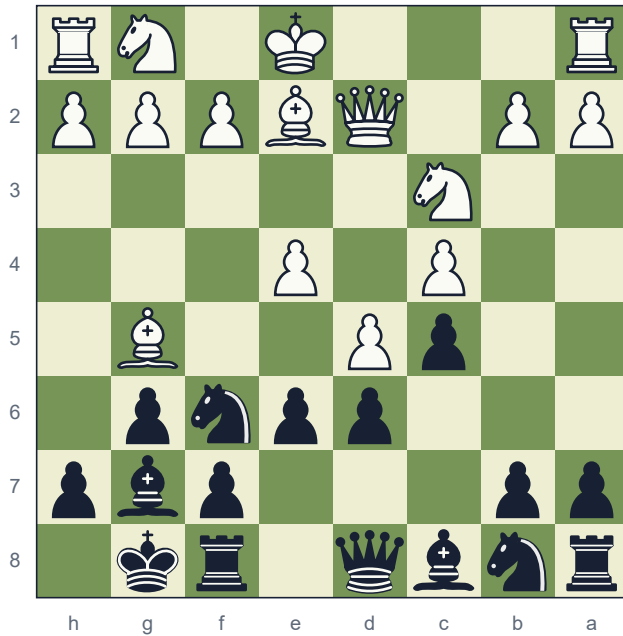
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 11-12



Black to move

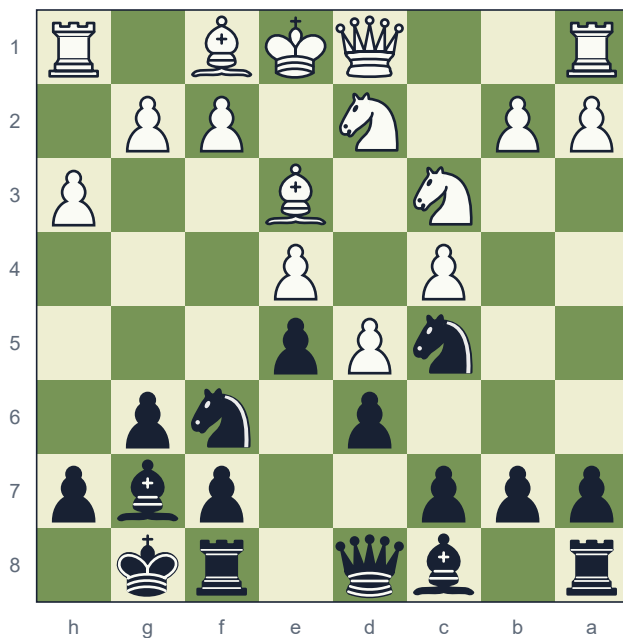
11. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

12. Black repertoire recall

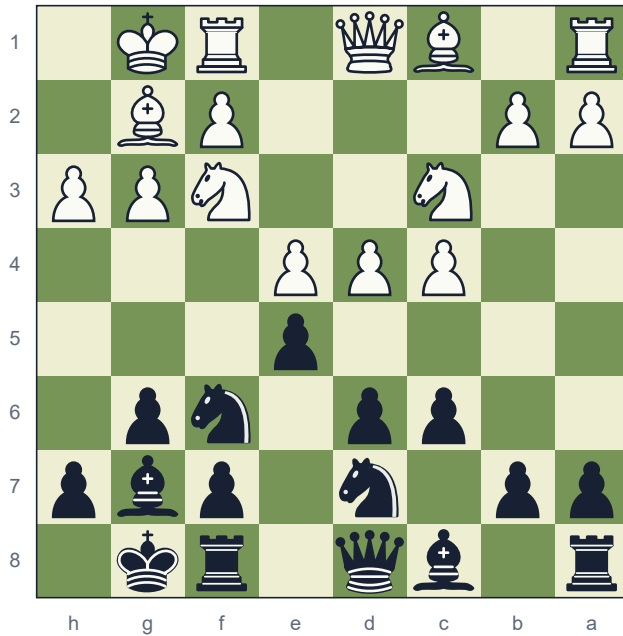
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 13-14



Black to move

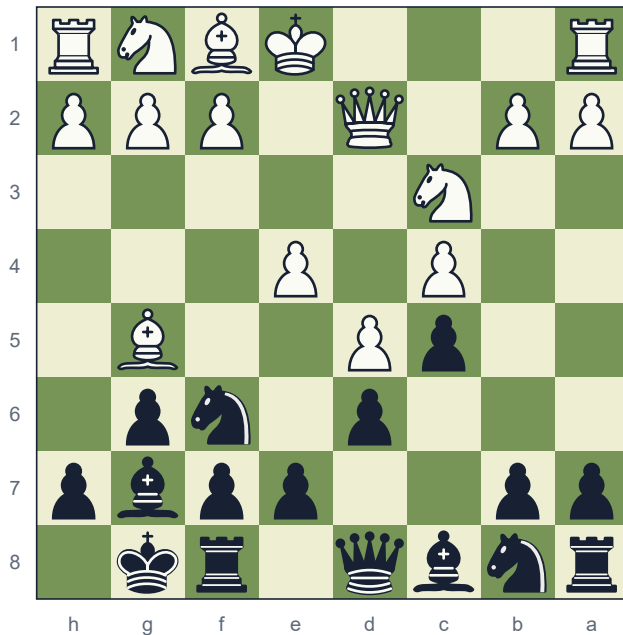
13. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

14. Black repertoire recall

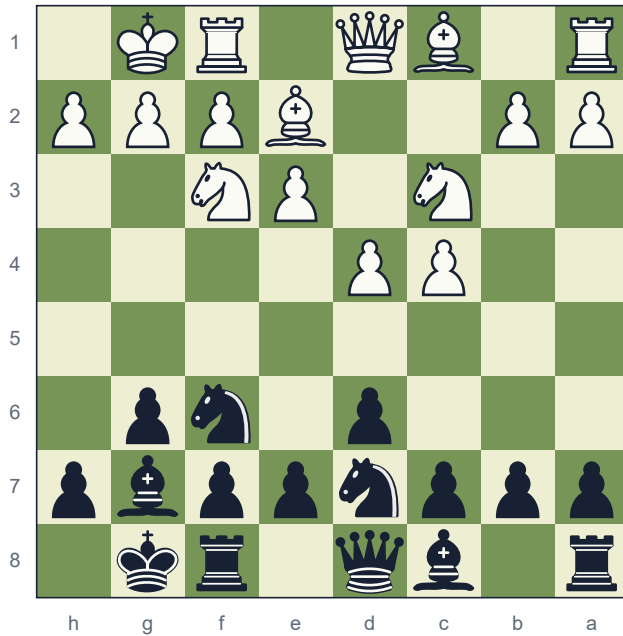
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 15-16



Black to move

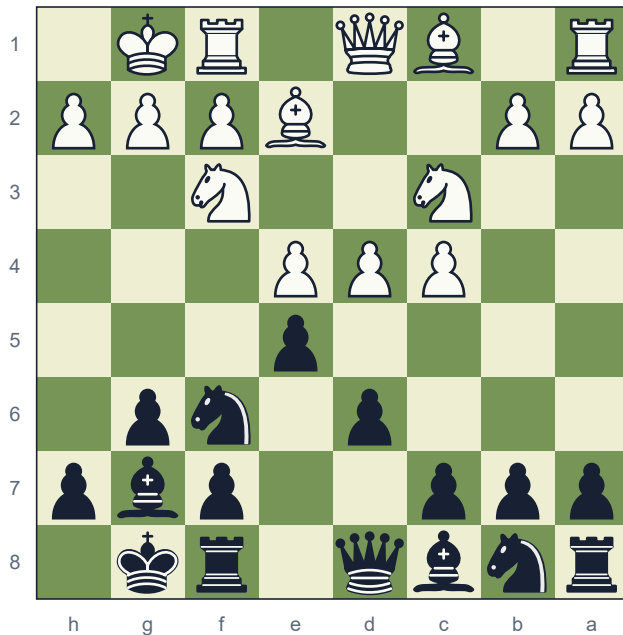
15. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

16. Black repertoire recall

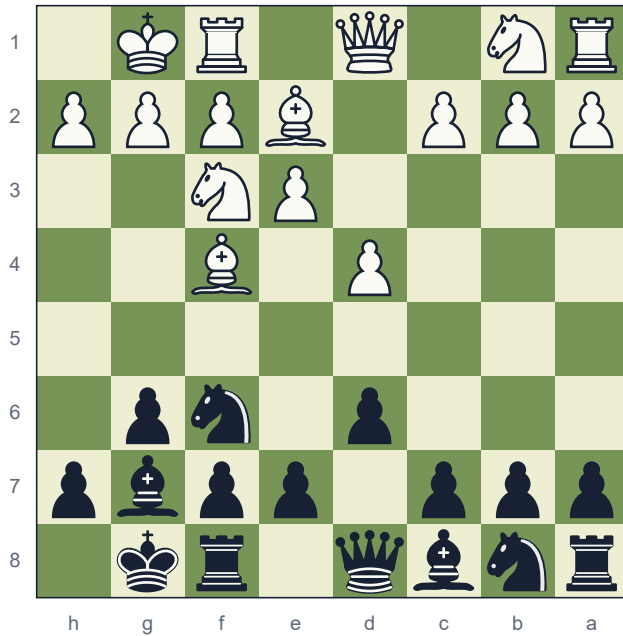
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 17-18



Black to move

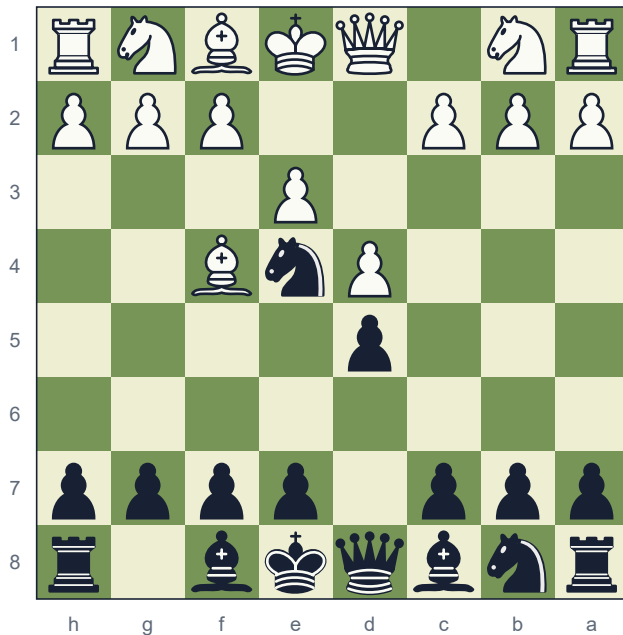
17. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

18. Black repertoire recall

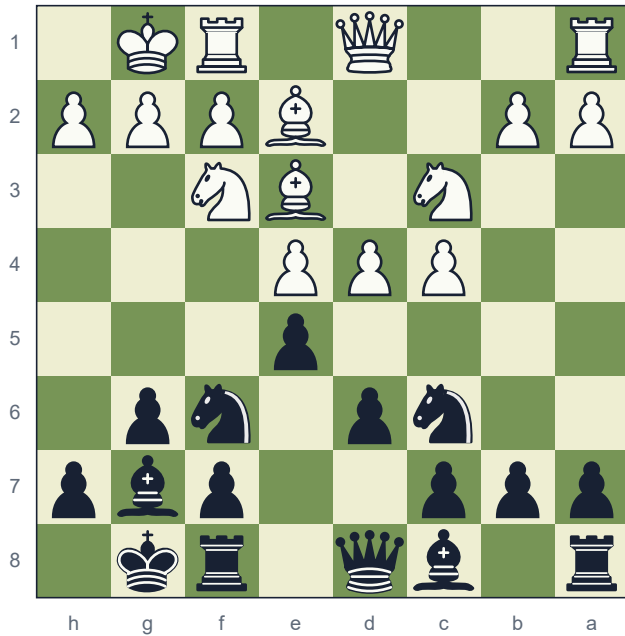
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 19-20



Black to move

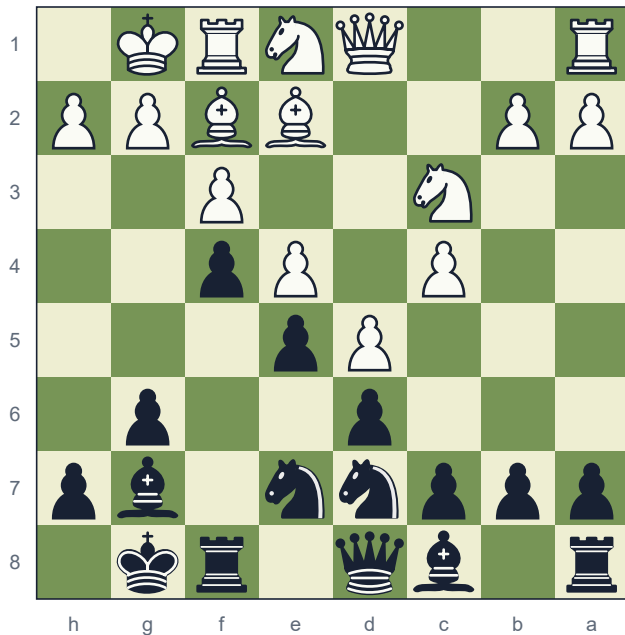
19. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

20. Black repertoire recall

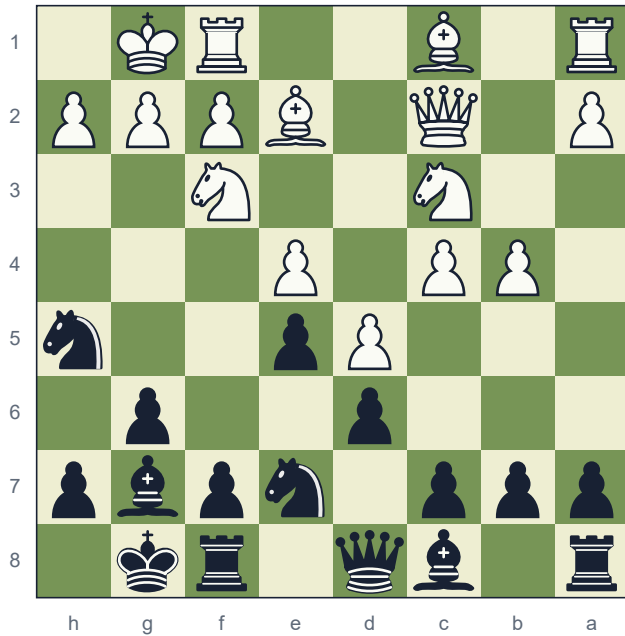
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 21-22



Black to move

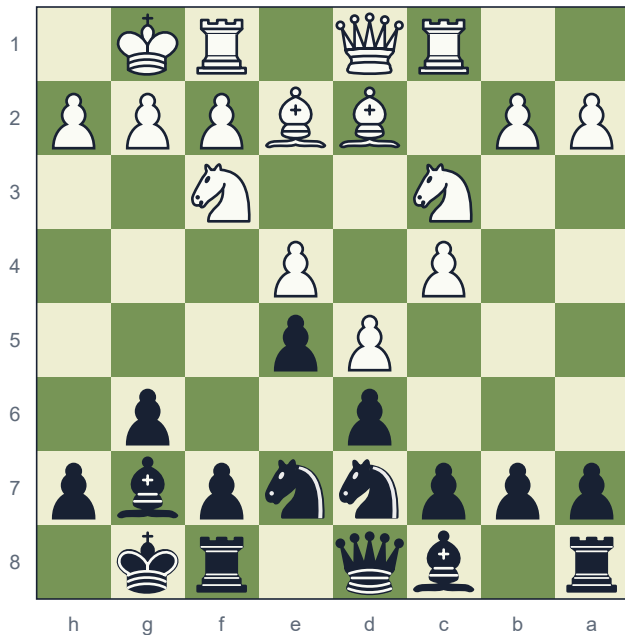
21. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

22. Black repertoire recall

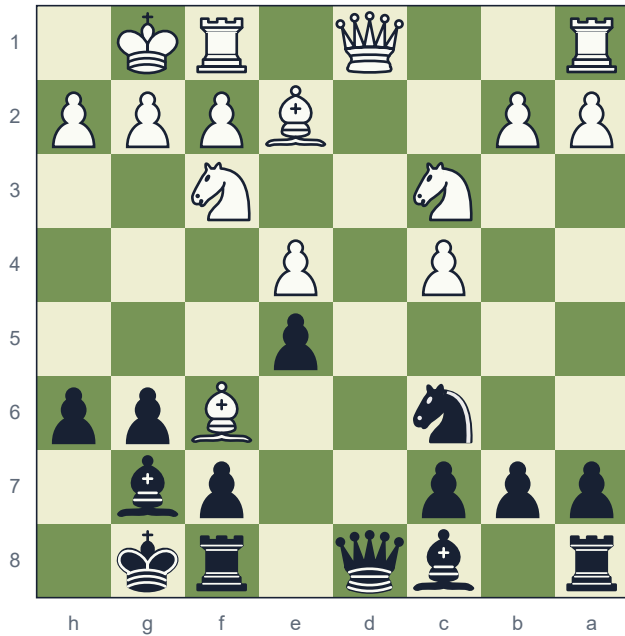
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 23-24



Black to move

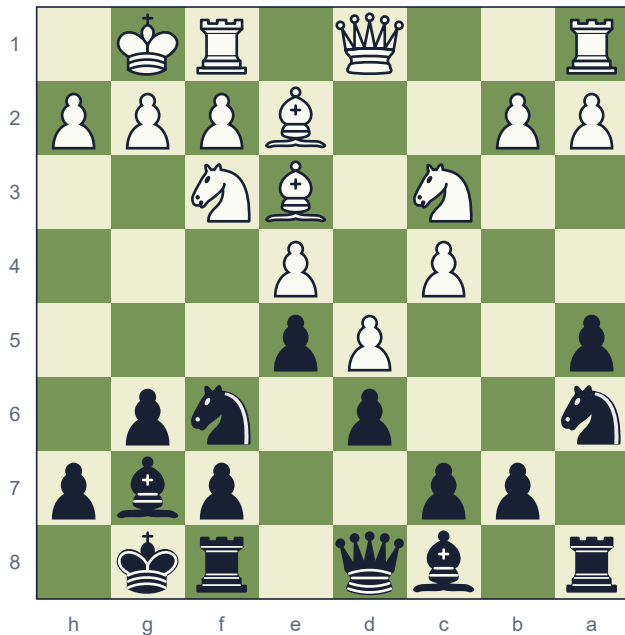
23. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

24. Black repertoire recall

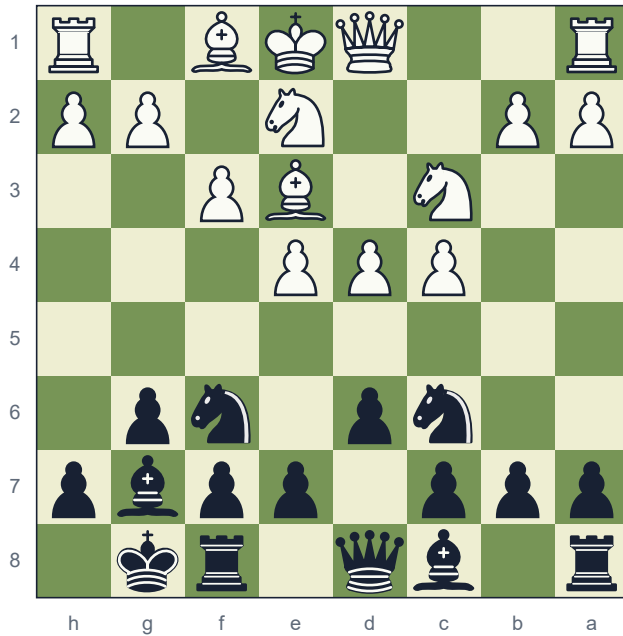
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 27-28



Black to move

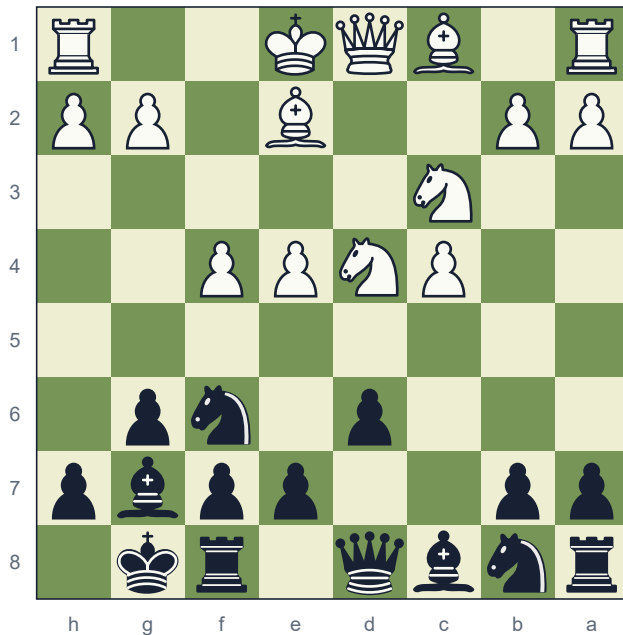
27. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

28. Black repertoire recall

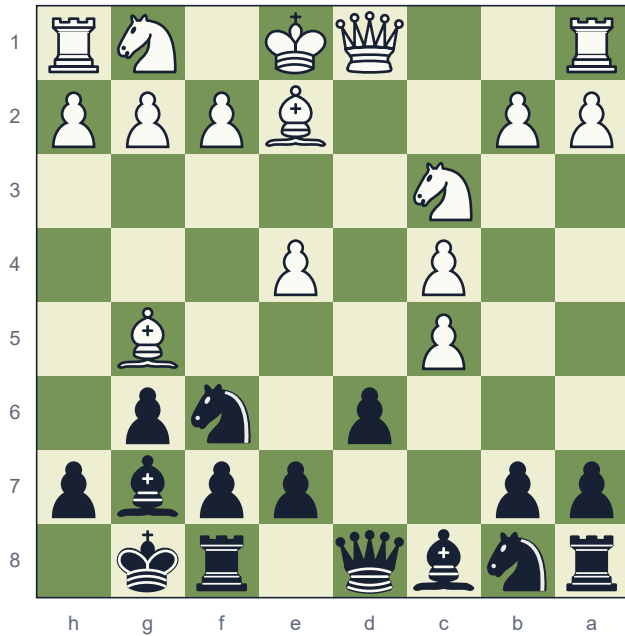
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 29-30



Black to move

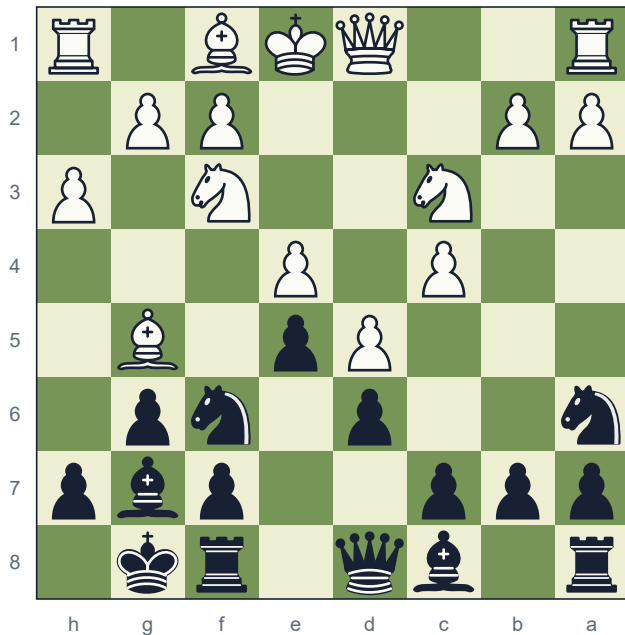
29. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

30. Black repertoire recall

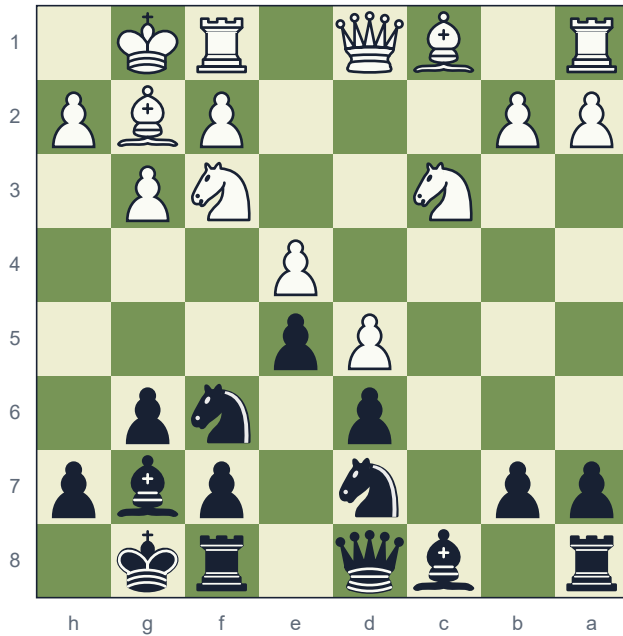
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 31-32



Black to move

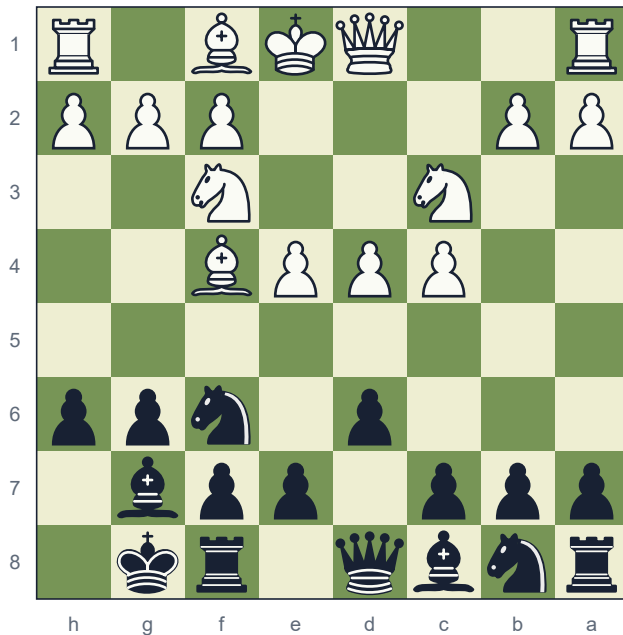
31. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

32. Black repertoire recall

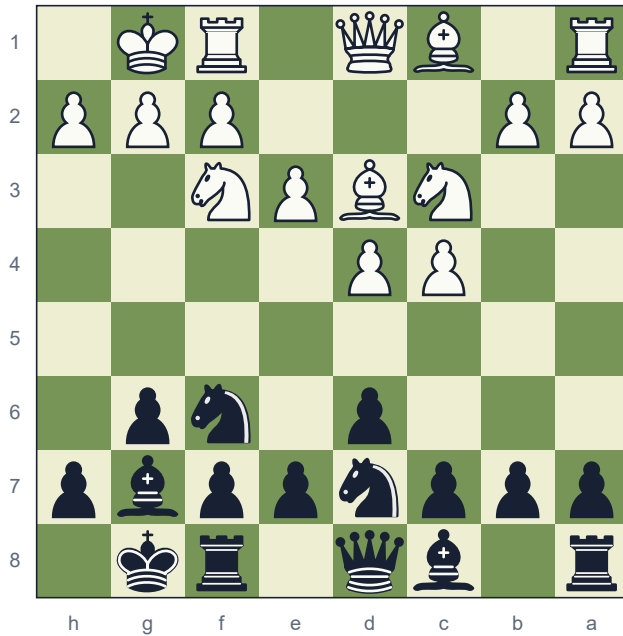
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 33-34



Black to move

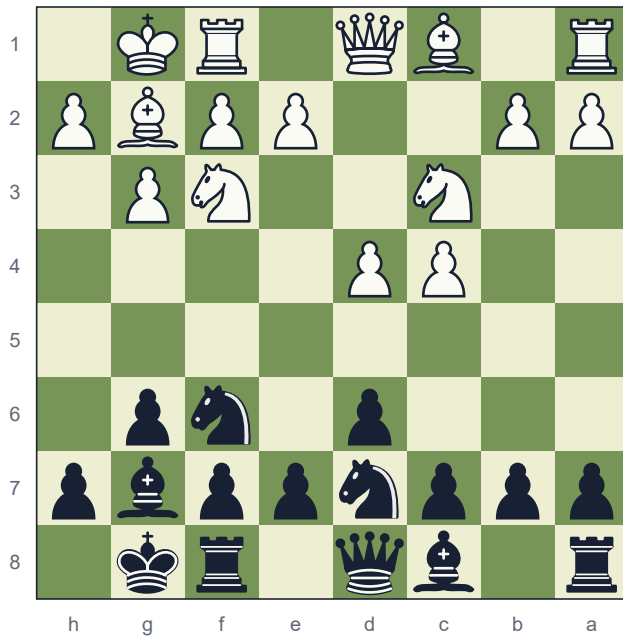
33. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

34. Black repertoire recall

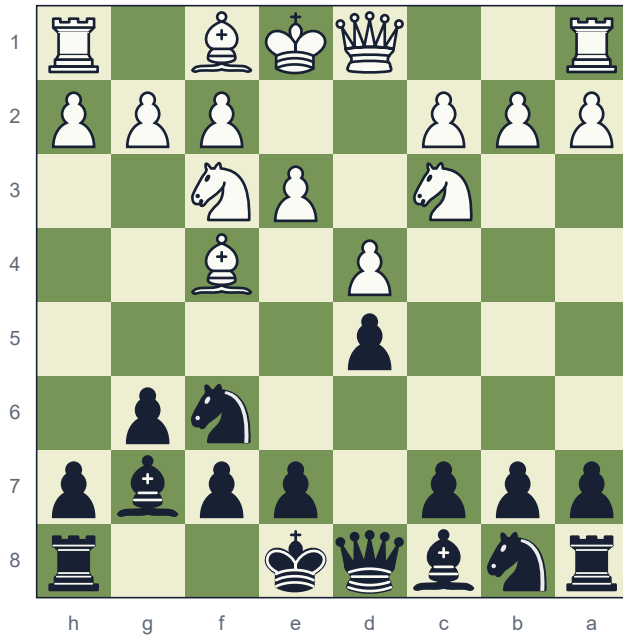
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 35-36



Black to move

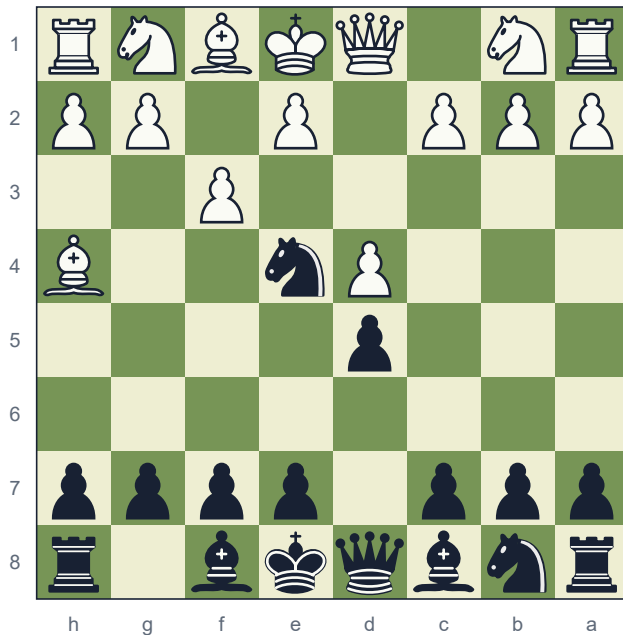
35. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

36. Black repertoire recall

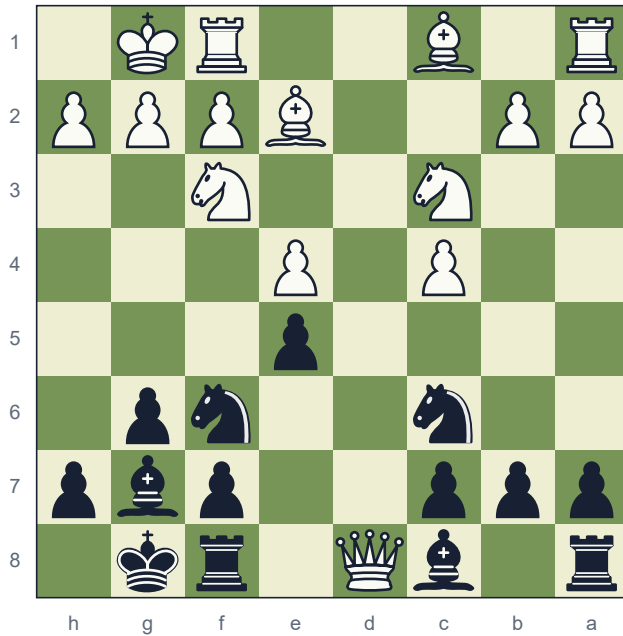
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 37-38



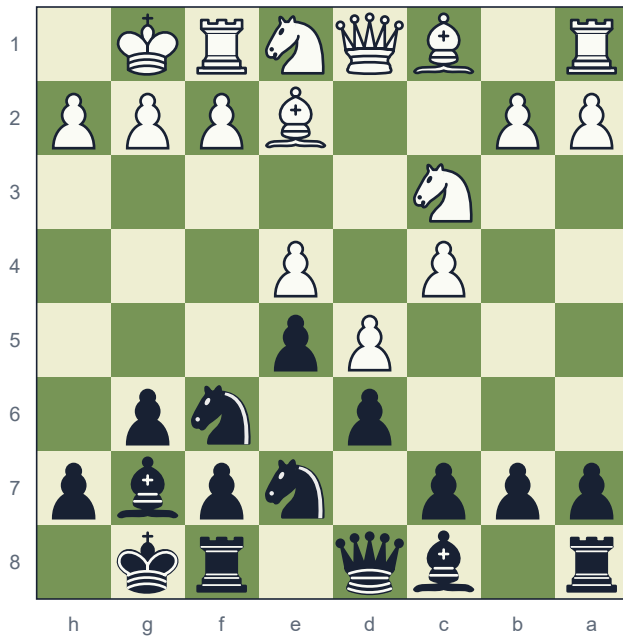
37. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



38. Black repertoire recall

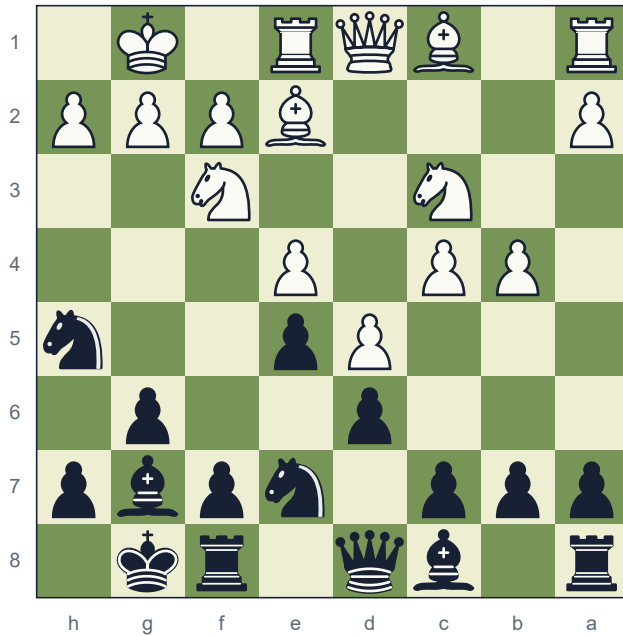
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 39-40



Black to move

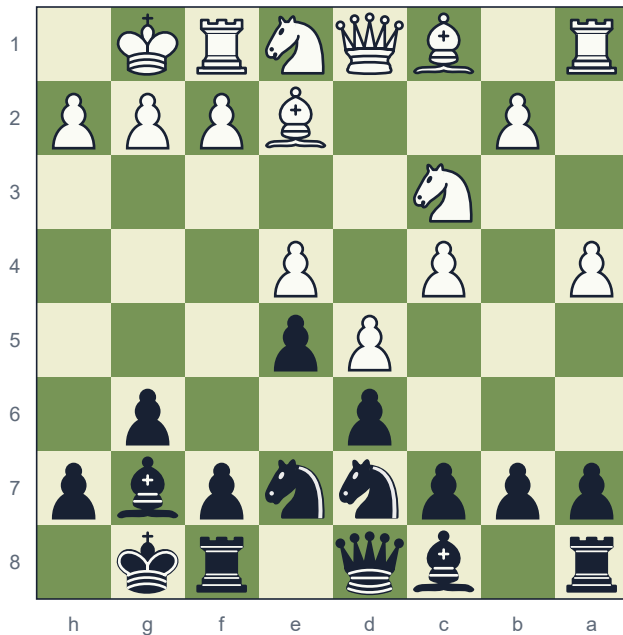
39. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

40. Black repertoire recall

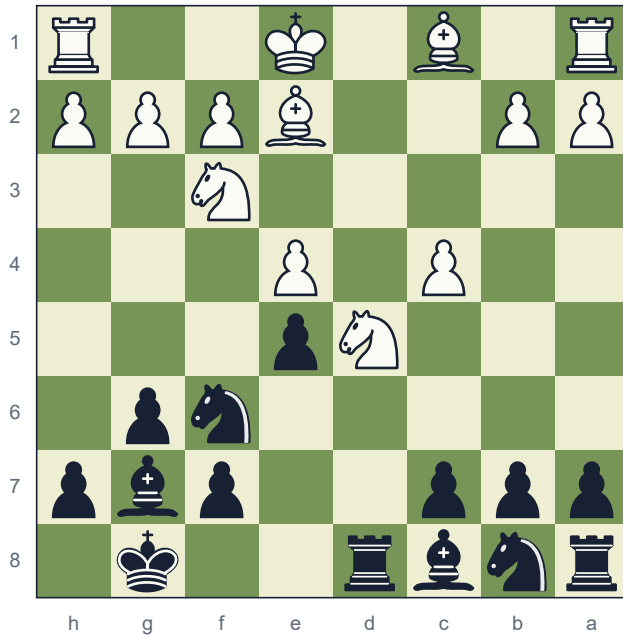
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 41-42



Black to move

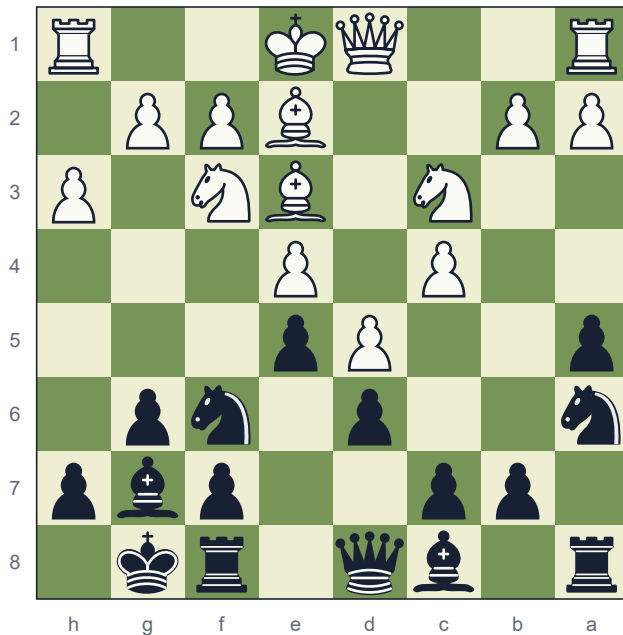
41. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

42. Black repertoire recall

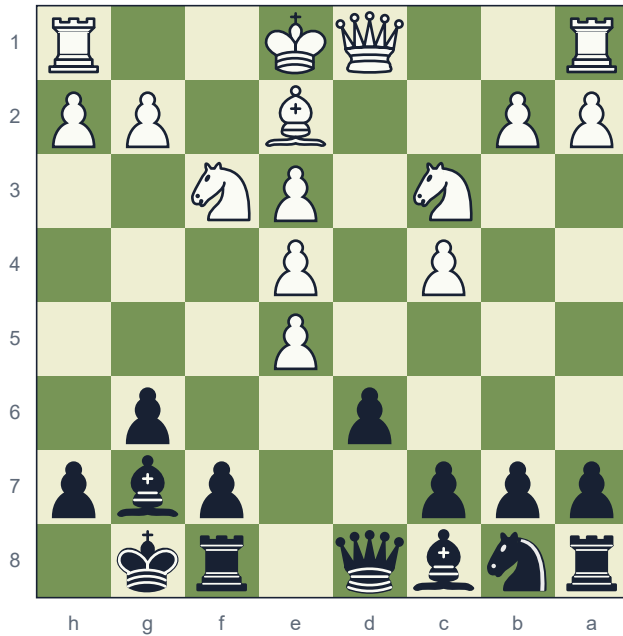
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 43-44



Black to move

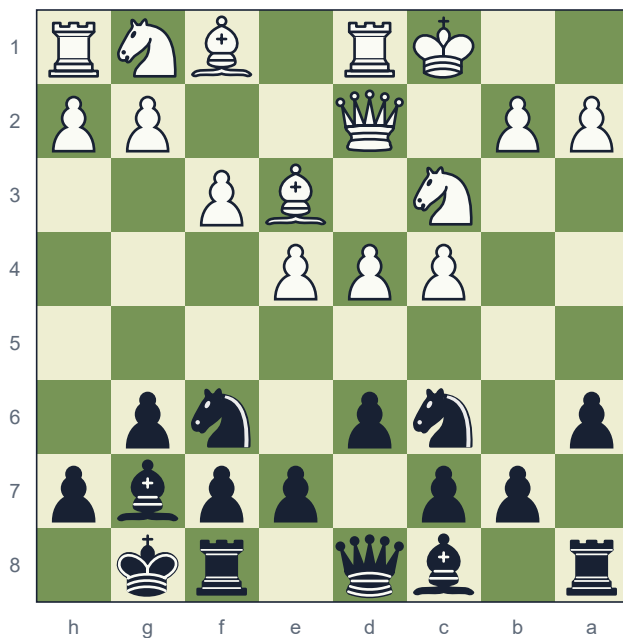
43. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

44. Black repertoire recall

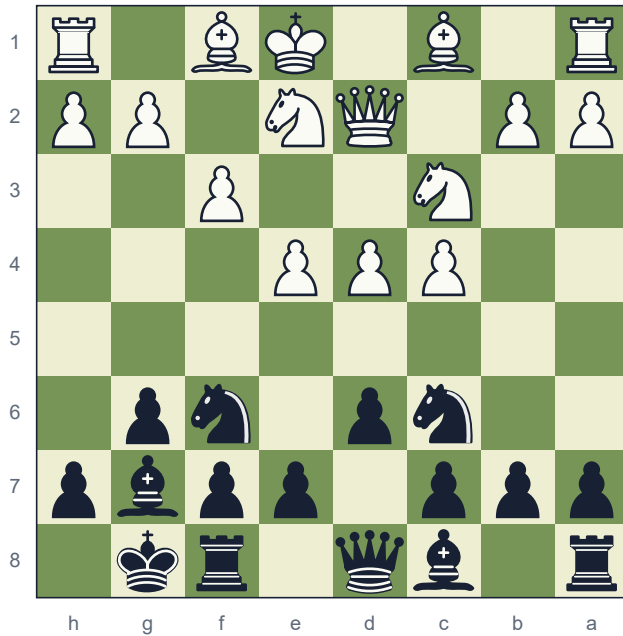
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 45-46



Black to move

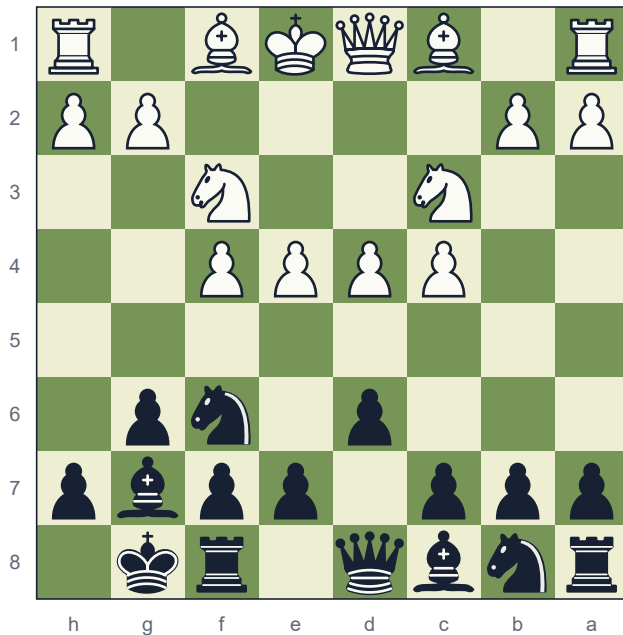
45. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

46. Black repertoire recall

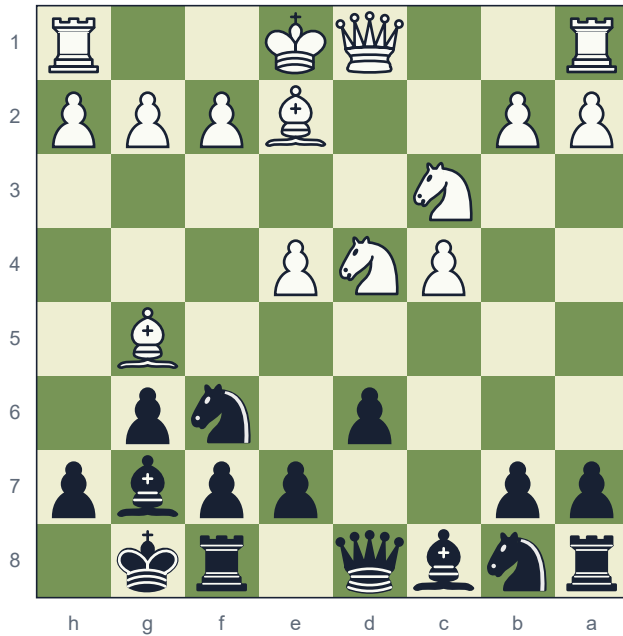
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 47-48



Black to move

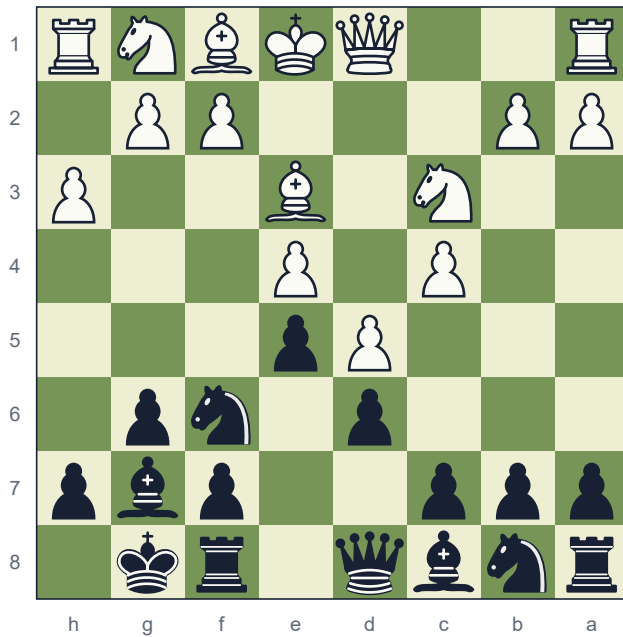
47. Black repertoire recall

Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

48. Black repertoire recall

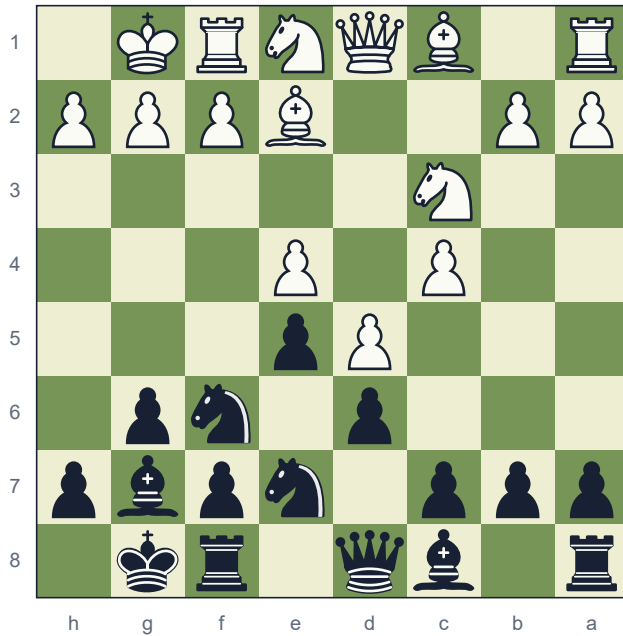
Choose the course move. Explain its purpose and one resource for White. Other moves may also be sound.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 49-50



Black to move

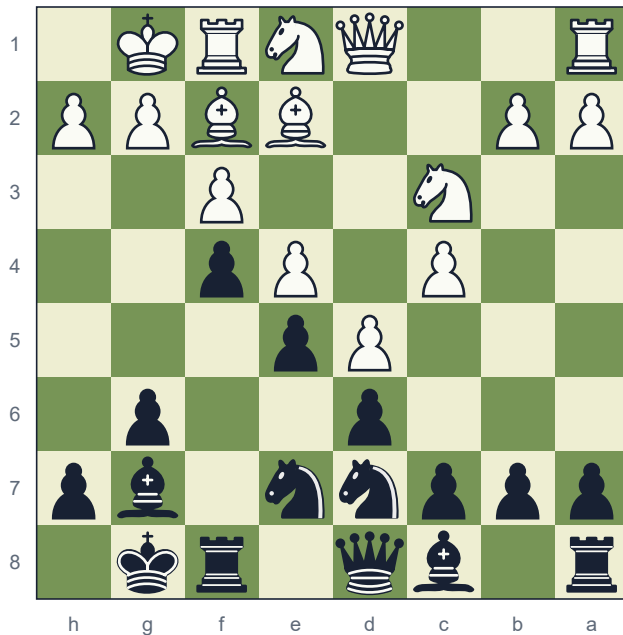
49. Plan for Black

Which knight must move before ...f5, and what is White's fastest central or queenside reply? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

50. Plan for Black

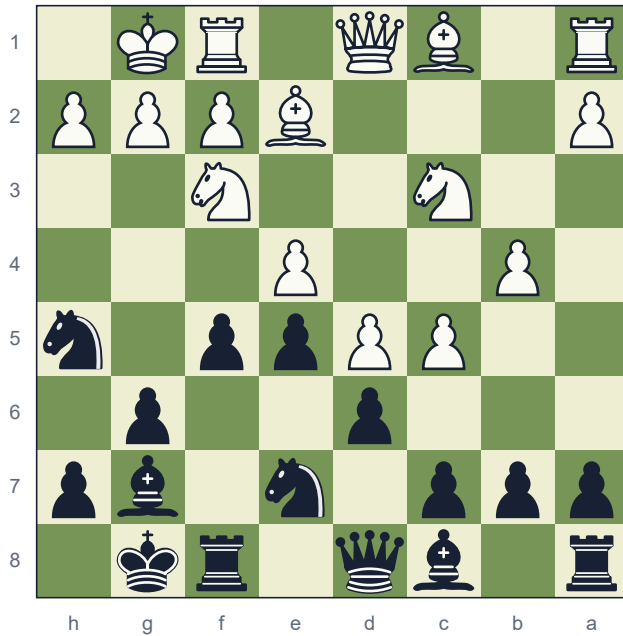
Name the first piece that should join the attack and the line it will use. Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 51-52



White to move

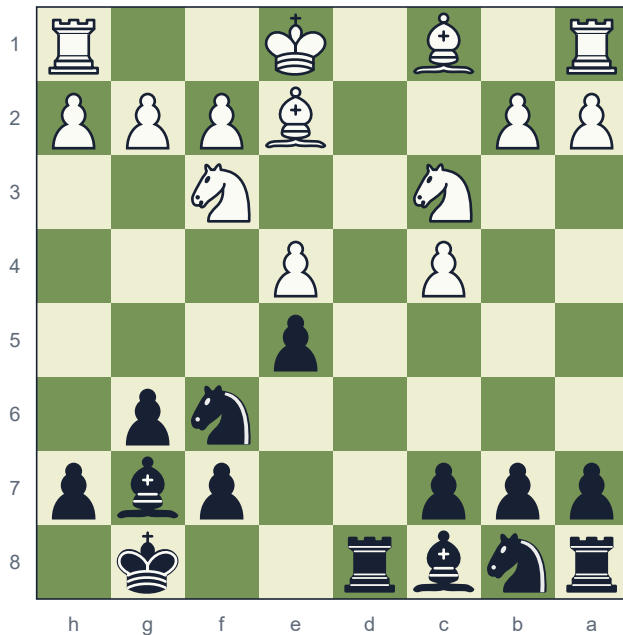
51. Plan for Black

Which captures can change the center immediately, and what file opens after each? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



White to move

52. Plan for Black

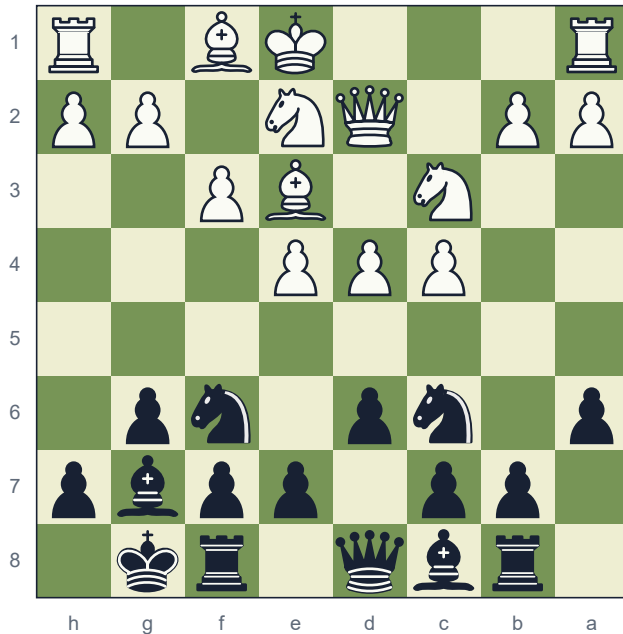
What would make a rook trade favorable, and which minor-piece square must you control? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 53-54



White to move

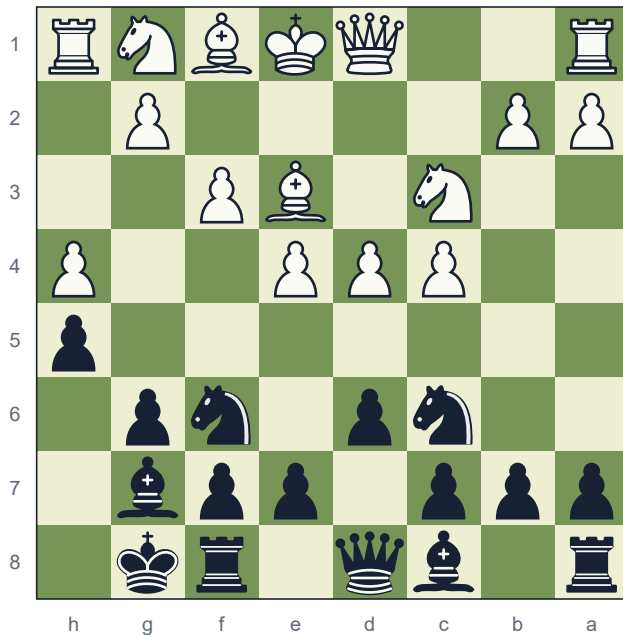
53. Plan for Black

What would change your decision between ...b5 and ...e5? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



White to move

54. Plan for Black

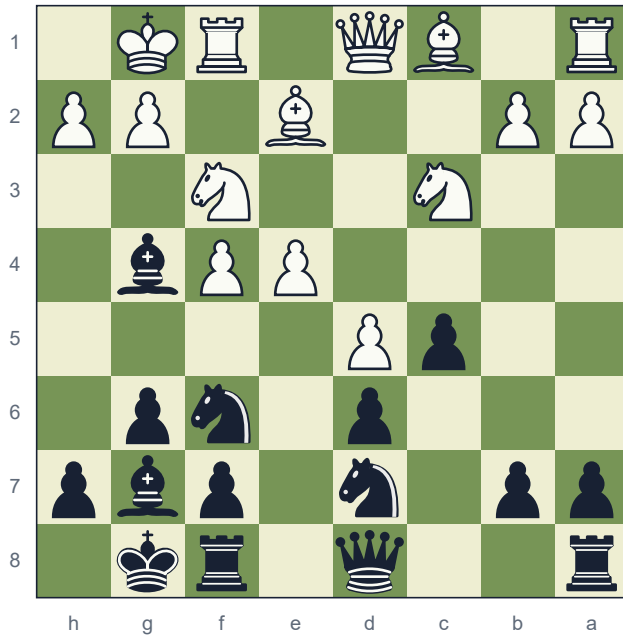
Which new pawn lever attacks h5, and what active counterplay can Black prepare? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 55-56



White to move

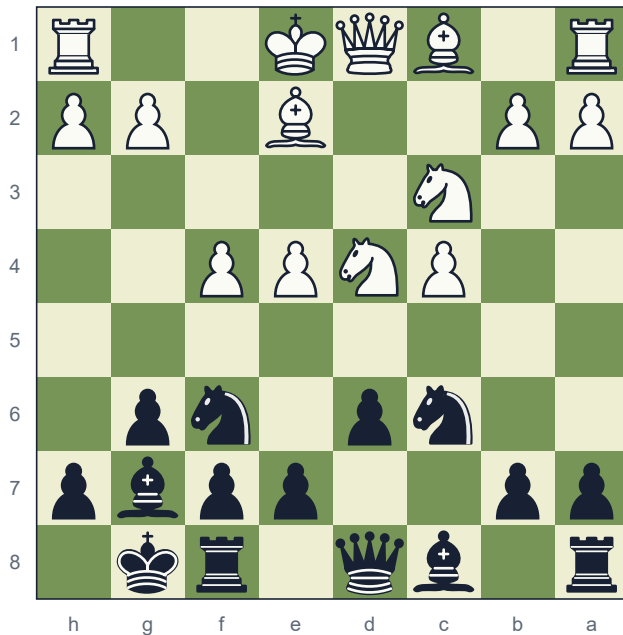
55. Plan for Black

Which white piece supports e5, and why is exchanging it potentially useful? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



White to move

56. Plan for Black

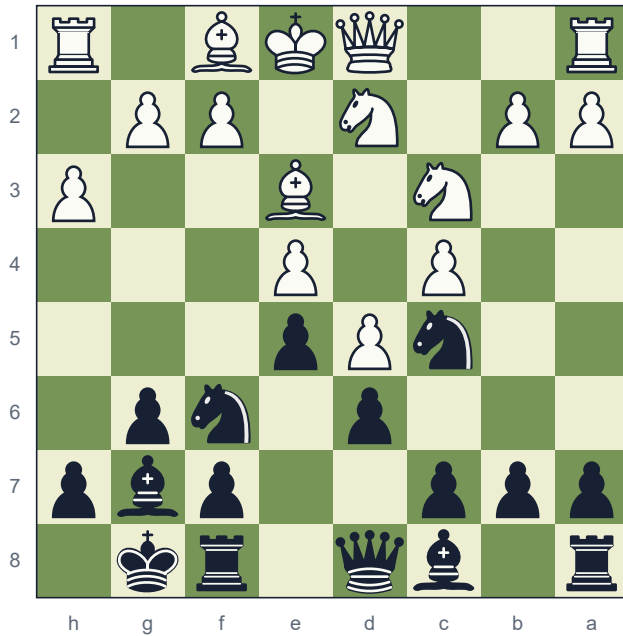
What preparation would make ...d5 a freeing break rather than a pawn sacrifice? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 57-58



Black to move

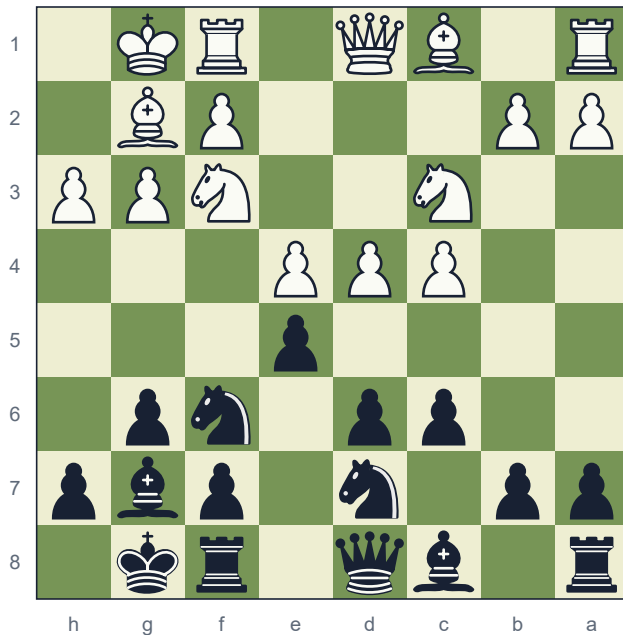
57. Plan for Black

What information about White's king do you need before launching a pawn storm? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

58. Plan for Black

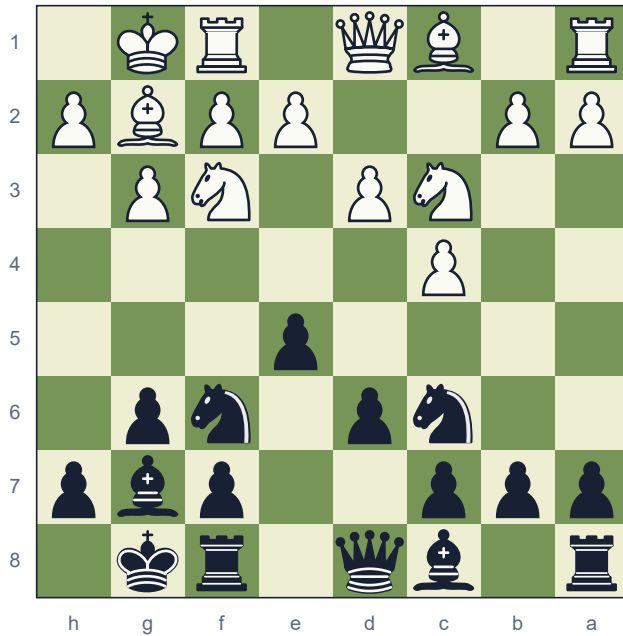
Which central exchange activates the g2 bishop, and what must Black recheck afterward? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 59-60



White to move

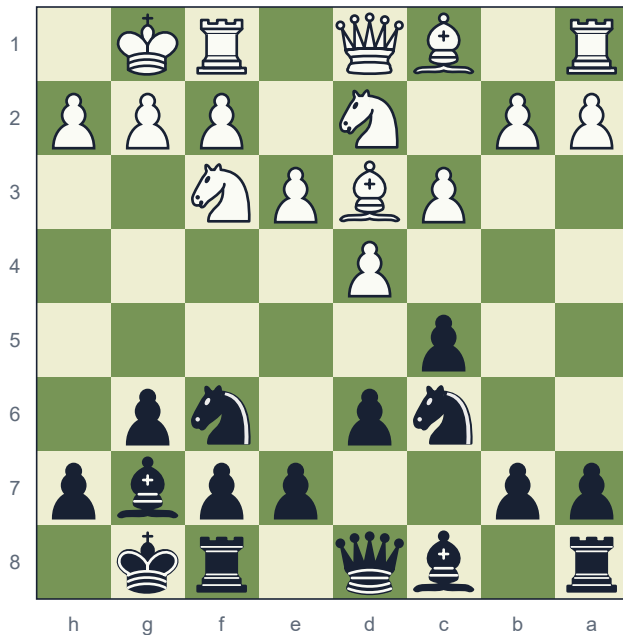
59. Plan for Black

Why is a routine Mar del Plata kingside race inappropriate in this diagram? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



White to move

60. Plan for Black

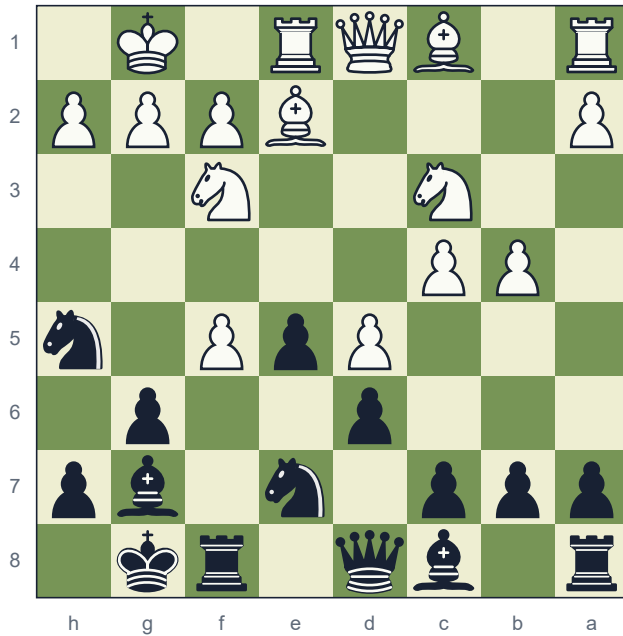
What is White's intended central break, and which black pieces should contest it? Explain Black's plan after any necessary White reply.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 61-62



Black to move

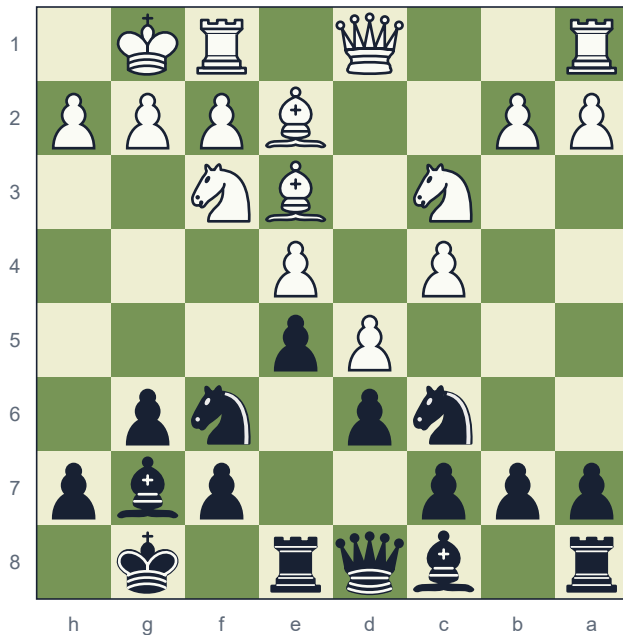
61. Concrete Black decision

White captured on f5. Find a stronger idea than an automatic recapture.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

62. Concrete Black decision

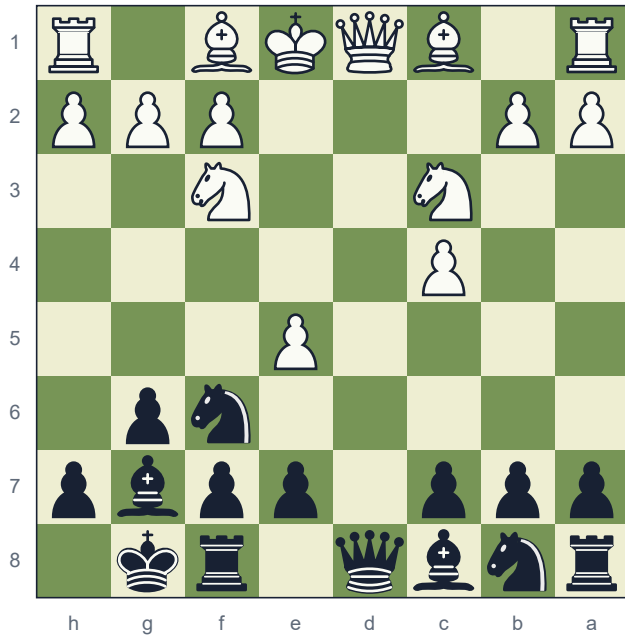
The c6 knight is attacked. Find an active square supported by the center.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 63-64



Black to move

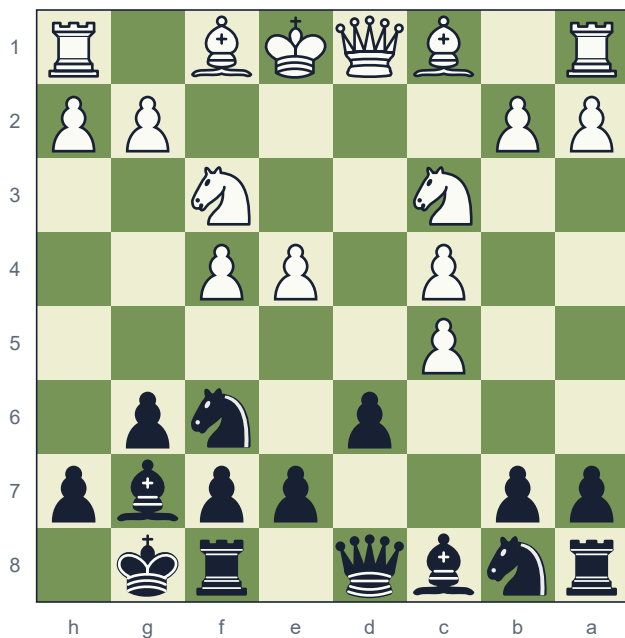
63. Concrete Black decision

White has opened the d-file. How can Black use the queen contact?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

64. Concrete Black decision

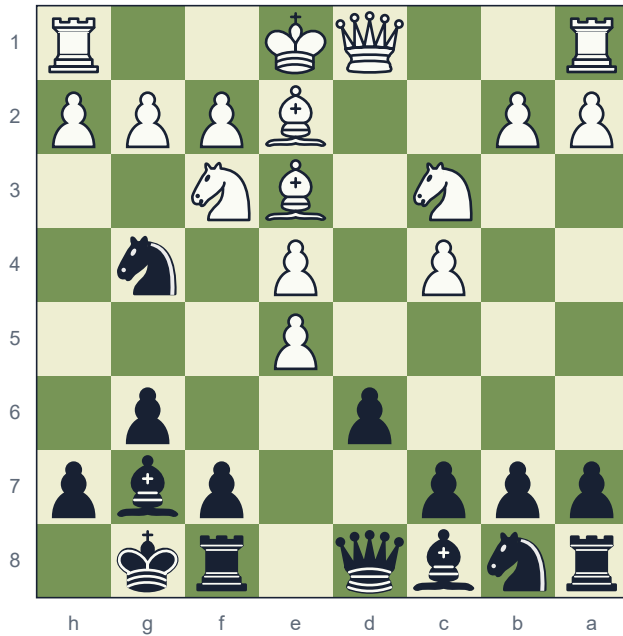
White captured on c5. Find a move that creates pressure on two central targets.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 65-66



Black to move

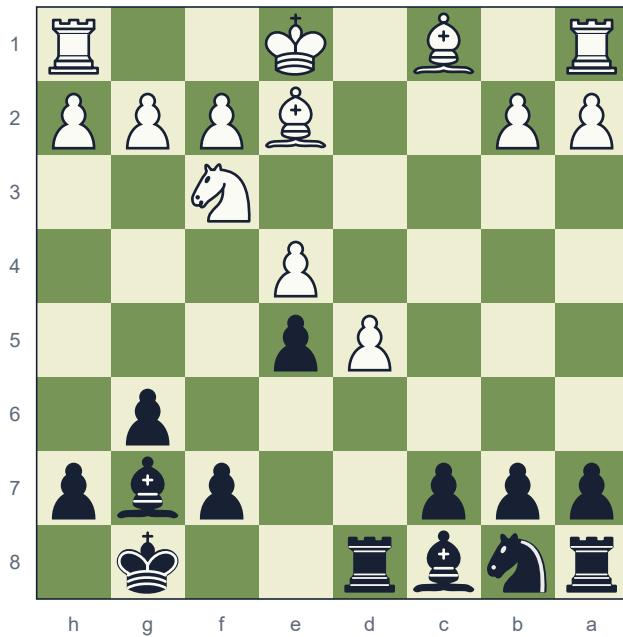
65. Concrete Black decision

White exchanged on e5 while your knight attacks a bishop. What intermediate capture is available?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

66. Concrete Black decision

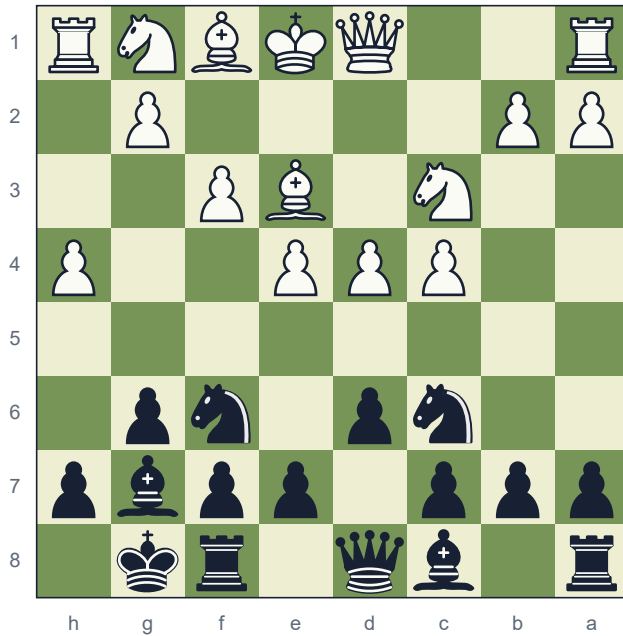
White created a pawn wedge on d5. Which pawn move challenges it?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 67-68



Black to move

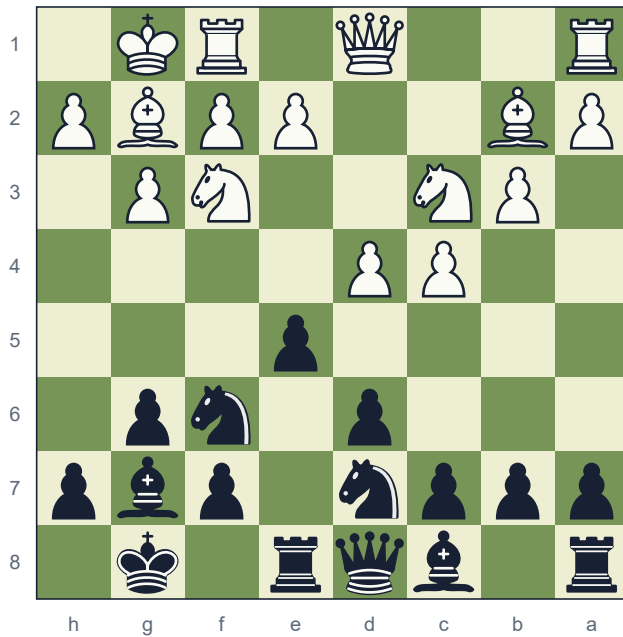
67. Concrete Black decision

White threatens h5. Give the course response and name White's next pawn lever.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

68. Concrete Black decision

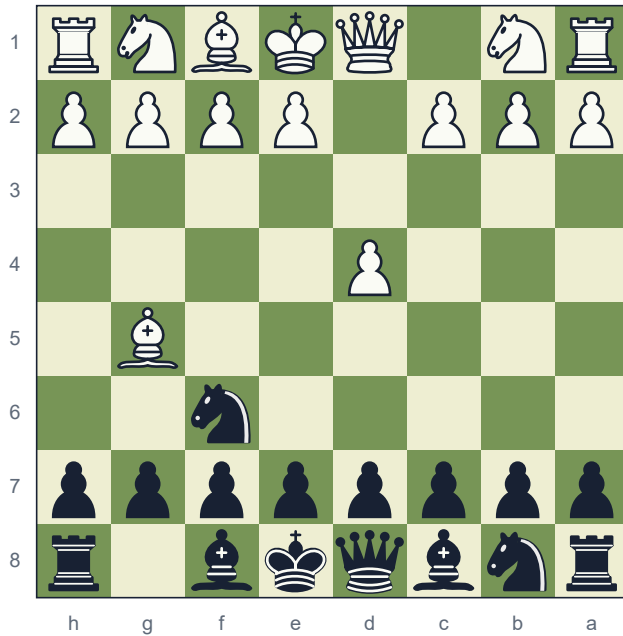
White developed the bishop on b2. Find a central advance with tempo.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 69-70



Black to move

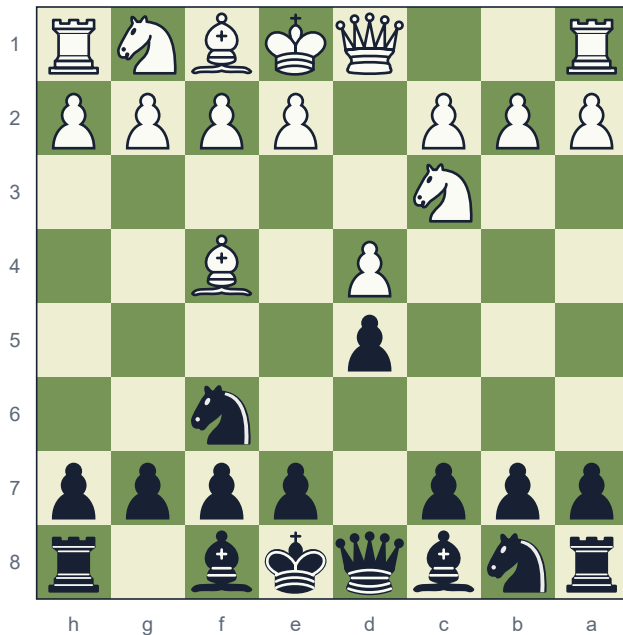
69. Concrete Black decision

White played 2.Bg5. What active knight move does the companion repertoire choose?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

70. Concrete Black decision

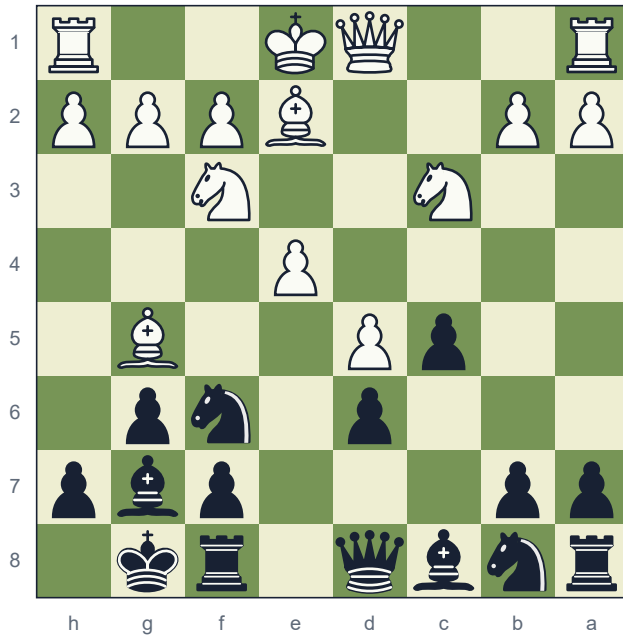
White threatens a knight jump toward c7. What prophylactic move is selected?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Exercises 71-72



Black to move

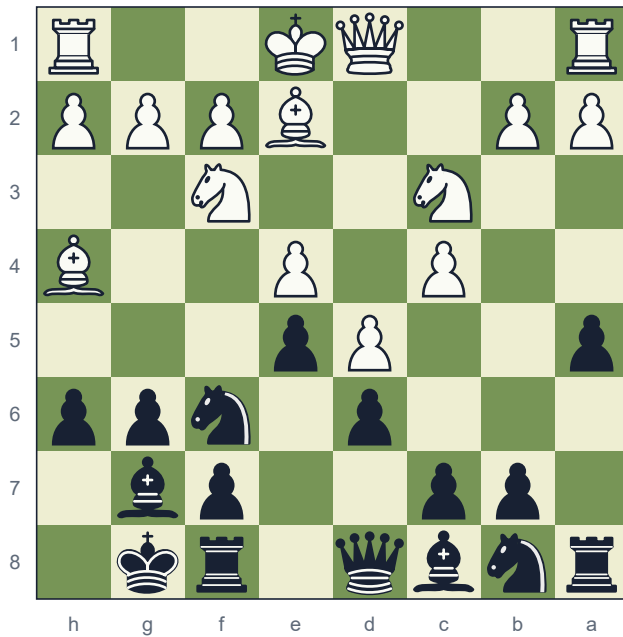
71. Concrete Black decision

The e-file has opened. Which rook move connects Black's play to that file?

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:



Black to move

72. Concrete Black decision

White's bishop has retreated to h4. Develop the b8 knight without blocking the c-pawn.

My move / plan:

Why it works:

White's resource:

Answers 01-03

01. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-01

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Close the center, reroute the knight, then choose the pawn break. White's broader aim: White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

Replay: 10... f5

02. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-01

Ng6. Brings a knight toward kingside entry squares while maintaining central influence. The pawn wave creates entry squares for pieces. White's broader aim: White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

Replay: 13... Ng6

03. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-01

Nf6. Improves the knight on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. A retreat after ...f5 can be productive. White's broader aim: White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

Replay: 11... Nf6

Answers 04-06

04. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-01

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Restrain one break while preparing your own. White's broader aim: White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

Replay: 11... f5

05. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-01

c6. Controls d5 and can support a later ...d5 break or challenge a white d5 wedge. King safety improves, but calculation remains necessary. White's broader aim: White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

Replay: 10... c6

06. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-01

h6. Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target. Flexibility comes from the knight and c-pawn. White's broader aim: White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

Replay: 8... h6 9. Bh4 Na6 10. Nd2 Qe8

Answers 07-09

07. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-01

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. A defensive pawn move changes your attacking timetable. White's broader aim: White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

Replay: 9... Nc6 10. d5 Ne7

08. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-01

Rb8. Prepares queenside play on the b-file, commonly supporting ...b5. The Panno attacks the center and the queenside. White's broader aim: White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

Replay: 8... Rb8 9. h4 h5 10. Nc1 Bd7

09. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-01

exd5. The pawn captures on d5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. Break the center before chasing the bishop. White's broader aim: White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

Replay: 8... exd5 9. Nxd5 Be6 10. h4 Bxd5

Answers 10-12

10. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-01

Nbd7. Develops the b8 knight and supports e5, while keeping the c-pawn flexible. Challenge the supporters of the pawn mass. White's broader aim: White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

Replay: 10... Nbd7

11. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-01

exd5. The pawn captures on d5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. The identity of the recapturing pawn matters. White's broader aim: White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

Replay: 8... exd5 9. exd5 Qb6 10. Nf3 Bf5

12. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-01

a5. Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5. Respect the restraint and find another useful square. White's broader aim: White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

Replay: 9... a5 10. g4 a4

Answers 13-15

13. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 14-01

Re8. Places the rook on the e-file to support or pressure the center. Central counterplay is the main engine of activity. White's broader aim: White wants a safe king, strong central control, and pressure on the long diagonal. White often meets attacks by exchanging the center.

Replay: 9... Re8 10. Be3 exd4

14. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 16-01

e6. Improves the pawn on e6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. Early bishop development changes the tactical support. White's broader aim: White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

Replay: 7... e6 8. Be2 exd5 9. exd5 Qb6 10. Rc1 Re8

15. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 17-01

e5. Challenges d4 and asks White to advance, exchange or maintain the central tension. A smaller center gives Black more room to choose. White's broader aim: White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

Replay: 7... e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 c6 10. Qc2 Re8

Answers 16-18

16. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 18-01

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. A real transposition is permission to reuse your study. White's broader aim: White may fianchetto, play a Botvinnik c4/d3/e4 setup, or transpose late to a standard King's Indian.

Replay: 7... Nc6 8. d5 Ne7 9. b4 a5 10. bxa5 Rxa5

17. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 19-01

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. Fight the center, not the name of the system. White's broader aim: White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

Replay: 6... c5 7. c3 Nh5 8. Bg5 h6 9. Bh4 g5 10. Ne1 cxd4

18. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 20-01

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. Active central play replaces the fianchetto script. White's broader aim: White may double your pawns, seize e4, or use Nb5 and Bf4 to attack c7. The aim is active development and concrete central control.

Replay: 4... c5 5. Nd2 Nxd2 6. Qxd2 cxd4 7. exd4 Bf5 8. Nf3 Nc6 9. Ne5 h5 10. Be2 e6

Answers 19-21

19. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-02

Re8. Places the rook on the e-file to support or pressure the center. An attacked knight may have an active forward square. White's broader aim: White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

Replay: 8... Re8 9. d5 Nd4 10. h3 Nxe2+

20. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-02

g5. Supports the advanced f-pawn and gains kingside space, while creating new king-safety responsibilities. A transposition is the same board, not a similar diagram. White's broader aim: White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

Replay: 12... g5

21. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-02

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Identify the actual defender of e4. White's broader aim: White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

Replay: 10... f5

Answers 22-24

22. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-02

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. A pawn advance is better when it attacks something. White's broader aim: White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

Replay: 10... f5

23. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-02

Bxf6. The bishop captures on f6. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. Keep the structure and activate the pair. White's broader aim: White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

Replay: 10... Bxf6

24. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-02

Ng4. Attacks a bishop on e3 or a pawn on e5 when present. The knight needs a useful follow-up or retreat. A tempo on a bishop can improve the whole setup. White's broader aim: White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

Replay: 9... Ng4 10. Bd2 Nc5

Answers 25-27

25. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-02

Ne7. Keeps the knight connected to the center and can prepare a route toward g6. Use the gained tempo to improve coordination. White's broader aim: White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

Replay: 9... Ne7 10. h3 Nf6

26. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-02

Ne5. Improves the knight on e5. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. Answer d5 before completing the formation. White's broader aim: White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

Replay: 7... Ne5 8. f4 Neg4 9. Bd2 e6 10. dxe6 fxe6

27. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-02

a6. Controls b5 and can support ...b5; in the Jobava it prevents the specific Nb5 jump. A transposition must include the bishop square. White's broader aim: White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

Replay: 7... a6 8. Qd2 Rb8 9. Rc1 Bd7 10. h4 h5

Answers 28-30

28. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-02

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. When the d-pawn disappears, change the plan. White's broader aim: White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

Replay: 8... Nc6 9. Be3 Bg4 10. Nxc6 Bxe2

29. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-02

Qa5. Creates concrete pressure on central or queenside targets; count tempo attacks on the queen. Use the opened diagonal, then bring the pieces out. White's broader aim: White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

Replay: 7... Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Nc6 10. Nf3 Bg4

30. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-02

h6. Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target. A small question to the bishop is enough for now. White's broader aim: White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

Replay: 8... h6 9. Be3 Nc5 10. Nd2 a5

Answers 31-33

31. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 14-02

Nc5. Uses a central outpost to pressure e4 and nearby squares; check White's b4 advance. Use the c-pawn to create squares for pieces. White's broader aim: White wants a safe king, strong central control, and pressure on the long diagonal. White often meets attacks by exchanging the center.

Replay: 10... Nc5

32. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 16-02

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. An active bishop creates a real target. White's broader aim: White may preserve flexibility, restrain your f-pawn, or begin a king attack before normal development.

Replay: 7... c5 8. d5 g5 9. Be3 e6 10. h3 exd5

33. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 17-02

e5. Challenges d4 and asks White to advance, exchange or maintain the central tension. A familiar bishop square can be a tactical target. White's broader aim: White develops safely with Bd3, Be2, b3 or b4 and may prepare e4 later. Quiet moves can still support a strong queenside plan.

Replay: 7... e5 8. h3 Re8 9. e4 exd4 10. Nxd4 Nc5

Answers 34-36

34. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 18-02

e5. Challenges d4 and asks White to advance, exchange or maintain the central tension. Fianchetto positions need their own central plan. White's broader aim: White may fianchetto, play a Botvinnik c4/d3/e4 setup, or transpose late to a standard King's Indian.

Replay: 7... e5 8. e4 exd4 9. Nxd4 Nc5 10. h3 Re8

35. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 19-02

O-O. The king moves toward shelter and the h8 rook enters the central files. A new knight square can require a new central answer. White's broader aim: White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

Replay: 5... O-O 6. Nb5 Na6 7. Nc3 Nb8 8. Nb5 Na6 9. Nc3 Nb8 10. Be2 c5

36. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 20-02

Nf6. Improves the knight on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat. A retreat can preserve the benefits of an early sortie. White's broader aim: White may double your pawns, seize e4, or use Nb5 and Bf4 to attack c7. The aim is active development and concrete central control.

Replay: 4... Nf6 5. Nc3 c5 6. e4 Nc6 7. Bb5 Bd7 8. Bxc6 Bxc6 9. Bxf6 gxf6 10. exd5 Bxd5

Answers 37-39

37. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 02-03

Rxd8. The rook captures on d8. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. An open center needs active pieces. White's broader aim: White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

Replay: 9... Rxd8 10. Bg5 Rf8

38. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 03-03

Nd7. Reroutes a knight toward useful central squares. Check which knight moved and whether f6 is now clear. When White breaks the chain, calculate again. White's broader aim: White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

Replay: 9... Nd7 10. f3 f5 11. g4

39. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 04-03

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Before recapturing, look for a forcing intermediate move. White's broader aim: White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

Replay: 10... f5 11. exf5 e4

Answers 40-42

40. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 05-03

f5. Challenges e4 after the f6 square has been cleared. The center and White's king placement must justify the break. Space costs time; use the time purposefully. White's broader aim: White may send a knight to c4, support c5, restrain ...b5 with a4, or develop the bishop on b2.

Replay: 10... f5

41. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 06-03

Nxd5. The knight captures on d5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. Challenge a new wedge at its base. White's broader aim: White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

Replay: 9... Nxd5 10. cxd5 c6

42. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 07-03

Nc5. Uses a central outpost to pressure e4 and nearby squares; check White's b4 advance. A good outpost still needs a retreat plan. White's broader aim: White may pin Nf6, stop ...f5, and expand on the queenside while deciding where the king belongs.

Replay: 9... Nc5 10. Nd2 Ne8

Answers 43-45

43. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 08-03

dxe5. The pawn captures on e5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan. A structural concession always has a practical price. White's broader aim: White keeps the king flexible and may answer the knight attack by creating a pin or counterattacking in the center.

Replay: 9... dxe5 10. Qxd8 Rxd8

44. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 09-03

Rb8. Prepares queenside play on the b-file, commonly supporting ...b5. Attack with tempi and defend forcing threats. White's broader aim: White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

Replay: 8... Rb8 9. h4 h5 10. Nd5 b5

45. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 10-03

a6. Controls b5 and can support ...b5; in the Jobava it prevents the specific Nb5 jump. Check the whole castling path. White's broader aim: White wants to pin Nf6, exchange the g7 bishop, and create a pawn lever against your king.

Replay: 7... a6 8. Qd1 Rb8 9. Rb1 b5 10. cxb5 axb5

Answers 46-48

46. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 11-03

c5. Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated. Central captures can expose two targets at once. White's broader aim: White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

Replay: 6... c5 7. dxc5 Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Na6 10. a3 Qc6

47. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 12-03

Nc6. Develops toward d4 and e5. Be ready to answer d5 if White can attack the knight. Open central squares reward active pieces. White's broader aim: White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

Replay: 8... Nc6 9. Be3 Bd7 10. Qd2 Qa5

48. BLACK REPERTOIRE RECALL | SEE 13-03

Na6. Develops the b8 knight toward c5 without blocking the c-pawn. Delayed development can preserve dangerous options. White's broader aim: White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

Replay: 7... Na6 8. g4 Nc5 9. f3 a5 10. Qd2 c6

Answers 49-51

49. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE LOCKED CLASSICAL CHAIN

White's d5/e4 chain faces Black's d6/e5 chain. Neither d-pawn can move straight forward. The chain gives a direction to the plans, but either side can open it with a pawn lever. Prepare ...f5 by moving the f6 knight and coordinating the pieces. If ...f4 fixes the center, use the gained space to bring pieces toward the king. White: White expands with c5 and may invade on the c-file. White can also undermine the attack with g4. Count how many moves your pieces need.

50. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / AFTER ...F4: SPACE IS NOT A MATING ATTACK

The f4 pawn gains space and restricts White's pieces. It also fixes targets and closes lines your own rooks might otherwise use. Support the pawn with ...g5 only if the pieces can join. Typical jobs include ...Ng6, ...Nf6, ...h5 and queen access. Identify the entry square, not just the next pawn. White: White may play c5, g4, or bring defenders to f2 and d3. If the attack slows, the queenside weaknesses can become decisive.

51. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE BAYONET: TWO SIMULTANEOUS PAWN CONTACTS

White's c5 attacks d6 while Black's f5 attacks e4. The locked center can open from either end, so a one-wing evaluation is incomplete. Compare ...f4, ...fxe4 and a d-pawn exchange only after analyzing White's captures. Preserve piece activity if the pawn skeleton changes. White: White can trade on d6 or f5 and use open files before Black finishes regrouping.

Answers 52-54

52. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE OPEN D-FILE AFTER AN EXCHANGE

Both d-pawns have left the d-file, and the queens are gone. A direct mating race has been replaced by piece coordination and control of d4 and d5. Develop the remaining pieces and contest the d-file. Keep e5 defended, especially if a bishop pins Nf6. A rook on an open file needs support and entry squares. White: White may invade d5 with a knight or double rooks. A passive black bishop can be worse than a small pawn weakness.

53. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / PANNO: THE QUEENSIDE BREAK

Black has ...Nc6, ...a6 and ...Rb8. White's f3 pawn supports the center but delays natural king-knight development. Prepare ...b5 when the captures work. If White restrains it with a4, compare ...e5. If White closes with d5, answer the knight attack first. White: Bh6, h4 and g4 can threaten the king. White may avoid long castling and turn the queenside opening into a central game.

54. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / SAMISCH: DEFENDING THE KING WITHOUT PASSIVITY

The h-pawns face one another after ...h5. The h-file is closed for now, but White can create a new lever with g4. Finish development and create central or queenside counterplay. Defend forcing threats directly. Keep a defender near g6 and avoid unnecessary dark-square weaknesses. White: White may play g4, sacrifice on h5, or exchange the g7 bishop with Bh6. A blocked h-file is not permanent safety.

Answers 55-57

55. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / BENONI STRUCTURE AGAINST THE FOUR PAWNS

White has a d5 wedge and an e4/f4 center; Black has d6 and c5. Black's e-pawn has been exchanged, opening the e-file. Pressure e4, challenge the knight that supports e5, and develop rapidly. Prepare queenside expansion only when d6 and the king are secure. White: White threatens e5 with tempo or a kingside attack. A passive setup lets the space advantage grow.

56. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / THE CENTRAL BIND AFTER ...CXD4

White's d-pawn has disappeared. Pawns on c4 and e4 control d5, restricting Black's central break. Develop toward a supported ...d5 or create useful queenside pressure. Trade a pair of pieces when it reduces the cramp without conceding a permanent weakness. White: White can maintain the bind, improve pieces and attack d6. An unsupported ...d5 may simply lose a pawn.

57. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / MAKOGONOV: RESTRAINT BEFORE ATTACK

h3 restrains g4 and supports a possible g4 advance. The c5 knight gives Black activity but can be challenged by b4. Coordinate pieces behind the center. Compare ...a5, ...c6 and a prepared ...f5; choose according to White's king and the knight's safety. White: White can attack on the kingside while delaying castling, or gain queenside space against Nc5.

Answers 58-60

58. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / FIANCHETTO: PRESSURE THROUGH THE CENTER

Both kings have fianchettoed bishops. White's g2 bishop adds a defender and a long-range attacker, changing the value of a kingside pawn advance. Develop central pressure with ...Re8, ...exd4 and a knight on c5 when justified. ...c6 can support a later ...d5 break. White: White may open the long diagonal with a central exchange. An exposed b7 pawn or loose c6 piece can then become a target.

59. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / ENGLISH: NO D4 WEDGE

White uses d3 rather than d4. Black's e5 foothold controls d4, and there is no locked d5/e4 chain. Develop the queen bishop and consider a well-supported ...d5. Watch queenside expansion and use central squares for pieces. White: White can play Rb1/b4, f4, or d4 later. Each advance changes which pawn break is most relevant.

60. PLAN FOR BLACK | SEE 21 / SYSTEM OPENINGS: STOP A FREE E4 BREAK

White has a compact d4/e3 center and Bd3. Black attacks d4 with ...c5 and develops against the coming e4 advance. Increase central pressure with ...Nc6 and useful bishop development. Resolve the pawn tension only when the resulting structure helps you. White: White can prepare e4 with Nbd2 and Re1. If the center opens, Bd3 may create threats toward h7.

Answers 61-63

61. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 04-03

e4. The intermediate ...e4 attacks Nf3 and opens the g7 bishop toward Nc3. Calculate the combined threats before recovering a pawn.

Replay: 11... e4

62. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 02-02

Nd4. ...Nd4 uses support from e5 and the e-file pressure from Re8. Calculate both minor-piece captures and the recapture.

Replay: 9... Nd4 10. h3 Nxe2+

63. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 02-05

Qxd1+. ...Qxd1 forces a queen exchange and changes the task to attacking e5 and developing the pieces.

Replay: 7... Qxd1+ 8. Nxd1 Ng4 9. Bf4 Nc6 10. Ne3 Nb4

Answers 64-66

64. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 11-03

Qa5. ...Qa5 pressures c5 and e4. Continue the calculation through attacks on the queen before claiming material.

Replay: 7... Qa5 8. Bd2 Qxc5 9. Rc1 Na6 10. a3 Qc6

65. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 08-03

Nxe3. ...Nxe3 exchanges the knight for the bishop before the d-pawn recaptures on e5. White's f-pawn recapture changes the structure.

Replay: 8... Nxe3 9. fxe3 dxe5 10. Qxd8 Rxd8

66. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 06-03

c6. ...c6 questions the new wedge. Compare dxc6 and ...cxd5 by rook activity and the resulting pawn targets.

Replay: 10... c6

Answers 67-69

67. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 10-04

h5. ...h5 blocks the immediate lever. White can now use g4 against h5, so Black still needs central or queenside activity.

Replay: 7... h5 8. Qd2 a6 9. O-O-O Rb8 10. Nd5 b5

68. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 14-05

e4. ...e4 attacks Nf3 and gains space. Support the advanced pawn and calculate the knight retreat before treating it as a permanent advantage.

Replay: 9... e4 10. Ng5 e3

69. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 20-01

Ne4. ...Ne4 attacks the bishop and prepares a central game with ...d5 and ...c5. The knight can retreat later if White plays f3.

Replay: 2... Ne4 3. Bf4 d5 4. e3 c5 5. Nd2 Nxd2 6. Qxd2 cxd4 7. exd4 Bf5 8. Nf3 Nc6 9. Ne5 h5 10. Be2 e6

Answers 70-72

70. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 20-04

a6. ...a6 prevents Nb5. Black then returns to central development and ...c5.

Replay: 3... a6 4. e3 e6 5. Nf3 c5 6. dxc5 Bxc5 7. Bd3 Nc6 8. O-O Bb4 9. a3 Bxc3 10. bxc3 O-O

71. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 12-04

Re8. ...Re8 increases central pressure and supports the struggle against e4. This is an Averbakh/Benoni structure, not a closed ...e5 chain.

Replay: 9... Re8 10. Nd2 h6

72. CONCRETE BLACK DECISION | SEE 07-01

Na6. ...Na6 offers c5 and preserves the c-pawn's flexibility. Black has already used ...a5 to restrain b4.

Replay: 9... Na6 10. Nd2 Qe8

A routine you can sustain

FOUR SESSIONS PER WEEK

Session A: 25 minutes learning one branch and 10 minutes reconstructing it. Session B: 20 minutes solving exercises and 15 minutes playing a diagram. Session C: one slow game. Session D: 30-45 minutes reviewing that game.

USE SPACED RECALL

Review a new branch the next day, after three days and after a week. Once it becomes reliable, review it less often and spend more time on the positions where you still choose a plan incorrectly.

KEEP A SMALL PERSONAL NOTEBOOK

Record the White trigger, your chosen reply, the reason, a danger and the booklet line ID. Add your own game after the opening line. Do not accumulate long engine variations without a practical question.

STUDY THE MAIN PATH FIRST

Booklet 15 is an optional second Fianchetto repertoire. Learn Booklet 14 first. Learn the companion defenses in 18-20 as distinct positions, rather than forcing a KID setup into them.

Weeks 1-4

WEEK 1 / ORIENTATION AND MOVE ORDERS

Read 00, 01, 20. Learn the basic setup and the points where you choose a companion defense. Reconstruct the board from Black's side without reversing square names.

WEEK 2 / CLASSICAL GATEWAY AND EXCHANGES

Read 02, 06. Practice d5, dxe5 and continued tension as three different central decisions. Play four training games from the gateway position.

WEEK 3 / MAR DEL PLATA PLANS

Read 03, 21. Learn the knight routes and ...f5 conditions. In each training game, count White's c5 timing before pushing another kingside pawn.

WEEK 4 / BAYONET AND OTHER NINTH MOVES

Read 04, 05. Practice 9.b4 separately from 9.Ne1. Solve the central ...e4 intermezzo and explain the g7 bishop's role.

Weeks 5-8

WEEK 5 / PETROSIAN AND GLIGORIC

Read 07, 08. Explain why the early bishop and delayed castling change the plans. Reconstruct one main line and one White deviation for each.

WEEK 6 / SAMISCH PANNO

Read 09, 10. Practice d5, a4, long castling, h4 and g4 as different triggers. Count forcing moves on both wings.

WEEK 7 / FOUR PAWNS AND AVERBAKH

Read 11, 12. Learn the ...c5/...e6 transition and the e5 threat. Compare the f4 and f2 pawn positions before using a tactical idea.

WEEK 8 / MAKOGONOV AND EARLY PIECE CHOICES

Read 13, 16. Play against h3, Bg5, Nge2 and Bd3. Identify White's king plan before deciding the direction of your attack.

Weeks 9-12

WEEK 9 / FIANCHETTO CORE

Read 14. Study the central ...Nbd7/...e5 plan. Compare the positions with your earlier White 1.d4 course. Leave optional Booklet 15 until the core is secure.

WEEK 10 / QUIET SYSTEMS AND COMPANION DEFENSES

Read 17, 18, 19. Practice the moment White omits d4, c4 or e4. Explain why an English or London position needs a different central plan.

WEEK 11 / MIDDLEGAME DECISIONS

Read 21, 22, 23. Play both colors from three laboratory positions. Annotate the first divergence and one missed defensive resource.

WEEK 12 / ASSESSMENT AND CONSOLIDATION

Read 24, 25; optional 15. Take the exercise assessment in three sessions. Repair weak branches in the notebook, then play six slow games using the whole repertoire.

Reference card: your first decisions

CLASSICAL

Nf3 and Be2: ...e5. After O-O: ...Nc6. After d5: ...Ne7. Then distinguish Ne1, b4, Nd2 and Bd2. Do not guess White's ninth move.

OTHER CENTRAL SYSTEMS

f3: Panno ...Nc6/...a6/...Rb8. f4: ...c5/...e6. Be2/Bg5: ...c5/...e6. h3: keep the king choice in view and use ...e5/...Na6 plans.

FIANCHETTO

Use ...Nbd7, ...e5 and a central plan. The usual pawn storm is not automatic. Compare ...c6, ...exd4 and ...Nc5.

COMPANION DEFENSES

2.Bg5: ...Ne4. 2.Nc3: ...d5. London/Torre/Colle: challenge d4 and the coming e4 break. English/Reti: transpose only when the center actually matches.

BEFORE EVERY MOVE

Checks, captures, threats. Then the center, king safety and worst piece. Calculate White's strongest forcing reply before committing to a plan.

Your post-game review form

GAME DETAILS

Date: _____ Opponent: _____ Time control: _____

Result: _____ Booklet / line ID: _____

FIRST UNFAMILIAR DECISION

Move number: _____ White's threat: _____

My candidates: _____

What I played and why: _____

POSITION ASSESSMENT

Center: locked / fluid / open. Relevant pawn break: _____

Black's worst piece: _____ White's best resource: _____

Was a trade or defensive move necessary? _____

ONE REPAIR

Better plan or calculation: _____

One notebook change: _____

Review dates: tomorrow _____ three days _____ one week _____

What was checked and what it means

LEGALITY

All 83 opening anchors were parsed as legal SAN. All printed continuations and PGN moves were replayed. Every diagram was generated from a legal course position, with Black at the bottom. Exercise moves were checked against the position they answer.

BLACK DECISION SCREENING

Stockfish 18 used two threads and 192 MB hash. Selected Black anchor decisions after move two were screened with 70,000-node best-move and root-restricted searches. Apparent losses greater than 90 centipawns were rechecked at 700,000 nodes. Flagged draft choices were revised and rechecked; no unresolved flags remain at that threshold.

ILLUSTRATIVE CONTINUATIONS

Anchors shorter than ten full moves were extended with 180,000-node searches. Final opening endpoints were assessed at 400,000 nodes. The ten middlegame laboratories used 500,000-node analyses with two candidates. Short principal variations are examples, not forced replies.

LIMITS OF THE CHECKS

Finite search does not prove that a move is best or that every reply has been covered. The screen targets large local errors in the selected Black moves; it is not a proof of equality, a complete database survey or a guarantee against future theory.

EDUCATIONAL SCOPE

This is an original practical repertoire and study course. It covers common King's Indian systems and selected companion defenses. It does not provide a complete response to 1.e4, every rare move, or every possible middlegame and endgame.

Sources and further study

OPENING NAMES AND MOVE-ORDER REFERENCE

The public Lichess chess-openings dataset was used to identify named branches and compare anchor move orders. Its data are public domain under CC0. The course selection and explanations are original.

<https://github.com/lichess-org/chess-openings>

FAMILY OVERVIEW CROSS-CHECK

ChessBase's introductory overview was consulted to cross-check the distinction between the Classical, Samisch, Averbakh, Makogonov and Fianchetto families. Detailed course lines were checked locally rather than copied from a commercial course.

<https://learn.chessbase.com/en/page/kings-indian>

OPENING IDENTIFICATION

Chess.com's King's Indian overview and Makogonov opening page were used as supplementary identification references. No annotated game collection or commercial chapter is reproduced.

<https://www.chess.com/openings/Kings-Indian-Defense>

Sources and further study

MAKOGONOV MOVE-ORDER REFERENCE

The early h3 system is identified separately from ordinary Classical development.

<https://www.chess.com/openings/Kings-Indian-Defense-Makogonov-Variation>

LOCAL ENGINE VERIFICATION

Official Stockfish 18, Windows AVX2. The locally available engine was used for finite checks and explicitly labelled training continuations.

<https://stockfishchess.org/download/>

DIAGRAM ARTWORK

The Cburnett piece artwork is supplied through python-chess SVG rendering. Artwork attribution, adapted SVG sources and GPL version 2 license text accompany the course.

<https://python-chess.readthedocs.io/en/latest/svg.html>

Working chess vocabulary

HYPERMODERN PLAY

Allowing an opposing pawn center while preparing to challenge it with pieces and pawn breaks.

PAWN LEVER

A pawn move that creates contact with an enemy pawn and can change the structure through captures.

LOCKED CENTER

Central pawn chains block each other's forward movement; pawn breaks can still open the position.

FLUID CENTER

Central tension has not been resolved. Either side may advance or exchange pawns.

FIANCHETTO

Developing a bishop to g7 or b7 for Black, usually after moving the adjacent knight pawn.

OUTPOST

A useful square for a piece that is difficult for enemy pawns to attack. Its value still depends on exchanges and tactics.

INTERMEZZO

An intermediate move inserted before an expected recapture, usually because it creates a stronger threat.

Working chess vocabulary

RELATIVE PIN

Moving a piece exposes a more valuable piece behind it, such as a queen. The move may be legal but costly.

ABSOLUTE PIN

A piece cannot legally move off a line if that would expose its king to check.

MAROCZY BIND

A structure with pawns on c4 and e4 controlling d5, often restricting Black's freeing ...d5 break.

BENONI STRUCTURE

In this course, a white d5 wedge against black d6 and c5, usually after an exchange of Black's e-pawn.

PROPHYLAXIS

Identifying the opponent's useful plan or forcing resource and making a move that limits it.

COMPENSATION

Activity, king exposure, structure or other benefits received in return for a material or positional concession.

TRANSPOSITION

Reaching the same chess position by a different move order, including the same side to move and relevant rights.

Working chess vocabulary

ANCHOR

The selected course sequence before any clearly labelled illustrative continuation.

PLY

One move by one side. A full move normally contains a White ply and a Black ply.

SAN

Standard algebraic notation, such as ...Nbd7, ...Bxc3+ and O-O.

PGN

A text format for chess games, positions and variations. The course files are study material, not claimed historical games.

ENGINE EVALUATION

A numerical assessment from a finite computer search. It is not a proof, a win probability or a guarantee of practical ease.

CANDIDATE MOVE

A plausible move selected for calculation and comparison with alternatives.

File guide and credits

PDFS

Booklets 00-26 can be studied independently. COMPLETE_Kings_Indian_Defense_Course.pdf contains the same pages with bookmarks. Start with 00 and follow the schedule in 25.

PGNS

Repertoire_Lines.pgn stores 83 study branches. Middlegame_Laboratory.pgn stores ten illustrative continuations. Exercises.pgn contains the 72 exercise positions and answers. These are study files, not claims of historical games.

ARTWORK

Chess piece design: Colin M. L. Burnett / Cburnett. Dark colors were adapted to #182133 and white fills to #fafbf5. SVG units are normalized for correct size and centering within the squares. Source artwork and licensing are included in Artwork_Credits_and_Sources.

ORIGINAL WORK AND REPRODUCIBILITY

The teaching text, exercises, course structure and page design were written for this project. Course_Manifest.json records final PDF page counts and hashes. Verification_Summary.txt records production checks and their limits.